Timebars Ltd
Agile PM | Classic PM | PPM

# Costbars — Complete Reference Guide

**Version**: 1.4
**Last Updated**: 2026-10-21

Every help topic for **Costbars**, compiled into one document: the product guide, followed by the guides shared across Agilebars, Timebars and Costbars.

This file is **generated** from the individual guides in `public/docsHelp` of the helpapp repo by `tools/buildCompleteGuides.py`. Edit those guides and rebuild — changes made here are lost on the next run.

> **About the cross-references.** Each part keeps the links it had as a standalone guide, so a reference to another guide points at its page on the help site. In this document, that guide is one of the parts listed below.

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## What changed in version 1.4 (2026-10-21)

- The help guides moved to the Timebars Help Library. Every link to another guide, and every image, now points at `help.timebars.com` instead of the old help articles on www.timebars.com, and images that did not show in 1.3 (the Supply and Demand grids) are fixed.

Earlier versions: 1.3 (2026-09-26), 1.2 (2026-09-10), 1.1 (2026-09-10), 1.0 (2026-09-04).

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# Part 1 — The Costbars Product

## Costbars User Guide

> **This is the master user guide for Costbars.** It is complete for everything Costbars does on its own, and is used **alongside the common guides**, which cover what all three products share — the canvas and the user interface, the data model and scheduling engine, configuration and picklists, spreadsheet sync and data control, reports, risks and issues, cloud publishing and notifications. Agilebars and Timebars each have their own master guide in the same way.
>
> The four **PPM reference sections** at the end of this guide — the Five-Step Process, Writing a Business Case, the Project Assessment Tool and the Portfolio Status and Balancing Report — were previously separate documents and are now part of this one.

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4. The Portfolio Status and Balancing Report


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### Introduction

**Costbars** is the Project Portfolio Management (PPM) edition of the Timebars product family, designed specifically for portfolio managers, PMO leaders, and executives who need to make strategic decisions about project selection, resource allocation, and portfolio balance.

While Timebars focuses on project execution and Agilebars on sprint planning, Costbars provides the strategic layer above individual projects—helping you answer critical questions

like:

- Which projects should we approve, delay, or kill?
- How do we balance our portfolio across strategic objectives?
- Are we investing in the right initiatives?
- Do we have the resource capacity to deliver our committed projects?
- How do we ensure our portfolio aligns with organizational strategy?

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## What Makes Costbars Different

Costbars extends the core Timebars platform with specialized PPM capabilities:

### Strategic Scoring and Prioritization

- **Strategic Value (SV) Scores** – Calculate 0-100 scores based on alignment with investment categories, initiatives, objectives, and strategies
- **Ability to Execute (AE) Scores** – Evaluate project feasibility based on risk, size, complexity, and organizational capacity
- **Automated Recommendations** – Data-driven guidance on which projects to approve, review, or reject

### Portfolio-Level Views

- **Bubble Chart Selection** – Visual quadrant analysis showing SV Score vs. AE Score with bubble size representing budget/hours
- **Balanced Scorecard** – Portfolio balance analysis across strategic alignment, risk distribution, investment mix, and timeline spread
- **Tabular and Card Views** – Multiple viewing modes for analyzing project portfolios

### Resource Capacity Management

- **Supply vs. Demand Grids** – See resource availability compared to project demand across time periods
- **Resource Leveling** – Optimize project schedules to align demand with available capacity
- **Multiple View Modes** – Switch between FTE/Hours, Monthly/Weekly, and various GroupBy options

### Executive Reporting

- **Portfolio Status Reports** – Comprehensive portfolio health, balance, and strategic alignment reporting
- **Notification and Escalation** – Configurable alerts when projects exceed defined thresholds
- **Project Assessment Tool** – Standardized framework for evaluating project complexity and risk

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## ⚡ Get Started Fast with Ask AI

The quickest way to build your portfolio's project data is to let **Ask AI** create it for you, then refine it for your PPM analysis.

**You don't start from a blank page.** When your Costbars canvas is empty, the app automatically places a starter top-level bar near the top:

> **L1 Get Started here using AI, click the L1 ID below**

This is a ready-made **Portfolio (L1)** running from today for about six months. To begin:

1. **Click the bar's ID** to open its status pop-up form.
2. Click the ✨ **sparkle icon** (the Ask AI button) on that form.
3. **Describe a project** — paste a Business Case, or type a name and description — and click **Create**.

From there you work down the hierarchy by clicking the ✨ icon on each bar to create Projects, Work Packages, Tasks and Milestones. Two options are especially useful for portfolio planning:

- **Fill in Project Charter fields with AI** (when creating a Project) — enriches the value proposition, benefits, success criteria and more, which feed your strategic scoring.
- **Create a Resource Plan** — adds a task with **generic role placeholders** for the people the project will need, giving you an early resource estimate before names are known.

You can also assign **real, named people** to Tasks (the **Assign people** option, or the **Create Allocations** button) so your Supply vs. Demand grids reflect actual capacity.

After AI finishes, **refresh the page (F5)** to see the new bars on the canvas.

> 📚 For full step-by-step instructions, examples and tips, see **Common_06_How_To_Use_Ask_AI** ("How to Use Ask AI") in the Common Help Topics.

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## Getting Started with PPM

Before running the Costbars PPM process, you need to establish your data foundation.

### Prerequisite: Configure Your Resource Pool

Download the spreadsheet template through the Hamburger Icon menu. Populate the Resources Tab with:

- Resource IDs and names
- Roles and skills
- Resource rates

Then drag and drop onto the Canvas to build your centralized resource pool.

### Prerequisite: Allocate Resources to Tasks

Assign resources from your pool to specific tasks using the Resource Allocator. The system automatically calculates hours, ensuring accurate workload distribution and capacity planning.

### Prerequisite: Set Strategic Metadata

Configure strategic metadata to determine Strategic Value (SV) Scores. Set values for each project:

- **Investment Category** – Functional area or business unit
- **Investment Initiative** – Type of initiative (Innovation, Growth, Maintenance, Compliance)
- **Investment Objective** – Run/Grow/Transform classification
- **Investment Strategy** – Strategic pillar alignment

**Tip:** Use the Edit Metadata Icon to launch the Core Form from Tabular or Card View, or use the spreadsheet sync process.

### Prerequisite: Complete Project Assessments

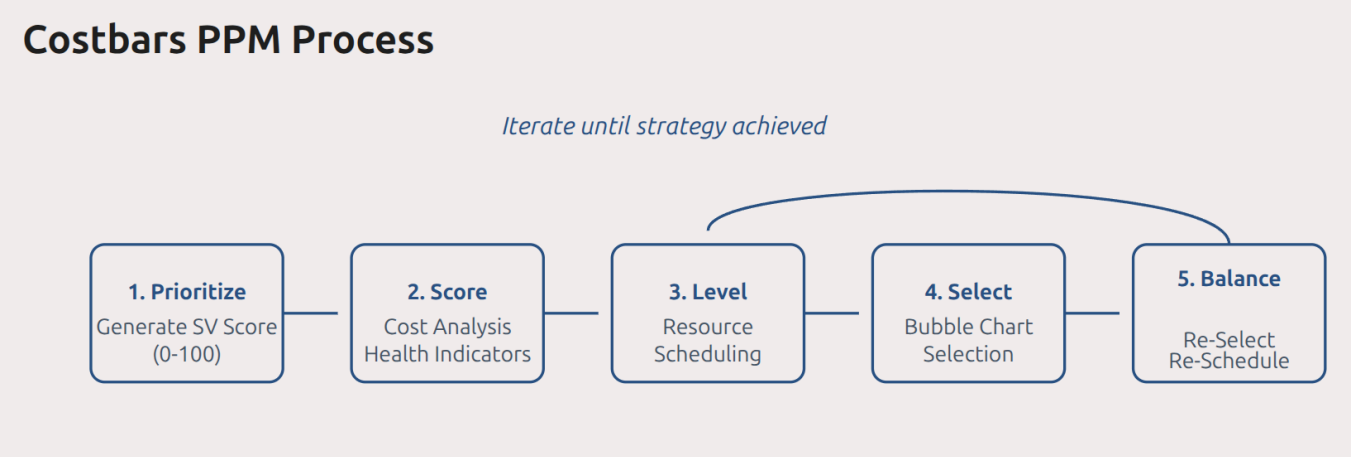
Fill in the Project Assessment form to capture critical project information:

| Field | Purpose |
|---|---|
| Risk vs Size and Complexity | 0-100 scale rating of project complexity |
| Executive Level Commitment | Level of senior leadership support |
| Estimation Class | SWAG / Based on History / Resource Driven |
| ROM Estimate | Rough Order of Magnitude budget range |
| Health Indicators | Issues, Schedule, Scope status (In-Flight projects) |

For detailed guidance on completing project assessments, see The Project Assessment Tool in the reference sections.

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## The Five-Step PPM Process



The Costbars PPM process helps you make data-driven decisions about project approval and termination through five sequential steps.

> This section is the working summary. The full reference — including the data foundation you need in place first, the scoring rules and the quick reference tables — is The PPM Five-Step Process in the reference sections at the end of this guide.

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### STEP 1: Prioritize Projects (Generate SV Scores)

Calculate Strategic Value based on custom Alignment Values and Order of Importance. The SV Score ranges from 0-100, where 100 indicates perfect alignment with operational strategy.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Prioritize** in the actions menu
2. The Prioritize popup opens

**Process:**

1. **Set Order of Importance** by dragging items in each list (most important at top):
    - Investment Categories
    - Investment Initiatives
    - Investment Objectives
    - Investment Strategies
2. Click **"Prioritize Test!"** to preview results without saving
3. Click **"Prioritize Finalize!"** to save scores to the database

**Database Field Updated:** `tbMDPriorityStrategic`

**Scoring Methods:**

- **Strategic + Financial (50/50):** Projects with ≥4 financial fields populated
- **Strategic Only (100%):** Projects with insufficient financial data (no penalty applied)

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### STEP 2: Score Projects (Generate AE Scores)

Evaluate projects using multiple data points including health indicators, costs, hours, and Size vs Complexity metrics. The Ability to Execute (AE) Score identifies potential challenges and resource requirements.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Score** in the actions menu
2. The Scoring popup opens

**Process:**

1. Review "Data Requirements & Formula Descriptions" section
2. Click **"Generate Ability to Execute Scores - Test"** to preview
3. Click **"Generate Ability to Execute Scores - Final"** to save

**Database Fields Updated:** `tbMDCostbarsScore`, `tbMDDecisionStrategic`

**AE Score Recommendations:**

| Score | In-Flight Projects | New Projects |
|---|---|---|
| ≥80 | Continue | PROCEED: Strong scoring |
| 60-79 | Review | REVIEW: Moderate scoring |
| <60 | Consider Terminating | REJECT: Weak scoring |

**Score Color Coding:**

| Color | Score Range | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| Green | ≥80 | Strong |
| Yellow | 60-79 | Moderate |
| Red | <60 | Weak |

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### STEP 3: Level Resources

Optimize resource demand to align with resource supply by adjusting project start and finish dates. View in real-time the resource demand comparison across the timeline as projects are manually rescheduled on the Timebars Canvas.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Level** in the actions menu
2. The Leveling View opens on the Timebars Canvas

**Process:**

1. View total resource demand chart
2. Identify over-allocations (red areas)
3. Drag and drop project bars to adjust schedules
4. Monitor real-time demand updates
5. Continue until demand aligns with supply

For detailed resource capacity analysis, see Resource Management below.

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### STEP 4: Select Projects (Bubble Chart)

Utilize the bubble chart visualization to quickly identify which projects to approve or kill. Bubble size, color, and position are based on SV Score and AE Score ranges.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Select** or **Bubble Chart** in the actions menu
2. The Bubble Chart view opens

**Understanding the Bubble Chart:**

- **X-Axis:** Strategic Value (SV Score)
- **Y-Axis:** Ability to Execute (AE Score)
- **Bubble Size:** Budget Cost or Forecast Hours
- **Bubble Color:** By Status or by Product

**Quadrant Interpretation:**

| Position | Meaning | Action |
|---|---|---|
| Top-Right (High SV + High AE) | Strategically aligned, likely to succeed | **APPROVE** – High-value, low-risk projects |
| Top-Left (Low SV + High AE) | Misaligned but low-risk projects | **REVIEW** – Easy to execute but questionable value |
| Bottom-Right (High SV + Low AE) | Strategically aligned, risky execution | **MITIGATE** – Important but needs risk reduction |
| Bottom-Left (Low SV + Low AE) | Misaligned and risky projects | **KILL** – Poor candidates for approval |

**Selection Process:**

1. Enter SV Score threshold (e.g., 60)
2. Enter AE Score threshold (e.g., 70)
3. Click **"Select Test"** to preview
4. Click **"Select Final"** to save

**Database Field Updated:** `tbMDYesNoSelector` (Yes/No)

**Selection Formula:**

```
Final Score = (SV Score × 60%) + (AE Score × 40%)
If Final Score > Average Threshold → Selected: Yes
If Final Score ≤ Average Threshold → Selected: No
```

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### STEP 5: Balance the Portfolio

Review the Score Card to assess portfolio balance. Discover anomalies and perform project adjustments to optimize portfolio alignment across strategic dimensions.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Balance** or **Score Card** in the actions menu
2. The Portfolio Score Card view opens

**Score Card KPI Sections:**

| Section | What It Measures |
|---|---|
| SV Score Distribution | Very High (80-100) to Very Low (0-19) |
| AE Score Distribution | Same ranges as SV Score |
| Investment Strategy | Projects by strategy alignment |
| Investment Objectives | Run/Grow/Transform balance |
| Investment Category | Category concentration |
| Risk Balance | Risk coverage across priorities |
| Resource Balance | Allocation by priority level |
| Duration Balance | Short (0-4mo) / Medium (4-12mo) / Long (12+mo) |

**KPI Indicators:**

- 🟢 **Green:** Balanced
- 🟡 **Yellow:** Needs attention
- 🔴 **Red:** Action required

**Balancing Actions:**

1. Review KPI indicators for problem areas
2. Re-select killed projects if needed
3. Kill additional projects to free resources
4. Reschedule projects to improve timing
5. Re-run scoring if metadata changes

For comprehensive portfolio balancing guidance, see Portfolio Balancing with the Balanced Scorecard below.

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## Resource Management (Supply vs. Demand)

Costbars provides powerful resource capacity planning through Supply and Demand grids that show resource availability compared to project demand across time periods.

### Understanding the Supply vs. Demand Grid

The grid displays **5 summary rows** that help you identify over-allocation and resource constraints:

1. **Supply (FTE)** – Available resource capacity in Full-Time Equivalents
2. **Demand (FTE)** – Required resource capacity from all projects
3. **Variance (S-D)** – Supply minus Demand (negative = over-allocated)
4. **Month Header** – Time period labels (Monthly or Weekly view)
5. **Resource/Project/Role** – The dimension being analyzed

### View Modes

**FTE vs Hours:**

- **FTE (Full-Time Equivalent)** – Shows capacity as decimal (e.g., 0.5 = half-time)
- **Hours** – Shows actual hours required/available

**Monthly vs Weekly:**

- **Monthly** – Aggregates capacity across entire months
- **Weekly** – Provides granular week-by-week analysis

**GroupBy Options:**

| GroupBy | What It Shows |
|---|---|
| **Project** | Resource demand organized by project |
| **Resource Name** | Workload for each named resource |
| **Role** | Capacity and demand by role/skill |

## Named vs Generic Resources

**Named Resources:**

- Specific individuals (e.g., "John Smith, Senior Developer")
- Allocated by person
- Shows individual capacity and workload

**Generic Resources:**

- Role-based allocation (e.g., "Developer", "Business Analyst")
- Represents pools of similar resources
- Useful for planning before specific assignments

## Interpreting Variance Values

| Variance | Meaning | Action |
|---|---|---|
| **Positive (e.g., +2.5)** | Supply exceeds demand | Capacity available for new projects |
| **Zero or Near-Zero** | Balanced allocation | Optimal utilization |
| **Negative (e.g., -1.5)** | Over-allocated | Delay projects, hire resources, or reduce scope |

## Using Supply vs. Demand for Resource Leveling

1. **Identify Over-Allocations** – Look for negative variance (red) in any time period
2. **Adjust Project Schedules** – Drag project bars on the canvas to shift demand
3. **Monitor Real-Time Updates** – Watch variance recalculate as you move projects
4. **Balance Across Time** – Smooth resource demand to avoid peaks and valleys

**Best Practice:** Aim for slight under-allocation (positive variance) to allow for unexpected work and planning buffers.

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## Project Views (Tabular and Card)

Costbars provides two specialized views for analyzing your project portfolio: Tabular View and Card View.

### Tabular View

A spreadsheet-style interface for data-intensive portfolio analysis.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Tabular View** in the actions menu
2. The spreadsheet-style grid opens

**Key Columns:**

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| ID | Project identifier (e.g., L2:PJ01) |
| Type | Project type classification |
| Name | Project name |
| Product | Timebars/Agilebars/Costbars |
| Status | In-Flight, Approved, Proposed, etc. |
| SV Score | Strategic Value Score (0-100) |
| AE Score | Ability to Execute Score (0-100) |
| F Score | Final Combined Score |
| Selected | Yes/No indicator from selection process |
| Decision | Approve/Review/Reject recommendation |

**Use Cases:**

- Quickly sort and filter large project lists
- Export to Excel for further analysis
- Bulk edit project metadata
- Review scoring results across entire portfolio

### Card View

A visual, card-based interface for intuitive portfolio review.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Cards View** in the actions menu
2. The card grid displays

**Card Elements:**

Each card displays:

- Project name and ID
- Product type (Costbars/Timebars/Agilebars)
- Status badge (color-coded)
- SV Score and AE Score (with color indicators)
- Budget/forecast information
- Selection status (Yes/No)
- Decision recommendation

**Use Cases:**

- Executive presentations and portfolio reviews
- Visual pattern recognition (e.g., many red scores)
- Quick scanning of portfolio health
- Stakeholder communication

### Editing Metadata from Views

**From Tabular View:**

- Click the **Edit Metadata Icon** on any row
- Core Form launches with full project details
- Make changes and save

**From Card View:**

- Click any card to expand
- Access editing options
- Update fields and save

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## Portfolio Balancing with the Balanced Scorecard

The Balanced Scorecard helps you assess whether your portfolio is balanced across multiple strategic dimensions.

### What is Portfolio Balance?

A balanced portfolio means:

- Investment is distributed appropriately across strategic objectives
- Risk is managed within organizational tolerance
- Resources are allocated to the right priorities
- Projects span appropriate time horizons

An **unbalanced portfolio** creates strategic risk, operational problems, and misalignment with organizational goals.

## The Four Scorecard Quadrants

### 1. Strategic Alignment

Shows how portfolio budget is distributed across strategic pillars (e.g., "Increase market share", "Improve core products", "Ensure compliance").

**What to Look For:**

- Does budget allocation match strategic priorities?
- Are top strategic pillars adequately funded?
- Are low-priority areas consuming too many resources?

**Example Problem:**

- Strategic Pillar #1 receives only 15% of budget
- Strategic Pillar #5 receives 45% of budget
- **Action:** Reallocate budget to match stated priorities

### 2. Risk Balance

Displays portfolio distribution across risk categories (Very High, High, Medium, Low, Very Low).

**What to Look For:**

- Does risk distribution match organizational risk tolerance?
- Are you over-concentrated in high-risk projects?
- Do you have enough low-risk quick wins?

**Example Problem:**

- 60% of budget allocated to High/Very High risk projects
- Organization has conservative risk appetite
- **Action:** Kill or defer high-risk projects; approve safer alternatives

### 3. Investment Mix

Shows portfolio breakdown by initiative type:

| Initiative Type | Typical Range |
|---|---|
| **Maintenance & Operational** | 20-35% |
| **Innovation & Transformation** | 20-40% |
| **Growth & Enhancement** | 25-35% |
| **Mandatory & Compliance** | 10-20% |

**What to Look For:**

- Over-investment in Maintenance (starving innovation)
- Under-investment in Compliance (regulatory risk)

- Appropriate balance for your organizational strategy

**Example Problem:**

- 50% of budget in Maintenance & Operational
- Only 15% in Innovation & Transformation
- **Action:** Defer low-value maintenance; approve innovation projects

### 4. Timeline Distribution

Evaluates balance across time horizons:

| Time Horizon | Typical Range | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| **Short-term (0-4 months)** | 20-30% | Quick wins, bug fixes |
| **Medium-term (4-12 months)** | 40-50% | Standard projects |
| **Long-term (12+ months)** | 20-30% | Strategic transformations |

**What to Look For:**

- Zero long-term projects (no strategic positioning)
- Too many short-term projects (reactive mode)
- Balanced distribution across horizons

**Example Problem:**

- 0% long-term projects
- 80% medium-term projects
- **Action:** Approve strategic long-term initiatives

### How to Use the Balanced Scorecard

#### Step 1: Review Each Quadrant

- Check KPI indicators (🟢 Green, 🟡 Yellow, 🔴 Red)
- Identify problem areas (red or yellow)

#### Step 2: Analyze Imbalances

- Understand why imbalances exist
- Consider organizational context
- Determine acceptable vs. problematic imbalances

#### Step 3: Take Rebalancing Actions

- **Kill Projects:** Remove low-priority projects in over-represented categories
- **Approve Projects:** Fast-track projects in under-represented categories
- **Reschedule Projects:** Shift timelines to smooth resource demand
- **Adjust Metadata:** Correct misclassified projects

#### Step 4: Re-Run the Five-Step Process

- Re-prioritize if strategic rankings changed
- Re-score if project complexity changed
- Re-select with new thresholds
- Review updated Balanced Scorecard

**Step 5: Monitor Over Time**

- Generate scorecard monthly
- Track progress toward target balance
- Adjust approval criteria to maintain balance

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## Advanced Features

The following advanced features provide additional depth for sophisticated portfolio management. Click the links below for detailed guides.

### Project Assessment Tool

A comprehensive evaluation framework that helps you objectively evaluate project feasibility, complexity, and risk before committing resources.

**What It Does:**

- Analyzes projects across four dimensions: Technical Risk, Political Risk, Size, and Complexity
- Generates an Overall Feasibility Score (0-100)
- Provides tailored recommendations based on risk category
- Helps compare projects objectively using consistent criteria

**When to Use:**

- Before approving new projects
- During portfolio reviews
- When requesting additional resources
- To justify timeline or budget negotiations

**Key Sections:**

- Technology Assessment (maturity, team expertise, architecture complexity, integrations)
- Team & Resources Assessment (team size, stakeholder count, resource availability)
- Organizational & Political Factors (change impact, executive Comittment, stakeholder alignment)
- External Factors & Constraints (regulatory requirements, external dependencies, market timing)
- Project Scope & Scale (duration, budget magnitude)

**Risk Categories:**

| Score | Risk Level | Recommended Action |
|---|---|---|
| 0-25 | LOW RISK (Green) | Proceed with standard project management |

| Score | Risk Level | Recommended Action |
|---|---|---|
| 26-50 | MEDIUM RISK (Yellow) | Enhanced monitoring and risk mitigation |
| 51-75 | HIGH RISK (Orange) | Consider phasing or scope reduction |
| 76-100 | CRITICAL RISK (Red) | Reconsider or start with proof-of-concept |

**For complete assessment guidance:** See The Project Assessment Tool in the reference sections at the end of this guide.

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### Portfolio Status and Balancing Report

A comprehensive portfolio-wide report providing health indicators, financial analysis, strategic alignment assessment, and multi-dimensional balance evaluation.

**What It Provides:**

- Executive Summary with health indicators (Overall, Scope, Schedule, Cost, Hours, Risk, Issues)
- Financial Summary by category (In Progress, Approved, Proposals)
- Strategic Alignment Analysis (budget distribution across strategic pillars)
- In-Flight Projects Status (with critical projects requiring attention)
- Approved Projects Readiness Assessment
- New Proposals Evaluation
- Risk Score Portfolio Analysis (budget distribution by risk level)
- Initiative Type Balance Analysis (Maintenance, Innovation, Growth, Compliance)
- Time Horizon Balance Analysis (Short/Medium/Long-term mix)

**When to Use:**

- Before quarterly portfolio review meetings
- When evaluating new project proposals
- When needing to free up resources
- For executive leadership reporting
- To assess strategic alignment

**Key Metrics:**

| Metric | Purpose |
|---|---|
| Portfolio Health Indicators | Quick overview of portfolio status |
| Budget Variance Analysis | Spending vs. planned budgets |
| Strategic Pillar Allocation % | Does spending match strategic priorities? |
| Risk Distribution % | Is portfolio within risk tolerance? |
| Initiative Type Balance Score | Balanced across project types? |
| Time Horizon Balance Score | Appropriate short/medium/long-term mix? |

**For complete report guide:** See Costbars PPM Pf Detail Report for Balancing How To

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### Configuring Notification Thresholds and Alerts

Configure automated notifications to alert stakeholders when projects exceed defined thresholds for schedule, budget, risk, or health indicators.

**What It Does:**

- Define threshold rules for triggering notifications
- Set delivery preferences (SMS, Push, Email)
- Configure escalation paths for critical projects
- Customize quiet hours and cooldown periods

**Threshold Rules:**

| Rule | What It Monitors | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Days Overdue Threshold | Schedule slippage | Alert if >5 days late |
| Budget Overrun % | Cost variance | Notify if costs exceed budget by 15% |
| Overall Health | Project health status | Flag any project marked Red |
| Executive Commitment | Sponsor support level | Alert if Comittment drops |
| Strategic Value % | Strategic alignment | Flag high-value at-risk projects |
| Likelihood of Success % | Risk scoring | Alert if likelihood <40% |

**Configuration Steps:**

1. Open Admin → Notifications
2. Add or Edit Notification Profile
3. Set contact details and delivery channels
4. Configure threshold values
5. Test configuration before activating
6. Enable automated alerts

**For complete configuration guide:** Text Notifications Guide

Text Notifications User Guide, Part 2 — Technical Reference

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### Five-Step Scoring Process (Technical Details)

Deep dive into the scoring methodology, data requirements, and formula specifications for both Strategic Value (SV) and Ability to Execute (AE) scoring.

**SV Score Components:**

- Investment Category alignment
- Investment Initiative alignment
- Investment Objective alignment
- Investment Strategy alignment
- Financial metrics (if sufficient data available)

**AE Score Components:**

- Risk vs. Size and Complexity assessment
- Executive Commitment level
- Estimation Class quality
- Health Indicators (for In-Flight projects)
- Budget and hours variance (for In-Flight projects)

**Data Requirements:**

- Minimum required fields for scoring
- Data quality thresholds
- Handling of missing data
- "Not Assessed" handling

**For complete technical specifications:** See Costbars PPM Scoring Guide 5 Step Process

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## Troubleshooting

### Missing Data Warnings

**Problem:** Scoring fails with data requirement errors

**Solutions:**

- Check that Project Assessment fields are populated
- Verify Risk vs Size/Complexity is assessed (not "Not Assessed")
- Ensure Executive Commitment is set
- For In-Flight: Check health indicators and baseline hours
- For New: Check Estimation Class and ROM Estimate

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### Projects Not Appearing in Views

**Problem:** Expected projects don't show in Tabular/Card/Bubble Chart

**Solutions:**

- Confirm Status is not "Closed"
- Check State is not "Spawned"
- Verify project is within selected filter criteria
- Refresh the view

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### Financial Score Shows Zero

**Problem:** SV Score shows 0 or projects not getting financial component

**Solution:**

- Need at least 4 of 7 financial fields populated
- Values of "Not Assessed" don't count toward the 4-field minimum
- Enter actual budget, baseline, forecast, or cost values

### Resource Variance Always Negative

**Problem:** Supply vs. Demand grid shows constant over-allocation

**Solutions:**

- Verify resource supply is configured correctly
- Check that resource pool includes all available resources
- Consider whether project resource estimates are realistic
- Use resource leveling to shift project timelines

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## References to Common Guides

Costbars shares many features with Timebars and Agilebars. For guidance on these common capabilities, refer to these user guides:

### Core Functionality

- **Common User Interface Guide** – Canvas navigation, filters, hierarchy display, bar creator, editing bars, baseline management, view controls
- **Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide** – How data is organized, IndexedDB details, data hierarchy, backup/restore procedures
- **Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide** – 6-step sync cycle, CSV file export/import, template configuration, bidirectional data exchange

### Project Management Features

- **Common Risks Issues Change Requests User Guide** – Creating and managing RIC items, visual indicators, card/tabular views, progress workflows

### Reporting and Publishing

- **Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide** – General Reports, Portfolio Reports, Project Reports, Task Reports, Resource Reports
- **Common Cloud Reports and Dashboard Guide** – Executive Portfolio Reports, Card-Based Drilldown, Interactive dashboards with 7-dimension health tracking
- **Common Cloud Publishing Guide** – Publishing to Timebars Cloud, PubSets, Re-Publish, Re-Hydrate, cross-device sync

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## Quick Reference

### PPM Menu Actions

| Button | Action |
|---|---|
| Prioritize | Generate SV Scores based on strategic alignment |
| Score | Generate AE Scores based on feasibility assessment |

| Button | Action |
|---|---|
| Level | Open resource leveling view for capacity optimization |
| Select / Bubble Chart | Run selection algorithm with visual quadrant analysis |
| Balance / Score Card | Review portfolio balance across multiple dimensions |
| Tabular View | Spreadsheet-style data view for analysis |
| Cards View | Visual card-based view for reviews |
| Process Help ❓ | Open PPM documentation |

### Score Interpretation

| Score Range | Color | SV Score Meaning | AE Score Meaning |
|---|---|---|---|
| 80-100 | Green | Very High Strategic Value | Very High Ability to Execute |
| 60-79 | Yellow | High Strategic Value | High Ability to Execute |
| 40-59 | Orange | Moderate Strategic Value | Moderate Ability to Execute |
| 0-39 | Red | Low Strategic Value | Low Ability to Execute |

### Decision Matrix

| SV Score | AE Score | Recommendation |
|---|---|---|
| High | High | **APPROVE** – Strategic and feasible |
| High | Low | **MITIGATE** – Important but risky; reduce scope or phase |
| Low | High | **REVIEW** – Easy to execute but questionable value |
| Low | Low | **KILL** – Neither strategic nor feasible |

---

## Getting Help

For additional assistance:

- **Process Help Button ( ❓ )** – Context-sensitive help within the PPM interface
- **Advanced Feature Guides** – See links in Advanced Features section above
- **Common Feature Guides** – See links in References to Common Guides section above
- **Support Contact** – Contact your Timebars administrator or support team

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# PPM Reference Sections

The four sections that follow are the detailed references behind the PPM workflow described above. Each was previously a separate document. They run in the order an initiative travels through the portfolio:

| Section | Covers |
|---|---|
| The PPM Five-Step Process | the method, end to end, and the data foundation it depends on |

| Section | Covers |
|---|---|
| Writing a Business Case | how an idea enters the portfolio, with two worked examples |
| The Project Assessment Tool | scoring one project's risk, size and complexity |
| The Portfolio Status and Balancing Report | reading the portfolio as a whole, and acting on it |

Read them in order the first time; after that, go straight to the one you need.

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## The PPM Five-Step Process

### Introduction

This guide covers the Costbars Project Portfolio Management (PPM) module - a Five-Step Procedure for Project Approval or Termination.

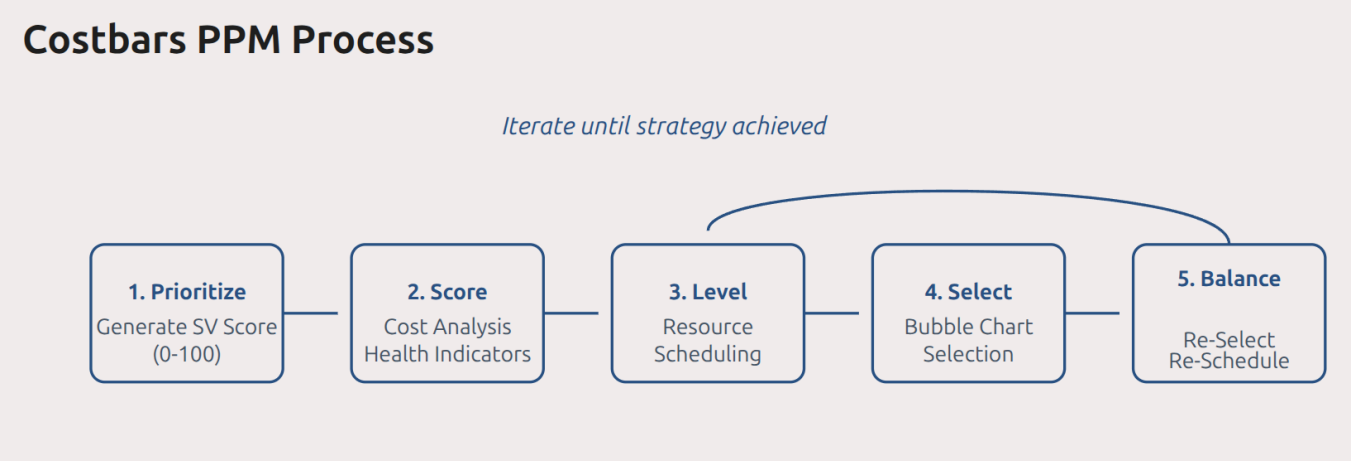
**What you will learn:**

- **Prerequisite Workflow Process** - Prepare project metadata for project selection
- **Project Selection Process** - How to use Costbars Project Pipeline Scheduler and prioritise, approve or kill projects

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### Costbars High-Level Process Diagram

The PPM (Project Portfolio Management) process can start once the Portfolio of Projects has been resource-loaded and is ready for analysis. If resource-loaded schedules are not feasible—which is often the case—ensure that Hours Estimates and/or Cost Estimates have been entered into each Project Bar within the Portfolio.




### Prerequisite Workflow: Establish the Data Foundation

Before running the Project Selection Process, complete these five setup steps.

---

### Prerequisite Step 1: Configure Resource Pool & Metadata

Download the spreadsheet template through the Hamburger Icon menu. Populate the Resources Tab with resource IDs, names, roles, skills, and rates. Then drag and drop onto the Canvas to build your centralized resource pool.

---

### Prerequisite Step 2: Establish Resource Summary Task

Create a resource summary task that serves as the foundation for resource allocation. This task provides a consolidated view and enables accurate resource planning across the project portfolio.

---

### Prerequisite Step 3: Allocate Resources to Tasks

Assign resources from your centralized pool to specific tasks using the Resource Allocator. The system automatically calculates hours, ensuring accurate workload distribution and capacity planning.

---

### Prerequisite Step 4: Set Strategic Metadata

Configure strategic metadata against projects to determine Strategic Value (SV) Scores. This metadata drives portfolio balance decisions and ensures alignment with organizational priorities.

Set values for each project:

- **Investment Category**
- **Investment Initiative**
- **Investment Objective**
- **Investment Strategy**

> **Tip:** Use the Edit Metadata Icon to launch the Core Form from Tabular or Card View, or use the spreadsheet sync process.

---

### Prerequisite Step 5: Complete Project Assessment

Fill in the Project Assessment form to finalize the Project Charter. This comprehensive assessment captures all critical project information, justification, and expected outcomes.

**Project Assessment Form Fields:**

The Project Assessment captures data that feeds into the AE Score calculation:

| Field | Purpose |
|---|---|
| Risk vs Size and Complexity | 0-100 scale rating of project complexity |
| Executive Level Commitment | Level of senior leadership support |
| Estimation Class | SWAG / Based on History / Resource Driven |
| ROM Estimate | Rough Order of Magnitude budget range |
| Health Indicators | Issues, Schedule, Scope status (In-Flight projects) |

**For In-Flight Projects, also assess:**

- Health Issues status (Green/Yellow/Red)
- Health Schedule status (Green/Yellow/Red)
- Health Scope status (Green/Yellow/Red)
- Budget Cost
- Baseline Hours

**For New Projects, also assess:**

- Cost estimate
- Work hours estimate
- State (Approved/Awaiting Approval/etc.)

---

## Project Selection Process: 5 Steps to Approve or Terminate Projects

---

### STEP 1: Prioritize Projects (SV Score)

Calculate Strategic Value based on custom Alignment Values and Order of Importance. The SV Score ranges from 0-100, where 100 indicates perfect alignment with operational strategy. This score becomes the foundation for all prioritization decisions.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Prioritize** in the actions menu
2. The Prioritize popup opens

**Process:**

1. **Set Order of Importance** by dragging items in each list (most important at top):
    - Investment Categories
    - Investment Initiatives
    - Investment Objectives
    - Investment Strategies
2. Click **"Prioritize Test!"** to preview results without saving
3. Click **"Prioritize Finalize!"** to save scores to the database

**Database Field Updated:** `tbMDPriorityStrategic`

**Scoring Methods:**

- **Strategic + Financial (50/50):** Projects with ≥4 financial fields populated
- **Strategic Only (100%):** Projects with insufficient financial data (no penalty applied)

---

### STEP 2: Score Projects (Risk/Complexity)

Evaluate projects using multiple data points including health indicators, costs, hours, and Size vs Complexity metrics. Incorporate additional project metadata to generate comprehensive risk scores that identify potential challenges and resource requirements.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Score** in the actions menu
2. The Scoring popup opens

**Process:**

1. Review "Data Requirements & Formula Descriptions" section
2. Click **"Generate Ability to Execute Scores - Test"** to preview
3. Click **"Generate Ability to Execute Scores - Final"** to save

**Database Fields Updated:** `tbMDCostbarsScore`, `tbMDDecisionStrategic`

**AE Score Recommendations:**

| Score | In-Flight Projects | New Projects |
|---|---|---|
| ≥80 | Continue | PROCEED: Strong scoring |
| 60-79 | Review | REVIEW: Moderate scoring |
| <60 | Consider Terminating | REJECT: Weak scoring |

---

### STEP 3: Level Resources

Optimize resource demand to align with resource supply by adjusting project start and finish dates. View in real-time the resource demand comparison across the timeline as projects are manually rescheduled on the Timebars Canvas.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Level** in the actions menu
2. The Leveling View opens on the Timebars Canvas

**Process:**

1. View total resource demand chart
2. Identify over-allocations (red areas)
3. Drag and drop project bars to adjust schedules
4. Monitor real-time demand updates
5. Continue until demand aligns with supply

### STEP 4: Select Projects

Utilize the bubble chart visualization to quickly identify which projects to kill. Bubble size, color, and position are based on SV Score and Risk Score ranges. Enter your thresholds and run the selection algorithm for data-driven recommendations.

**How to Access:**

1. From the PPM Page, click **Select** or **Bubble Chart** in the actions menu
2. The Bubble Chart view opens

**Understanding the Bubble Chart:**

- **X-Axis:** Strategic Value (SV Score)
- **Y-Axis:** Ability to Execute (AE Score)
- **Bubble Size:** Budget Cost or Forecast Hours
- **Bubble Color:** By Status or by Product

**Quadrant Interpretation:**

| Position | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Top-Right (High SV + High AE) | Strategically aligned, more likely to succeed |
| Top-Left (Low SV + High AE) | Misaligned low risk projects |
| Bottom-Right (High SV + Low AE) | Strategically aligned, less likely to succeed |
| Bottom-Left (Low SV + Low AE) | Misaligned and risky projects |

**Selection Process:**

1. Enter SV Score threshold
2. Enter AE Score threshold
3. Click **"Select Test"** to preview
4. Click **"Select Final"** to save

**Database Field Updated:** `tbMDYesNoSelector` (Yes/No)

**Selection Formula:**

```
Final Score = (SV Score × 60%) + (AE Score × 40%)
If Final Score > Average Threshold → Selected: Yes
If Final Score ≤ Average Threshold → Selected: No
```

---

### STEP 5: Balance the Portfolio

Review the Score Card—is it in balance? Discover anomalies and perform project adjustments as necessary to optimize portfolio balance. Re-select killed projects, kill other projects, or reschedule projects to achieve optimal alignment.

### How to Access:

1. From the PPM Page, click **Balance** or **Score Card** in the actions menu
2. The Portfolio Score Card view opens

### Score Card KPI Sections:

| Section | What It Measures |
|---|---|
| SV Score Distribution | Very High (80-100) to Very Low (0-19) |
| AE Score Distribution | Same ranges as SV Score |
| Investment Strategy | Projects by strategy alignment |
| Investment Objectives | Run/Grow/Transform balance |
| Investment Category | Category concentration |
| Risk Balance | Risk coverage across priorities |
| Resource Balance | Allocation by priority level |
| Duration Balance | Short (0-4mo) / Medium (4-12mo) / Long (12+mo) |

### KPI Indicators:

- 🟢 **Green:** Balanced
- 🟡 **Yellow:** Needs attention
- 🔴 **Red:** Action required

### Balancing Actions:

1. Review KPI indicators for problem areas
2. Re-select killed projects if needed
3. Kill additional projects to free resources
4. Reschedule projects to improve timing
5. Re-run scoring if metadata changes

---

## Quick Reference

## Menu Actions

| Button | Action |
|---|---|
| Prioritize | Generate SV Scores |
| Score | Generate AE Scores |
| Level | Open resource leveling view |
| Select/Bubble Chart | Run selection algorithm |
| Balance/Score Card | Review portfolio balance |
| Tabular View | Spreadsheet-style data view |
| Cards View | Visual card-based view |
| Process Help ❓ | Open PPM documentation |

### Score Color Coding

| Color | Score Range | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| Green | ≥80 | Strong |
| Yellow | 60-79 | Moderate |
| Red | <60 | Weak |

---

### Troubleshooting

#### Missing Data Warnings:

- Check that Project Assessment fields are populated
- Verify Risk vs Size/Complexity is assessed (not "Not Assessed")
- Ensure Executive Commitment is set
- For In-Flight: Check health indicators and baseline hours
- For New: Check Estimation Class and ROM Estimate

#### Projects Not Appearing:

- Confirm Status is not "Closed"
- Check State is not "Spawned"

#### Financial Score Shows Zero:

- Need at least 4 of 7 financial fields populated
- Values of "Not Assessed" don't count toward the 4-field minimum

---

*Transform Your Portfolio Management: Data-driven decisions. Strategic alignment. Optimized outcomes.*

*For technical details on scoring algorithms, see the Costbars PPM Technical Design Specification.*

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## Writing a Business Case

### How the Business Case becomes a Project Charter

In Costbars an idea enters as an **initiative justified by a Business Case**, is **scored/selected**, and is then **authorized by a Project Charter** to become a formal project. You author the **Business Case first** — with an AI assistant or by hand, following the sample below — then bring it into Costbars:

1. On a **Portfolio (L1)** bar, click its **ID**, then the ✨ **Ask AI** icon.
2. **Paste your Business Case** (formal or rough — headings are optional) and click **Create**.
3. The AI creates **one Project (L2)** initiative and maps your content into the **Project Charter** fields by meaning. Anything it cannot place in a specific field is preserved under headings in **Management Notes** ( `tbMDNotes` ) so nothing is lost.

4. **Review and complete** any thin fields. The initiative starts at **Status = New**.
5. Run the existing **PPM scoring / selection**. Once the initiative is approved and formally underway, set **Status = In Progress**.

You can also enter or refine Charter data by hand: click a Project (Green) bar's **ID → Form**, scroll to the **Project Charter** section, and edit the fields (you can paste formatted text directly; data saves when you leave a field). To hide fields from your users, configure the Core Report spreadsheet tab. **To view and print the Project Charter**, launch the Cards view on the PPM Page or the Portfolio Reports Menu.

> The **Business Case** is your *input* document; the **Project Charter** is the formal, generated sign-off artifact. The sample Business Case below is a worked example you can adapt for AI-assisted or manual authoring — it is a sample, not a fixed template.

### Sample Business Case: CRM System Cloud Migration

The following example was generated by Grok.

### Metadata

| Attribute | Value | Attribute | Value | Attribute | Value |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Status | New | Sponsor | Jim Cox | Primary Line of Business | IT Department |
| Workflow State | Awaiting Approval | PMI Phase | Initiating | Business Owner | Jim Cox |
| Stage | Prioritized | Business Advisor | Joe Blow | Sponsoring Department | Sales |
| Investment Portfolio | xxx | Type of Initiative | Project | Primary Contact | null |
| Contact Info | xxx | | | | |

### Project Name/Title

### CloudSync CRM Migration

### Background Information

The organization currently relies on an on-premises CRM system (LegacyCRM v5.2) that is over a decade old. The system struggles with frequent downtime, slow performance, and limited scalability, impacting sales team productivity. Maintenance costs have risen by 15% annually, totaling $120,000 in 2024. A cloud-based CRM solution offers scalability, enhanced security, and integration with modern tools like mobile apps and AI analytics.

### Stakeholders

| Name | Role | Department | Contact Info |
|---|---|---|---|
| Jim Cox | Sponsor/Business Owner | Sales | jim.cox@company.com |
| Joe Blow | Business Advisor | IT | joe.blow@company.com |
| Sarah Lee | IT Project Manager | IT | sarah.lee@company.com |
| Sales Team | End Users | Sales | sales.team@company.com |
| Finance Department | Budget Approver | Finance | finance@company.com |

### Problem/Opportunity

The current on-premises CRM system cannot support the organization’s growth, with a 20% increase in customer data annually. It lacks real-time analytics, mobile access, and integration with marketing platforms, leading to missed sales opportunities estimated at $200,000 annually. Migrating to a cloud-based CRM (e.g., Salesforce or HubSpot) provides scalability, real-time insights, and improved user experience.

### Consequence of Inaction

- **Financial Impact**: Continued maintenance costs of $120,000/year and lost revenue of $200,000/year due to inefficiencies.
- **Operational Impact**: Increased system downtime (currently 10 hours/month) disrupts sales workflows.
- **Competitive Risk**: Competitors using modern CRMs gain market share through faster customer response times.

### Objectives and Scope

### Objectives

- Migrate the CRM system to a cloud platform by Q4 2025.
- Reduce system downtime to under 1 hour/month.
- Enable mobile access and real-time analytics for the sales team.
- Achieve 20% improvement in sales team productivity within 6 months post-migration.

### Scope

- **Inclusions**: Data migration, cloud CRM setup, user training, and integration with email and marketing tools.
- **Exclusions**: Hardware upgrades for on-premises servers, custom feature development beyond standard CRM capabilities.

### Expected Benefits

- **Financial**: $150,000/year savings from reduced maintenance and $250,000/year in additional revenue from improved sales efficiency.
- **Operational**: 90% reduction in downtime and 20% faster data access.
- **Strategic**: Enhanced customer insights through AI analytics, supporting 25% faster decision-making.

### Capabilities Needed

- Cloud infrastructure (e.g., AWS or Azure).
- CRM platform expertise (e.g., Salesforce-certified administrators).
- Data migration tools (e.g., Informatica or Talend).
- Training program for 50+ sales staff on cloud CRM usage.

### Senior Level Commitment

- **Sponsor**: Jim Cox (VP of Sales) will champion the project, securing budget and aligning with strategic goals.
- **IT Director**: Maria Gomez will oversee technical implementation and resource allocation.

### Constraints & Assumptions

### Constraints

- Budget capped at $300,000 for migration and first-year licensing.
- Project completion required by Q4 2025 to align with sales cycle.

### Assumptions

- Existing data can be migrated without significant cleansing (80% clean).
- Staff training will be completed within 2 months post-migration.

### Cost Benefit Analysis

| Item | Cost | Benefit | Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cloud CRM Licensing (Year 1) | $100,000 | Maintenance Cost Savings | $150,000/year |
| Data Migration & Setup | $150,000 | Increased Revenue | $250,000/year |
| Training Program | $50,000 | Productivity Gains | $100,000/year |
| **Total** | **$300,000** | **Total (Year 1)** | **$500,000** |

**ROI**: 66.7% in Year 1 ($500,000 benefits - $300,000 costs / $300,000).

### Risk Assessment

| Risk | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Data migration errors | Medium | High | Conduct pre-migration testing and backups. |
| Staff resistance to new system | High | Medium | Implement change management and training. |
| Budget overrun | Low | High | Lock in vendor contracts early. |

### Timeline and Milestones

| Milestone | Date |
|---|---|
| Vendor Selection | Q2 2025 |
| Data Migration Completion | Q3 2025 |
| System Testing | Q3 2025 |
| User Training | Q4 2025 |
| Go-Live | Q4 2025 |

### Resource Requirements

- **Personnel**: 1 Project Manager, 2 CRM Developers, 1 Data Analyst, 1 Trainer (6-month contracts).
- **Tools**: Cloud CRM subscription, migration software, training materials.
- **Budget**: $300,000 (including licensing, migration, and training).
- **Gaps**: Need to hire external CRM consultant for 3 months.

### Workflow Status

- **Current Status**: Awaiting Approval (as of April 29, 2025).
- **Next Steps**: Present to Finance Committee in May 2025 for budget approval.

### Written By

- **Author**: Sarah Lee, IT Project Manager
- **Role**: Project Lead
- **Date**: April 29, 2025

### A second worked example, generated by an AI assistant

### CRM Cloud Migration Business Case

**Project ID:** CLD-CRM-2025-Q2
**Project Name:** Enterprise CRM Cloud Migration
**Department:** Information Technology
**Project Sponsor:** Sarah Chen, Chief Information Officer
**Project Manager:** Michael Rodriguez
**Date Created:** April 29, 2025

**Version:** 1.0
**Status:** Draft - Pending Executive Approval
**Priority:** High
**Estimated Budget:** $675,000
**Expected Duration:** 8 months

## Executive Summary

Global Dynamics Inc. currently relies on a legacy on-premises CRM system that is approaching end-of-life with vendor support ending in December 2025. This business case proposes migrating our CRM infrastructure to a cloud-based solution to enhance customer engagement capabilities, improve operational efficiency, and reduce long-term IT maintenance costs. The initiative aligns with our 2025 digital transformation strategy and is expected to generate an ROI of 127% over three years with a payback period of 17 months. Implementation would begin in Q3 2025 with full deployment by Q1 2026.

## Background Information

Global Dynamics has been using the current on-premises SalesForce Enterprise v9.2 CRM system for over seven years, with significant customizations developed for our specific sales and customer service processes. System performance has degraded over time, and our current architecture lacks integration capabilities with modern cloud tools our teams increasingly rely on. IT maintenance costs have risen 18% annually for the past three years, while system availability has declined to 97.2% against our target of 99.5%.

Our 2025-2027 strategic plan emphasizes customer-centric digital transformation, requiring more robust analytics and omnichannel engagement capabilities that our current system cannot efficiently deliver. Recent competitive analysis reveals that 78% of our industry peers have already transitioned to cloud-based CRM infrastructure, potentially gaining market advantages through improved customer insights and engagement capabilities.

## Stakeholders

- **Executive Leadership Team:** Requires improved business intelligence and ROI from customer relationship management
- **Sales Department (120 users):** Primary system users needing reliable mobile access and integrated communication tools
- **Customer Service Team (85 users):** Requires enhanced case management and customer journey tracking
- **IT Department:** Responsible for implementation, integration, and ongoing support
- **Finance Department:** Concerned with cost management and accurate revenue forecasting
- **Marketing Team (45 users):** Needs better campaign attribution and customer segmentation tools
- **Compliance & Legal:** Must ensure data governance and privacy regulations are maintained
- **External Customers:** Will experience improved service delivery and communication channels

### Problem Opportunity & Options Analysis

The current on-premises CRM system presents several challenges:

- Limited mobile functionality hampering field sales effectiveness (productivity loss estimated at $325,000 annually)
- Siloed data preventing unified customer view across touchpoints
- Manual reporting processes requiring 25+ hours weekly of analyst time
- Limited scalability during peak seasons causing system slowdowns
- Rising maintenance costs (currently $420,000 annually)

Three options were evaluated:

1. **Maintain Current System with Upgrades**
    - Lowest initial investment ($125,000)
    - Does not address fundamental architecture limitations
    - Continues high maintenance costs and technical debt
    - Risk of unsupported system after December 2025
2. **Build Custom Hybrid Solution**
    - Preserves some existing customizations
    - Higher development complexity and risk
    - Medium initial cost ($900,000) but higher long-term maintenance
    - 14-month implementation timeline
3. **Full Cloud Migration (Recommended)**
    - Higher initial investment ($675,000)
    - Eliminates on-premises infrastructure costs
    - Provides immediate access to new capabilities and regular updates
    - 8-month implementation timeline with phased approach
    - Supports strategic goals for data-driven customer engagement

### Consequence of Inaction

Failing to address our CRM infrastructure limitations will likely result in:

- Potential system failure after vendor support ends in December 2025
- Continued productivity loss estimated at $520,000 annually across departments
- Growing competitive disadvantage as competitors leverage advanced cloud CRM capabilities
- Inability to implement planned customer experience initiatives in our strategic roadmap
- Increasing technical debt and maintenance costs projected to rise 20% annually
- Growing security vulnerabilities as security patches become unavailable
- Employee dissatisfaction and potential retention issues among sales and service teams

### Expected Benefits

The cloud CRM migration is expected to deliver:

- Reduction in IT infrastructure costs of $275,000 annually starting in year 2
- 15% increase in sales team productivity through improved mobile access and automation
- 30% reduction in reporting time through enhanced analytics capabilities
- Improved system availability from current 97.2% to 99.9%
- Enhanced customer satisfaction through unified communication channels and faster response times
- Scalability to support planned company growth of 20% over next two years
- Annual software license cost reduction of $120,000 through SaaS subscription model
- Improved data security and compliance with automatic security updates

## Capabilities Needed & Implementation Approach

### Required capabilities:

- Cloud CRM platform with strong mobile support and API ecosystem
- Data migration tools and expertise
- Integration capabilities with ERP and marketing automation tools
- Enhanced analytics and reporting functionality
- Training resources for all user groups

### Implementation approach:

- Phase 1 (Months 1-2): Requirements validation and vendor selection
- Phase 2 (Months 3-4): System configuration and data migration planning
- Phase 3 (Months 5-6): Integration development and testing
- Phase 4 (Month 7): User acceptance testing and training
- Phase 5 (Month 8): Go-live and hypercare support
- Cross-functional implementation team with dedicated resources from IT, Sales, and Customer Service
- Change management program including executive sponsorship and department champions

## Risk Assessment

| Risk | Probability | Impact | Mitigation Strategy |
|---|---|---|---|
| Data migration errors | Medium | High | Comprehensive data audit, multiple test migrations, validation protocols |
| User adoption resistance | High | Medium | Early stakeholder engagement, phased training approach, identified champions in each department |
| Integration failures with legacy systems | Medium | High | Detailed integration mapping, API testing framework, contingency interfaces |
| Budget overruns | Medium | Medium | 15% contingency buffer, fixed-price vendor contracts where possible, bi-weekly financial reviews |
| Timeline delays | Medium | Medium | Agile implementation methodology, critical path monitoring, resource redundancy for key roles |
| Business disruption during cutover | Low | High | Weekend deployment window, rollback plan, parallel systems during transition |

## Performance Measurement

Success of the CRM cloud migration will be measured through:

- System availability metrics (target: 99.9% uptime)
- User adoption rates across departments (target: 95% within 60 days)
- Average case resolution time (target: 20% improvement by 6 months post-implementation)
- Sales cycle length (target: 15% reduction by 9 months post-implementation)
- Customer satisfaction scores (target: 8% improvement within first year)
- Report generation time (target: reduction from current 25+ hours weekly to under 8 hours)
- Monthly tracking of actual vs. projected cost savings
- Quarterly executive dashboards showing ROI and KPI progress

## Constraints & Assumptions

### Constraints:

- Implementation must complete before current vendor support ends (December 2025)
- Total project budget cannot exceed $700,000 (including contingency)
- System must maintain all current compliance certifications (SOC2, GDPR, CCPA)
- Core business operations cannot be disrupted during business hours
- All customizations must be thoroughly documented for future maintenance

### Assumptions:

- Vendor selection can be completed within 45 days
- IT resources will be available as scheduled without competing priorities
- Department SMEs will be allocated 25% time to the project during critical phases
- Current data quality is sufficient for migration without major cleansing efforts
- Network infrastructure can support increased cloud traffic without upgrades

## Cost Benefit Analysis

### Investment costs:

- Software licensing: $325,000 (year 1), $275,000 annually thereafter
- Implementation services: $220,000
- Data migration: $85,000
- Training and change management: $45,000
- Contingency (15%): $101,250
- **Total Year 1 Investment: $675,000**

### Annual benefits (steady state):

- Infrastructure cost reduction: $275,000
- License cost savings: $120,000
- Productivity improvements: $325,000
- Reduced maintenance effort: $180,000

- **Total Annual Benefits: $900,000**

Financial analysis:

- Year 1 net benefit: $225,000
- 3-year ROI: 127%
- Payback period: 17 months
- NPV (3 years, 12% discount rate): $1.12M

### Senior Level Commitment & Next Steps

Executive sponsorship has been secured from:

- Sarah Chen, CIO (Primary Sponsor)
- David Takahashi, VP of Sales
- Elena Rodriguez, Chief Customer Officer

Next steps:

1. Present business case to Executive Committee for approval by May 15, 2025
2. Form project steering committee with biweekly meeting cadence
3. Initiate procurement process for vendor selection by June 1, 2025
4. Allocate required IT resources and finalize project team by June 15, 2025
5. Begin requirements validation and system design by July 1, 2025

**Decision requested:** Executive approval to proceed with project initiation and $675,000 budget allocation from FY2025 IT transformation fund.

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## The Project Assessment Tool

### Introduction

The Project Assessment Tool is a comprehensive evaluation framework built into Costbars that helps you objectively evaluate project feasibility, complexity, and risk before committing resources. It analyzes your project across four critical dimensions—technical risk, political risk, size, and complexity—to generate an Overall Feasibility Score ranging from 0 (low risk) to 100 (critical risk).

This guide will walk you through how to complete an assessment, explain what to consider for each question, and show you how to use the results to make better project decisions.

---

### Why Use the Project Assessment Tool

### Before You Commit Resources

Complete an assessment when you're evaluating whether to green-light a new project or add it to your portfolio. The assessment helps you:

- **Identify hidden complexity** that isn't obvious from the project proposal

- **Surface risk factors** across technical, political, organizational, and market dimensions
- **Compare projects objectively** using consistent criteria rather than gut feelings
- **Generate talking points** for portfolio review meetings and gate reviews
- **Set realistic expectations** with stakeholders about project difficulty

### During Portfolio Reviews

Use assessment scores to:

- **Balance your portfolio risk** by mixing low-risk and high-risk initiatives appropriately
- **Prioritize projects** based on both strategic value and feasibility
- **Justify decisions** with objective data when stakeholders challenge project selections
- **Identify projects** that need additional risk mitigation planning before launch

### When Requesting Resources

Assessment results provide evidence when negotiating for:

- **Extended timelines** for complex projects
- **Additional budget** to address high-risk technical components
- **More experienced team members** when expertise gaps are identified
- **Executive sponsorship** for politically complex initiatives

---

## Understanding the Scoring System

### The Four Risk Dimensions

Your project receives four component scores, each ranging from 0-100:

1. **Technical Risk Score** – Measures technology maturity, team expertise, architectural complexity, and integration challenges
2. **Political Risk Score** – Evaluates stakeholder alignment, decision-maker complexity, and organizational change impact
3. **Size Score** – Quantifies project duration, team size, budget, and number of integrations
4. **Complexity Score** – Assesses regulatory requirements, external dependencies, organizational experience, and market factors

### Overall Feasibility Score

These four component scores are combined into a single Overall Feasibility Score (0-100) that determines your project's risk category:

- **0-25: LOW RISK** (Green) – "Very Small and Simple" to "Medium with Some Complexity"
    - Highly feasible with manageable complexity
    - Proceed with standard project management practices
    - Expected success rate is high

- **26-50: MEDIUM RISK** (Yellow) – "Large with Moderate Complexity" to "Complex but Manageable"
    - Moderate feasibility requiring careful planning
    - Enhanced monitoring and stakeholder communication needed
    - Success likely with proper risk management
- **51-75: HIGH RISK** (Orange) – "Significant Complexity" to "Very Large and Complex"
    - Significant feasibility challenges present
    - Consider phased approach or scope reassessment
    - Requires executive sponsorship and dedicated risk resources
- **76-100: CRITICAL RISK** (Red) – "Highly Complex and Risky" to "Extremely Complex and Risky"
    - Extremely challenging feasibility
    - Recommend reconsidering or significant scope reduction
    - If proceeding, consider proof-of-concept or pilot first

### What Higher Scores Mean

**Important:** Higher scores indicate higher risk and lower feasibility. A project scoring 85 is significantly riskier than a project scoring 35. Don't confuse this with a "grade" where higher is better—in risk assessment, lower scores are more favorable.

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### How to Launch an Assessment

### Step 1: Navigate to Your Project

Open your Costbars Project Pipeline view and locate the project you want to assess.

### Step 2: Open the Assessment Tool

Click the actions menu for your project and select **"Project Assessment"** (or the assessment icon, depending on your interface configuration). The Project Assessment Tool modal will open.

### Step 3: Review the Project Assessment Guide

At the top of the assessment form, you'll see a collapsible **"Project Assessment Guide"** section (green header). Click it to expand helpful context about:

- The purpose of the assessment
- Quick start tips
- How to approach each section honestly
- What to do with your results

### Step 4: Verify Project Information

Confirm the project details shown at the top:

- **Project Name** – The project you're assessing
- **tbID** – Your project's unique identifier
- **Type/Sub-Type** – Project classification
- **Duration** – Calculated project duration in months

---

### Completing Each Section

The assessment form is organized into logical sections. For each question, select the option that most accurately reflects your current project reality—not what you hope will be true, but what you know today.

### Section 1: Technology Assessment

This section evaluates technical risk factors.

### Technology Maturity

*"How mature and proven is the core technology?"*

**What to consider:**

- Has this technology been used successfully in production environments?
- Are there established best practices and vendor support?
- Is the technology cutting-edge or bleeding-edge?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Well-established and mature** – Choose this if you're using proven, widely-adopted technology with years of production use (e.g., standard relational databases, established web frameworks)
- **Mature but evolving** – Technology has been around but is still adding major features or undergoing significant updates
- **Relatively new but tested** – Technology has production users but limited track record (e.g., framework that's 2-3 years old)
- **Emerging/early adoption** – Very few production implementations, mostly early adopters
- **Cutting-edge/unproven** – Brand new technology, experimental, or still in beta

**Why it matters:** Unproven technology increases technical risk exponentially. You may encounter undocumented bugs, lack of community knowledge, and limited vendor support.

### Team Technical Expertise

*"Does your team have experience with this technology stack?"*

**What to consider:**

- How many team members have hands-on production experience?
- Have they built similar systems before, or will they be learning?
- Is this a completely new technology area for your organization?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Extensive expertise** – Multiple team members have 2+ years production experience
- **Solid understanding** – Team has worked with similar technologies and can adapt
- **Some experience** – 1-2 team members have experience, others will learn
- **Limited knowledge** – No one has significant experience, but fundamentals are understood
- **Learning on the job** – Completely new to everyone, requires extensive training

**Why it matters:** Even mature technology becomes risky when your team lacks experience. Learning curves delay projects and increase the probability of architectural mistakes.

### System Architecture Complexity

*"How complex is the technical architecture?"*

**What to consider:**

- How many moving parts does the system have?
- Are you building microservices, monoliths, or distributed systems?
- How many different technologies need to work together?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Simple/straightforward** – Single application, minimal components
- **Moderate complexity** – A few integrated components with clear boundaries
- **Multiple interconnected systems** – Several systems that need to coordinate
- **Complex distributed architecture** – Microservices, event-driven, multiple data stores
- **Highly complex/novel** – Cutting-edge architecture patterns, complex state management

**Why it matters:** Architectural complexity multiplies integration points, increases debugging difficulty, and makes changes ripple across systems.

### Integration Requirements

*"How many systems will this project need to integrate with?"*

**What to consider:**

- Count both internal systems and external third-party services
- Include APIs, databases, authentication systems, and data pipelines
- Consider real-time vs. batch integrations

**Scoring guidance:**

- **None or 1-2** – Standalone or minimal integrations
- **3-5 integrations** – Multiple but manageable
- **6-10 integrations** – Significant integration effort required
- **11-15 integrations** – Complex integration landscape
- **More than 15** – Extremely complex integration requirements

**Why it matters:** Each integration point is a potential failure point. Testing complexity grows exponentially with integration count, and coordinating across teams becomes a project management challenge.

### Section 2: Team & Resources Assessment

This section evaluates whether you have the right people and resources.

### Project Team Size

*"How many people will actively work on this project?"*

**What to consider:**

- Count everyone who will contribute significant effort (developers, designers, analysts, etc.)
- Don't count occasional reviewers or advisors
- Consider both full-time and part-time contributors

**Scoring guidance:**

- **1-3 people** – Small, agile team
- **4-7 people** – Medium team size
- **8-15 people** – Large team requiring coordination
- **16-30 people** – Very large team with management overhead
- **More than 30** – Extremely large team, high coordination complexity

**Why it matters:** Larger teams require more communication, coordination meetings, and management overhead. Brooks' Law suggests that "adding people to a late project makes it later" due to communication complexity.

### Decision-Maker/Stakeholder Count

*"How many people have decision-making authority or significant input?"*

**What to consider:**

- Include everyone who can veto decisions or require design changes
- Count executive sponsors, product owners, compliance officers, etc.
- Include external stakeholders like regulators or partners

**Scoring guidance:**

- **1-2 stakeholders** – Clear decision-making authority
- **3-5 stakeholders** – Manageable stakeholder group
- **6-10 stakeholders** – Requires active stakeholder management
- **11-20 stakeholders** – Complex stakeholder ecosystem
- **More than 20** – Extremely complex stakeholder coordination

**Why it matters:** More stakeholders means more opinions, longer approval cycles, and higher probability of conflicting requirements. This increases political risk dramatically.

### Resource Availability

*"How certain are you that resources will be available when needed?"*

**What to consider:**

- Are team members dedicated to this project or splitting time?
- Do you have confirmed budget approvals?
- Are there competing priorities that could pull people away?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Fully committed and secured** – Dedicated team, approved budget, no conflicts
- **Generally available** – Resources committed but some flexibility needed
- **Partially available** – Significant time-sharing with other projects
- **Uncertain/competing priorities** – Resources are in high demand across projects
- **Highly uncertain** – No confirmed commitments, speculative team

**Why it matters:** Resource uncertainty creates schedule risk. Projects with part-time team members take 2-3x longer than projects with dedicated resources due to context-switching and coordination delays.

## Section 3: Organizational & Political Factors

This section assesses "soft" factors that often determine project success.

### Organizational Change Impact

*"How much organizational change will this project require?"*

**What to consider:**

- Will people need to change how they work?
- Are you replacing existing systems that people are comfortable with?
- Does this affect organizational structure or reporting lines?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Minimal/none** – Small improvement to existing processes
- **Some process adjustments** – Minor workflow changes
- **Moderate change** – Significant process changes, training required
- **Significant organizational change** – Major shifts in how work gets done
- **Transformational change** – Fundamental changes to business model or culture

**Why it matters:** Resistance to change is a leading cause of project failure. The more you disrupt existing workflows, the more change management effort is required.

### Executive/Sponsor Commitment

*"How committed is executive leadership to this project?"*

**What to consider:**

- Is there an active executive sponsor who attends meetings?
- Has leadership allocated appropriate budget and resources?
- Is this a strategic priority or a nice-to-have?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Strongly committed and visible** – Active sponsor, clear priority, visible support
- **Committed and supportive** – Sponsor engaged, project prioritized
- **Neutral/passive support** – Approved but not actively championed
- **Lukewarm interest** – Approved reluctantly, could be deprioritized
- **Minimal/unclear** – No clear sponsor, questionable Comittment

**Why it matters:** Projects without executive air cover stall when they hit obstacles. Strong sponsorship unblocks resources, resolves cross-functional conflicts, and protects the project during budget reviews.

### Stakeholder Alignment

*"How aligned are stakeholders on project goals and approach?"*

**What to consider:**

- Do stakeholders agree on what success looks like?
- Are there competing visions for the project?
- Have major conflicts been resolved or are they still simmering?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Fully aligned** – Clear shared vision, no significant disagreements
- **Mostly aligned** – General agreement with minor differences
- **Some disagreement** – Different priorities but willing to compromise
- **Significant conflicts** – Major unresolved disagreements
- **Highly conflicted** – Fundamental disagreements about goals or approach

**Why it matters:** Misaligned stakeholders create project whiplash—constant direction changes, rework, and scope creep as different factions push their agendas.

### Section 4: External Factors & Constraints

This section evaluates factors outside your direct control.

### Regulatory/Compliance Requirements

*"What regulatory or compliance requirements apply?"*

**What to consider:**

- Are there industry regulations (HIPAA, GDPR, SOX, etc.)?
- Do you need government approvals or certifications?
- Are there internal security/compliance requirements?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **None or minimal** – No significant regulatory requirements
- **Standard compliance** – Well-understood requirements, established processes
- **Moderate regulatory oversight** – Multiple requirements, some coordination needed
- **Significant regulatory burden** – Complex requirements, extensive documentation
- **Extensive and complex** – Heavy regulatory scrutiny, potential for delays

**Why it matters:** Regulatory requirements add time, cost, and risk. They often involve external parties (auditors, regulators) whose timelines you can't control.

### External Dependencies

*"How dependent is success on external parties?"*

**What to consider:**

- Are you waiting on vendor deliveries or third-party integrations?
- Do you need approvals from partners or customers?
- Are external market conditions critical to success?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Fully self-contained** – Everything needed is under your control
- **Minor external dependencies** – A few external factors, manageable

- **Moderate dependencies** – Success requires coordination with external parties
- **Significant external factors** – Heavy reliance on third parties
- **Critical external dependencies** – Success completely dependent on external parties

**Why it matters:** External dependencies introduce schedule risk you can't control. Vendor delays, partner priorities, or market timing can derail projects regardless of your team's execution.

### Organizational Experience

*"Has your organization done something like this before?"*

**What to consider:**

- Have you delivered similar projects successfully?
- Is this a completely new type of initiative?
- Do you have established playbooks and processes?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Highly experienced** – Done this many times, established processes
- **Experienced** – Several similar projects completed successfully
- **Some experience** – Attempted similar projects with mixed results
- **Limited experience** – Different from anything attempted recently
- **No experience** – Completely new territory for the organization

**Why it matters:** Organizations learn from experience. Your first e-commerce platform, first AI project, or first global rollout will encounter unknown challenges that experienced teams anticipate and mitigate.

### Market/Timing Sensitivity

*"How time-sensitive is this project?"*

**What to consider:**

- Is there a narrow market window?
- Are competitors launching similar offerings?
- Are there regulatory deadlines or contractual commitments?

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Not time-sensitive** – Flexible timeline, no urgency
- **Moderate timing preference** – Better sooner but not critical
- **Important timing** – Significant advantage to hitting target date
- **Critical timing** – Missing deadline has major consequences
- **Extremely time-sensitive** – Narrow window, delay means failure

**Why it matters:** Time pressure increases risk by forcing shortcuts, reducing testing time, and preventing proper risk mitigation. Critical deadlines eliminate flexibility to address unexpected problems.

### Section 5: Project Scope & Scale

This section quantifies the magnitude of your project.

### Project Duration

*This is automatically calculated based on your project's start and finish dates.*

**What it measures:**

- Projects under 3 months are lower risk from a schedule management perspective
- Projects over 12 months face higher risk due to:
  - Team turnover during the project
  - Technology and market changes
  - Requirement drift over time
  - Sustained momentum and stakeholder engagement

**Why it matters:** Longer projects have more opportunities to go wrong. Requirements change, people leave, priorities shift, and technologies evolve.

### Budget Magnitude

*"What is the total project budget?"*

**What to consider:**

- Include all costs: labor, software, hardware, consulting, training
- Consider fully-loaded costs including overhead
- Don't just count incremental expenses

**Scoring guidance:**

- **Under $50K** – Small investment, low financial risk
- **50*K*–250K** – Moderate investment
- **250*K*–1M** – Significant investment, requires careful management
- **1*M*–5M** – Major investment, executive visibility
- **Over $5M** – Strategic investment, board-level visibility

**Why it matters:** Larger budgets increase visibility and scrutiny, but also provide more resources to address problems. They also increase the consequence of failure.

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## Interpreting Your Results

### After You Click "Calculate Scores"

Once you complete all sections and click **"Calculate Scores"**, the tool processes your inputs and displays:

1. **Overall Feasibility Score** – The central risk score (0-100) with color-coded risk level
2. **Four Component Scores** – Individual scores for Technical Risk, Political Risk, Size, and Complexity
3. **Risk Level Badge** – Visual indicator (Green/Yellow/Orange/Red) showing your risk category
4. **Tailored Recommendations** – Specific guidance based on your project's risk profile

### Understanding Component Scores

Look at which components are driving your overall score:

**If Technical Risk is highest:**

- Your challenges are primarily about technology execution
- Consider technical prototypes or proof-of-concept phases
- Allocate more time for R&D and technical validation
- Ensure you have the right technical expertise on the team

**If Political Risk is highest:**

- Your challenges are about people, alignment, and organizational dynamics
- Invest heavily in stakeholder management and communication
- Ensure strong executive sponsorship
- Create clear decision-making frameworks upfront

**If Size Score is highest:**

- Your challenges are about project management and coordination
- Consider phased delivery to reduce team size and duration
- Implement robust project management practices
- Plan for extensive communication and coordination

**If Complexity Score is highest:**

- Your challenges are about external factors and unknowns
- Plan for contingencies and longer timelines
- Engage experts early (regulatory, integration, etc.)
- Build in flexibility to adapt as you learn

### Using the Recommendations

The tool generates specific recommendations based on your scores. Common recommendations include:

- **For projects with high technical risk:** Allocate extra time for R&D and consider technical pilots
- **For projects with high political risk:** Ensure strong executive sponsorship and stakeholder alignment
- **For large projects:** Consider phased approach and robust project management
- **For complex projects:** Plan for extensive integration testing and coordination
- **For cutting-edge technology:** Establish innovation labs and prototype early
- **For large teams:** Implement robust communication protocols and team coordination
- **For complex integrations:** Plan extensive testing phases and fallback strategies
- **For significant regulatory requirements:** Engage compliance experts from project start

### Risk Level Interpretation

#### LOW RISK (0-25) – GREEN

- **What it means:** Straightforward project with manageable complexity
- **Typical action:** Approve with standard project management practices
- **Watch for:** Don't become complacent—even "easy" projects need proper execution

#### MEDIUM RISK (26-50) – YELLOW

- **What it means:** Feasible but requires careful attention to risk factors
- **Typical action:** Approve with enhanced monitoring and risk mitigation plans
- **Watch for:** Specific component scores that are elevated—address those areas specifically

#### HIGH RISK (51-75) – ORANGE

- **What it means:** Significant challenges that could jeopardize success
- **Typical action:** Consider scope reduction, phasing, or additional resources before approval
- **Watch for:** Whether you have the organizational appetite for this level of risk

#### CRITICAL RISK (76-100) – RED

- **What it means:** Extreme challenges with low probability of success as scoped
- **Typical action:** Seriously reconsider; if proceeding, start with proof-of-concept
- **Watch for:** Pressure to proceed anyway due to political factors—resist if possible

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### What to Do With Your Assessment

### For Portfolio Managers

#### Document the Decision

- Save the assessment as part of your project intake documentation
- Reference scores when explaining portfolio decisions to stakeholders
- Use assessments to justify resource allocation recommendations

### Balance Your Portfolio

- Track the risk distribution across your entire portfolio
- Avoid concentrating too many high-risk projects simultaneously
- Balance high-risk/high-reward projects with safer initiatives

### Set Monitoring Thresholds

- Configure executive alerts based on assessment scores
- Schedule more frequent reviews for higher-risk projects
- Establish early warning indicators tied to the risk dimensions

### Compare Projects

- Use assessment scores to rank competing projects for resource allocation
- Consider both strategic value AND feasibility when prioritizing
- Identify projects that may need descoping to reduce risk scores

## For Project Managers

### Create Your Risk Management Plan

- Focus mitigation efforts on the highest-scoring risk dimensions
- Identify specific actions to address each elevated component
- Build contingency plans for the highest-risk areas

### Negotiate for Resources

- Use assessment scores as evidence when requesting additional time or budget
- Show stakeholders why complex projects need more resources
- Push back on unrealistic timelines with objective risk data

### Communicate with Stakeholders

- Share assessment results with your team and sponsors
- Ensure everyone understands the project's complexity
- Use scores to set realistic expectations about challenges ahead

### Plan for Phases

- If your score is high, propose a phased approach
- Start with proof-of-concept or pilot to de-risk before full investment
- Use early phases to validate assumptions and reduce uncertainty

## For Executive Sponsors

### Make Informed Investment Decisions

- Consider both strategic value and feasibility when approving projects
- Understand what level of risk your organization can handle
- Don't approve projects where scores exceed your risk tolerance

### Allocate Sponsorship Time Appropriately

- High-risk projects need more executive attention and intervention
- Plan to spend more time removing blockers for complex projects
- Schedule regular check-ins proportional to risk level

### Set Portfolio Risk Limits

- Establish acceptable thresholds for aggregate portfolio risk
- Limit the number of critical-risk projects running simultaneously
- Ensure your organization has capacity to handle high-risk projects

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## Best Practices

### Be Brutally Honest

The assessment is only as valuable as the honesty of your inputs. Don't let optimism bias or political pressure cause you to underestimate risk factors.

**Common honesty pitfalls:**

- "The team will learn quickly" (underestimating expertise gaps)
- "Stakeholders will align once we start" (ignoring current conflicts)
- "The technology should work fine" (hoping unproven tech magically succeeds)
- "We can probably get it done in 6 months" (ignoring historical data)

**Instead, be realistic:**

- "The team has never used this technology in production"
- "Stakeholders currently have conflicting requirements"
- "This technology has limited production track record"
- "Similar projects at our organization took 12-18 months"

### Complete Assessments Early

Don't wait until you've already committed resources. The assessment is most valuable **before** you approve the project, not after you're already underway.

**Ideal timing:**

- During initial project proposal evaluation
- Before portfolio review meetings
- When comparing multiple project proposals
- Before making final go/no-go decisions

### Involve Multiple Perspectives

Have several people complete the assessment independently, then compare and discuss differences. Different stakeholders often see different risk factors.

**Who should provide input:**

- Technical leads (for technology and architecture questions)
- Business owners (for stakeholder and organizational questions)
- Project managers (for resource and schedule questions)
- Compliance/legal (for regulatory questions)

### Reassess Periodically

Risk profiles change as projects progress. Reassess at major milestones:

- After requirements are finalized
- When technology choices are locked in
- If key team members leave or join
- When major scope changes are proposed
- At phase-gate reviews

### Don't Ignore Critical Risk Scores

If your project scores in the critical risk range (76-100), take it seriously. These scores indicate a very high probability of failure or major overruns.

**Your options:**

1. **Descope significantly** – Remove the highest-risk components to reduce score
2. **Start with a pilot** – Prove feasibility on a smaller scale first
3. **Wait for conditions to improve** – Delay until technology matures or expertise is acquired
4. **Accept the risk consciously** – Proceed knowing this is a high-risk bet

What you shouldn't do: Ignore the score and hope for the best.

### Use Scores in Context

Assessment scores don't make decisions for you—they inform your decision-making. A high-risk project might still be worth pursuing if:

- The strategic value is extraordinarily high
- You have no alternative path to achieve the goal
- You're willing to invest heavily in risk mitigation
- Failure wouldn't be catastrophic to the organization

Conversely, a low-risk project might not be worth doing if:

- The strategic value is minimal
- Opportunity cost is high (you'd have to pass on better projects)
- Even "easy" execution doesn't justify the benefit

### Document Your Assumptions

When completing the assessment, note any assumptions or uncertainties. This helps when reassessing later or explaining your reasoning.

**Example notes to capture:**

- "Assumed vendor delivers API on time (high uncertainty)"
- "Stakeholder count based on initial discussions, may increase"
- "Technology choice not final, could change to more mature option"
- "Resource availability depends on Project X completing on schedule"

### Share Results Broadly

Don't keep assessment results in a drawer. Share them with:

- Your project team (so they understand the challenges)
- Executive sponsors (so they know what they're signing up for)
- Other stakeholders (to set realistic expectations)
- Portfolio reviewers (to support portfolio decisions)

Transparency about risk builds trust and alignment.

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### Conclusion

The Project Assessment Tool transforms subjective project evaluation into objective, data-driven analysis. By systematically evaluating technical, political, size, and complexity dimensions, you gain clear visibility into project feasibility before committing resources.

Remember: The goal isn't to only approve low-risk projects. Organizations need to take calculated risks to achieve strategic objectives. The goal is to **know** what risks you're taking, **choose** which risks are worth taking, and **plan** appropriately for the risks you accept.

Use the assessment tool early and often. Complete honest evaluations. Share results broadly. Make informed decisions. And build a portfolio that balances ambition with achievability.

Your future self (and your organization) will thank you for the time invested in thorough project assessment.

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## The Portfolio Status and Balancing Report

### Introduction

The Portfolio Status and Balancing Report is your comprehensive tool for understanding portfolio health, strategic alignment, and balance across multiple dimensions. Unlike project-level reports that focus on individual initiative status, this report provides the portfolio-wide intelligence you need to make strategic decisions about what to start, what to continue, what to delay, and what to kill.

**When to use this report:**

- Before quarterly portfolio review meetings
- When evaluating new project proposals for approval
- When you need to free up resources and must identify projects to kill or delay
- When assessing whether your portfolio aligns with organizational strategy
- When reporting portfolio status to executive leadership
- When determining whether portfolio risk exposure is acceptable

**What you'll learn from this report:**

- Where your investment dollars are allocated (by strategic pillar, benefit type, initiative type, risk level)
- Whether your portfolio is balanced across time horizons and initiative types
- Which projects need immediate attention
- How your portfolio risk exposure compares to your organizational risk tolerance
- Specific recommendations for rebalancing your portfolio

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## Generating the Report

### Step 1: Ensure Your Data is Current

Before generating the report, make sure your project data is up-to-date:

- Project health indicators (scope, schedule, cost, hours, risk, issues) have been updated
- Budget, baseline, and forecast values are current
- Strategic priority scores are assigned to all active projects
- Risk scores have been calculated (ideally using the Project Assessment Tool)
- Project phases and states are accurate (Planning, Executing, Closing, etc.)
- Strategic pillar assignments are complete

**Why this matters:** The report's analysis is only as good as the underlying data. Outdated information leads to incorrect conclusions and poor decisions.

### Step 2: Navigate to the Report

Access the Portfolio Status and Balancing Report through:

- The Reports menu in Costbars
- The dashboard view, if configured
- The main navigation under "Portfolio Reports"

### Step 3: Configure Report Parameters (if applicable)

Depending on your Costbars configuration, you may be able to filter the report by:

- **Date range** – Focus on a specific quarter or fiscal year
- **Portfolio** – If you manage multiple portfolios, select which to analyze

- **Project states** – Include or exclude certain project states
- **Include proposals** – Choose whether to include new project proposals in the analysis

### Step 4: Generate and Export

- Click "Generate Report" to create the current portfolio analysis
- Export to PDF for executive distribution or meeting materials
- Export to Excel if you want to perform additional custom analysis
- Save a timestamped version for historical comparison

**Best practice:** Generate the report at consistent intervals (e.g., start of each month) so you can track how portfolio balance evolves over time.

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## Understanding the Executive Summary

The report opens with an Executive Summary designed to give you an immediate sense of overall portfolio health without requiring you to read the entire document.

### Portfolio Performance Summary

You'll see a table with health indicators for:

**Overall** – Composite indicator synthesizing all other dimensions **Scope** – Are projects delivering their planned scope? **Schedule** – Are projects meeting their timeline commitments? **Cost** – Is spending aligned with budgets? **Hours** – Is work effort tracking to estimates? **Risk** – What's the aggregate portfolio risk profile? **Issues** – Are active issues impacting delivery?

Each indicator shows a color-coded status:

- 🟢 **Green** – Performing well, no significant concerns
- 🟡 **Yellow** – Some concerns, requires monitoring
- 🔴 **Red** – Significant problems requiring immediate attention
- ○ **White/Gray** – Not assessed or insufficient data

### How to Interpret Health Indicators

**If Overall is Red:** Your portfolio has systemic problems affecting multiple dimensions. This requires executive attention and likely a portfolio review meeting to identify root causes and corrective actions.

**If Schedule is Red but Cost is Green:** Projects are running late but not over budget. This suggests schedule pressure, potentially due to optimistic planning, resource constraints, or underestimated complexity. Consider whether deadlines are realistic or need adjustment.

**If Cost is Red but Scope is Green:** You're spending more than planned but delivering planned scope. This could indicate poor initial estimates, scope creep that wasn't captured in scope metrics, or inefficient execution. Dig into individual project cost overruns.

**If Risk is Red:** Your portfolio contains too many high-risk projects or individual projects with extreme risk levels. This may be acceptable if it aligns with organizational strategy (e.g., transformation initiatives), but if it's unintentional, you need to de-risk the portfolio.

**If Issues is Red:** Active issues are accumulating across projects. This suggests inadequate issue resolution processes, resource constraints preventing issue closure, or systemic organizational problems creating issues faster than they can be resolved.

### What to Do With Red Indicators

1. **Read the detailed section** for that dimension later in the report
2. **Prepare discussion topics** for your next portfolio review meeting
3. **Identify specific projects** contributing most to the red status
4. **Develop action plans** to address the root causes
5. **Set a timeline** for when you expect the indicator to return to yellow or green

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### Reading Financial Summary Sections

The Financial Summary provides three critical views into portfolio spending:

### Portfolio Investment by Category

This table shows spending across three project categories:

**"In Progress" Projects** – Currently executing **"New and Approved" Projects** – Approved but not yet started **"New and Not Approved" Projects** – Proposals under evaluation

For each category, you see:

**Budget** – Original planned investment **Baseline** – Committed investment after planning (often $0 if not baselined) **Forecast** – Current expected total cost **Budget Variance** – How much forecast differs from budget **Forecast Variance** – How much forecast differs from baseline **Status** – Whether the category is on track

### How to Read the Numbers

Let's use an example:

```
"In Progress" Projects Budget: $1.4M
Baseline: $0.0M
Forecast: $0.4M
Budget Variance: $-0.9M (-68.6%)
```

### What this tells you:

You originally budgeted $1.4M for in-progress projects, but your current forecast shows you'll only spend $0.4M—a $900K underspend. This massive variance (-68.6%) suggests:

- Projects were cancelled or descoped after budget approval
- Initial budgets were extremely optimistic
- Projects are delayed and costs are being deferred
- Some "in progress" projects haven't actually consumed significant resources yet

**Action required:** Investigate why actual spending is so far below budget. If projects were cancelled, ensure those budget dollars are reallocated. If projects are delayed, update schedules accordingly.

### Example: Healthy Variance

```
"New and Approved" Projects Budget: $3.3M
Forecast: $3.1M
Budget Variance: $-0.2M (-6.1%)
Status: 🟢
```

This shows a small favorable variance (-6.1%), indicating your approved projects are forecast to come in slightly under budget—a healthy outcome suggesting good planning and execution.

### Example: Concerning Variance

```
"In Progress" Projects Budget: $2.0M
Forecast: $2.8M
Budget Variance: $+0.8M (+40%)
Status: 🔴
```

This shows significant cost overruns. Your in-progress projects were budgeted at $2.0M but are now forecast to cost $2.8M—a 40% overrun. This requires immediate investigation and corrective action.

### Financial-Benefits Forecast

This section shows expected benefits by category, such as:

- Source cloud services for core products
- Improve product reliability
- Improve productivity with Agile teams
- Strengthen cybersecurity infrastructure
- Build AI/ML capabilities

For each benefit type, you see budget, baseline, forecast, variances, and status.

**Why this matters:** It's not enough to track costs—you must also verify that your portfolio is delivering the strategic benefits that justified the investment. If "Build AI/ML Capabilities" shows a large negative variance, you're underinvesting in an area that may be strategically critical.

**How to use this section:**

1. **Identify benefit categories with large negative variances** – These are areas where you're delivering less benefit than planned
2. **Investigate why benefits are not materializing** – Are projects cancelled? Descoped? Not delivering expected value?
3. **Reallocate budget if needed** – If a benefit category is strategic, consider approving more projects in that area
4. **Question benefit assumptions** – If benefits consistently exceed forecasts across all categories, your benefit estimation methodology may be flawed

### Financial-Strategic Alignment

This critical section shows how portfolio budget is distributed across your strategic pillars, such as:

- Increase share of market
- Build recurring revenue streams
- Improve our core products
- Improve customer service
- Reduce waste
- Ensure compliance
- Serve more customers

For each strategic pillar:

**Budget** – Total budget allocated to projects supporting this pillar **% Budget Allocated** – What percentage of total portfolio budget goes to this pillar **Baseline, Forecast, Variances** – Standard financial tracking **Status** – Whether the pillar is adequately funded

### The Critical Metric: % Budget Allocated

This percentage reveals whether your portfolio spending matches your strategic priorities. Let's interpret an example:

```
Strategic Pillar: "Increase share of market"
Budget: $5.0M
% Budget Allocated: 82.1%
Status: 🔴
```

This says that 82.1% of your portfolio budget is allocated to projects supporting "Increase share of market." If this is your #1 strategic priority, that might be appropriate. But if it's one of seven equal priorities, this is a massive over-allocation that starves other strategic areas.

**Common problems revealed by this section:**

**Problem: Over-concentration in one pillar**

- One strategic pillar receives 70%+ of budget
- Other pillars are starved for resources
- Portfolio is not balanced across strategic objectives

**Action:** Identify lower-priority projects in the over-funded pillar and reallocate budget to under-funded pillars.

**Problem: Strategic priority mismatch**

- Your #1 strategic priority receives only 15% of budget
- Your #3 strategic priority receives 45% of budget
- Portfolio spending doesn't reflect stated strategy

**Action:** Either adjust portfolio composition to match strategy, or acknowledge that your actual strategy differs from your stated strategy and update strategic communications accordingly.

**Problem: Red status on critical pillars**

- Strategic pillars marked 🔴 indicate problems
- May indicate large variances between budget and forecast
- Suggests projects in that strategic area are struggling

**Action:** Investigate projects supporting that strategic pillar to understand root causes of variance or performance issues.

---

### Strategic Alignment Analysis

(This section is covered above in Financial-Strategic Alignment)

---

### In-Flight Projects Section

This section focuses on projects currently in execution, providing both overall status and specific project details.

### Status Summary

You'll see a breakdown like:

```
🟢 GREEN: 7 projects (54%)
🟡 YELLOW: 1 project (8%)
🔴 RED: 2 projects (15%)
⚪ NOT ASSESSED: 3 projects (23%)
TOTAL PROJECTS: 13
```

### How to Interpret Status Distribution

**Healthy Portfolio:**

- 60-80% of projects in Green status
- 15-25% in Yellow status (some challenges are normal)
- 0-10% in Red status
- 0-15% not assessed

**Concerning Portfolio:**

- Less than 50% Green
- More than 20% Red
- More than 25% not assessed (suggests inadequate monitoring)

### Critical Projects Requiring Attention

The report automatically identifies projects that meet specific risk criteria. The standard criterion is:

**"Project Priority is Immediate, and Overall Health is not Green"**

These are your fires that need fighting—high-priority projects that are struggling. The report lists them explicitly so you don't have to search for them in the full project list.

**If you see "No Projects are requiring attention at this time":** This is good news. It doesn't mean you have no struggling projects—it means your highest-priority projects are on track. You may still have lower-priority red projects, but they're not mission-critical.

**If you see multiple critical projects listed:** This requires executive intervention. High-priority projects that are red need one of:

- Additional resources to get them back on track
- Scope reduction to make them achievable
- Risk mitigation plans and executive sponsorship
- Possible termination if they can't be rescued

### Key Project Milestones

This table shows major milestones across all in-flight projects, with:

**Milestone** – Name of the milestone **Baseline** – Original committed date **Forecast** – Current expected completion date **Status** – Whether milestone is on track

Pay attention to:

- **No Baseline** – Milestone has no committed date yet

  - If this is early in the project, that's normal
  - If the project is well underway, this suggests poor planning

**Forecast significantly later than Baseline:**

- Indicates schedule slippage
- May signal broader project problems
- Could cascade delays to downstream projects

**Best practice:** For critical path milestones, investigate any forecast date that's more than 2 weeks later than baseline.

---

## Approved Projects Analysis

This section covers projects that have been approved but not yet started—your launch pipeline.

### Readiness Status Categories

✅ **READY TO START** – All prerequisites met

- Status is New, State is Approved, Awaiting Approval, or Requested Approval
- In Planning Phase
- Can launch as soon as resources become available

⚠️ **AWAITING INFORMATION** – Need inputs before launch

- Missing key requirements, dependencies, or decisions
- Cannot proceed until information is provided
- May require stakeholder engagement or additional analysis

❌ **BLOCKED** – Schedule Health indicates the project cannot progress

- Set via the Schedule Health (tbMDHealth) field, not the Status field
- Allows a project to be "In Progress" AND blocked simultaneously
- May be technical, organisational, or resource-related
- Requires active intervention to unblock

🔷 **INITIATING PHASE** – In early planning

- Still in PMI Initiating Phase
- Not yet ready for launch
- Expected to move to Planning Phase soon

### Project Inventory & Readiness Assessment Table

For each approved project, the table shows:

**Project Name** – The approved initiative **State** – Current approval state (Approved, Awaiting Approval, etc.) **PMI Phase** – Project management phase (Initiating, Planning, Executing, etc.) **Strategic Priority** – Priority score (0-100 scale) **Est. Duration** – Expected project length in months **Budget/Forecast** – Budgeted amount and current forecast **Readiness Status** – Visual indicator of launch readiness **Earliest Start** – First possible start date based on dependencies **Key Dependencies** – Predecessor projects that must complete first

### How to Use This Table

#### Scenario 1: Selecting next projects to launch

1. Filter for "✅ READY TO START" projects
2. Sort by Strategic Priority (highest first)
3. Check Earliest Start dates for any in the past or near-term
4. Verify no blocking dependencies

5. Confirm resources will be available (check Resource Capacity Analysis)
6. Approve launch for highest-priority ready projects

**Scenario 2: Unblocking projects**

1. Identify "⚠️ AWAITING INFORMATION" and "❌ BLOCKED" projects
2. For each project, identify what's missing or what's blocking it
3. Assign ownership for resolving each blocker
4. Set target dates for unblocking
5. Follow up until projects move to "✅ READY" status

**Scenario 3: Sequencing projects with dependencies**

Some projects show "Predecessor ID: A030" or similar in the Key Dependencies column. This means:

- The project cannot start until another project (ID A030) completes
- Launching it before its predecessor would create problems
- You need to respect this sequencing in your launch plan

**How to handle dependencies:**

1. Find the predecessor project in your portfolio
2. Check its forecast completion date
3. Set the dependent project's start date after the predecessor completes
4. Add buffer time for any handoff or knowledge transfer needed

### Recommended Start Sequence

The report provides a prioritized launch sequence like:

```
1. L2:PJ13 Private Cloud Phase 1
2. L2:PJ06 Constant Internal Delivery Enablement
3. L2:PJ04 Digital Desktop - Transformation
4. L2:PJ12 Partner Portal Platform
```

This sequence is calculated based on:

- Strategic priority scores
- Project dependencies
- Readiness status
- Earliest start dates

**How to use this:**

- Treat this as a suggested sequence, not a mandate
- Override the sequence if you have reasons (e.g., resource availability, stakeholder pressure, changing priorities)
- Use it as a starting point for discussion in portfolio planning meetings
- Validate that resource capacity supports this sequence (check Resource Capacity Analysis)

### Resource Capacity Analysis

This table shows monthly resource demand (in FTE or hours) for each approved project across future months. It's presented as a grid:

```
Project Name    | Sep 2025 | Oct 2025 | Nov 2025 | ...
----------------|----------|----------|----------|-
Project A       | 0.5      | 0.5      | 0.5      |
Project B       | 0        | 0        | 1.0      |
```

Numbers represent required FTE (full-time equivalent) resources in each month.

**How to interpret:**

**0.5 FTE** = Half of one person's time for that month **1.0 FTE** = One full person for that month **2.5 FTE** = Two and a half people for that month

**Sum the columns** to see total demand in each month. If total demand exceeds your available capacity, you have an over-allocation problem.

**Example interpretation:**

```
Total Demand:
Sep 2025: 3.5 FTE
Oct 2025: 5.0 FTE
Nov 2025: 7.5 FTE
Dec 2025: 8.0 FTE

Available Capacity: 5.0 FTE
```

This shows you'll be over-allocated starting in November (7.5 FTE demand with 5.0 FTE capacity). You need to either:

- Delay some project starts
- Hire additional resources
- Reduce scope to lower resource demand
- Accept that some projects will take longer than planned

**Smoothing resource demand:**

If you see sharp spikes in demand followed by valleys, consider:

- Shifting lower-priority project starts to fill the valleys
- Spreading project work more evenly over time
- Staggering project starts rather than launching many simultaneously

---

### New Proposals Evaluation

This section covers project proposals that haven't been approved yet—your intake pipeline.

### Proposal Status Categories

✅ **READY for Planning Phase** – Approved to move forward ⚠️ **AWAITING INPUT** – Need more information before decision ⚠️ **AWAITING REVIEW** – Pending evaluation by decision-makers 🔷 **Spawned State** – Initial creation, no progress in workflow

### Proposal Inventory & Assessment Table

Similar to approved projects table, but shows proposals with:

**Proposal Status** – Visual indicator of where it stands in approval process **Estimated values** – Since these aren't approved, budget/duration are estimates

### How to Evaluate Proposals

#### Step 1: Review proposals in "⚠️ AWAITING REVIEW" status

These are proposals waiting for your decision. For each:

1. Check Strategic Priority score – Does this align with current priorities?
2. Review Budget/Forecast – Is this investment level appropriate?
3. Check Est. Duration – Does timeline fit portfolio capacity?
4. Look for Key Dependencies – Will this create sequencing problems?
5. Consider portfolio balance – Will approving this improve or worsen portfolio balance?

#### Step 2: Use portfolio context for go/no-go decisions

Don't evaluate proposals in isolation. Consider:

**Risk balance:** If your portfolio is already 40% high-risk projects, do you want to approve another high-risk proposal?

**Initiative type balance:** If you're under-invested in Innovation & Transformation and this proposal falls in that category, it's more valuable than a similar Maintenance project.

**Time horizon balance:** If you have zero long-term projects, approve some long-duration proposals even if they're not the highest priority.

**Strategic alignment:** If a strategic pillar is under-funded, prioritize proposals supporting that pillar.

**Resource capacity:** If your resource capacity analysis shows over-allocation, don't approve resource-intensive proposals until capacity becomes available.

#### Step 3: Reject or defer proposals that cannot proceed

Proposals that cannot move forward due to unavailable budget, missing resources, unresolved dependencies, or strategic conflicts should be either formally **rejected** (removing them from the pipeline) or returned to **Awaiting Input** with a clear description of what must be resolved before re-submission. Do not use a Blocked health indicator on proposals — Blocked is a schedule health condition that applies to active projects only.

### Step 4: Request additional information for "⚠️ AWAITING INPUT" proposals

These proposals need more details before you can decide. Common missing information:

- Detailed cost breakdown
- Resource requirements by month
- Strategic benefit quantification
- Risk assessment
- Technical feasibility study
- Regulatory impact analysis

Assign someone to gather this information and move the proposal to "AWAITING REVIEW" status.

---

## Risk Score Portfolio Analysis

This is one of the most valuable sections for portfolio rebalancing. It shows how risk is distributed across your portfolio.

### Overall Risk Metrics

**Average Risk Score:** Mean risk score across all projects

- 0-25: Very low average risk (conservative portfolio)
- 26-50: Low to moderate average risk (balanced portfolio)
- 51-75: High average risk (aggressive portfolio)
- 76-100: Very high average risk (extremely risky portfolio)

**Projects Without Risk Score:** Number of projects missing risk assessments

- Ideally this should be 0
- High numbers indicate inadequate risk assessment
- Use Project Assessment Tool to score these projects

**Projects With Very High Score:** Count of projects in 80-100 range

- These are your highest-risk initiatives
- Monitor closely and consider enhanced governance

### Budget Distribution by Risk Score

This shows what percentage of your total portfolio budget is allocated to each risk category:

```
Very High (80-100): 24.4% ($1.5M)
High (60-79): 17.9% ($1.1M)
Medium (40-59): 20.3% ($1.25M)
Low (20-39): 30.9% ($1.9M)
Very Low (0-19): 6.5% ($400K)
```

### Interpreting Risk Distribution

#### Question 1: What's your organizational risk tolerance?

Different organizations should have different risk distributions based on their strategy and risk appetite:

**Conservative Organization** (risk-averse, regulated industry, limited resources):

- Target: 10-15% in Very High/High risk
- Target: 60-70% in Low/Very Low risk
- Accept fewer but safer projects

**Balanced Organization** (typical mid-size company):

- Target: 20-30% in Very High/High risk
- Target: 30-40% in Medium risk
- Target: 30-40% in Low/Very Low risk
- Mix of innovation and safe bets

**Aggressive Organization** (growth-focused startup, transformation initiative):

- Target: 40-50% in Very High/High risk
- Target: 30-40% in Medium risk
- Target: 10-20% in Low/Very Low risk
- Taking calculated risks for high rewards

#### Question 2: Does your actual distribution match your target?

Compare your actual distribution to your organizational target. If they don't match, you need to rebalance.

#### Example problem:

Your organization says it's conservative, but analysis shows:

- 42% in Very High/High risk
- 20% in Medium risk
- 38% in Low/Very Low risk

This mismatch means either:

1. Your portfolio is riskier than your risk appetite allows (fix: kill or delay high-risk projects)
2. Your stated risk tolerance doesn't match reality (fix: acknowledge you're actually risk-seeking)

### Top Risk Score Projects

The report lists your highest-risk projects:

```
Public Cloud Phase 1: 100.0
Database Upgrade Market Datamart: 93.0
```

```
Private Cloud Phase 1: 93.0
```

**Why this matters:** These projects have the highest probability of failure, delays, or cost overruns. They require:

- **Enhanced governance** – More frequent status reviews
- **Executive sponsorship** – Remove blockers quickly
- **Risk mitigation resources** – Extra budget and time
- **Contingency plans** – What happens if they fail?
- **Possible kill decisions** – If risk is unacceptable

**Questions to ask about each top-risk project:**

1. **Is this risk score accurate?** – Should we reassess using the Project Assessment Tool?
2. **Is this risk acceptable?** – Does the strategic value justify this level of risk?
3. **Can we de-risk it?** – Can we reduce scope, phase it, or add resources to lower risk?
4. **Do we have the right team?** – Are we staffing high-risk projects with our best people?
5. **Should we kill it?** – Would organizational resources be better deployed elsewhere?

### Risk Score by Project Characteristics

This analysis shows whether risk correlates with project size:

**By Project Size:**

```
Large (>$500K): 7 projects, Avg Risk Score 54.7, $4.0M (65% of budget)
Medium ($100K-$500K): 6 projects, Avg Risk Score 63.8, $2.15M (35% of budget)
Small ($10K-$100K): 0 projects
```

**What this tells you:**

Your medium-sized projects (63.8 avg risk) are riskier on average than your large projects (54.7 avg risk). This is unusual—typically larger projects are riskier. This could mean:

- You're managing large projects well but struggling with medium ones
- Medium projects are in unfamiliar territory (new technologies, new markets)
- Large projects have more resources and oversight, reducing risk
- Your risk assessment methodology may under-score large project risks

**By Risk Level** (Project Health Status):

This shows actual project health status (green/yellow/red) vs. risk scores, helping you identify:

- High-risk projects that are currently green (still risky, just performing well so far)
- Low-risk projects that are red (something unexpected is going wrong)

### Risk Score Distribution Table

This provides the detailed breakdown:

```
Risk Score Range    | Projects | % of Projects | Total Budget | % of Budget
Very High (80-100)  | 4        | 30.8%         | $1.5M        | 24.4%
High (60-79)        | 2        | 15.4%         | $1.1M        | 17.9%
Medium (40-59)      | 3        | 23.1%         | $1.25M       | 20.3%
Low (20-39)         | 3        | 23.1%         | $1.9M        | 30.9%
Very Low (0-19)     | 1        | 7.7%          | $400K        | 6.5%
```

Use this to calculate:

**Combined High Risk Exposure:** Very High + High = 30.8% + 15.4% = 46.2% of projects
**Combined High Risk Budget:** Very High + High = 24.4% + 17.9% = 42.3% of budget

If your target is 25% high-risk budget, you're substantially over-allocated (42.3% vs. 25%).

### Risk Score Balance Analysis & Recommendations

The report automatically generates insights and recommendations, such as:

**Key Insights:**

- "Strong portfolio with 4 projects in the very high Risk Score range"
- "3 large budget projects have low Risk Scores (below 40)"

**Recommendations:**

- "Review and potentially restructure large projects with low Risk Scores to improve their viability"
- "Aim for a more balanced Risk Score distribution with most projects in the 40-79 range"
- "Regularly review Risk Score calculation methodology to ensure it accurately reflects project characteristics"

**How to act on recommendations:**

1. **If told to reduce high-risk projects:** Identify lowest-priority high-risk projects for kill or delay decisions
2. **If told to add more risk:** Consider whether you're being too conservative and missing strategic opportunities
3. **If told large projects have low scores:** Reassess those projects—are you under-estimating risks on important initiatives?
4. **If told to balance distribution:** Adjust approval criteria to favor projects that balance out your current distribution

---

### Initiative Type Balance Analysis

This section evaluates whether your portfolio has the right mix of project types.

### The Four Initiative Types

**Maintenance & Operational** – Keep-the-lights-on projects

- System upgrades, bug fixes, operational improvements
- Necessary but not strategic
- Low risk, low reward
- Examples: Server upgrades, license renewals, routine maintenance

**Innovation & Transformation** – Game-changing initiatives

- New business models, major process changes, emerging technologies
- High risk, high reward
- Strategic importance
- Examples: Digital transformation, AI implementation, new product lines

**Growth & Enhancement** – Expand capabilities

- New markets, new features, incremental improvements
- Moderate risk, moderate reward
- Strategic execution
- Examples: Market expansion, feature development, capability building

**Mandatory & Compliance** – Required by regulation or policy

- Can't be avoided regardless of strategic value
- Risk of non-compliance
- Must-do projects
- Examples: GDPR compliance, security upgrades, regulatory reporting

### Initiative Balance Score

The report calculates an overall balance score (0-100) with sub-scores:

**Project Count Balance (93.7%)** – How evenly projects are distributed **Budget Allocation Balance (96.0%)** – How evenly budget is distributed **Strategic Priority Balance (93.4%)** – How evenly priority is distributed

**Interpretation:**

- **90-100%** – Well balanced, no significant imbalances
- **70-89%** – Moderately balanced, some imbalances present
- **50-69%** – Imbalanced, needs attention
- **Below 50%** – Severely imbalanced, requires immediate correction

A score of 94.8/100 indicates your portfolio is very well balanced across initiative types.

### Distribution by Initiative Type

For each initiative type, the report shows:

**Projects:** Count and percentage of total **Budget:** Dollar amount and percentage **Cost:** Actual spending to date **Priority Score:** Sum of strategic priorities

**Example:**

```
Maintenance Operational
Projects: 5 (38.5%)
Budget: $2,100,000 (34.1%)
Cost: $1,115,500
Priority Score: 184.0
```

### Interpreting Initiative Type Distribution

**Ideal distribution (varies by organization):**

**Growth-Stage Company:**

- Maintenance: 20-25%
- Innovation: 35-45%
- Growth: 30-40%
- Compliance: 5-10%

**Mature Enterprise:**

- Maintenance: 30-40%
- Innovation: 20-30%
- Growth: 20-30%
- Compliance: 10-20%

**Regulated Industry:**

- Maintenance: 25-35%
- Innovation: 15-25%
- Growth: 20-30%
- Compliance: 20-30%

**Common Problems Identified:**

**Problem: Over-invested in Maintenance (40%+ of budget)**

- Consuming resources on operational work
- Under-investing in strategic initiatives
- Risk of competitive decline

**Action:** Identify lower-value maintenance projects to defer or eliminate. Redirect freed resources to Innovation and Growth initiatives.

**Problem: Under-invested in Compliance (< 5% when it should be 15%)**

- Regulatory risk exposure
- Potential fines or operational disruptions
- Audit findings will force corrective action

**Action:** Identify mandatory compliance projects that aren't in the portfolio. Assess regulatory risk. Add compliance projects or accept documented risk.

**Problem: Too much Innovation (50%+ of budget)**

- High portfolio risk
- Neglecting operational stability
- Potential for many projects to fail

**Action:** Be realistic about organizational change capacity. Defer some innovation projects to future periods. Ensure adequate maintenance to keep operations stable.

### Visualizations

The report includes pie charts showing:

- **Project Count Distribution** – How many projects in each category
- **Budget Allocation Distribution** – How budget is distributed
- **Cost Distribution** – How actual spending is distributed
- **Strategic Priority Distribution** – How priority points are allocated

Compare these charts:

**If Project Count and Budget Allocation are misaligned:**

- Example: 40% of projects are Maintenance, but only 20% of budget
- This means Maintenance projects are smaller on average
- May indicate you're running too many small Maintenance projects

**If Budget Allocation and Priority Distribution are misaligned:**

- Example: 30% of budget to Innovation, but only 10% of priority points
- This means you're spending money on Innovation but not prioritizing it
- Suggests strategic confusion

### Initiative Type Analysis Recommendations

The report provides insights like:

**Key Insights:**

- "Low representation of Mandatory Compliance initiatives in the portfolio"

**Recommendations:**

- "Establish target allocation percentages for each initiative type based on organizational strategy"
- "Regularly review initiative type balance during portfolio planning sessions"

**How to implement recommendations:**

1. **Establish targets:**
    - Work with leadership to define ideal initiative type distribution
    - Document target percentages for each category
    - Get executive agreement on targets

2. **Review regularly:**
    - Add initiative type balance to portfolio review meeting agendas
    - Track trends over time (are you improving or worsening?)
    - Adjust approval criteria to maintain balance
3. **Use as decision filter:**
    - When evaluating new proposals, consider current balance
    - If over-invested in Maintenance, defer new Maintenance proposals
    - If under-invested in Compliance, fast-track Compliance proposals

---

### Time Horizon Balance Analysis

This section evaluates whether your portfolio has appropriate short-term, medium-term, and long-term balance.

### The Three Time Horizons

**Short-term (0-4 months)** – Quick wins

- Fast delivery, immediate value
- Low risk of scope creep or changing requirements
- High visibility and momentum
- Examples: Bug fixes, small enhancements, quick deployments

**Medium-term (4-12 months)** – Standard projects

- Typical project duration for most organizations
- Manageable scope and risk
- Deliver meaningful capabilities
- Examples: System implementations, process improvements, new features

**Long-term (12+ months)** – Strategic initiatives

- Major transformations, large-scale programs
- High complexity and coordination requirements
- Strategic positioning for the future
- Examples: Platform migrations, market expansions, organizational transformations

### Time Horizon Balance Score

Similar to Initiative Type Balance, this shows:

**Overall Score (67.0/100)** – How balanced your time horizon mix is **Project Count Balance (70.0%)** – Distribution of project counts **Budget Allocation Balance (65.4%)** – Distribution of budget **Strategic Priority Balance (70.0%)** – Distribution of priority

A score of 67/100 indicates moderate imbalance requiring attention.

### Ideal vs. Actual Distribution

The report shows recommended vs. actual mix:

**Recommended Portfolio Mix:**

- Short-term: 20%
- Medium-term: 50%
- Long-term: 30%

**Your Current Portfolio Mix:**

- Short-term: 23.1%
- Medium-term: 76.9%
- Long-term: 0%

### Interpreting Time Horizon Imbalances

**Your Example Problem:**

You have zero long-term projects. This is a significant strategic risk because:

- You're not building future capabilities
- No projects positioning you for 2-3 years out
- Over-focused on tactical execution
- Competitors investing in long-term may leap ahead

Additionally, you're over-weighted in medium-term (76.9% vs. recommended 50%), which means:

- Too many projects in the 4-12 month range
- May be breaking up what should be long-term initiatives into smaller chunks
- Missing both quick wins and strategic bets

**Common Time Horizon Problems:**

**Problem: No long-term projects (0% when should be 30%)**

- **Why it happens:** Long-term projects are risky and don't show immediate results
- **Consequence:** Competitive decline, strategic drift, future capability gaps
- **Action:** Approve strategic initiatives even if ROI is distant

**Problem: Too many short-term projects (40% when should be 20%)**

- **Why it happens:** Quick wins are appealing, easy to justify
- **Consequence:** Constantly reacting, never building transformational capabilities
- **Action:** Consolidate fragmented short-term work into fewer, more substantial projects

**Problem: Too many medium-term projects (80% when should be 50%)**

- **Why it happens:** This is the "safe" duration—not too short, not too long
- **Consequence:** Missing both quick wins and strategic positioning

- **Action:** Break some medium-term projects into quick wins; extend others into strategic initiatives

**Problem: Only long-term projects (60% when should be 30%)**

- **Why it happens:** Large transformation programs, limited project count
- **Consequence:** No near-term value delivery, stakeholder patience wears thin
- **Action:** Add short-term projects to show progress and momentum

### Project Timeline Overview

The report includes a visual timeline showing when projects are scheduled across future months. Use this to:

**Identify gaps:**

- Months with no project completions
- Periods where nothing is delivering
- Stakeholders see no value for extended periods

**Identify congestion:**

- Too many projects completing simultaneously
- Resource bottlenecks for deployment/rollout
- Risk of quality issues from rushing

**Validate sequencing:**

- Ensure dependencies are respected
- Check that project order makes sense
- Verify no impossible overlaps

### Time Horizon Analysis Recommendations

**Key Insights from your example:**

- "Portfolio lacks long-term projects (12+ months), which may affect strategic future positioning"
- "Portfolio is heavily weighted toward Medium-term (4-12 months) projects (76.9% of total projects)"
- "Budget allocation is concentrated in Medium-term (4-12 months) projects (84.6% of total budget)"

**Recommendations:**

- "Consider reducing focus on Medium-term projects from current 76.9% toward the recommended 50% of portfolio"
- "Increase the number of Long-term projects to approach the recommended 30% of portfolio (currently at 0%)"
- "Include long-term projects to support strategic objectives and future positioning"

**How to act on these recommendations:**

1. **Identify potential long-term projects:**
    - Review new proposals for long-duration initiatives
    - Consider whether some approved medium-term projects could be extended into long-term strategic initiatives
    - Brainstorm strategic capabilities needed 2-3 years out
2. **Reassess medium-term projects:**
    - Can any be accelerated into short-term quick wins?
    - Should any be expanded into long-term strategic initiatives?
    - Are any actually delivering less value than their cost, making them candidates for cancellation?
3. **Set time horizon targets:**
    - Establish organizational targets for time horizon distribution
    - Create approval criteria that favor projects balancing toward targets
    - Track progress toward targets over multiple quarters

---

## Using the Report for Portfolio Decisions

### Scenario 1: Quarterly Portfolio Review Meeting

**Before the meeting:**

1. Generate the most current Portfolio Status and Balancing Report
2. Distribute to all attendees 24-48 hours in advance
3. Ask attendees to review and come prepared with questions

**During the meeting:**

**Agenda Item 1: Executive Summary Review (10 min)**

- Review health indicators
- Discuss any red or yellow indicators
- Identify which detailed sections need deep discussion

**Agenda Item 2: Financial Performance (15 min)**

- Review portfolio investment vs. budget
- Discuss significant variances
- Assess whether spending aligns with expectations

**Agenda Item 3: Strategic Alignment Check (15 min)**

- Review strategic pillar budget distribution
- Confirm spending matches priorities
- Identify any strategic misalignments

**Agenda Item 4: In-Flight Project Status (15 min)**

- Review critical projects requiring attention
- Discuss red and yellow projects
- Decide on interventions needed

**Agenda Item 5: Portfolio Balance Review (20 min)**

- Review Risk Score Distribution
- Review Initiative Type Balance
- Review Time Horizon Balance
- Identify specific imbalances requiring correction

**Agenda Item 6: New Project Approvals (20 min)**

- Review proposals awaiting decision
- Consider portfolio context (balance, capacity, risk)
- Make approval decisions

**Agenda Item 7: Rebalancing Decisions (15 min)**

- Based on balance analysis, what needs to change?
- Identify projects to delay, descope, or kill
- Commit to specific actions

**Agenda Item 8: Action Items and Next Steps (10 min)**

- Document decisions made
- Assign action item owners
- Set follow-up timelines

## Scenario 2: Approving a New High-Risk Project

**Question:** Should we approve this new AI/ML project with a risk score of 85?

**Step 1: Check current risk exposure**

Look at Risk Score Portfolio Analysis:

- Current High + Very High Risk budget: 42% of portfolio
- Organizational target: 30% max

**Step 2: Calculate impact of approval**

If this project is budgeted at $500K and portfolio is $6M:

- Adding it: ($2.6M + 500*K*)/(6M + $500K) = 47.7% high-risk
- This exceeds target even more

**Step 3: Make context-informed decision**

**Option A: Reject the project**

- "We're already over-allocated in high-risk projects at 42% vs. our 30% target. Adding another high-risk project would push us to 48%, which is unacceptable."

**Option B: Approve with risk mitigation**

- "We'll approve this project, but only after implementing these risk mitigation actions: [specific actions]. We expect these to reduce the risk score from 85 to 65."

**Option C: Approve and kill a different high-risk project**

- "We'll approve this project because it's strategically critical. To maintain portfolio balance, we'll kill Project X (risk score 92, budget $600K), which is lower priority."

**Option D: Defer approval**

- "This project has merit, but our portfolio can't absorb more risk right now. We'll revisit approval in Q3 after some current high-risk projects complete."

### Scenario 3: Forced Budget Cut of 20%

**Question:** Executive leadership mandates 20% portfolio budget reduction. How do we decide what to cut?

**Step 1: Calculate total reduction needed**

Portfolio budget: $6.2M Required cut: 20% = $1.24M

**Step 2: Use portfolio analysis to identify candidates**

**First, protect critical projects:**

- Mandatory Compliance projects (regulatory requirement)
- Critical Projects identified in the report
- Projects with high strategic priority AND low risk

**Second, identify kill candidates:**

**Low-hanging fruit:**

- Projects with low strategic priority scores (<30)
- Projects with high risk scores (>80) AND low strategic value
- Projects in red health status that are struggling anyway
- Projects where benefits are not materializing (large negative variance)

**Look at Initiative Type Balance:**

- If over-invested in Maintenance & Operational (38.5% vs. target 25%), cut there first
- Protect under-represented categories

**Look at Time Horizon Balance:**

- If over-invested in medium-term (76.9% vs. target 50%), cut medium-term projects
- Protect the few long-term strategic initiatives you have

**Step 3: Create cut scenarios**

**Scenario A: Kill 4 low-priority maintenance projects**

- Total savings: $1.2M
- Impact: Reduces Maintenance category to 28% (closer to target 25%)
- Risk: Some operational debt accumulates

**Scenario B: Kill 1 large high-risk project + 2 small projects**

- Total savings: $1.3M
- Impact: Reduces high-risk exposure from 42% to 35%
- Risk: May affect strategic initiative

**Scenario C: Descope 6 projects by 20% each**

- Total savings: $1.25M
- Impact: All projects continue but with reduced scope
- Risk: May reduce delivered value, create scope creep pressure

**Step 4: Model the impact**

For each scenario, calculate the resulting:

- Risk score distribution
- Initiative type balance
- Time horizon balance
- Strategic alignment

Choose the scenario that maintains best overall portfolio balance.

### Scenario 4: Rebalancing for Strategic Shift

**Question:** Leadership announces new strategy emphasizing Innovation & Transformation. How do we rebalance the portfolio?

**Step 1: Understand current state**

Current Initiative Type Distribution:

- Maintenance: 38.5% of projects, 34.1% of budget
- Innovation: 30.8% of projects, 26.8% of budget
- Growth: 23.1% of projects, 26.0% of budget
- Compliance: 7.7% of projects, 13.0% of budget

**Step 2: Define target state**

New strategy targets:

- Maintenance: 25% of budget
- Innovation: 40% of budget
- Growth: 25% of budget
- Compliance: 10% of budget

**Step 3: Calculate required changes**

Current Innovation budget: $1.65M (26.8%) Target Innovation budget: 2.48*M*(40*Gap* : *Need*+830K in Innovation projects

Current Maintenance budget: $2.1M (34.1%) Target Maintenance budget: 1.55*M*(25*Excess* : *Need*−550K in Maintenance projects

**Step 4: Take rebalancing actions**

**Over next two quarters:**

1. **Defer or kill lower-priority Maintenance projects** worth $550K
2. **Fast-track Innovation proposals** currently in intake pipeline
3. **Approve new Innovation projects** to reach $830K additional investment
4. **Adjust approval criteria** to favor Innovation over Maintenance going forward

**Step 5: Monitor progress**

- Generate Portfolio Status and Balancing Report monthly
- Track Initiative Type Balance Score
- Confirm moving toward 40% Innovation target
- Adjust approvals as needed to maintain trajectory

---

## Portfolio Rebalancing Actions

When the report identifies imbalances, here are specific actions you can take:

### Action 1: Kill Projects

**When to use:** Severe imbalances, forced budget cuts, portfolio risk too high

**Process:**

1. Identify kill candidates using report analysis
2. Calculate impact of killing each candidate on portfolio balance
3. Notify stakeholders and project teams
4. Execute orderly wind-down
5. Reallocate freed resources to higher-priority work

**Selection criteria:**

- Low strategic priority + High risk = Top kill candidate
- Red health status + Low priority = Project is failing anyway
- Projects not aligned with strategic pillars = Misaligned with strategy
- Projects in over-represented categories = Helps rebalance

### Action 2: Delay Projects

**When to use:** Resource capacity constraints, temporary imbalances, sequencing issues

**Process:**

1. Identify approved-not-started projects that could be delayed
2. Check dependencies—don't delay if other projects depend on it
3. Set new target start date (e.g., delay by one quarter)
4. Communicate to stakeholders
5. Use freed near-term capacity for higher-priority work

**Selection criteria:**

- Projects with flexible timelines (not time-sensitive)
- Projects in categories you're over-invested in
- Projects waiting on dependencies that aren't ready yet
- Projects that could benefit from more planning time

### Action 3: Descope Projects

**When to use:** Need to reduce budget/risk but want to keep project alive

**Process:**

1. Identify projects that could deliver value with reduced scope
2. Work with project teams to identify nice-to-have vs. must-have features
3. Remove nice-to-have features to reduce cost/duration/risk
4. Update project budgets and timelines
5. Recalculate portfolio balance with new numbers

**Selection criteria:**

- Projects with "gold-plating" or unnecessary complexity
- Projects where 80% of value comes from 50% of scope
- High-risk projects that could become medium-risk with reduced scope
- Large projects that could be broken into phases

### Action 4: Accelerate Projects

**When to use:** Categories are under-represented, need near-term wins

**Process:**

1. Identify approved-not-started projects that could launch earlier
2. Verify resources are available
3. Confirm readiness to start
4. Fast-track through any remaining approval gates
5. Launch project

**Selection criteria:**

- Projects in under-represented initiative types
- Projects that improve time horizon balance (add long-term if missing)
- Projects that could be quick wins (short-term)

- Projects supporting under-funded strategic pillars

### Action 5: Phase Projects

**When to use:** Large projects, high-risk projects, long-duration projects

**Process:**

1. Identify large or high-risk projects
2. Break into phases (e.g., Phase 1: Pilot, Phase 2: Rollout)
3. Approve Phase 1 only
4. Gate Phase 2 approval on Phase 1 success
5. Reduces committed budget and risk exposure

**Benefits:**

- Reduces risk by proving feasibility in Phase 1
- Allows learning before full Comittment
- Spreads cost over longer time period
- Provides natural kill points if project doesn't prove value

### Action 6: Adjust Approval Criteria

**When to use:** Preventing future imbalances, guiding intake decisions

**Process:**

1. Based on current imbalances, create weighted approval criteria
2. Give extra weight to proposals in under-represented categories
3. Give negative weight to proposals in over-represented categories
4. Use criteria consistently in approval decisions

**Example criteria:**

```
Base Score = Strategic Priority Score

Adjustments:
+10 points if project is Innovation (currently under-invested)
+10 points if project is Long-term duration (currently 0%)
-10 points if project is Maintenance (currently over-invested)
-10 points if project is Medium-term (currently 76.9%)
+15 points if project supports under-funded strategic pillar
-5 points if risk score > 80 (already over-exposed to high risk)

Final Score = Base Score + Adjustments
```

Approve projects with highest Final Scores until budget/capacity exhausted.

---

## Best Practices

### Generate Reports Consistently

**Monthly generation:** Create report at start of each month

- Track trends over time
- Identify emerging imbalances before they become severe
- Document portfolio evolution

**Before key decisions:** Always generate fresh report before:

- Quarterly portfolio reviews
- New project approval decisions
- Budget planning cycles
- Strategic planning sessions

**Save historical versions:** Archive each report with date stamp

- Compare current to past quarters
- Show stakeholders how portfolio has evolved
- Demonstrate that rebalancing actions are working

### Ensure Data Quality

The report is only as good as your underlying data. Maintain quality by:

**Regular project updates:**

- Update health indicators monthly (minimum)
- Keep budgets, forecasts, and schedules current
- Record actual costs and hours

**Complete risk assessments:**

- Use Project Assessment Tool for all active projects
- Reassess risk when project circumstances change
- Don't leave projects un-assessed

**Accurate strategic tagging:**

- Assign correct initiative types (Maintenance, Innovation, etc.)
- Tag projects with supported strategic pillars
- Maintain consistent strategic priority scores

**Proper project phasing:**

- Keep PMI phase current (Initiating, Planning, Executing, etc.)
- Update project states (Approved, In Progress, Closed, etc.) and health indicators (Blocked, Slipping, Late, etc.)
- Don't let project status become stale

### Share Widely

Don't keep the report in portfolio management only:

**Executive leadership:** Provides portfolio-level visibility they need for strategic decisions

**Project sponsors:** Shows portfolio context for their projects

**Resource managers:** Helps understand upcoming demand

**Project managers:** Understand where their project fits in the bigger picture

**Finance:** Aligns financial planning with portfolio reality

### Use as Discussion Tool, Not Mandate

The report provides data and recommendations, but humans make decisions:

- Don't blindly follow recommendations without considering context
- Use recommendations as starting point for discussion
- Override recommendations when you have good reasons
- Document why you chose to override (for future reference)

### Act on Insights

Generating the report without acting on it wastes time:

- Identify top 3 imbalances from each report
- Create action plans to address imbalances
- Assign ownership for each action
- Follow up on action completion in next portfolio review
- Verify next month's report shows improvement

### Establish Portfolio Targets

Define organizational targets for:

**Risk exposure:**

- Maximum % of budget in High + Very High risk: ___%
- Minimum % of budget in Low + Very Low risk: ___%

**Initiative type distribution:**

- Target % for Maintenance: ___%
- Target % for Innovation: ___%
- Target % for Growth: ___%
- Target % for Compliance: ___%

**Time horizon distribution:**

- Target % for Short-term: ___%
- Target % for Medium-term: ___%
- Target % for Long-term: ___%

Document these targets and reference them when reviewing reports.

### Calibrate Your Methodology

Periodically validate that your assessment methodologies are accurate:

**Risk score validation:**

- Do projects with high risk scores actually experience more problems?
- Do low-risk projects typically succeed as expected?
- Adjust assessment criteria if scores don't predict reality

**Strategic priority calibration:**

- Do high-priority projects actually deliver more strategic value?
- Are priority scores consistent across different evaluators?
- Adjust priority methodology if scores don't reflect true importance

**Initiative type classification:**

- Are projects properly categorized?
- Do team members agree on classifications?
- Update classification guidelines if confusion exists

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### Conclusion

The Portfolio Status and Balancing Report is your most powerful tool for strategic portfolio management. It transforms raw project data into actionable intelligence about portfolio health, strategic alignment, and balance across multiple dimensions.

**Use this report to:**

- Make informed approval decisions that consider portfolio context
- Identify and correct dangerous imbalances before they cause problems
- Defend difficult kill decisions with objective data
- Communicate portfolio status clearly to executives
- Maintain portfolio alignment with organizational strategy and risk tolerance

**Remember the key principles:**

1. **Generate regularly** – Monthly minimum, before key decisions always
2. **Ensure data quality** – Report is only as good as underlying data
3. **Share widely** – Portfolio management is a team sport
4. **Act on insights** – Reports without action are wasted effort
5. **Track progress** – Compare over time to verify improvements
6. **Balance competing priorities** – Use the report to make explicit trade-offs

Your portfolio represents your organization's future. This report ensures that future is balanced, strategic, and aligned with your objectives.

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*Transform Your Portfolio Management: Data-driven decisions. Strategic alignment. Optimized outcomes.*

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# Part 2 — The User Interface

## Product Help - Common Across Products

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## What You Should Know First

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The following sub-section describes important Need to Know information First, before you can even get started. The following help topics describe how to use any Timebars Ltd. products. For help related to an individual product see other tabs in the knowledge base for each product (Timebars, Agilebars, Costbars)

### How to Use for Free

You can try our products for free without registering. The free version limits how many projects, tasks and Pubsets you can hold, and there is no time limit — use it for as long as you like. The current limits are on the sales site.

There is no software to install. We apply data limits rather than a trial period so that users with small teams and portfolios can keep the price down.

Important Note: We don't install cookies on your device. Our management software products are secure web pages. Your data in stored in the browser cache, not on our servers (unless you choose to use the Pubset feature).

## How to Get a License

After registering and purchasing a subscription you can begin using our Apps as a licensed user. See video: how to purchase a subscription. In summary, your new license will automatically install when you log into one of our Apps.

If you wish to purchase a subscription, use the Quick Buy button found through out the site. Subscriptions are single person monthly purchases. Register with an email and password, purchase your desired subscription, then use the email/password combination as your license to log in and use our products with the desired data limits.

Our monthly subscription model has three pricing tiers. Each tier increases the data limits to suit your needs. After you purchase a subscription and log in, it automatically alters the data limits imposed by the free version to suit your new subscription, your project and resource data remains unchanged. You can buy one month at a time or up to 12 months in one credit card transaction. Read the Pricing Table & Sales FAQ at the Sales Site!

## How to Login/Logout

Click the Yellow Icon in the top most menu, right side, enter user name and password, same ones used when registering. That is it you are now logged in as a licensed user.

## Switching Products

There are scenarios where you may be running agile bars product and you drag and drop a Time bars based spreadsheet onto the canvas and you will find you may get an error about the license not being valid or correct. this may be normal And it requires you to log in again with the username and password from the desired product subscription.

## About Security and Product Limits

Data limits are enforced by product line and subscription tier. The limits — bars (every row below the Project level: Sub-Projects, Tasks, Allocations, Milestones, Gates, Risks, Issues and Notes), projects (backlogs in Agilebars) and cloud pubsets — come from the product you purchased and are downloaded when you log in. Tier-1 subscriptions include no cloud pubsets, so the Publish icons are hidden; OpenProject sync is included with Tier-3 only. It calculates the number of days remaining until the license expires by comparing the current date with the expiration date store with the license. If the license is valid, it checks to determine the type of license and performs additional UI trimming based on the license type. For each product and license type, it checks if the bar count exceeds certain limits. If the limits are exceeded, it displays the appropriate user information message and re-establishes a demo license status so the user can continue with nag screens until a valid license is established.

## About Demo Data

When the App is loaded for the first time, the demo data is populated as part of the page loading process. This is a one-time thing and it's done only only the very first time you use the product you can and start new with fresh new demo data.

It is important to always start off with demo data because the mandatory seed data is installed. Seed data for the default pick lists (tags/metadata), timescale settings etc. The demo data consists of a demo license for free access to the product for life with data limits as stated in the sales site at www.Timebars.com.

There are two demo data sets, a small demo data set with a few Timebars and there is a large data set with over 350 bars. To load switch demo data, click on the hamburger icon on the top left of the screen to load the admin menu, click Data Actions, click clear demo data. Click either load demo data Small or load core demo data large defined by S or L in Brackets.

The population of demo data includes not only project data but all the seed data. If you make changes to your time Bars by dragging them around the screen and if you create custom fields and other operations you will lose them all when you clear demo data and restore demo data from scratch so you have to be careful.

### Top Menu and the Main Menu

The top menu shows the product icon and name, import and export arrows, bar refresh icon, shopping cart icon and login icon. In the middle of the top menu is the currently logged in user, if the license is invalid or not downloaded yet it will show license status instead.

The Main Menu is a row of icons for launching core functionality of the application, an explanation of each follows within the Core Product Functionality section.

### The Hamburger Icon

Click the hamburger icon in the Main Menu to access links to various features, including the Filter Menu, Getting Started Page, AI Search, FAQ, WBS Generator, and Data Actions (such as Import, Export, Backup, and more).

## The Canvas

Our application comprises two key components: the Kanban and Timescale canvases. The Timescale canvas, featuring Timebars, offers distinct advantages over traditional Gantt charts. Unlike Gantt charts, Timebars on the Timescale canvas empower users to effortlessly drag and drop bars to any position they desire. In contrast to the rigid one-row-per-bar format of Gantt charts, Timebars allow for greater flexibility in bar placement.

This flexibility not only accommodates a larger number of bars on the screen but also enhances resource allocation and project scheduling, ultimately boosting the productivity of project management personnel.

### About the Timescale Canvas

The first thing you encounter when logging in with fresh demo data is the Getting Started Page. Once closed, the Timescale Canvas becomes visible by default. The Switch Modes icon on the Main Menu offers a choice between the Timescale Canvas and the Kanban Canvas.

The Timescale Canvas comprises a series of vertical lines that can be separated by either weeks or months. You have the flexibility to select the timescale (weeks or months) from the canvas settings window. Click Tools > Set Canvas to load the window. A flyout menu will appear, with the Set Canvas icon at the top. Click on it to adjust your time scale preferences such as either a weekly or monthly view. Furthermore, you can zoom in and and out buy selecting a zoom factor. The default zoom factor is 1.5, but alternatives include 0.5, 1.5, 2, and so forth. Be sure to save and close to apply your chosen settings. The Canvas will automatically reload.

Numerous other Canvas settings await exploration, such as toggling between light and dark modes, displaying baseline bars or ghost bars, and adjusting levels. We will delve into these topics later, as they are somewhat more intricate and warrant further documentation immediately following the Kanban discussion.

### About the Kanban Canvas

Kanban is a potent visual management tool that empowers teams to plan, track, and manage their work with exceptional efficiency. Its visual representation of project workflows fosters collaboration and transparency.

To switch to Kanban mode, simply locate the "Switch Modes" icon on the main menu at the top center of the screen. Clicking it again will return you to the Timescale mode.

The Kanban board is available in all our products, but each functions differently to cater to either Agile or Classic management processes. For more specific information, please refer to the dedicated help topics for the product you are interested in.

### The Timebar Hierarchy

Timebars conforms to 3 different hierarchies. The minimum is a 3 level hierarchy, and maximum is a 5 level hierarchy with a 4 level hierarchy in the middle. The rules are built into the tool to not allow violation of these hierarchies as you drag and drop Timebars to create schedules. Each level is color coded to make it easy to remember the levels in the hierarchy and to allow choice as to what levels are needed.

L1 - Dark Grey L2 - Green (Always a Project for all 3 hierarchies) L3 - Orange L4 - Blue (Always a Task for all 3 hierarchies) L5 - Gold (Always an Allocation for all 3 hierarchies)

### The maximum 5 Levels:

You can optionally look at the 5 level hierarchy as follows:

L1-Portfolio L2--Project/Program L3---SubProject L4----Task (incl milestones and gates) L5----- Resource Allocation

### The medium is a L4 level hierarchy:

For most small and medium sized projects 4 levels is sufficient. This one is the same a the 5 level except it allows a user to not use the Orange bars.

L1-Portfolio L2--Project/Program L3----Task (incl milestones and gates) L4-----Resource Allocation

**The minimum is a L3 level hierarchy:**

For most small and medium sized projects 4 levels is sufficient. This one is the same as the 5 level and 4 level except it allows a user to not use the Dark Grey L1 bars.

L1--Project/Program L2---Task (incl milestones and gates) L3---Resource Allocation

**Canvas Settings**

**Adjusting the Weekly/Monthly Settings:**

- To switch to a weekly timescale:
    1. Click on the wrench icon on the Main Menu.
    2. Click on "Canvas Settings".
    3. Change the radio button to "weekly".
    4. Click "save and close".
- For optimal viewing, it's recommended to set the Zoom Factor to 1. Click and drag the slider icon and drop it to see the zoom factor.

**Adjusting the Time Scale Start, Report Date** The timescale must always start on a Monday so that the scheduling engine has a work week reference point. The Report Date is one of the most important settings for the automatic cost, hours and date calculations to be accurate. It must be set to a work week day, not a weekend to improve accuracy. When you change the Time Scale Start, Report Date, the settings stored in IndexedDB and reused when the page loads.

The general rule is that if a bar is visually behind the Report Date line on the Timescale canvas, it will automatically set actual dates, costs and hours based on the configurations. You will learn about how to configure this later.

**Show Baseline, Ghost and Visible Levels** Show Baseline Bars: Yes/No - If the user has set a baseline and this value is set to Yes, it will show Baseline Bars on the Canvas as thin bars below each timebar

Show Ghost Bars: Yes/No - If the user has this value is set to Yes, the dit will show Ghost Bars on the Canvas. This is useful to see the original position of the bar as a light ghostly bar.

Visible Levels, L1, L2, L3, L4 or L5 - The user can check off which levels in the hierarchy to hide on the Canvas. For example if L2 is checked, bars at levels L1 and L2 are shown, hiding the levels below. This is useful to reduce clutter on the screen for large data sets.

Hide Completed Bar True/False - If set to true, bars in the past (before the Report Date) are hidden.

### L3 / L4 / L5 Level Tick Boxes on the Main Menu

Three tick boxes sit in the Main Menu, beside the timescale changer, and decide how far down the hierarchy the canvas draws:

| Tick box | Hides when cleared |
|---|---|
| **L3** | Sub-Projects |
| **L4** | Tasks, Milestones and Gates |
| **L5** | Allocations |

**L1 Portfolio and L2 Project bars are always shown** — only the three lower levels are optional. Clearing L5 on a large plan is usually the quickest way to turn a wall of allocations back into a readable portfolio.

They apply to the **Timebar View, Modern View, Filters View, and the Vertical and Horizontal Timelines**. They do not appear on the Gantt Schedule View, which has its own tick boxes in its filter panel, and not in Agilebars, which has no L1, L3 or L5 hierarchy. They are also hidden while the Filter Menu is loaded — that menu already decides which rows are on screen, so the tick boxes would do nothing there.

Your choice is saved with your settings, so it survives a page refresh and rides along with a backup and restore.

### Bar Spacing and the "Fit" Tick Box

Next to the level tick boxes are a **spacing picklist** (Small, Medium, Large) and a **Fit** tick box. This is the one place in the application where vertical bar spacing is chosen.

**Spacing** means different things depending on how a view places its bars:

| View | What the spacing setting does |
|---|---|
| Modern View, Filters View | Sets the row height. Bars always sit on even rows |
| **Timebar View** | Nothing *until you tick Fit* — see below |
| Vertical and Horizontal Timelines | Sets the spacing between points |
| Gantt Schedule View, Kanban | Ignored — these lay themselves out |

**Fit** is the trade-off tick box, and it only appears on the Timebar View.

The Timebar View's defining feature is that you place bars wherever you like vertically — that freedom is what lets you fit far more work on one screen than a conventional Gantt chart. The cost is that a plan built that way can end up looking ragged.

Tick **Fit** and the Timebar View lays every bar out on even rows at the spacing you picked, cleaning the view up instantly. You keep horizontal drag and resize, so you can still reschedule; what you give up is **vertical reorder** — bars are on their rows and cannot be dragged up or down. Clear the tick box and your hand-placed positions come back, because they were never discarded.

Use it to tidy a plan for a screenshot or a review, and clear it when you go back to laying bars out by hand.

Both the spacing and the Fit setting are saved with your settings and survive a refresh, backup and restore.

The picklist hides in the two cases where there is no spacing to pick — while the Filter Menu is in use (it draws bars at the exact position stored on each row), and in Agilebars.

### Refresh the Canvas

Quickly refresh the Canvas and bars without a full browser page reload.

- Click the Refresh icon on the top menu (black)
- Will invoke a full cost schedule rollup

### Reload the Canvas (Full Browser Page Reload)

Sometimes you may want a full browser page reload if the page seems to be rendering something unexpected.

- Right click on Canvas > Reload Page or
- Use the standard browser page reload that is available on all browsers, typically located to the left of the URL (e.g., tb.timebars.com)

### Recalculate All System Generated Data

The System can perform a complete recalculation: hours/cost rollup, updates L1 to L5 hierarchy names, hierarchy numbers (WBS), and re-populates the tbMDJoined data store if you notice data anomalies.

- Right click on Canvas > Recalculate All
- There are other Recalculate All buttons, such as on the Reports Page, to ensure that the system data has complete and updated information

## How to Manage your Data

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### Download Open Office Spreadsheet

This OpenOffice Calc spreadsheet is specially designed to sync with all Timebars products with the ability to optionally synchronize your data with OpenOffice Calc to move data in and out of our products in a fast, clean and simple manner. Click on the Hamburger icon to launch the Admin menu, near the bottom is the link to download the spreadsheet. See the Spreadsheet syncing topic below for further details on how to use it.

### Download Excel Spreadsheet

This Excel spreadsheet is specially designed to sync with all Timebars products with the ability to optionally synchronize your data with Excel to move data in and out of our products in a fast,

clean and simple manner. See the Spreadsheet syncing topic below for further details on how to use it.

### Spreadsheet Syncing

tbClient Pre-configured Spreadsheet Syncing: How It Works

Licensed users will have access to our spreadsheet, which contains custom code that facilitates the synchronization of data between exported CSV files and the spreadsheet. To achieve this synchronization, the code inside the spreadsheet imports CSV files stored in a user-configurable location on the hard drive.

From the app, users should first click the export button to save CSV files to this designated location. Once saved, the data in these CSV files can be imported into the spreadsheet by clicking the "import all" button located on the setup page.

Below is a description of the setup page inside the spreadsheet (a screenshot would typically be here). Notably, both the import and export locations can be adjusted to fit any directory on your hard drive. On the setup page, you can utilize the "import all" button to pull data from all stores that have a "yes" marked in the "import yes/no" column. However, if you prefer to selectively import specific data, such as time bars and metadata, you can navigate to the respective tabs and use the individual import buttons.

Within the spreadsheet, users have the flexibility to manually edit data. This includes adding new tasks, modifying resources, changing tag data, and using common Excel functionalities like drag-and-drop, copy-paste, and fill-down.

When you've finished making your edits, ensure you save your changes. After saving, simply drag and drop the spreadsheet onto the application canvas, and the app will update to reflect the modifications. It's crucial to remember not to make edits in the app while the data is in the spreadsheet, as doing so could lead to overwriting and loss of your changes.

### Export as CSV (multi-file)

Export all data stores to csv for import into spreadsheet

### Database Backup and Restore

Drag and drop the spread sheets or the JSON backup file for full restore of all data

### Editing Data Inside the Application

Sometimes it is quicker to edit data in the application than to go out to the spreadsheet. Every store now has its own **tabular report** on the Report Menu, rather than one combined grid:

| To edit | Go to |
|---|---|
| Bars, tasks, metadata | **Report Menu > Project > General Tabular View**, or the Gantt Report |
| The resource pool | **Report Menu > Resource > Shared Resource Pool** |
| Picklist values | **Report Menu > Other > Picklist Values** |

| To edit | Go to |
|---|---|
| Form and layout configuration | **Report Menu > Other >** Fields Values, Schema Values, CoreReport Values |

The schedule and metadata grids are edited **in place** — click a cell and type. The four configuration reports are read-only in the grid and edited on their form; see the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide* for why.

> The old **Data Management Grids** screen, which put every store behind one set of tabs, has been removed. Each of its tabs is now a proper report in the list above.

## Data Actions Menu

The Admin menu — the **Hamburger icon** at the top left of the main menu — carries the data actions. Each one is covered in full in the *Synchronization and Data Control User Guide*; this is the summary.

| Menu item | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Full Backup** | writes every store to one JSON file — your restore point |
| **Export to CSV (SpreadSheet sync.)** | writes 15 CSV files, one per store, for the workbook round trip |
| **Export to JSON** | writes 15 JSON files, one per store, for integrations |
| **Import SpreadSheet, CSV or JSON** | opens the drop panel — drop a file, or browse for one |
| **Bulk Manage Bars** | duplicate a bar and its children, or transfer bars to another product |
| **Migrate Rich Text** | converts legacy rich text to the current editor format; safe to run any time |
| **Clear Timebars & Metadata** | a clean canvas, keeping your resources, picklists and configuration |
| **Load Demo Data** | replaces the data with a demo set for this product |
| **Delete Database** | destroys everything; refresh afterwards to rebuild with demo data |
| **Download Excel SS / Libre Office Calc SS** | the workbook template |

Two things are worth knowing before you use any of them:

- **A Full Backup is taken automatically** before an import, a demo data load, or Clear Timebars & Metadata. **Delete Database is the exception** — it does not back up for you.
- **An import replaces each store rather than merging into it.** If you have edits in the application that are not yet in the spreadsheet, the application **blocks the import** and shows a warning icon on the top menu. Double-click that icon for the way out. This is covered properly in the *Data Synchronization Backup Recovery And Retention User Guide*.

### Clearing data by hand

You can clear individual stores from the browser's own developer tools — F12, Application tab, IndexedDB, right-click a store, Clear. Deleting the whole database there works too, but **no backup is taken first**. Refresh afterwards and a new database is built with demo data; drop one of your backup files on the import panel to get back to where you were.

Prefer **Clear Timebars & Metadata** on the menu for the everyday case — it backs up first and keeps your configuration.

# Core Product Functionality

This section provides details about the user interface that enhances your productivity and serves as the core functionality across all our products.

## Automatic Calculations

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### Scheduling Engine

The scheduling engine is at the heart of the application and it is proprietary. It is not something that you can see or hear but it is listening and running in the background. With its advanced algorithms, it can recalculate your schedule in a matter of seconds when you make any changes to your project such as when you drag and drop a bar, adding resources, changing the percent allocated or changing the time scale.

For example if you have a set of bars on the timescale and one bar is moved, this bar and the child bars will have new dates, costs and hours calculated by the scheduling Engine. Tasks with relationships to other tasks also calculate new dates for the successors in addition to the child bars. If a bar has a constraint on it it states will not be recalculated by the scheduling engine.

### Automatic Cost and Schedule Rollup

In order for the reports graphs and charts to be accurate we have to continually roll up or sum up the data as it's being created or modified. The process of automatically rolling up data is to aggregate cost and hours data from lower levels of a hierarchy into higher levels. All products enforce a 5 tier hierarchy also known as levels which are abbreviated like this: L1, L2, L3, L4 and L5.

### Switch Modes (Timescale/Kanban)

Switch to Kanban mode from the Main Menu by selecting the "Switch Modes" option.

Imagine a project represented as a green bar. In Kanban mode, this project is managed using swim lanes. The blue bars signify individual work items or tasks, representing the backlog items chosen for the current Sprint.

There's also a filter option which allows users to transition between different projects. Using this filter, one can view various work items in the project's backlog. The project team then

decides which tasks they'll undertake. Once these are selected, a burn down chart can be plotted to visualize progress. As tasks shift between stages like 'doing' and 'done', progress is tracked automatically. The burn down chart can be revisited at any time to compare the initial plan with the ongoing progress.

Additionally, users have the option to toggle between viewing tasks as bars or text boxes in the Kanban view.

### Filter Menu

The Filter Menu is derived from the underlying hierarchical data. Each row is a hyperlink that allows drill-down or filtering at specific levels of the bar hierarchy to reduce clutter. Double-click the pink FM tab to launch the Filter Menu. Click the Filter Icon to remove the filter completely and hide it.

The menu renders three levels: L1 (brown bars), L2 (green bars), and L3 (orange bars). Agilebars renders one level: Project. When a level is clicked, a filter is applied. The selected level is saved so that when the user returns it will show the filter menu and the filtered project by default.

### Main Filter Panel

The Main Filter Panel helps users refine and focus on specific projects and tasks based on freeform search or metadata picklists.

- Choose Main Filters on the Main Menu
- Click button to Reset filters to get back to an unfiltered state
- Click the X to close the Filter Panel and go back to the Canvas with all bars loaded
- Notice that the bars are all shown on individual lines, not beside each other as shown when the Filter Panel is closed

## How to Create Bars

Launch the **Creator Bars** popup to create new bars. Drag a bar from the popup and drop it onto an existing bar to establish a hierarchical structure.

- Choose **Main Menu > New Bar**

### Steps to Create a New Bar

1. If there are no existing bars, a special step is required to create the first bar at the top of the hierarchy
2. Begin dragging a **Creator Bar**, and follow the instructions displayed in the **dashed box** before dropping it as instructed

Create new L1 Portfolios, L2 Projects, L3 Sub-projects, L4 Tasks and Milestones and L5 Allocations. Also create Gate Notes to link and show notes on the Canvas.

Bars are created by drag and drop that forces the hierarchy of L1 to L5. When you drag the L2 Project Creator Bar, instructions pop up on the right. If an L1 exists, drop it on top to create and

link the L2 bar. Or you can decide not to link it to the L1, this could be considered as a standalone project, not belonging to a Portfolio L1 bar if you choose.

The Filter Menu will show it as such. We recommend always using an L1 bar as a scheduling best practice. L3 orange bars can only be created by dropping the Creator Bar on an L3 bar, dropping it anywhere else is not allowed and the user is notified. Task and Milestone Creator Bars can only be dropped on L2 or L3. Gate Notes can be dropped at any level, L1 to L5.

### Example in Agilebars

- **Task bars** can only be created by **dropping the Task Creator Bar (blue) onto a Project Bar (green)**
- Dropping the Task Creator Bar elsewhere will trigger a **user notification** and prevent the action

## Filter Menu

The filter allows the user to drill down into specific levels in the hierarchy. All products enforce a 5 tier hierarchy known as levels abbreviated like this: L1, L2, L3, L4 and L5. In the graphic above the pink FM tab, when its double clicked it opens the Filter Menu and the user can click to drill and filter. When they click, the “isFilteredFrom” value is stored in indexedDB, so the next page reload it will hit drawBarsFromP3Menu(isFilteredFrom, tbID) function more on this later. The graphic below shows the Filter Menu, it can only render L1, L2 and L3 items. In this case the brown bar indicates it is an L1, Green is L2 and Orange is an L3 (See the “L” at bottom left of all bars). For example If the user clicks on an orange bar, the filtering will look like this:

## Shortcut Menu

The Shortcut Menu is standard “Right Click” functionality like in any app. Right click on the canvas and the shortcut menu will pop up. There is a different shortcut menu for the kanban View.

Right-click anywhere on the Canvas to bring up the Shortcut Menu for quick access to: Canvas Settings, Bulk Move, Refresh Bars, Filter Menu and Toggle Bars vs Time Boxes on the Kanban Board. Bulk Move allows moving many bars at once to a new position on the Canvas.

## Toggle Light/Dark Mode

In software development, "dark mode" and "light mode" refer to two different color schemes or visual styles that can be applied to user interfaces. 1. Dark Mode: Dark mode, also known as night mode or dark theme, is a design option where the user interface predominantly uses dark or black backgrounds with lighter text and elements. This color scheme is intended to reduce the amount of light emitted by the screen, making it more comfortable to view in low-light environments. Dark mode is often preferred by users who find it easier on the eyes or who want to reduce eye strain, particularly in dimly lit conditions. 2. Light Mode: Light mode, on the other hand, is the default or traditional design option in many software applications. In light mode, the user interface typically uses light or white backgrounds with darker text and elements. This color scheme is more reminiscent of the classic paper-like appearance and is often the default choice for readability in well-lit environments. The choice between dark mode

and light mode is largely a matter of personal preference and user experience. Some individuals may find dark mode more visually appealing or less intrusive, while others may prefer the traditional light mode. Many software applications and operating systems now provide the option to switch between these modes to accommodate different user preferences and environments.

## Creating Relationships between Tasks

To create relationships between Tasks, this tells the scheduling engine to reschedule the successor bar as well, by the same amount of time. Te create a relationship drag a task by grabbing the beginning of it and dragging it over the ending of the target bar and droppin it as shown below.

## Show/Hide Hierarchy Lines

To show the hierarchy lines on the Canvas:

- Right click on the Canvas to show the Shortcut Menu and click "Hierarchy Lines" or
- Choose Tools > "Hierarchy Lines"

For example to see the hierarchy through the lines: The Gold Bar (L5) is linked to the Blue Bar (L4), the Blue Bars are linked to the Orange Bar (L3), Green Bar (L2) is linked to the Brown Bar at L1. The Brown bar is the top of the hierarchy.

## How to Turn On/Off Bar Relationship Lines

To toggle relationship lines between tasks:

- Right click on the Canvas to show the Shortcut Menu and click "Bar Relationships" or
- Choose Tools > Bar Relationships

## Task Bar Lines (Relationships)

To show the Task Lines on screen, turn on Task Bar lines as described above. Relationship lines visually connect predecessor and successor tasks, showing task dependencies in your schedule.

## Drop to Delete Bar Lines

To remove a relationship, drag and drop the successor bar on the “Drop to Delete Task Lines” Pad.

## Manage Constraints

Add constraints to tasks so they are not rescheduled ever. Click the Edit Menu button on the Main Menu then click on the Manage Constraints link. The pin now shows and the Canvas has been darkened. The pin can be dragged and dropped on a task to constrain it. Remove the constraint by clicking on the pin on the bar and dragging it off the bar and dropping it on the Canvas.

## Popup Cost Schedule Form Off of Bar

To load the popup the user clicks on the lower portion of the bar e.g. T:3773... it will load the form below the bar associated with the bar, works at all levels.

## How to Make Edits to Bar and Metadata

There are multiple ways to edit bars and metadata throughout the application:

### Method 1: Flyout Form

- Click on the **bar Name** to open the right side flyout form
- Click on Name Field, make changes
- Data is saved automatically when you move off the field
- Close the form when done

### Method 2: Freeze Bars for Quick Edits

- Click the **pink FZ Tab** on the left side of the Canvas to freeze the Bars so they cannot be moved
- Simply change the bar name directly on the Canvas
- Click on another bar to save your changes
- Click the **Refresh Icon** on top black menu to remove the freeze

### Method 3: Core Report

Launch the Core Report from multiple locations:

- Click on a **bar ID** (bottom left of any bar) to launch the Cost Schedule popup, click "Core Report"
- Launch the Core Report from rows in the **Risk and Issues page**
- Launch the Core Report from rows in **Tabular and Card View reports** available from the Reports Menu

### Method 4: Spreadsheet Sync Feature

- Use the Spreadsheet Sync Feature to change metadata in bulk
- Export data to spreadsheet, make changes, and load it back into the application
- See Data Management section above for details

**Note:** Edits are saved automatically when you move off a field throughout all editable fields in the applications.

## Metadata Coding

Metadata coding is a flexible way to organize and break down a project into groups of activities. By establishing a coding structure and assigning codes to Timebars it will allow virtually any view or report of your project information.

The metadata codes are maintained in the custom spreadsheet template and are updated in the Timebars Web App by drag and drop gestures on the Canvas. There is no complex code tables and look up tables to maintain, just spread sheet maintenance and Timebars does the rest saving you time.

## Metadata View

Available from the Cost/Schedule Popup form.

## How to Create a Baseline

When planning is complete and before work begins, create a baseline to generate your Planned data. Use the Planned data to compare with current data and actuals for variance reporting.

Easy Baseline Management: When Sprint planning is done and before the work starts, set a baseline or snapshot with one click. Compare current forecast to the baseline (original plan) with the burndown chart and other reports with one click. Unlimited baselines supported.

### Steps to Create a Baseline

1. Click on a **Bar ID** (bottom left of any bar) to open the Cost Schedule popup
2. From the popup, click the **"Set Baseline"** button to create a baseline for this bar and all its child bars
3. The checkbox is enabled by default, so it will **overwrite an existing baseline**
4. You can set a baseline at the **L2 Project Level (green bar)** or any level below it, but **not at the L1 (brown bars) level**

When the Set Baseline button is clicked and the check mark is on, the previous baseline is lost. The baseline will be created at the current level and all child bars below it in the hierarchy.

## How to Update a Baseline for Added Scope

If the checkbox is unchecked, this Timebar and any child Timebars without an existing baseline will not delete existing baseline data. This is necessary for scenarios where the baseline is initially set, and later a new bar and/or its children need to be added to the baseline.

**Use Case:** The Baseline is initially set at L1, then later, an individual bar and its children need to be re-baselined without affecting existing baselines.

## How to Delete Bars

To delete a bar, **drag and drop it onto the Trash Can** located on the **left side of the Canvas**. This will remove the bar along with all of its child bars.

When a bar is dragged, the Edit Menu shows automatically, allowing you to delete one bar at a time or the dropped bar and all child bars, one level below. For example if you delete a Task, the Allocations will be deleted also, if you wish to delete just the Task and keep the Allocations, drop the bar on the Delete One pad.

**Important Notes**

- If you want to delete a bar and keep the child bars, first move the children to another bar in the hierarchy using **drag and drop**
- **Deleting cannot be undone**, so if needed, **make a backup first**:
  - Select **Hamburger Icon > Full Backup**
  - To restore a backup, simply **drag and drop the backup file onto the Canvas**
- **Undo Bar Move does not cover deletion.** It puts *moved* bars back where they were; it cannot bring a deleted bar back. A backup is the only way back from a delete. See *Undo Bar Move* in the **Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide**

## Drop to Duplicate Bars

Below is the result of duplicating a project. After dragging and dropping the duplicate onto the L1 bar (brown), it shows in the Filter Menu as a new project. The child bars were not duplicated. There are other ways to do this such as the SpreadSheet. More on this later.

## Bulk Move Tasks

To Bulk Move Tasks or to drag and drop many tasks at one time, click the Edit Menu button on the main menu then click on the Bulk Move Tasks link. Now click on each task that is to be moved, then click again and drag and drop to the right place on the timescale. Notice that selected bar are highlighted with blue dotted lines. When done, screen refreshes and bars have been rescheduled including child bars or Allocations.

- Tip: When you get to the last bar that you plan to move, double-click it then drag.

## Bulk Move Projects (Costbars Only)

To bulk move Projects (green bars) in Costbars:

- Choose Tools Menu > Bulk Move Projects link to reschedule Projects (green Bars) in bulk
- Click on two or more projects to highlight them, then drag and drop to reposition them

Notice that selected bars are highlighted with green dotted lines. When done, refresh the screen and confirm they have been rescheduled including the child bars.

- Tip: When you get to the last bar that you plan to move, double-click it then drag.

## Change Creator Bar Names

The names and descriptions of the six Creator bars are configurable, and they live in the Tags store.

Go to **Report Menu > Other > Picklist Values**, filter the **Picklist** column to the relevant list, then click the edit icon on the value you want. Change its **Short Name** — that is the text shown on the Creator bar — and its **Purpose**, which is the instruction text in the Creator Bar popup. Changes save as you type.

Leave the other columns alone. A value that carries a **padlock** cannot be renamed at all: the application compares against that exact text, and renaming it would break a calculation

silently. Adding your own values is always safe.

You can also change these in the Tags worksheet and sync back to the app.

### Metadata View

The metadata view is available from several locations within the application, such as the General Tabular View and from each bar on the canvas. This view is a large collapsible report or form that allows for editing metadata based on business driven headings such as business case cost and schedule information etc.

### Get Started Page

From the main menu click on the hamburger icon to launch the admin menu. The "Getting Started" menu graphic is shown below. From there you can fire up the getting started page. Below is a view of the getting started page which can be configured to fire up by default every time the application loads for the first time.

### FAQ

The FAQ can be launched by the link on the Admin Menu similar to how the Getting Started page is set up and called. The graphic below shows the frequently asked questions page each question is in a drop-down when you click on another next question the current one collapses.

### Intro

The intro can be launched from the right side tools menu. Each of the three applications has been configured so that the intro is launched whenever a new database is created in other words when a user first uses the app. Most users will read the intro once and click close don't show the intro again or if you click skip intro it will close and fire up the next time you relaunch the page.

### Tour

The tour can be launched from the tools menu slide out right tools menu by clicking on the tour link when the tour is fired it starts at the hamburger icon and you just keep clicking next and the tour stops off at each of the visible UI portions of the application it's a nice little tool to inform the users quickly who are new about the usability and features.

## Risk & Issues Features

### Overview of Risks and Issues

The risk system has the same look and feel as the risks and issues system but data storage is different. Click on the Risks and Issues button on the main menu to launch the risk list. From the filter menu, find the project you want and click on it to view linked Risks and Issues.

### Create New Risks and Issues

Risks and Issues are created by adding a task with the Bar Creator and launching the Slide Out Right Form. The SubType can be set as Risk or Issue, and additional metadata fields can be configured for filtering and grouping.

### Filter Risks and Issues

Use the Risks/Issues page to track and manage lists of risks and issues. Filter by project and view the status of each item. Edit details of a Risk or Issue by launching the FOCD Form.

### Edit Risks and Issues

Edit the status, title, and content of a Risk or Issue by clicking on the edit icon and entering data in markdown format.

### Add fields to the Form

Use FOCD to add or remove fields in the form to customize it according to specific needs or methodologies.

## Local Reports Menu

The Reports Menu gives access to tabular reports, charts and the configuration tables. It is grouped into five menus: **Portfolio**, **Project**, **Task**, **Resource** and **Other**.

### Portfolio, Project and Task Reports

Projects by Portfolio, Drilldown from Portfolio and Portfolio Detail at portfolio level; the General Tabular View and Baseline Variance at project level; the Task Tabular Report and the Gantt Report at task level.

### Resource Reports

Resource Usage — the supply and demand grids and charts — and the Shared Resource Pool.

### Other

Print WBS, and the five configuration reports: Picklist Values, Fields Values, Schema Values, CoreReport Values and Config Integrity.

See the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide* for what each one does.

### Joining tbTimebars and tbMetaData Stores

The function in scripts/tbdatabase.js joins the tbTimebars store and the tbMetaData store, creating a new store called tbMDJoined. This combined data store is useful for reporting, dashboard code, and integration with other tools.

# Burndown Chart

## What is a Burndown Chart

Easily generate Burndown Charts with one click that are based on Agilebars data in the browser that was generated while using the Kanban Board canvas and/or the Timebars Timescale canvas. Switching lanes in Kanban mode updates the progress of sprint work based on internal rules. For example dropping an Agilebar in the Done lane, sets the work item to 100% complete which feeds the burndown chart.

To launch the burndown chart click on the Project ID, in this case Pj:40 and launch the Burndown Chart. Click the “Refresh Button” to calculate the graph, then click Run to launch it.

## How to Calculate the Burndown Chart

The graphic below shows the core function that will timephase the data for the burndown chart. It calls many other functions, not shown. There are 2500 lines in kanvanv2.js file.

# Local Dashboard

## What is Local Dashboard

The Local Dashboard, (not to be confused with the Cloud Dashboard), is the place where your data is transformed into information. It has four tabs for the Agilebars and Timebars Apps (Summary, Resource Demand Charts, Project Status and Finance), and three additional tabs for the Costbars PPM functionality (Programs, Priorities and Strategy). The filter menu drives the dashboard at the L1 level. Each page of the Dashboard is a FOCD form so the user can add and remove fields to suit, there are up to 150 different fields available.

Timebars Ltd. Products provides two dashboards because many customers will not be allowed to store their data in the cloud due to security reasons. Corporate data is often proprietary and if exposed to unwanted eyes it could pose serious threats to the organization. Therefore there is a local dashboard that is available on the main menu that pulls data from the index DB inside the browser.

In the example below the L1 title “Digital Works Space - Transformation” is available because there is one L1 in the data set. Each page of the Dashboard is a FOCD form so the user can add and remove fields to suit, there are up to 150 different fields available.

## Summary Tab

Currently shows the following fields as part of the Demo Data. This form renders data from L1 rows only. User can add and remove fields as needed.

## Resources Tab

Shows the same set of buttons as on the Resource Allocator to show Weekly Demand by various metadata. This form renders data from ResCalcs2 store.

### Project Tab

Shows the projects which are children of the L1 (Digital Workspace - Transformation). Multiple L1 bars would be listed in the Filter Menu. This form renders data from L2 rows only in the tbTimebars store.

### Financial Tab

This form renders data from L1 rows only. User can add and remove fields as needed. The Cost Analysis field can be edited using the rich text editor.

## Cloud Publishing

### Overview of Publishing

The Cloud Publishing feature is opt-in functionality with secure Cloud login and authentication. The Cloud Dashboard provides customizable and dynamic reports and graphs, for insightful visualizations. Also rehydrate the Cloud data on another device. e.g. work from your PC one minute and on your Ipad the next.

### Cloud Login

Code location and details about the cloud login process.

### Show License

Clicking on the Show License Button displays the license details, including the quantity of PubSets available and the expiry date.

### Create Your Pubsets

PubSets are created automatically on cloud login and topped up to the number the license includes (none for Tier-1). They are never deleted automatically.

### Publish to Update Cloud Dashboard

Publishing PubSets allows updating the cloud dashboard, rendering charts and reports.

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# Part 3 — Data Model and Scheduling Engine

## Data Model and Scheduling Engine Guide

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1. Introduction
2. Data Hierarchy
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4. Field Rules — What Every Row Must Carry
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9. What Recalculate All Does
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### 1. Introduction

The platform is a multi-product scheduling application available in three variants — **Agilebars (AB)**, **Timebars (TB)**, and **Costbars (CB)**. All three products share the same underlying data model and a single client-side IndexedDB database. The differences between products are driven by different scheduling engines and configuration, not by separate codebases.

At the heart of the platform is a **five-level parent child data hierarchy**, where every item — from a top-level portfolio down to an individual resource allocation — is a record in the `tbTimebars` store with a `tbType` field that identifies its level:

| Level | `tbType` | Bar colour | Typical purpose | What its `tbSelfKey2` must point at |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| L1 | `Portfolio` or `Program` | dark brown | Top-level grouping of related projects | nothing — a root node has no parent |
| L2 | `Project` | green | A discrete deliverable or initiative | the parent L1, when a Portfolio exists |
| L3 | `Sub-Project` or `Work-Package` | orange | A work package or component within a project | the parent L2 |
| L4 | `Task`, `Milestone` or `Gate` | blue | Individual work items or schedule control points | its immediate parent — L3, or L2 when there is no Sub-Project |
| L5 | `Allocation` | gold | A resource's assignment to a task (TB/CB only) | the parent L4 Task — and it must also carry a `tbResID` that exists in `tbResources` |

A row may never skip a level or point at a parent that does not exist. An unresolved `tbSelfKey2` orphans the row: it disappears from the hierarchy and contributes nothing to any rollup.

**Important Note:** Agilebars is a Two Tier Hierarchy, Projects and Tasks, it has its own scheduling engine that skips the other levels.

Parent–child relationships are established via the **`tbSelfKey2`** field: every child record stores the `tbID` of its parent. This single field is what the scheduling engine, rollup functions, and hierarchy rendering all rely on to traverse the tree — upward to aggregate totals and downward to render the timescale and Kanban views.

**Work and cost values are entered at the lowest level in use** — normally L5 Allocations, but any childless row (a Task with no allocations, or even a Sub-Project, Project, or Portfolio with nothing beneath it) acts as the leaf for its branch and may carry directly entered values — and they are **rolled up automatically** through the hierarchy. The `tbWork`, `tbAWork`, and `tbWorkRemaining` fields represent forecast hours, actual hours, and remaining hours respectively; `tbCost`, `tbACost`, and `tbCostRemaining` follow the same pattern for costs. A parent **with children** always holds derived totals: the rollup overwrites any manually set values on it, ensuring consistency from allocation to portfolio.

The three products use that model differently:

| Product | Hierarchy | Scheduling |
|---|---|---|
| **Agilebars** | two levels — **Project (L2) → Task or Story (L4)**. L1, L3 and L5 are not used | lane-based progress steps on the Kanban board, plus a sprint burndown |
| **Timebars** | the full five levels on a gantt-style timescale | dragging an L5 Allocation recalculates actual start, actual and remaining hours and cost, and percent complete, then rolls the totals up the chain |
| **Costbars** | the full five levels, same cost and hours model | as Timebars, extended with portfolio pipeline features — strategic value scoring and demand vs. capacity analysis |

This guide documents how data flows through that hierarchy — from the scheduling engine calculations at L5 up through each rollup stage to the portfolio total — and how the two stores (`tbTimebars` for core fields, `tbMetaData` for extended fields) relate to each other across all levels.

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## 2. Data Hierarchy

The **tbTimebars** store in IndexedDB holds rows that represent different levels of work items. Each row is keyed by `tbID` (unique ID) and references its parent with `tbSelfKey2`. The `tbType` field determines its role in the hierarchy.

### Timebars and Costbars

The full hierarchy is:

**Portfolio → Project → Sub-Project → Task → Allocation**

Example:

- **Portfolio**: "Digital Workplace - Transformation"
- **Project**: "Synchronisation Client"

- **Sub-Project**: "Private Cloud Phase 1"
- **Task**: "Consume requirements"
- **Allocations**: "Alloc 1" and "Alloc 2"

Each row stores cost, work, dates, durations, and scheduling metadata. Higher-level rows (Sub-Projects, Projects, Portfolios) that **have children** always hold rolled-up totals — anything entered directly on them is overwritten by the rollup. A higher-level row **without children** is the leaf of its branch and may hold directly entered cost and work (see *Manual Cost, Work & Percent Complete* below).

At the task level, the rollup engine checks whether a Task has child Allocations. If Allocations exist, the Task's cost and work totals are summed from them. If no Allocations exist, the Task itself is treated as the leaf node and its own stored values are used directly in the rollup. This means allocations are optional — tasks without them still participate correctly in the hierarchy rollup.

### Agilebars

Agilebars uses a simplified two-level hierarchy:

**Project → Task (or Story)**

L1 (Portfolio/Program), L3 (Sub-Project), and L5 (Allocation) are not supported. Example:

- **Project**: "Sprint 4 - Mobile App"
- **Tasks / Stories**: "Design login screen", "Write unit tests", "Fix auth bug"

Tasks are always the leaf nodes in Agilebars. Cost and work values are entered directly on each Task, and the Project rolls them up. There is no allocation layer — resource assignment in Agilebars is handled through the Kanban board lanes and sprint membership rather than discrete allocation records.

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## 3. Parent–Child Relationships & WBS Ordering

Every row in `tbTimebars` links to its parent through a single field: **`tbSelfKey2`**, which stores the `tbID` of the parent row. Root nodes (Portfolios with no parent) have `tbSelfKey2` set to null or empty. This one field is what every traversal — rollup aggregation, hierarchy rendering, connector drawing — depends on.

**Breadcrumb labels (`tbL1` through `tbL5`)** are derived display fields, not structural ones. They are cleared and regenerated each time `updateL1ToL5()` runs. Each row gets its ancestor names written into these fields by walking up the `tbSelfKey2` chain, so that any row can show its full path without a live tree traversal at render time:

| Field | Contains |
|---|---|
| `tbL1` | Portfolio or Program name |
| `tbL2` | Project name |
| `tbL3` | Sub-Project name |
| `tbL4` | Task name |

| Field | Contains |
|---|---|
| `tbL5` | Allocation name |

**WBS ordering ( `tbHierarchyOrder` )** is a dot-separated position string, zero-padded to two digits per level, always five segments deep regardless of the actual depth of the row. Examples:

- Portfolio: `01.00.00.00.00`
- Project: `01.01.00.00.00`
- Sub-Project: `01.01.02.00.00`
- Task: `01.01.02.03.00`
- Allocation: `01.01.02.03.01`

This field is used for display ordering and WBS-style report sorting. Like `tbL1–tbL5`, it is a computed field regenerated on demand by `updateTbHierarchyOrder()` — it is not a source of truth for structure, only for ordering. This pre-processed data make managing project data in the spreadsheets and the reports easier for the users.

---

## 4. Field Rules — What Every Row Must Carry

The rules in this section apply to **every** route data takes into the product: typed on a form, generated by AI, or synced from the workbook. Data that breaks them does not throw an error — it renders wrongly, or calculates wrongly, or quietly does nothing.

### Mandatory fields

#### Every `tbTimebars` row, at every level:

| Field | What it must hold |
|---|---|
| `tbID` | a unique alphanumeric identifier — the key everything else joins to |
| `tbName` | the display label shown on the bar, in grids and in reports |
| `tbStart`, `tbFinish` | planned dates, `DD-MMM-YYYY` (for example `15-Jan-2026`) |
| `tbType` | one of the reserved values — `Portfolio`, `Project`, `Sub-Project`, `Task`, `Milestone`, `Gate`, `Allocation` |
| `tbSelfKey2` | the parent's `tbID`, per the table in section 1. Empty only on a root Portfolio |
| `canvasNo` | always `1` |

**Every `tbMetaData` row:** `tbMDID`, which must **exactly** match its bar's `tbID`. That single field is the entire join between the two stores — one metadata row per bar, no more and no less.

**Allocations (L5) additionally require** the fields the scheduling engine calculates from: `tbPayRate`, `tbPercentTimeOn`, `tbCalendar`, `tbWork`, `tbWorkRemaining`, `tbDuration`, `tbRemainingDuration` and `tbPercentComplete`. Section 6 shows how they interact.

### Field typing

Three rules, and they are absolute.

**Numeric fields must be numbers, and default to `0` — never `null`, never `"na"`, never blank:**

`tbWork`, `tbAWork`, `tbWorkRemaining`, `tbCost`, `tbACost`, `tbCostRemaining`, `tbBudgetCost`, `tbDuration`, `tbRemainingDuration`, `tbPercentComplete`, `tbPayRate`, `tbPercentTimeOn`, `tbCalendar`, `tbCoordTop`, `kbCoordTop`

A `null` or `"na"` in any of these propagates through every sum it touches: one bad value at allocation level can empty a portfolio total. This is the single most common defect in data arriving from a spreadsheet.

**Date fields must be `DD-MMM-YYYY` strings** — `07-Oct-2026`:

`tbStart`, `tbFinish`, `tbAStart`, `tbAFinish`

**Text fields hold `""` when empty**, never `null` or `undefined`. Every null and undefined is blanked on the way in.

### Where a bar sits on the canvas

`tbCoordTop` is the vertical pixel position of a bar. On the Timebar View you place bars where you like, and that freedom is what lets far more work fit on one screen than a conventional gantt chart — so the position has to be stored, not derived.

Data created **inside** the application gets this for free. Data you **generate or import** must set it, or every bar stacks at the same height:

- Give the first bar in the hierarchy a starting value — **100 pixels** is the default if you have no reason to choose otherwise.
- Step each following bar down from it. The Bar Creator uses **50 pixels**; AI-generated rows use **35**, and place an Allocation **40** below its parent Task.

Any consistent step works. The numbers above are what the application itself uses.

### Metadata defaults

When a metadata row is created without them, three fields are filled in so the row is never left in an unreportable state:

| Field | Default |
|---|---|
| `tbMDStatus` | `New` |
| `tbMDHealth` | `Not Assessed` |
| `tbMDPriority` | `Not Assessed` |

### Risks, Issues and Change Requests are Tasks

There is no `tbType` of `Risk`. A risk, an issue and a change request are all **Tasks** carrying a `tbSubType`:

| To create a | Set `tbType` | Set `tbSubType` |
|---|---|---|
| Risk | `Task` | `Risk` |
| Issue | `Task` | `Issue` |
| Change Request | `Task` | `CR` |

`tbType` is forced to `Task` for all three. The `tbSubType` value is what routes the item to the Risks and Issues views, draws its flag icon on the canvas, and keeps it out of resource calculations — a risk is tracked work, not scheduled effort.

---

## 5. Rollup Rules & Field Aggregation

Costs and work flow upward through the hierarchy via the rollup engine (`tbschedulingengineRollups.js`). It builds an in-memory map of the entire hierarchy keyed by `tbID`, links children to parents via `tbSelfKey2`, then walks the tree bottom-up with `aggregateCostsAndWork()`.

The engine applies one rule at every node, regardless of type or level:

- **If a node has children**: its cost and work fields are overwritten with the sum of its children's values.
- **If a node has no children** (leaf node): its own stored values (`originalValues`) are written back as-is and passed upward unchanged.

The leaf-node rule is **not type-aware**. It does not distinguish between an Allocation, a Task, a Sub-Project, or a Project. Any node without children becomes the leaf at that branch and its own stored cost and work values participate in the rollup. This means it is valid to mix approaches within a single portfolio — some projects fully broken down to allocations, others with a cost and work figure entered directly at the project or sub-project level — and the rollup will aggregate all of them correctly into the portfolio total.

The general convention is that cost and work are entered at the Allocation level and that higher-level rows hold only derived totals. But this is a convention, not an enforcement. The engine simply sums whatever exists beneath each node and falls back to the node's own values when nothing is beneath it.

Running the rollup multiple times produces the same result — it is fully idempotent.

**Fields that roll up at every level:**

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `tbWork` | Forecast hours |
| `tbAWork` | Actual hours to date |
| `tbWorkRemaining` | Remaining hours |
| `tbCost` | Forecast cost |
| `tbACost` | Actual cost to date |
| `tbCostRemaining` | Remaining cost |

**The full bottom-up flow:**

```
Allocation (or any childless node)
  → summed into Task (or nearest parent with children)
    → summed into Sub-Project
      → summed into Project
        → summed into Portfolio
```

The Portfolio row is always the root node (`tbSelfKey2` = null). Its totals equal the sum of every leaf node beneath it, wherever in the tree those leaves sit.

**Percent complete is derived, not summed.** Percentages cannot be meaningfully added, so `tbPercentComplete` is excluded from the summed fields. Instead, immediately after a parent's children are summed, its percent complete is derived from the fresh totals using the same rule hierarchy as manual entry: 100 when the parent itself is complete (it has an actual finish date), otherwise from work when the parent has work (`tbAWork ÷ tbWork`), from cost when it has cost but no work (`tbACost ÷ tbCost`), and left unchanged when it has neither.

### Manual Cost, Work & Percent Complete (rows without Allocations)

When a user chooses not to create Allocations, cost and work are entered by hand on the lowest row in use — typically the L4 Task, but the same applies to a childless L3, L2, or L1. These rows are edited in the **Cost & Schedule popup form** (launched from the bar's status icon), where the Forecast row's three cost cells, three work cells, and % complete render as editable dotted-border inputs on Timebars and Costbars. Rows **with** children stay read-only there — their values come from the rollup, and any manual entry on them would be overwritten (children always win).

Every manual entry is auto-reconciled so the seven fields stay mathematically aligned:

| You enter | The system derives |
|---|---|
| **Work** (first entry) | Work Remaining = Work, A Work = 0, % Complete = 0 |
| **A Work** later | Work Remaining = Work − A Work, % Complete = A Work ÷ Work × 100 |
| **% Complete** later (work present) | A Work = Work × %, Work Remaining = Work − A Work |
| **Work Remaining** directly | A Work is kept; Work is re-forecast to A Work + Work Remaining (same convention as the Allocation hours-to-go override) |
| **Cost fields**, no work present | identical rules on the cost triple; % Complete derived from cost |
| **Cost fields**, work present | Cost Remaining = Cost − A Cost kept consistent, but % Complete stays work-driven |
| **% Complete** with neither work nor cost | the typed percent is simply held for reporting |

The rule hierarchy for `tbPercentComplete` is therefore: **complete first, then work, then cost, user-entered as last resort**. If Allocations are later created beneath the row, the next rollup replaces the manual values with the children's totals — no cleanup needed.

**Completion always wins (all bar types).** A bar that carries an actual finish date ( `tbAFinish` ) is finished — that single field is what makes the Schedule Status read *Completed* and what the *Hide Completed Bars* filter looks for. The scheduling engine sets it on **any** bar type whose finish falls behind the report date, not just Allocations, so `tbPercentComplete` is forced to **100** on those rows too: Task, Sub-Project, Project and Portfolio as well as Milestone, Gate and Release. Previously only Allocations got the matching 100, which left completed rows sitting at whatever percent they happened to hold — complete by date, part-done by number — and Hide Completed Bars (which needs both the actual finish *and* 100%) never hid them.

Actual work and actual cost are **not** rewritten to match. The hours and money a row really consumed stay exactly as entered, so a completed row can legitimately read 100% with A Work below Work. Dates decide *whether* a row is done; the numbers stay a record of what it took. To show less than 100% on such a row, clear its actual finish date or move the bar out past the report date — percent then falls back to the work/cost rules on the next recalculation.

Because data can also arrive via AI generation and Spreadsheet Sync, these seven fields can drift out of alignment. The **Recalculate All** button runs a consistency checker before the rollup: on every childless L4–L1 row it treats forecast and actual work (and cost) as the source of truth, corrects the remaining and percent complete fields to match, and assumes actuals of 0 when only a forecast value exists. Allocation (L5) rows are never touched by the checker — they belong to the scheduling engine.

The scheduling engine ( `tbschedulingengine2.js` ) is triggered when a user drags or resizes an allocation bar on the timescale. It only recalculates **allocation-level fields** — tasks, sub-projects, projects, and portfolios are updated afterwards by the rollup engine, not by the scheduling engine directly.

---

> **Important — Manual Cost & Work at L1–L4:** The scheduling engine only recalculates cost and work fields for **Allocation (L5)** rows. If cost and work have been entered manually on a Task, Sub-Project, Project, or Portfolio row (i.e. the row has no children and is acting as a leaf node), those values will **not** be recalculated when the bar is dragged or resized on the timescale. The engine will still update the bar's dates and duration, but `tbWork` , `tbCost` , and all related actual and remaining fields will remain unchanged. To have cost and work recalculate automatically on drag, the values must be held at the Allocation level.
>
> The one progress field the engine does write on these rows is `tbPercentComplete` , and only on completion: when the drag, resize, or report-date change puts the bar entirely behind the report date, the engine stamps the actual finish date and sets percent complete to 100. Work and cost are still left alone.
>
> Manually entered values are maintained through the **Cost & Schedule popup form** (click the bar's status icon): on a childless L4–L1 row the Forecast row's cost, work, and % complete cells render as editable (dotted-border) inputs, and every entry is auto-reconciled by the manual calculation rules described in the *Manual Cost, Work & Percent Complete* section below.

---

## 6. Scheduling Engine & Scenarios

The scheduling engine runs when a user drags or resizes an **Allocation** bar on the timescale. It recalculates that allocation's dates, duration, hours, cost and percent complete; everything above it in the hierarchy is then updated by the rollup engine, not by the scheduling engine directly.

### Input: Pixels to Days

The entry point is `prepForDateHoursCostCalculator()`, which converts the pixel offset of the drag (`leftDiff` for a move, `resizeDelta` for a resize) into days using the current timescale pixel factor (`tsPxFactor`, set per the weekly or monthly view). This produces `daysdiffS` (start shift) and `daysdiffF` (finish shift), which are passed to `dateHoursCostCalculator()`.

### Scenario Detection

The engine reads the allocation's `tbStart` and `tbFinish` dates, converts them to JavaScript Date objects, then compares against `apStatusDate` (the user's status/report date) to determine which of three scenarios applies:

| Condition | Scenario |
|---|---|
| `dStart < statusDate` AND `dFinish > statusDate` | **In Progress** |
| `dStart < statusDate` AND `dFinish < statusDate` | **Completed** |
| `dStart >= statusDate` | **Not Started** |

### Scenario 1 — In Progress

The allocation has started but not yet finished. The actual start is locked to the bar's start date; actual finish remains empty.

**Standard (no override):**

```
tbDuration         = working days (dStart → dFinish)
tbADuration        = working days (dStart → statusDate)
tbRemainingDuration = tbDuration - tbADuration
tbWork             = tbCalendar × (tbPercentTimeOn / 100) × tbDuration
tbAWork            = tbCalendar × (tbPercentTimeOn / 100) × tbADuration
tbWorkRemaining    = tbCalendar × (tbPercentTimeOn / 100) × tbRemainingDuration
tbCost             = tbWork × tbPayRate
tbACost            = tbAWork × tbPayRate
tbCostRemaining    = tbWorkRemaining × tbPayRate
tbPercentComplete  = (tbWork - tbWorkRemaining) / tbWork × 100
tbAStart           = dStart (formatted DD-MMM-YYYY)
tbAFinish          = "" (not yet finished)
```

**Override path** (`tbSchEngOverride = "Overridden"`): The user has manually fixed `tbWorkRemaining`. The engine respects that stored value instead of recalculating it from duration:

```
tbAWork           = tbCalendar × (tbPercentTimeOn / 100) × tbADuration
tbWorkRemaining   = stored value (not recalculated)
tbWork            = tbWorkRemaining + tbAWork
tbCost/tbACost/tbCostRemaining recalculated from the above
tbPercentComplete  = tbAWork / tbWork × 100
```

### Scenario 2 — Completed

The entire bar sits before the status date. The allocation is 100% done.

```
tbAStart          = dStart (formatted DD-MMM-YYYY)
tbAFinish         = dFinish (formatted DD-MMM-YYYY)
tbDuration        = working days (dStart → dFinish)
tbADuration       = tbDuration
tbRemainingDuration = 0
tbWork            = tbCalendar × (tbPercentTimeOn / 100) × tbDuration
tbAWork           = tbWork
tbWorkRemaining   = 0
tbCost            = tbWork × tbPayRate
tbACost           = tbCost
tbCostRemaining   = 0
tbPercentComplete  = 100
```

### Scenario 3 — Not Started

The bar's start date is on or after the status date. No actual progress exists.

```
tbAStart          = "" (not started)
tbAFinish         = "" (not started)
tbDuration        = working days (dStart → dFinish)
tbRemainingDuration = tbDuration
tbWork            = tbCalendar × (tbPercentTimeOn / 100) × tbDuration
tbAWork           = 0
tbWorkRemaining   = tbWork
tbCost            = tbWork × tbPayRate
tbACost           = 0
tbCostRemaining   = tbCost
tbPercentComplete  = 0
```

### Key Allocation Fields Used by the Engine

| Field | Role |
|---|---|
| `tbCalendar` | Work hours per day for this resource |
| `tbPercentTimeOn` | Percentage of time allocated to this task (0–100) |
| `tbPayRate` | Hourly cost rate — used to derive all cost fields from work hours |
| `tbSchEngOverride` | `"Overridden"` locks `tbWorkRemaining` against recalculation |

After the scenario calculation completes, results are written back to IndexedDB via `UpdateProgressHoursCalculator()` (called from the drag/resize path in `tbschedulingengine.js`;

the allocation popup form path fills the form via `initSchEngForm()`), and the rollup engine then propagates the updated totals up the hierarchy chain.

---

> **Important — Progress is Calculated Against the Status Date, Not Today's Date:** The engine always compares bar positions against `apStatusDate` — the status or report date set by the user in the admin panel — not against the current calendar date. This is a deliberate project management discipline, not a technical limitation.
>
> In formal project management, schedules are updated on a defined reporting cycle: weekly, fortnightly, or monthly. The status date is the agreed "as of" date for that cycle — the point in time at which the team has collectively assessed progress and recorded actuals. Using today's date instead would mean that the same schedule opened on a Monday shows different percent complete, actual hours, and remaining work than it does on a Friday, even if no update has been made and no real work has been recorded. Reports sent to a steering committee or PMO would not match the numbers the PM sees in the tool, and trend analysis across reporting periods would become unreliable because the reference point keeps drifting.
>
> By anchoring all calculations to a fixed status date, the platform ensures that every report, chart, and rollup total reflects a consistent snapshot: what the project looked like as of that date. The PM advances the status date at the start of each new reporting period, updates the schedule, and the next snapshot is produced cleanly.
>
> Note: The Agilebars Kanban board offers an optional setting (`apABuseStatusDate`) that allows teams to use today's date instead of the status date, for teams that prefer to update progress continuously rather than on a fixed reporting cycle.

---

## 7. Predecessor & Constraint Logic

### Predecessor (`tbPredecessor`)

A row can reference one other row as its predecessor by storing that row's `tbID` in the `tbPredecessor` field. This establishes a **Finish-to-Start** relationship in intent: the successor is expected to start when its predecessor finishes. The field stores the predecessor's `tbID` as a plain string and defaults to `""` when no predecessor exists.

Predecessors are supported on **Projects (L2)** and **Tasks, Milestones, and Gates (L4)**. Sub-Projects (L3), Allocations (L5), and Portfolios (L1) do not carry a predecessor reference in their rendered bar HTML and will not display connector lines even if a value exists in `tbPredecessor` on the underlying record.

### Constraint Type (`tbConstraintType`)

The `tbConstraintType` field controls whether a bar's position is locked against movement caused by a predecessor cascade. The meaningful value is:

| Value | Effect |
|---|---|
| `"Pinned"` | The bar is locked. A predecessor cascade will not move it. A pin icon is rendered on the bar. |
| `""` (empty) | No constraint. The bar moves freely and participates in predecessor cascades normally. |

Pinning is useful when a task has a hard deadline or a fixed contractual date that must not drift when upstream bars are rescheduled.

### Connector Rendering

When the timescale draws bars, each bar element receives `data-pred` and `data-tbid` HTML attributes. After rendering, `tbCanvas.js` iterates the bar elements, reads `data-pred` on each successor, looks up the corresponding predecessor element by `id="key{tbID}"`, and draws a connector line between the two. If the predecessor element is not found in the current view (filtered out or off-screen), the connector is silently skipped.

### Important — Simplified Dependency Relationships (Scheduling Light)

Traditional project scheduling tools support four dependency relationship types: **Finish-to-Start (FS)**, **Start-to-Start (SS)**, **Finish-to-Finish (FF)**, and **Start-to-Finish (SF)**, each optionally combined with a positive or negative lag value. This platform intentionally implements a simplified subset of that model.

Only **Finish-to-Start** relationships are supported, with the option to apply a **positive lag** (a gap between the predecessor finishing and the successor starting) or a **negative lag** (which effectively approximates a Start-to-Start with overlap, allowing the successor to begin before its predecessor finishes). Finish-to-Finish and Start-to-Finish relationships are not supported, as Finish-to-Finish is rarely practical in day-to-day scheduling and Start-to-Finish is almost never used in practice.

When a **Task** is dragged on the timescale, the engine automatically cascades the move to any successor Tasks linked to it via `tbPredecessor`, recursively cascading through the full chain. A successor Task that has been **Pinned** will not move regardless of what its predecessor does — the pin takes priority over the cascade. This cascade is **limited to Tasks only** — dragging a Project bar does not trigger a cascade to linked successor Projects. The predecessor connector line will display on Project bars as a visual reference, but Project-level predecessors must be manually rescheduled.

This approach is intentionally described as **Scheduling Light** — enough dependency structure to communicate sequence and intent clearly on the timescale and in reports, without requiring teams to manage the complexity of a fully automated predecessor network across all levels of the hierarchy.

---

## 8. Where the Full Field List Lives

Every field in the system is a row in the **`tbSchema`** store, and you read it in the application rather than here: **Report Menu → Other → Schema Values**.

For each field it gives you the internal name, its label, **what it is for**, the picklist it draws from and whether that picklist is a tag list or the live resource pool, its data type, whether it is mandatory, whether it is validated, and which spreadsheet sheet it belongs to. It is filterable by sheet and by picklist, and its purpose column is full-text searchable.

That report is the field reference. A field list printed into a guide would start drifting from the product the day it was written; the report cannot.

**The related stores, in one line each:**

| Store | What it holds |
|---|---|
| `tbTimebars` | every bar — the scheduling backbone |
| `tbMetaData` | the extended fields for each bar, joined on `tbMDID` = `tbID` |
| `tbBaseline` | a point-in-time snapshot that mirrors the `tbTimebars` structure **exactly** — the same fields populate it |
| `tbResources` | the resource pool, one row per person or generic role. L5 Allocations link to it through `tbResID` |
| `tbTags` | every picklist value, grouped by `tbTagGroup`, each group pointed at a field by `tbTagTbInternalName` |

The picklists and their values are documented in the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide*; the stores and how they move in and out of the product are in the *Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide*.

---

## 9. What Recalculate All Does

**Recalculate All** is the single button that puts every derived value back in step. It matters because data arrives from three directions — typed in the app, generated by AI, synced from a workbook — and only the first of those keeps the derived fields current as it goes.

It runs in this order, and the order is the point: each step feeds the next.

| # | Step | What it fixes |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Consistency check** | on every childless L4–L1 row, treats forecast and actual work and cost as the truth and corrects the remaining and percent-complete fields to match. Runs **first**, so corrected leaf values feed the rollup in the same pass. Allocations are left alone — they belong to the scheduling engine |
| 2 | **Cost and work rollup** | sums the six cost and work fields bottom-up in a single pass, and derives each parent's percent complete from its fresh totals |
| 3 | **Hierarchy names** | clears and rewrites the `tbL1`–`tbL5` breadcrumb fields by walking `tbSelfKey2` up the tree |
| 4 | **WBS ordering** | regenerates `tbHierarchyOrder`, the five-segment sort path |
| 5 | **Grouping fill-down** | empty grouping fields inherit the nearest tagged ancestor's value, so reports do not group everything as untagged. Runs after the ordering is fresh and before the rebuild below, so the joined rows carry the filled values |
| 6 | **Joined table rebuild** | rebuilds `tbMdJoined`, the cached join of bars and metadata that every report reads |

**Run it after** any spreadsheet import, any AI generation, and any bulk edit — and before publishing, exporting, or trusting a portfolio total. Running it twice changes nothing the second time; every step is idempotent.

> **Resource calculations are not part of this.** The weekly resource demand figures behind the charts and grids are rebuilt separately, so a resource chart that looks stale after a Recalculate All needs its own refresh rather than another run of this.

## 10. Values the Code Depends On

This section replaces the old *Picklist Values Locked By Code* document and the old *System-Reserved Metadata Fields and Values* section, which said similar things in different words and had both drifted from the product.

**144 values across 46 picklists are locked.** Twelve picklists are locked end to end. Every locked value is shown in **bold** in the A–Z reference in the picklist reference in the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide*, so there is one list to read rather than two to reconcile.

### The picklists whose meaning is not obvious

Most locked values explain themselves. These do not, and getting them wrong is expensive:

| Picklist | Field | Why the exact text matters |
|---|---|---|
| **tbType** | `tbType` | Tells the scheduling engine whether a row is a Project, Task, Milestone or Allocation. Everything downstream branches on it. |
| **SubType** | `tbSubType` | Turns a Task into a Risk, Issue or CR. The Risks & Issues module, and the health rules in section 7, find their rows by this value. |
| **Timebar Status** | `tbMDStatus` | Drives the whole PPM pipeline — what counts as a proposal, in-flight work, or closed. `Rejected`, `On Hold` and `Blocked` also make a row immune to the status automation. |

| Picklist | Field | Why the exact text matters |
|---|---|---|
| **Schedule Status** | `tbMDHealth` | The word behind the schedule colour. Section 6 maps each value to a colour by exact text. |
| **Escalation Level** | `tbMDEscalationLevel` | `Executives` and `Directors` push a project's scope, risk or issue health straight to Red, and drive Enterprise Dashboard notifications. |
| **Budget Estimate** | `tbMDROMEstimate` | Band names are parsed as money ranges, used as the fallback when Budget Cost is zero in the PPM select/kill process. |
| **Risk Probability**, **Risk Impact** | `tbMDProbability`, `tbMDImpact` | Each value carries a hidden 1–5 weight **held in code, not in sort order**. Rename one and risks stop scoring — see the warning below. |
| **Labour Type** | `tbResLabourType` | `Human` is what makes a resource appear in every people-picker; `Generic` and `Human` split the supply-and-demand analysis. |
| **Health Cost/Hours/Issues/Overall/Risk/Schedule/Scope** | `tbMDHealth*` | `Green`, `Yellow`, `Red`, `Not Assessed` are matched exactly to select an indicator colour. There is no `Grey` — grey is how `Not Assessed` renders. |
| **Executive Commitment** | `tbMDSeniorLevelCommitment` | Feeds PPM scoring and notification thresholds. |

| Picklist | Field | Why the exact text matters |
|---|---|---|
| **Show In Reports** | `tbMDShowIn` | Each value is a report filter. A renamed value silently removes rows from that report. |

> **Risk Probability and Risk Impact deserve a specific warning.** The 1–5 weights behind them are an explicit map in the code, deliberately *not* taken from the tag sort order — because `Not Assessed` shares a sort order with the worst value in both lists, and taking sort order would score an unassessed risk as the worst possible one. The consequence for you: **renaming a probability or impact value stops it scoring altogether**, and the risk silently reads 0 / Not Assessed. Add values freely; do not rename the five in each list.

### Why this list can drift, and what to do about it

The lock list is maintained alongside the code, and the picklist values are maintained in the spreadsheet. Nothing automatically checks one against the other, and they have gone out of step before — the `Part-time Full-time` rename detached two values the portfolio report still branches on, and left the resource form's picker opening empty for months.

Two things protect you:

- **Config Integrity** after every import.
- The A–Z in the picklist reference in the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide* is **generated from the live data**, so a value that has been renamed away simply stops appearing in bold rather than sitting in the documentation as a value that no longer exists.

---

## 11. Status and Health Automation

The product can set status, stage, phase, schedule status and all seven health indicators for you, across the whole database, from the dates, baselines, budgets and risk register you already hold. This section documents what each button does.

**Where:** the buttons sit on the **Core Form** and on the **CS status form**.

| Button | Sets | On |
|---|---|---|
| **Update Status** | Status, PPM Stage, PMI Phase, Schedule Status | Projects and Sub-Projects (all four); Tasks, Milestones, Allocations (Status only) |
| **Sch Status** | Schedule Status | Projects, Sub-Projects, Tasks, Milestones, Allocations |
| | …and the Health Schedule colour | Projects and Sub-Projects only — it is the only level the colour is reported on |
| **Cost Hours** | Health Cost, Health Hours | Projects and Sub-Projects |

| Button | Sets | On |
|---|---|---|
| **RIC** | Health Scope, Health Risk, Health Issues | Projects and Sub-Projects |
| **Overall** | Portfolio rollup, then Health Overall | Portfolios, Projects, Sub-Projects |
| **Run All** | all five, in the correct order, in one pass | everything |

**Run All before sending reports to management.** The buttons can be pressed individually and in any order, but Overall reads what the others wrote, so running them out of order gives an Overall based on stale inputs.

### What automation never touches

- **A row whose Status is `Rejected`, `On Hold` or `Blocked` is skipped entirely.** Somebody put it there deliberately; nothing automatic moves it out, and skipping the whole row means it can never end up half updated.
- **Actual work and actual cost are never rewritten.** The automation reads them.
- Every indicator is recomputed from current state on every run, so a withdrawn escalation or a corrected date moves a project back *down* as readily as up. Nothing gets stuck on Red.

### Update Status — lifecycle from the actual dates

A row's state is read from its actual dates alone:

| The row has | State | Status | Stage | Phase | Schedule Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| no actual dates | Not started | `New` | `1 Proposed` | `Initiating` | `Not Assessed` |
| an actual start | Started | `In progress` | `6 Delivering` | `Executing` | `On schedule` |
| an actual finish | Finished | `Closed` | `8 Closed` | `Closing` | `Completed` |

On Projects and Sub-Projects all four fields move together, so the row always reads consistently. On Tasks, Milestones and Allocations **only Status** is set — stage, phase and schedule status are left alone.

### Sch Status — schedule health

Two methods, tried in order:

**With a baseline** — compares forecast finish against baseline finish. The tolerances scale with the length of the item, because five days late on a three-week task is not the same event as five days late on a two-year programme:

| | Default |
|---|---|
| Slip tolerance | the greater of **3 days** or **5%** of baseline duration |
| Late tolerance | the greater of **10 days** or **10%** of baseline duration |

| Result | When |
|---|---|
| `Early` | earlier than baseline by more than the slip tolerance |
| `On schedule` | within the slip tolerance either way |
| `Slipping` | late, but within the late tolerance |
| `Late` | later than the late tolerance |
| `Completed` | the row has an actual finish — this wins over everything |

**Without a baseline** — it can only see what is already overdue against the Report Date, which is a genuinely different question. So it returns `Late` or `Not Assessed` and never `Early` or `Slipping`. Work still ahead of the Report Date stays `Not Assessed` rather than being flattered with an "On schedule" there is no evidence for.

The **Health Schedule** colour is a pure projection of the word, so the two can never disagree: Early and On schedule and Completed are Green, Slipping is Yellow, Late is Red, Not Assessed is grey.

Each run tells you which method it used. If it reports that no baselines were found, every schedule status on that run came from the Report Date alone — useful, but not schedule variance. **Set a baseline to get the real answer.**

### Cost Hours — cost and hours health

Two questions, combined, with the **worse of the two** winning:

- **Variance** — is the forecast bigger than the plan? An estimating question. The plan is the baseline if there is one, otherwise the entered Budget Cost or Budget Hours. Green within 5%, Yellow within 15%, Red beyond — with an absolute floor (**5,000** currency units, **40** hours) so a small project's rounding noise does not read as an overrun.
- **CPI** — are we burning faster than we are earning? An execution question, meaningful only once something has actually been spent. Green at 0.95 and above, Yellow at 0.85, Red below.

Two safeguards worth knowing, because they are what stop a dashboard lying:

- **With neither a baseline nor a budget the answer is `Not Assessed`, never Green.** A brand-new project reporting green cost health is the most common way a portfolio dashboard misleads.
- **Below 15% complete, a variance-driven Red is reported as Yellow.** Early on, a forecast above plan is an estimate revision rather than an overspend — attention, not alarm. A genuinely bad CPI still shows Red at any percent complete, so nothing is hidden.

### RIC — scope, risk and issue health

Each of the three indicators counts the Change Requests, Risks or Issues beneath the project. A row stops counting once its Status is `Closed` or `Rejected`.

| Result | When |
|---|---|
| `Not Assessed` | the register is empty — no items of that kind at all |

| Result | When |
|---|---|
| `Green` | items exist and none are open |
| `Yellow` | an open item is escalated to the **Project Office**, or **3 or more** remain open |
| `Red` | an open item is escalated to **Executives** or **Directors**, or a risk is marked `Escalated` |

### Overall — the summary indicator

First, **Portfolios take their six indicators from their Projects** — the worst reading among them. Sub-Projects are deliberately excluded, because their costs already roll into the Project totals and their risks are already counted at Project level; reading them again would count the same problem twice. A Portfolio with no Project in progress stays `Not Assessed` rather than claiming health it has not earned.

Then Health Overall is set from the other six indicators on the same row:

| Result | When |
|---|---|
| `Red` | **any** indicator is Red, or **4 or more** are Yellow |
| `Yellow` | 1 to 3 indicators are Yellow |
| `Green` | all assessed indicators are Green |
| `Not Assessed` | no indicator has been assessed |

Indicators reading `Not Assessed` are excluded from the count entirely, so an unassessed dimension neither dilutes nor inflates the result. Zero assessed dimensions gives `Not Assessed`, never a confident green built on no evidence.

### Tuning the thresholds

Every threshold above is a default, and every one can be overridden per install through an **`apMetadataRules`** JSON value on the admin panel row. Absent or unparseable, the defaults apply — so a malformed entry degrades to standard behaviour rather than breaking anything.

| Key | Default | Controls |
|---|---|---|
| `slipDaysMin` / `slipPct` | 3 / 0.05 | Slipping tolerance |
| `lateDaysMin` / `latePct` | 10 / 0.10 | Late tolerance |
| `costGreen` / `costYellow` | 0.05 / 0.15 | cost variance bands |
| `costMateriality` | 5000 | absolute floor below which cost variance is ignored |
| `hoursGreen` / `hoursYellow` | 0.05 / 0.15 | hours variance bands |
| `hoursMateriality` | 40 | absolute floor, in hours |
| `cpiGreen` / `cpiYellow` | 0.95 / 0.85 | earned-value bands |
| `evEarlyPct` | 15 | percent complete below which variance cannot force Red |
| `ricYellowCount` | 3 | open items before an unescalated register goes Yellow |
| `overallYellowToRed` | 4 | Yellow count that forces Overall to Red |

### The dependency you must not break

Every value in the tables above — `In progress`, `On schedule`, `Executives`, `Green` — is matched by **exact text** against the picklists. The automation writes the value, and the picker has to be able to offer the same value back to the user afterwards.

> **Rename one of these values and the automation stops working on that field**, silently. They are locked for exactly this reason (section 4). Note the lower-case second word in `In progress` and `On schedule`; they are not `In Progress` or `On Schedule`.

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*End of guide.*

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# Part 4 — Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention

## Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention User Guide

This guide covers everything about getting data **into** and **out of** Agilebars, Timebars and Costbars, and about keeping it safe while it moves: where your data lives, how to export it, how to bulk-edit it in a spreadsheet, how to bring it back, what protects you when the two get out of step, and how to recover when something goes wrong.

> **One thing to read before anything else.** A spreadsheet import is **not a merge**. It clears each store and replaces it. Anything you changed in the app since your last export is gone. The application now watches for exactly this and **stops the import** rather than letting it happen — see The import gate. It is the most important section in this guide.

### Contents


1. Where your data lives
2. The data stores
3. Which copy is the source of truth
4. Moving data out
5. Moving data in
6. The import gate and the sync alert
7. The spreadsheet workflow
8. Other data actions
9. Undo Bar Move
10. Backup, recovery and retention
11. Cloud publishing
12. Validation and integrity
13. Troubleshooting
14. Best practices


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### 1. Where your data lives

The products follow a **client-first** architecture:

- **Your data lives in your browser**, in IndexedDB
- **No internet is required** — the application works completely offline
- **Nothing moves unless you move it** — every export, import and publish is something you initiate
- **Cloud publishing is optional**

### Three storage layers

| Layer | Where | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| **IndexedDB** | your browser | live work; every edit lands here immediately |
| **Files** | your computer | bulk editing, backups, offline work |
| **Timebars Cloud** | Timebars servers | team sharing and cross-device access, opt-in |

```
Your browser (IndexedDB)
     ↓ ↑     you control every movement
Spreadsheet / JSON / CSV files  ↔  Timebars Cloud
```

### About IndexedDB

| | |
|---|---|
| **Database name** | `TB` |
| **Version** | 1 |
| **Typical size** | ~5–20 MB for 100–500 bars; up to ~100 MB for large portfolios |
| **Browsers** | Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari |

What this means in practice:

- Data survives closing the browser and restarting the machine.
- Data is **isolated per browser** — your Chrome data is not your Firefox data.
- Data is **per domain** — the Timebars site and the Costbars site hold separate databases.
- **Clearing browser data deletes it.** Take a Full Backup before you ever clear site data, change machines, or let IT reimage your laptop.

> The hierarchy itself — the five levels, what may parent what, and how rollups work — is covered in the *Data Model and Scheduling Engine Guide*, which owns that subject. This guide is about moving the data, not modelling it.

---

## 2. The data stores

Fifteen stores. Ten round-trip through the workbook; the rest are calculated.

### Stores you control

| Store | Holds | Edited through |
|---|---|---|
| **tbTimebars** | every bar on the canvas — portfolios, projects, tasks, milestones, allocations | canvas, Bar Creator, flyout forms, tabular grids |
| **tbMetaData** | 100+ extended fields per bar — status, health, priority, business case | Core Form, FOCD forms, tabular grids |
| **tbResources** | the resource pool — people and generic resources | Shared Resource Pool report, or the workbook |

| Store | Holds | Edited through |
|---|---|---|
| **tbAdminPanel** | settings — report date, timescale, zoom, product, view state | Canvas Settings and the toolbars |
| **tbTags** | every picklist value | Picklist Values report, or the workbook |
| **tbSchema** | the master field list — one row per field in the system | Schema Values report, or the workbook |
| **tbFields** | which fields sit on which FOCD form | Fields Values report, or the workbook |
| **tbCoreReport** | the Core Form layout — field, section, level | CoreReport Values report, or the workbook |
| **tbBaseline** | baseline snapshots of tbTimebars | Set Baseline on the CS form |
| **tbCharts** | saved chart configurations | saving an Agilebars burndown |

> **tbSchema is the newest of these and the most important to know about.** It is the master field list every other configuration table joins to, and it replaced the old `BulkOperations` configuration table in the workbook. If your workbook predates it, see The workbook sheets.

### Stores the application calculates

These are rebuilt from the stores above. Do not edit them, and do not carry them back into the workbook.

| Store | Holds | Rebuilt when |
|---|---|---|
| **tbMdJoined** | tbTimebars joined to tbMetaData, for reporting | canvas load, Recalculate All |
| **tbResCalcs** | time-phased hours and costs for burndown charts | burndown calculation |
| **tbResCalcs2** | weekly resource demand by role, skill, location, department | canvas load, Recalculate All |
| **tbResCalcsUsage** | weekly resource availability | resource data changes |
| **tbDocuments** | *deprecated* — retained for compatibility, nothing writes to it | — |

## 3. Which copy is the source of truth

This is the most important idea in the guide, and the one that explains every alert, block and bulk-update tool that follows.

Your data can exist in four places at once — the browser, a workbook, a backup file, and a published pubset. **Only one of them is current at any moment**, and the product's job is to stop you overwriting the current one with a stale one.

### The chain, in order

**1. Editing in the app makes the browser the source of truth — immediately.**

Change a picklist value on Picklist Values, a field label on Schema Values, a placement on CoreReport Values, or any bar or metadata field in a grid, and it is written to IndexedDB on the spot. There is no save step. From that instant, **the browser holds the only current copy**.

**2. The workbook is now behind.**

It still holds the configuration as it stood at your last export. Nothing about it looks wrong — it simply describes an earlier version of your product.

**3. The application blocks the import rather than let you lose the change.**

This is what the sync alert is. Rather than allow a stale workbook to overwrite a newer browser, the product **stops the import** and tells you which stores are affected. Export the changed stores, take them into the workbook, and the workbook becomes the source of truth again — at which point importing it is safe.

The full mechanism is in section 6. What matters here is *why* it exists: an import replaces stores wholesale, so without the gate the newer copy always loses.

**4. Anything already published or backed up is behind too — and nothing warns you.**

The gate protects the browser. It cannot protect copies that already left.

> A pubset published last month, or a Full Backup taken last month, carries **last month's Tags, CoreReport and Fields**. Re-hydrate from it and your configuration silently reverts — renamed picklist values come back with their old names, fields you moved go back where they were.

This is not a defect; it is what a snapshot is. But it means **a configuration change makes every existing pubset and backup progressively more out of date**, and the more configuration you tune, the faster that happens.

**5. Bulk Update is how published data catches up.**

Rather than republish every pubset by hand after a configuration change, the **Publishing and Syncing Timebars** page has a **Bulk Update** tab that pushes one store into many existing pubsets at once.

| Bulk Update mode | Use it for |
|---|---|
| **Complete Replacement** (JSON file) | replacing a whole store — the usual choice after a picklist or layout change |
| **Filter & Set** (no file) | changing one field's value wherever it currently equals something else, across the selected pubsets |
| **Row-Level Patch** (CSV file) | updating named rows only. First column is the store key, the rest are the fields to change |

Select the target store, optionally filter the pubset list by publish date, tick the pubsets to update, preview, and apply. The stores it can push are **tbTimebars, tbMetaData, tbResources, tbTags, tbFields, tbCoreReport and tbSchema**.

> **tbSchema** is available in **Complete Replacement** and **Row-Level Patch** only. Filter & Set builds its field list from the picklist table, which does not describe Schema's own columns, so Schema is greyed out in that mode.

### What to do after a configuration change

1. **Export** the changed stores — the sync alert panel offers exactly those
2. **Import them into the workbook**, so it is the source of truth again
3. **Bulk Update** your live pubsets with the changed configuration store
4. **Take a fresh Full Backup**, so your newest restore point matches your newest configuration

Steps 3 and 4 are the ones people skip, and they are the ones that hurt months later.

---

## 4. Moving data out

Three exports, for three different jobs. All of them write to your browser's download folder.

| Menu item | Produces | Use it for |
|---|---|---|
| **Full Backup** | one file, `tbFullBackup_YYYY-MM-DD_HH-MM-SS.js` | restore points — this is your safety net |
| **Export to CSV (SpreadSheet sync.)** | **15 CSV files**, one per store | the spreadsheet round trip |
| **Export to JSON** | **15 JSON files**, one per store | integrations, AI agents, external tools |

All three are on the **Hamburger Icon** menu.

> **Full Backup is the one that matters.** It contains every store, so restoring it returns the application to exactly the state it was in. The other two are working exports.

A fourth route exists and is often the best one: the **sync alert panel** exports **only the stores you have actually changed** — see section 6.

### Automatic backups

The application takes a Full Backup for you, without being asked, before:

- importing a spreadsheet, CSV or JSON file
- loading Demo Data
- Clear Timebars & Metadata

They land in your downloads folder with the same `tbFullBackup_…` naming. This is a safety net, not a backup strategy — the files accumulate unsorted among your downloads.

---

## 5. Moving data in

### The drop panel

**Hamburger Icon → Import SpreadSheet, CSV or JSON** opens the **Drop To Import Data** panel. Drop a file onto it, or use the browse button.

> Earlier documentation said to drag files onto the canvas. Use the import panel.

Accepted: `.xlsx`, `.xlsm`, `.ods`, `.csv`, `.js`, `.json`.

### The filename rule

The application decides what a file *is* from the **start of its name**. A file whose name does not begin with one of these is rejected before anything is read:

| Name starts with | The file is treated as |
|---|---|
| `tbClient…` | the workbook — all its sheets |
| `tbFullBackup…` | a full restore |
| `transferBars…` | bars transferred from another product |
| a store name — `tbTags…`, `tbMetaData…`, `tbTimebars…` | that single store |

The last row is why the per-store exports round-trip cleanly: a file exported as `tbTags.json` can be dropped straight back in. It is also why **renaming a file breaks the import**. Keep the name the application gave it.

### What an import actually does

This is the single most misunderstood behaviour in the product:

> **An import clears the store and replaces it. It does not merge.**

Every row in the store is removed and the file's rows are written in their place. A row you added in the app and did not export is not preserved, not conflicted, not reported — it is simply gone.

The application does two things to protect you:

1. It takes a **Full Backup first**, automatically.
2. It **refuses to import at all** when it knows you have unexported local changes. That is section 6.

---

## 6. The import gate and the sync alert

### Why this exists

You export to the workbook on Monday. On Tuesday you edit a few bars in the app, add a picklist value, set a baseline. On Wednesday you import the workbook you edited. Tuesday's work is destroyed, silently, with nothing on screen to suggest it was ever at risk.

The application now tracks this.

### The alert icon

When any workbook-backed store holds edits that are **not yet in the spreadsheet**, a **warning icon appears on the top menu**.

| Action | What happens |
|---|---|
| **Single click** | a message: *"Local changes pending — double-click for instructions."* |
| **Double click** | the sync alert panel opens |

Double-click rather than single, so a stray click cannot throw a panel over whatever you were doing.

### While the icon is showing, imports stop

Attempting an import gives you:

> **Import stopped.** You have local changes that are not yet in the spreadsheet. Double-click the alert icon on the top menu for instructions.

The panel opens automatically, listing the stores concerned.

The check happens **after** the filename is validated and **before** the pre-import backup runs — so a blocked import has touched nothing at all. No backup file, no partial write, nothing to clean up.

### The two ways out

The panel gives you two buttons, and they are not equivalent:

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Export to Remove Block** | writes one JSON file per changed store to your downloads folder, ready to import into the workbook, then clears the block |
| **Remove Block** | clears the block and keeps your local changes — **the next import will overwrite them** |

**Export to Remove Block is the safe path.** Remove Block is there because without an escape hatch a stale flag would leave the application unable to import at all — use it when you

genuinely do not want the local changes.

Exporting a store through the normal Export to CSV or Export to JSON also clears that store's own mark automatically.

### What gets watched

Nine stores can be changed from inside the app, and each is watched for the work that changes it:

| Store | Marked dirty by |
|---|---|
| **Timebars** | moving, resizing or rescheduling a bar; changing the Report Date; any field edit on a form or grid — Owner included |
| **MetaData** | field edits on a FOCD form, the Core Form or a tabular grid |
| **Resources** | edits in the Shared Resource Pool view or on the Resource form |
| **Tags** | editing, adding or deleting a value in Picklist Values |
| **Baseline** | setting or clearing a baseline from the CS form, at any level |
| **Charts** | saving a burndown chart in Agilebars |
| **Fields** | edits in Fields Values |
| **Schema** | edits in Schema Values |
| **CoreReport** | edits in CoreReport Values |

Five stores are deliberately **not** watched. Four of them — ResCalcs, ResCalcs2, ResCalcsUsage and MdJoined — are calculated, rebuilt by Recalculate All, and never worth carrying back. The fifth, **AdminPanel**, holds your settings and view state and is written on almost every click; watching it would leave the warning showing permanently and telling you nothing.

### Two routes into the workbook

They are alternatives, not steps:

- **Export to CSV** on the main menu gives you **everything, every time**, and you decide which sheets to import.
- **The sync alert panel** gives you **only the changed stores** — less to import, and less chance of overwriting a sheet you did not mean to touch.

### Setting it up

The tracking needs one column, `apDirtyStores`, on the **AdminPanel** worksheet. It needs no database change — if your workbook does not have it yet, add it. Without the column the app still works; it simply cannot remember the warning across a reload.

---

## 7. The spreadsheet workflow

### The template

| | |
|---|---|
| **Excel** | Hamburger Icon → **Download Excel SS** — `tbClientMaster….xlsm` |
| **LibreOffice Calc** | Hamburger Icon → **Download Libre Office Calc SS** — `tbClientMaster….ods` |

Both sync with all three products. **The filename must still begin with `tbClient`** — that prefix is how the application recognises it.

### The cycle

```
1. Export to CSV from the app          (15 files)
2. Import All on the workbook's Setup tab
3. Edit in Excel or Calc
4. Save the workbook
5. Import the workbook back through the drop panel
```

### Step 1 — export

**Hamburger Icon → Export to CSV (SpreadSheet sync.)**. Wait for all files to finish downloading before moving on.

### Step 2 — tell the workbook where they are

On the **Setup** tab, set the **Location** column to your browser's download folder. The **Import Yes/No** column controls which stores are pulled in by *Import All*, so you can leave the calculated stores out.

### Step 3 — import into the workbook

**Import All** on the Setup tab pulls every sheet marked Yes. Individual sheets have their own Import button if you only want one.

### Step 4 — edit

This is the point of the exercise: copy-paste, fill-down, formulas, filters, sorting, conditional formatting, bulk status changes, adding and deleting rows.

**Sheet structure:**

| Row | Contents |
|---|---|
| **Row 1** | database field names — `tbID`, `tbName`, `tbStart`. **Never change these.** |
| **Row 3** | friendly labels, for your reference |
| **Row 4+** | your data |

Changing Row 1 breaks the import. It is how each column is matched to a field.

### Step 5 — save, and step 6 — import back

Save the workbook (macros enabled writes the updated CSVs out), then drop it on the import panel. The app takes its automatic backup, replaces each store from its sheet, and redraws.

### The workbook sheets

Fifteen sheets map to the fifteen stores:

| Sheet | Store | Edit it? |
|---|---|---|
| Timebars | tbTimebars | yes |
| MetaData | tbMetaData | yes |
| Resources | tbResources | yes |
| AdminPanel | tbAdminPanel | yes — settings and holiday exceptions |
| Tags | tbTags | yes — picklist values |
| **Schema** | **tbSchema** | yes — the master field list |
| Fields | tbFields | yes — FOCD form layout |
| CoreReport | tbCoreReport | yes — Core Form layout |
| Charts | tbCharts | yes |
| Baseline | tbBaseline | no — snapshot |
| MdJoined | tbMdJoined | no — calculated |
| ResCalcs | tbResCalcs | no — calculated |
| ResCalcs2 | tbResCalcs2 | no — calculated |
| ResCalcsUsage | tbResCalcsUsage | no — calculated |
| Documents | tbDocuments | no — deprecated |

### How a sheet is laid out

Every data sheet in the workbook follows the same three-row anchor, and the macros, the exporter and the importer all depend on it:

| Row | Holds |
|---|---|
| **Row 1** | the exact internal field names — `tbID`, `tbName`, `tbStart` — as column headers |
| Row 3 | friendly column titles, for reading. Nothing reads these |
| **Row 4** | the **first data row** |

**Do not insert or delete rows above row 4, and do not edit row 1.** A field name typed into row 1 that does not exist in the Schema sheet is not imported and is not reported — the column is silently ignored. Change a name in Schema first, then in row 1.

The two sheets that carry your plan are **Timebars** (which maps to `tbTimebars`) and **MetaData** (which maps to `tbMetaData`), joined by `tbMDID` = `tbID`. Where a MetaData column mirrors a

Timebars one — `tbMDName`, `tbMDTypes`, `tbMDSubtype`, `tbMDCustomerID` — take the value from the matching Timebars row rather than typing it again.

### Validation, and where it comes from

The workbook's macros check data quality as you edit — mandatory columns, data types, valid picklist values — and highlight problems in red.

> **The validation rules now come from the `Schema` sheet.** They used to come from a table on the `BulkOperations` sheet. If you are maintaining the macros, `FormatAndValidateV1.bas` reads `CFG_SHEET = "Schema"`. The `BulkOperations` sheet still exists for its import and export control ranges, but its field-configuration table is gone — one row per field now lives in `Schema`, so no field can be configured twice with two different answers.

Two Excel-side tools worth knowing about:

- **The Column Managers** — show and hide groups of columns on the Timebars and MetaData sheets, so you can work on one section at a time instead of scrolling across hundreds of columns.
- **PickListsV1** — one picklist engine driving the dropdowns for both Tags and Resources values.

### Before you import: the six checks

The workbook's validators catch most of this as you type, but these are the six that break an import or produce a broken hierarchy, and they are worth a deliberate pass:

1. Every Timebars row has a **unique `tbID`**, and every MetaData row has a **`tbMDID` that matches one**
2. Every non-root row has a **`tbSelfKey2` pointing at a parent ID that exists**
3. **`tbType`** holds only the reserved values — Portfolio, Project, Sub-Project, Task, Milestone, Gate, Allocation
4. All dates are **`DD-MMM-YYYY`**
5. **`canvasNo` is `1`** on every row
6. Headers are in **row 1** and data starts at **row 4**

Numeric columns must hold numbers — `0`, never blank, never `na`. The full field rules are in the *Data Model and Scheduling Engine Guide*.

### After every import: run Config Integrity

An import can leave the four configuration tables pointing at each other incorrectly — a field renamed on one sheet and not another, a row deleted while others still reference it, a picklist emptied. **None of it throws an error.**

**Report Menu → Other → Config Integrity** measures it. Make it the last step of every import. See the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide* for what it checks.

### The rule about editing in two places

Do not edit in the application while the same data is out in a spreadsheet. The import gate now catches the dangerous half of this automatically, but the discipline is still worth keeping:

1. Export
2. Edit in the workbook
3. Import
4. Resume working in the app

---

## 8. Other data actions

All on the **Hamburger Icon** menu.

### Bulk Manage Bars

**Duplicate bars and children** — enter the Bar ID (bottom-left of the bar on the canvas) and click Duplicate. Copies appear near the original, names prefixed `duplicate`, IDs suffixed `-d`. Good for template projects and what-if scenarios.

**Transfer bars between products** — enter the Bar ID and an optional ID prefix to avoid collisions, click Transfer, and a `transferBars…json` file lands in your downloads. Open the target product and drop that file on the import panel. Use it when a waterfall project becomes agile, or an agile work package becomes a portfolio item.

### Migrate Rich Text

Converts legacy rich text from the old Quill format to the current editor's format. **Safe to run at any time** — already-converted and plain-text fields are left alone.

Run it once after upgrading, and again after importing an old backup file. If descriptions or business-case sections look like raw markup, this is the fix.

### Clear Timebars & Metadata

Gives you a clean canvas without losing your configuration. A Full Backup is written automatically first, and the action asks for confirmation.

| Cleared | Kept |
|---|---|
| Timebars, MetaData, **Baseline**, **Charts**, and all four calculated stores | AdminPanel, Schema, Tags, Resources, Fields, CoreReport |

Note that **baselines and saved charts go too** — they describe bars that will no longer exist. The undo history is cleared for the same reason. Everything that makes the application *yours* — your picklists, your form layouts, your resource pool, your settings — survives.

### Load Demo Data

Replaces current data with a demo dataset for the product you are running. A Full Backup is written automatically first.

### Delete Database

Destroys everything, permanently. Refresh the browser afterwards and a fresh database is built with demo data. **Back up first** — this one does not do it for you.

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## 9. Undo Bar Move

You moved a few bars, and the plan now looks wrong. **Undo Bar Move** puts them back.

**Where it is:** right-click anywhere on the canvas to open the **Shortcut Menu**. Undo Bar Move is the first item.

Undo remembers your **last 5 moves**, most recent first. Each click steps back one move.

> **Undo is not a backup.** It covers bar moves only, only since your last data load, and only in this browser. For anything larger — a spreadsheet sync, a bulk import, a version upgrade — take a **Full Backup** first.

### What Undo puts back

A drag or resize does not change one bar. It changes everything the scheduling engine recalculates as a result, and Undo reverses **all** of it:

- **Bar positions** — where each bar sat on the timescale, and its row
- **Dates** — Start, Finish, Actual Start, Actual Finish
- **Durations** — Duration and Remaining Duration
- **Work** — Work, A Work, Work Remaining
- **Cost** — Cost, A Cost, Cost Remaining
- **Progress** — % Complete
- **Allocation values** — Calendar hours, % Allocated, Pay Rate, Override flag
- **Baseline bars** — the matching baseline bar returns to its row

Because a move cascades, Undo restores more than the bar you touched. Move a Project and you moved its sub-projects, tasks, allocations, any linked successor tasks, its baseline bar, and the rolled-up totals on the Portfolio above it. Undo puts that whole branch back — which is what makes it trustworthy, but does mean undoing a Portfolio drag is a big operation.

### What Undo never touches

**Metadata is completely outside Undo.** One rule with two halves, and both are worth learning:

| | Undo restores it? | Does editing it cost an undo step? |
|---|---|---|
| **Schedule fields** (dates, durations, work, cost, % complete, allocation values, bar position) | **Yes** | Yes — see below |
| **Everything else** (Name, Owner, tags, descriptions, Status, Priority, all Metadata, Budget Cost, Budget Hours, WBS Description) | **No** | **No** |

So you can rename bars, change owners, tap picklists, write status updates and edit descriptions **whenever you like** — before, between or after moves. Undo will not put any of it back, and none of it uses up your undo steps.

**This works field by field, not bar by bar.** Drag a bar, rename that same bar, then press Undo: the bar's **dates go back** and its **new name stays**.

### Your typed schedule values are protected

Some values you type by hand are the *same* values Undo restores — hours to go, % Allocated, and the manual Cost / Work / % Complete cells on the status form. Without a safeguard, undoing an older move would quietly wipe out what you typed.

It cannot. **Typing one of those values clears every restore point older than it.**

1. You move two bars → 2 moves available to undo
2. You type a new **Hours to go** on an allocation → **undo list clears**, the button greys out
3. You move two more bars → 2 moves available again
4. You undo both → the bars go back, and **your typed value is still there**

You can undo moves made *after* your edit, but never back *past* it. Hover the menu item and it tells you exactly what happened, and when.

**Which edits clear the list:**

- **Hours to go**, **% Allocated** or **Available hours per day** on the Allocation Hours Calculator
- **Remove Override** on the Allocation form
- **Manual Cost, A Cost, Cost Remaining, Work, A Work, Work Remaining or % Complete** on the CS status form

Editing a bar's Name, Owner, tags, description, Status, Priority, Budget Cost or Budget Hours does **not** clear the list — Undo would never have touched those anyway.

### Reading the menu item

| What you see | What it means |
|---|---|
| **Undo Bar Move** | one restore point available |
| **Undo Bar Move (3)** | three moves can be undone, most recent first |
| greyed out | nothing to undo — hover it and the text says why |

### When Undo clears itself

Undo **survives a page refresh**. It is **cleared** whenever the underlying data is replaced:

- Loading Demo Data
- Clear Timebars & Metadata
- Restoring a Full Backup
- Importing a spreadsheet, CSV or JSON that replaces bars
- Typing a schedule value by hand (above)

This is deliberate. A restore point describes the bars that existed when it was taken; applying it to freshly loaded data would put back bars that no longer belong.

### Undo is per browser, per machine

Restore points live in your browser's local database alongside your project data. They are **not** published to the cloud, **not** shared with colleagues, and do **not** travel to another computer or browser profile. Two people working on the same plan each have their own Undo.

Undo history is **not included in a Full Backup** — backup files are unchanged in size and content by this feature, and restoring one correctly clears the undo list.

### Undo troubleshooting

| Symptom | Cause and fix |
|---|---|
| Undo is greyed out | No restore point. Hover it — either nothing has moved since the last data load, or a typed schedule value cleared the list |
| My undo list disappeared | You typed a schedule value. That protects your edit. Moves from now on are undoable again |
| Undo put back more than my last drag | Two things do this, both intended: a move cascades to children, siblings and linked tasks; and several drags within half a second are grouped into one restore point |
| Undo put back a bar I did not move | Same cause — it was part of the cascade |
| Undo did not restore my Name / tag / description change | Correct. Metadata is outside Undo entirely |
| Undo is slow on a large plan | It re-runs the full recalculation and redraw, the same cost as Recalculate |
| My colleague cannot undo my move | By design — undo history is local to one browser |

---

## 10. Backup, recovery and retention

### What each kind of file contains

| File | Contains | Restores to |
|---|---|---|
| **Full Backup** — `tbFullBackup_…` | **every store** | exactly the state the application was in when it was taken |

| File | Contains | Restores to |
|---|---|---|
| **Per-store JSON / CSV** — `tbTags.json`, `tbTimebars.csv` … | one store | that store only, replacing what is there |
| **The workbook** — `tbClient…` | the ten editable stores | those ten stores |
| **A pubset** in the cloud | fifteen stores | the application, on any device you log in from |

Only the Full Backup is a restore point. The others are working files: each replaces part of your data and leaves the rest as it is, which is exactly what you want for a bulk edit and exactly what you do not want after a mistake.

### Automatic backups

The application takes a Full Backup for you, unasked, immediately before it does anything destructive:

- importing a spreadsheet, CSV or JSON file
- loading Demo Data
- Clear Timebars & Metadata

They land in your downloads folder with the same `tbFullBackup_…` name. **This is a safety net, not a backup strategy.** The files accumulate unsorted among everything else you have downloaded, and after a fortnight you will not be able to tell which one is the good one.

### How to restore

Drop the file onto **Hamburger Icon → Import SpreadSheet, CSV or JSON**.

A Full Backup restore **replaces every store**. Anything done since that backup was taken is gone — including configuration changes, which is the case people forget. Take a fresh backup of the current state first if there is any chance you will want to come back to it.

### Recovery scenarios

| What happened | What to do |
|---|---|
| **Browser data was cleared** — you open the app and your work is gone | Restore your most recent Full Backup. Then stop the browser clearing site data on exit, or this repeats |
| **A different browser or profile** — the data looks missing but nothing was lost | IndexedDB is per browser, per profile, per machine. Go back to the browser you were working in, or restore a backup into this one |
| **You imported the wrong file** | Restore the automatic Full Backup the application took immediately before that import. It is the newest `tbFullBackup_…` in your downloads folder |
| **An import overwrote work you had done in the app** | Same — the automatic pre-import backup holds it. This is what the import gate exists to prevent; see section 6 |

| What happened | What to do |
|---|---|
| **Moving to a new machine** | Take a Full Backup on the old machine and import it on the new one. Publishing to the cloud and re-hydrating also works and carries thirteen of the stores |
| **The numbers look wrong rather than missing** | Not a restore problem. Run **Recalculate All**, then **Config Integrity**. See section 12 |
| **A picklist opens empty, or a field lost its list** | A configuration reference broke, usually from a partial import. Run **Config Integrity** — it names what no longer resolves |

### What a backup does not contain

- **Undo history.** Undo lives outside the backup, is cleared whenever data is loaded or imported, and is per browser. It is not a recovery tool — see section 9.
- **Your browser's view state** beyond what the AdminPanel store holds.

### Retention

A backup you cannot find is not a backup.

| Practice | Why |
|---|---|
| **Keep a dedicated backups folder** — not Downloads | the automatic pre-import backups land in Downloads and bury the ones you meant to keep |
| **Keep three to five recent Full Backups** | enough to step back past a bad day; few enough to tell apart |
| **Keep one monthly backup for as long as the plan matters** | the daily set will have rolled over long before anyone asks what the plan looked like at approval |
| **Keep the filename the application gave it** | the timestamp is in the name, and the import decides what a file is from the start of its name. Rename it and it will not import |
| **Take one before, not after** | any spreadsheet import, bulk operation, demo-data load, configuration change, or browser change |
| **Take a fresh one after a configuration change** | so your newest restore point matches your newest configuration — see section 3 |

**How often?** Daily while you are actively working a critical plan; weekly for stable work. The honest test is how much re-typing you are willing to do, because that is exactly what a restore costs you.

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## 11. Cloud publishing

Optional, user-initiated, and covered fully in the *Cloud Publishing Guide*. In outline:

**Publish** — Main Menu → Publish, log in, then **Re-Publish!** on the PubSet. Your data uploads and the Cloud Dashboard updates.

**Re-Hydrate** — on another device, Main Menu → Publish, log in, **Re-Hydrate!**. Data downloads to that device.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Control** | user-initiated only, never automatic |
| **PubSets** | up to 10 separate datasets, subscription dependent |
| **Dashboard PubSet** | the one with the blue background |
| **Security** | HTTPS in transit, token authentication, data isolated per account |

> **Re-Hydrate replaces all local data.** Same warning as an import: back up first, and check the PubSet's Last Published date. If your local data is newer, publish before you re-hydrate.

---

## 12. Validation and integrity

Four layers, at different moments:

**As you type** — required fields enforced, date pickers, picklists, numeric fields reject text.

**In the workbook** — macro validators check mandatory columns, data types, references and duplicate IDs, and highlight problems in red before you import. Driven by the `Schema` sheet.

**During import** — field names checked against the schema, types checked, unique constraints enforced. Multi-store operations are all-or-nothing: an error rolls the whole thing back.

**After import** — **Config Integrity** for the configuration tables (section 7), and **Recalculate All** to rebuild every calculated store.

Referential behaviour worth knowing: deleting a parent bar deletes its children.

---

## 13. Troubleshooting

### My data disappeared after restarting the browser

Browser data was cleared, or you are in a different browser or profile. Restore your most recent Full Backup through the import panel. Then check your browser is not set to clear site data on exit.

### The import is blocked and I do not know why

You have local changes that are not yet in the spreadsheet. That is the gate working. Double-click the warning icon on the top menu, then use **Export to Remove Block** to keep those changes, or **Remove Block** to discard them. See section 6.

### A pubset or backup brought back old picklists or an old form layout

It was published or taken before you changed the configuration, and a snapshot carries the configuration of its moment. Re-apply the change, then use **Bulk Update** on the Publishing and Syncing page to push the current store into your existing pubsets, and take a fresh Full Backup. See section 3.

### The file will not import at all

The filename does not start with a recognised prefix. It must begin with `tbClient`, `tbFullBackup`, `transferBars`, or a store name. Do not rename exported files, and do not drop folders.

### The import ran, but my changes are not there

Two likely causes. Either the sheet you edited was not marked Yes in the Setup tab's Import column, or you edited the sheet but did not save the workbook before dropping it. Re-export, re-import, and check the Setup tab.

### An import overwrote work I had done in the app

An import replaces stores; it does not merge. The gate exists to prevent exactly this — if it did not fire, the changes were made before the tracking was set up, or `apDirtyStores` is missing from your AdminPanel sheet. Restore the automatic backup taken immediately before the import; it is in your downloads folder.

### A picklist opens empty, or a field lost its list

A configuration reference has broken — usually a value or picklist renamed on one sheet and not another. Run **Config Integrity**.

### Rich text fields show raw markup

Run **Migrate Rich Text** from the Hamburger menu. Safe to run repeatedly.

### Storage quota exceeded

Rare. Export your data, delete the database, and import back only what you need. Consider splitting very large portfolios.

### The data looks inconsistent — totals do not add up

Run **Recalculate All** (right-click the canvas). It rebuilds every calculated store. If it persists, restore a backup.

### Macros are not working in the workbook

Excel blocks macros in files downloaded from the internet. Right-click the file → Properties → **Unblock**, or enable macros when prompted. Without them the Import and Export buttons do nothing.

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## 14. Best practices

### Backups

Covered in full in section 10. The short version: keep them in a dedicated folder, keep three to five recent ones plus a monthly, take one before anything destructive, and take a fresh one after a configuration change.

**Backups vs. Undo.** Undo handles the small everyday mistake — a bar dragged to the wrong place. It does not replace a backup: bar moves only, five of them, and cleared whenever data is loaded or imported.

### The sync loop

1. **Export** — everything, or just the changed stores from the alert panel
2. **Edit** in the workbook; do not edit the same data in the app meanwhile
3. **Save** with the `tbClient` name intact
4. **Import** through the drop panel
5. **Run Config Integrity**
6. **Run Recalculate All**
7. Keep the workbook as a record of what changed

Test a major restructuring against demo data before running it on real data.

### Multiple devices

1. Nominate one device as primary
2. Publish from it after changes
3. Re-hydrate on secondary devices *before* working, never after
4. Do not edit on two devices at once
5. Agree a team convention: last person to edit publishes

### Data hygiene

- Delete test and demo bars before production use
- Archive completed projects
- Keep naming conventions consistent
- Review unused resources and picklist values periodically
- Run **Config Integrity** after every import, not just when something looks wrong

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## Related documents

| For | See |
|---|---|
| Picklists, forms, and the configuration reports | *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide* |
| The hierarchy, rollups and the scheduling engine | *Data Model and Scheduling Engine Guide* |
| Field-by-field detail | **Schema Values** report |
| Publishing and the Cloud Dashboard | *Cloud Publishing Guide* |

| For | See |
| --- | --- |
| Moving from a legacy system | *Getting Started* — its data-migration chapter |

*Supersedes: Spreadsheet Sync User Guide, Data Management User Guide, and Data Structure User Guide.*

# Part 5 — Forms, Reports and Graphs

## Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide

This guide covers everything on the **Report Menu**, and it comes in two parts.

**Part A** is the reports about your work — tabular views, cards, charts, timelines and the Gantt Report, with the filters, grouping and inline editing that go with them.

**Part B** is the four **Editable Reports** that configure the product itself: what the picklists offer, which fields sit on which form, and how the Core Form is laid out. They sit on the same menu because they are reports; they are documented here because they are also the only place that configuration is done.

### Contents


**Part A — Reports and graphs**

1. How to access reports
2. Report categories
3. Tagging rows into reports — the Show In field
4. Special reports
5. Common report features
6. Where report data comes from
7. Publishing to the Cloud Dashboard
8. Tips
9. Troubleshooting

**Part B — Configuring the product through the Editable Reports**

10. The two rules that decide everything
11. Where configuration lives
12. Picklists and tagging
13. Dynamic forms (FOCD)
14. The Core Form
15. What is configurable, by product

Appendix A — Picklist reference A–Z


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## Part A — Reports and Graphs

### 1. How to Access Reports

Choose **Main Menu > Reports** to open the Reports menu. It is organised into five menus:

| Menu | Contains |
|---|---|
| **Portfolio** | Projects by Portfolio, PPM Cards Report, Drilldown from Portfolio, Portfolio Detail Report |

| Menu | Contains |
|---|---|
| **Project** | General Tabular View, Detail Cards, Baseline Variance |
| **Task** | Task Tabular Report, Gantt Report |
| **Resource** | Resource Usage, Shared Resource Pool |
| **Other** | Print WBS, Picklist Values, Fields Values, Schema Values, CoreReport Values, Config Integrity |

Most reports offer search, filtering, sorting and export. Reports can be published to the Timebars Cloud Dashboard with one click.

> **If you are looking for a report you remember by name**, several that used to be separate menu items are now reached from inside another report:
>
> | Looking for | It is now |
> |---|---|
> | Items Overdue, Milestone Horizon | tick-box filters inside the **Task Tabular Report**, and on the **Gantt Schedule View** header (reached from the Main Menu, not the Report Menu) |
> | Project Charter, Project Assessment | embedded on Project cards in **Detail Cards** |
> | Portfolio Status and Balancing | embedded per portfolio in **Portfolio Detail Report** |
> | Editable Grids / Data Management Grids | **removed** — each store now has its own report, see *Configuration reports* below |

## 2. Report Categories

### General Reports

### General Tabular View

- Comprehensive data table displaying all projects, tasks, milestones, and allocations
- Powerful search, filter, and sort capabilities across all fields
- Multiple column presets available:
  - Default Fields: Essential project information
  - Common Fields: Frequently accessed metadata
  - Notes & Descriptions: Detailed project narratives
  - Allocation Fields: Resource assignment details
  - KPI Fields: Key performance indicators
  - Variance Fields: Baseline comparison metrics
  - Investment Fields: Strategic alignment (Costbars)
  - Project Charter Fields: Comprehensive investment analysis
- Export to Excel/CSV with one click
- Color-coded rows by type (Portfolio, Project, Task, Milestone)
- Click any row to open the edit form

### General Card View

- Visual card layout showing projects and tasks
- Each card displays health indicators, status, priority, and key metadata
- Expandable sections for descriptions and notes
- Filter and search across all visible cards
- Color-coded by hierarchy level (Portfolio, Project, Sub-Project, Task)

#### Print WBS (Work Breakdown Structure)

- Professional WBS reports organized by hierarchy
- Shows parent-child relationships with indentation
- Includes WBS number, name, and description
- Copy and paste into markdown editors for sharing
- Export as documentation for project charters or scope baselines

#### All Drilldown (Portfolio Hierarchy)

- Interactive 5-tier hierarchy visualization
- Shows complete structure: Portfolio → Program → Project → Task/Milestone → Allocation
- Collapse and expand any level to focus on specific areas
- Color-coded levels for instant recognition
- Validates parent-child relationships and identifies orphaned items
- Export hierarchy as diagrams (Mermaid or GraphViz formats)

### Portfolio Reports

#### PPM Tabular Report

- Strategic portfolio analysis with dual scoring dimensions
- **Strategic Value (SV) Score**: Alignment with organizational objectives
- **Ability to Execute (AE) Score**: Resource availability and capability
- **Final Decision Score**: Weighted combination for prioritization
- Weekly resource demand grid (32 weeks visibility)
- Investment category, objective, strategy, and initiative fields
- System-generated decision notes
- Search and filter by project selection criteria
- Export for portfolio review meetings

#### PPM Cards Report

- Card-based view of portfolio projects with visual indicators
- Expandable tabs for Benefits, Impact Analysis, and Notes
- Health dashboard with 7 dimensions
- Filter by investment category, status, priority

#### Drilldown from Portfolio

- Portfolio report with color hierarchy showing all levels
- Visual representation of portfolio structure
- Click to drill down into specific portfolios or programs
- Shows relationships between portfolios, programs, and projects

### PPM Stop Light Report

- Visual health dashboard with color-coded status indicators
- Red/Yellow/Green indicators across all portfolio dimensions
- Quickly identify projects requiring attention
- Exception-based management view

## Project Reports

### Project Status

- High-level summary of all projects
- Green, yellow, and red health indicators
- Key metrics: schedule variance, cost variance, budget utilization
- Resource allocation status
- Risk and issue counts
- Escalation flags
- Sortable by any column
- Export for weekly status reporting

### Project Core Report

- Command center for project data in customizable card layout
- **7-Dimension Health Dashboard**: Overall, Scope, Schedule, Cost, Hours, Risk, Issues
- Expandable rich text sections: Executive summaries, descriptions, notes
- Inline editing: Update project fields without leaving the report
- Print-ready layouts for stakeholder distribution
- Real-time health monitoring
- Color-coded cards by project status

### All Tabular

- One large table showing all columns and all rows available
- Complete dataset with every field in the system
- Advanced filtering across 100+ fields
- Export entire dataset to Excel or CSV
- Useful for comprehensive data analysis

### Project Stop Light Report

- Individual project health metrics with color indicators
- Drill-down into specific performance areas
- Track trends over time
- Early warning system for project issues

### Baseline Variance Report

- Compare actual performance against approved baselines
- Variance calculations for:
    - Start Date Variance (days early/late)
    - Finish Date Variance (days early/late)

    - Duration Variance (work days)
    - Work Variance (hours)
    - Cost Variance (budget units)
- Advanced filtering with operators (>, <, =, >=, <=)
- Filter by hierarchy level (L1-L5)
- Type, status, priority, owner filters
- Earned value analysis support

**Project Charter Document**

- Comprehensive investment analysis report
- Strategic alignment (category, objective, strategy, initiative)
- Risk and complexity scoring with automated calculations
- Financial metrics (cost, hours, ROI indicators)
- Baseline comparison metrics
- Health indicators (7 dimensions)
- Resource demand by role and project
- Timeline visualization
- Export to PDF for board presentations

## Task Reports

The Task menu holds two reports over the same data. The **Task Tabular Report** is a table; the **Gantt Report** is the same table with a timescale beside it.

### Task Tabular Report

- Every Task, Milestone and Gate across the whole hierarchy in one table
- Free text name search, plus picklist filters for Status, PM, Owner, State, Portfolio (L1) and Project (L2)
- **L3 / L4 / L5 tick boxes** decide how deep the table goes. L1 Portfolio and L2 Project rows are always shown; the three lower levels are opt-out
- Column-set picker — Default, Schedule Standard, Schedule Advanced, Notes, Variance, Risks & Issues, All Columns
- **Inline editing** — click a cell and type; picklist cells open a picker and save on the tap (see *Direct Editing* below)
- Two override tick boxes replace the retired *Items Overdue* and *Milestone Horizon* reports (see below)

### Overdue and Milestone Horizon (the two override tick boxes)

These sit above the table on the Task Tabular Report, and on the header of the **Gantt Schedule View** (Main Menu). They are *overrides*: while one is ticked it replaces the L3/L4/L5 level filtering with its own result set. They are mutually exclusive — ticking one clears the other — and touching any level tick box clears both and returns you to the normal view.

| Tick box | What it shows |
|---|---|
| **Overdue** | Tasks **and** Milestones that are late — planned start *or* planned finish is in the past — **and** are still missing an actual start or an actual finish. A bar that is genuinely finished on time never appears |

| Tick box | What it shows |
|---|---|
| **Milestone Horizon** | Milestones. On the Task Tabular Report this is *every* Milestone. On the Gantt Schedule View it is limited to a recent horizon — nothing whose start or finish is more than **14 days in the past** — so the list stays focused on what is coming up or has only just passed |

Ticking **Overdue** on the Gantt Schedule View also switches the columns to the variance set, because the question you are about to ask is "by how much?". Un-ticking it puts the default columns back.

While either override is on, rows are banded by real hierarchy — Portfolio, Project and, where one genuinely exists, Sub-Project — so a long overdue list still reads as "whose is this?". A Task or Milestone with no Sub-Project sits directly under its Project band, and empty levels produce no placeholder band.

### Gantt Report

A two-pane report: the filterable, editable table on the left, and the bars on a timescale on the right. Both panes always render the same filtered set, so what you see in the table is what you see on the timescale.

- **Filter panel** (collapsible): name search, Reset Filters, and picklists for Status, PM, Owner, State, Portfolio (L1) and Project (L2)
- **L3 / L4 / L5 tick boxes** at the foot of the panel — same rule as elsewhere, L1 and L2 always show
- **Show In** picklist along the top — narrows to rows tagged for one report (see *Tagging Rows Into Reports* below). It combines with everything else
- **Columns** picker and **row spacing** picker along the top
- **Grouping By** picklists — see the next section
- Inline editing throughout, including **Predecessor** on Task and Project rows
- L2 Project rows are emphasised: darker green band, larger bold name, and the project name drawn on the timescale itself
- Sort by clicking any column header; while grouping is on, the clicked column sorts the tasks *inside* each band rather than the whole list

> The Overdue and Milestone Horizon tick boxes are deliberately **not** on the Gantt Report — they live on the Task Tabular Report and the Gantt Schedule View. The Gantt Report's job is the grouped structural view.

### Grouping the Gantt Report

Set one or both **Grouping By** picklists and the Gantt Report stops being a flat hierarchy and reorganises the tasks under bands. The structure is:

```
L1 Portfolio                (real row)
  L2 Project                (real row)   ← grouping starts under L2
    ▸ Sub-Project           (light orange band, showing the Sub-Project name)
        ▸ Owner: Jane       (group band)
            task, task…
        ▸ Owner: Sam        (group band)
```

```
            task…
        ▸ Owner: Not Tagged (muted band)
            task…
    (if the project has no Sub-Projects, the group bands sit directly under L2)
```

Points worth knowing:

- **The whole data set is grouped, not one project.** Every Portfolio, and every Project under it, is drawn with its own bands. Filter to a single Project on the L2 picklist if you want to look at just one
- **Two levels of grouping.** Set the first picklist to group, set the second to sub-divide inside each of those bands. Leave either on *No grouping* to use fewer levels
- **Nothing is ever hidden.** Tasks with no value for the grouping field are collected under a **Not Tagged** band rather than dropped. Tasks whose parent was removed by a filter are still shown at the end
- **Bands are labels, not bars.** A band has no dates, so the right-hand pane draws a band across the row instead of a bar
- **Allocations (L5) are not grouped** — grouping works on Tasks, Milestones and Gates
- Inside a band, tasks are ordered by planned start until you click a column header

The dimensions on offer are Sched Status, Owner, WBS, Priority, Phase, Category, Department, Product, Weighting and Risk/Issue/CR. The list is a single configurable set — adding a dimension to it makes it appear in **both** grouping picklists at once, so the report can be extended without redesigning the panel.

> **Blank group bands?** Grouping fields are usually tagged at Project level and left empty on the tasks below, which would put everything into *Not Tagged*. **Recalculate All** fixes this — see *Grouping Fields Are Filled Down the Hierarchy* below.

### Resource Reports

#### Resource Usage

- Comprehensive resource demand visualization
- Multiple rollup options available
- Stacked bar charts showing allocation over time
- 32-week visibility window
- Identify over/under allocation patterns
- Forecast hiring needs
- Balance workloads across teams

#### Resource Usage Stacked Charts By:

- **Resource Name**: Individual allocation patterns
- **Primary Role**: Developer, Architect, PM, Tester, etc.
- **Primary Skill**: Technical skills distribution
- **Location/Office**: Geographic resource distribution
- **Department**: Organizational unit allocation
- **Project**: Project-based resource demand

- **Initials**: Condensed view for large teams

### Resource Usage Detail Table

- Tabular view with 32-week visibility
- Weekly hours breakdown
- Resource metadata (location, role, skill, department)
- Sortable and exportable
- Supports capacity planning analysis

### Shared Resource Pool

- Complete resource pool management view
- All resources in the tbResources store
- Shows all resources added by Administrator
- Typically managed via Spreadsheet integration
- Includes:
  - Skills, roles, and competencies
  - Department, location, organizational structure
  - Pay rates, cost codes, financial attributes
  - Availability calendars and capacity
  - Manager, team leader, reporting relationships
- Click any resource to open full resource form for updates
- Skills gap analysis support
- Organization chart maintenance

### Which Generic resources count as supply

Generic resources are role placeholders — "Senior Developer", "Tester", "Project Manager" — and not all of them represent capacity you can plan work against. The rule the application uses everywhere is simple:

> A Generic resource counts as supply only when its **Quantity is greater than zero**.

That one number is the switch, and it controls three things at once:

| Where | What Quantity > 0 does |
|---|---|
| **Supply and Demand grids** | Only these Generic roles form the supply target. Capacity is Quantity × calendar hours × working days |
| **AI Resource Plan** | Only these roles are offered to the AI, so only these can be added as Allocations |
| **Resource charts and rollups** | Only these contribute to organisational capacity totals |

**This makes the resource pool manager the gatekeeper.** Roles that exist for reporting or org structure rather than delivery — governance boards, steering committees, management overhead — should be set to **Quantity 0**. They stay in the pool, stay reportable, and stop turning up in plans and capacity totals.

The practical consequence: if an AI-generated resource plan keeps proposing management roles you did not want, do not fight the prompt — set those Generic roles to Quantity 0 in the Shared Resource Pool and generate again. Equally, a delivery role sitting at Quantity 0 is invisible to planning, which is the usual reason a role you expected never appears.

See the *How to Use Ask AI* guide for the resource plan itself, and the *Supply and Demand Grids User Guide* for capacity analysis.

## 3. Tagging Rows Into Reports — the Show In Field

Several report sections are not built from a query at all. They show **only the rows you have tagged for them**, using the **Show In** field on the metadata form (picklist: *Show In Reports*). This is deliberate: an executive-facing section should show the five risks that matter, not all forty.

A row can carry more than one Show In value, so one Milestone can appear in a Project Charter and on a portfolio pack at the same time.

### Which tag feeds which section

| Report and section | Shows | Tag its Show In field with |
|---|---|---|
| **Project Charter → 5. High-Level Risks** | Risks belonging to that project | `Key Risks` |
| **Project Charter → 6. Summary Milestone Schedule** | Tasks and Milestones | `Key Deliverables` |
| **Project Charter → Resource Requirements** | Allocations | `Project Charter` |
| **Portfolio Status and Balancing → Notable Risks by Project** | Risks | `Key Risks` |
| **Portfolio Status and Balancing → Key Deliverables** | Tasks and Milestones | `Key Deliverables` |

The Charter's risk and deliverable sections use the **same two tags** as the Portfolio Status and Balancing Report. Tag a risk `Key Risks` once and it appears in both — you do not tag the same row twice for two reports. Only the Charter's **Resource Requirements** section still uses the `Project Charter` tag, because allocations are charter-specific.

> Hover the heading of any of these sections in the app and the tool-tip tells you which tag it reads.

### If a section is empty

An empty section is almost always an untagged one, and each says so in place of its content — for example *"No Key Risks for this project. Tag a Risk's Show In field with 'Key Risks' to display it here."* To fix it:

1. Open the Risk, Task, Milestone or Allocation

2. Click its **Show In** field
3. Pick the value from the list

The change saves on the tap, and the report shows it on the next open.

### Bulk tagging by spreadsheet

Tagging a whole portfolio one row at a time is slow. Export to the spreadsheet, fill the **Show In** column down, and sync back. Make sure your Tags sheet carries these three values in the **Show In Reports** group, or the picklist will not offer them:

- `Project Charter`
- `Key Deliverables`
- `Key Risks`

See the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide* for adding picklist values, and the *Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide* for the spreadsheet round trip.

## 4. Special Reports

### Risk, Issue & Change Management Reports

#### Risks and Issues Report (Card View)

**Risk Cards** (Blue):

- Probability × Impact scoring matrix
- Automated risk score calculation
- Mitigation status and plans
- Escalation tracking
- Assign owners and track mitigation activities

**Issue Cards** (Red):

- Priority and severity classification
- Assignment and ownership
- Resolution tracking
- Impact assessment

**Change Request Cards** (Gradient Blue):

- Requestor and department
- Impact assessment (cost, hours, schedule)
- Benefits and justification
- Options analysis
- Version tracking

All cards support:

- Rich text editor for detailed descriptions
- Expandable sections for plans and strategies
- Filter by status, priority, owner

- Search across all text fields
- Export for audit trails

#### Risks and Issues Report (Tabular View)

- Same data as card view in table format
- Sortable columns
- Multi-row selection
- Bulk export capabilities

### Timeline Visualizations

#### Horizontal Timeline Report

- Interactive timeline with draggable event cards
- Events positioned along horizontal date axis
- Persistent positioning (saved in browser)
- Filter and search by name, type, status
- Connector lines from timeline to event details
- Reset positions for fresh layouts

#### Vertical Timeline Report

- Similar to horizontal but oriented vertically
- Project chronologies and milestone sequences flow downward
- Milestone planning visualization
- Dependency relationships

### Configuration Reports (Other menu)

Five reports that show the tables the application is configured from, rather than your project data. They are covered fully in the *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide*; in outline:

#### Picklist Values

- Every value behind every picklist — 97 lists in the shipped data
- Filter to one picklist, then open a value on its form to edit it
- Add and delete values; locked values carry a padlock and cannot be renamed
- A picklist can never be emptied — the last value is renamed rather than deleted

#### Fields Values

- The fields placed on the dynamic FOCD forms, one row per field per form
- Add a field to a form, remove one, change its label, type and picklist
- Label, Top, Left and Width are edited directly in the grid — the only configuration columns that are

#### Schema Values

- The master field list every other configuration table joins to
- Read and update only — rows cannot be added or deleted, because a row here corresponds to a database index and a spreadsheet column

### CoreReport Values

- The Core Form layout — which field sits in which section, at which level
- Read and update only

### Config Integrity

- Checks the four configuration tables against each other and reports what does not resolve: orphaned field names, duplicate placements, picklists that are empty or referenced by nothing
- It never blocks and never repairs — it measures
- **Run it after every spreadsheet import.** Broken configuration references do not throw errors; a picker whose list has gone simply opens empty

---

## 5. Common Report Features

All reports in the system share these capabilities:

### Search & Filter

- Free text search across names and descriptions
- Filter by hierarchy level (L1-L5)
- Filter by type (Portfolio, Project, Sub-Project, Task, Milestone, Allocation)
- Filter by status (Active, On Hold, Cancelled, Complete)
- Filter by priority (High, Medium, Low)
- Filter by owner (Resource names)
- Multiple filters can be combined

### Data Export

- **Excel**: Full data export with formatting
- **CSV**: Raw data for external analysis
- **Print**: Print-ready layouts with proper page breaks
- **Copy**: Copy to clipboard for quick sharing

### Visual Indicators

- **Color Coding**: By type, status, priority, health
- **Health Indicators**: Red/Yellow/Green status
- **Icons**: Visual markers for risks, issues, milestones
- **Progress Bars**: Completion percentage visualization

### Direct Editing

Not every grid is editable, and the difference is deliberate.

| Report | Editing |
|---|---|
| Schedule and metadata reports — General Tabular View, Task Tabular, Gantt Report, Detail Cards | **inline** — click a cell and type; picklist cells open a picker |
| Shared Resource Pool | inline, plus a full edit form |
| Picklist Values, Fields Values, Schema Values, CoreReport Values | **read-only in the grid**; the grid finds the row, the form edits it |

The configuration reports work that way because every one of their columns carries a rule — a name that must exist elsewhere, a list that must not be emptied — and enforcing those rules in two places would let the two drift apart. The exception is the four layout columns on Fields Values, which are plain numbers and edit in the grid.

Edits save as you go. There is no separate Save step, and no need to switch screens.

### Editing Predecessors in a Grid

**Predecessor** is editable in the grids, but not on every row, and the list you are offered depends on what you clicked:

| Row type | Predecessor cell |
|---|---|
| **Task** | Editable. The list holds the other **Tasks in the same project** — a task cannot depend on work in a different project |
| **Project** | Editable. The list holds **all Projects**, with no hierarchy restriction |
| Portfolio, Sub-Project, Milestone, Gate, Allocation | Read-only, like the Type column |

The picker shows each candidate's **ID and name**, with long names trimmed to fit — hover a row to read the full name. Picking a row stores the **ID** as the predecessor while showing you the name, so you never have to look an ID up.

The current row is always left out of its own list, so a bar can never be made its own predecessor.

> Unlike the other picklists, this one is **live**: it is built from your actual bars at the moment you click, not from a stored list of values. Create a task and it is immediately available as a predecessor.

### Grouping Fields Are Filled Down the Hierarchy

Most people tag a project once — one Department, one Product, one PM — and leave the tasks below it blank. Grouping and filtering would then be nearly useless: every task would land in the *Not Tagged* band.

**Recalculate All** solves this. As part of the recalculation, empty grouping fields inherit the value of their **nearest tagged ancestor**, all the way down the hierarchy: Portfolio → Project → Sub-Project → Task → Allocation. Tag a project as *Finance* and every task beneath it groups and filters as *Finance* without you touching one of them.

The fields filled down are:

| Field | Set at |
|---|---|
| **Owner** | any level |
| **Department** | any level |
| **Product** | any level |
| **Project Number** | any level |
| **Project Manager** | any level |

Three rules make this safe to run as often as you like:

1. **A value you typed is never overwritten.** Only empty fields are filled. A task tagged to a different department than its project keeps its own value
2. **Blank means blank in every form** — an empty cell, spaces, or a stray "null" left behind by a spreadsheet import are all treated as empty and get filled
3. **Gaps in the hierarchy are skipped.** A task sitting directly under a project with no sub-project between them inherits from that project

Run it from **Right click on Canvas > Recalculate All**, or any *Recalculate All* button, including the one on the Reports page. Do it after a spreadsheet import and before you rely on grouped or filtered output.

> Not every field that you can group by is filled down. A field is filled down only where inheriting the parent's value is genuinely meaningful — Status and Priority, for instance, belong to the individual task, so they are left alone and blanks show as *Not Tagged*.

### Report Persistence

- Last viewed report is remembered
- Filter settings saved per report
- Return to your exact view next session

## 6. Where Report Data Comes From

Reports read the browser database. Two stores do most of the work:

- `tbMdJoined` — the cached join of bars and metadata that nearly every tabular and card report reads. It is rebuilt by **Recalculate All**, which is why a report showing stale numbers is usually a report that needs a recalculation, not a bug.
- `tbResCalcs2` — the weekly resource demand figures behind the resource charts and grids. Rebuilt separately from Recalculate All.

Baseline variance reads `tbBaseline`, and the resource reports read `tbResources`. The stores themselves are documented in the *Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide*.

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## 7. Publishing to the Cloud Dashboard

**One-Click Publishing**: All reports can be published to the Timebars Cloud Dashboard:

- No configuration required
- Customize graph types and filter data sets
- Share with stakeholders via secure links
- Access from any device with internet connection
- Real-time updates when you publish new data

Learn more in the Cloud Publishing Guide.

## 8. Tips

1. **Recalculate before grouping.** Run Recalculate All after any spreadsheet import, so grouping fields are filled down before you group or filter on them
2. **Tag once, report twice.** `Key Risks` and `Key Deliverables` feed both the Project Charter and the Portfolio Status and Balancing Report — tag a row once and it appears in both
3. **Keep Generic quantities honest.** Quantity 0 on management-only roles keeps them out of resource plans and capacity totals
4. **Check the level tick boxes first** when a report looks empty. L4 off means no tasks
5. **Run Config Integrity after every import**, not only when something looks wrong

## 9. Troubleshooting

**Report is Empty or Shows No Data:**

- Check that you have data loaded in the application
- Verify filters are not excluding all results
- Click "Reset Filters" to clear all filter settings
- Check the **L3 / L4 / L5** tick boxes — if L4 is off, no tasks are shown
- Check the **Show In** picklist is not narrowed to a tag nothing carries

**A Report Section Says "No Key Risks" / "No Key Deliverables":**

- The section is tag-driven, not a query — nothing is tagged for it yet
- Open the row, click its **Show In** field, and pick the value the message names. See *Tagging Rows Into Reports* above

**Everything Lands in the "Not Tagged" Band:**

- The grouping field is set on the project but empty on the tasks below
- Run **Recalculate All** to fill grouping fields down the hierarchy, then re-open the report. See *Grouping Fields Are Filled Down the Hierarchy*

**The Overdue / Milestone Horizon Tick Box Keeps Switching Off:**

- That is by design. They are overrides — ticking one clears the other, and touching any L3/L4/L5 tick box clears both and returns the normal view

**A Generic Role Never Appears in a Resource Plan or Supply Grid:**

- Its **Quantity** is 0. Only Generic resources with Quantity greater than zero count as supply — see *Which Generic resources count as supply* above

**A cell will not accept an edit:**

- Not every column is editable, and the difference is deliberate — see *Direct Editing*
- On the configuration reports the grid is read-only by design; the form does the editing
- System fields such as Type and Hierarchy Order are read-only everywhere

---

# Part B — Configuring the Product Through the Editable Reports

Four reports on **Report Menu → Other** are not reports about your projects at all: they are where the product itself is configured — what the dropdowns say, which fields sit on which form, and how the Core Form is laid out. They are called the **Editable Reports**, and a fifth report checks that they still agree with each other.

Everything in this part used to live in a separate Configurable Data guide. It is here because the reports *are* the configuration interface — there is nothing to describe separately from them.

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## 10. The Two Rules That Decide Everything

Almost every question in this guide — can I change this? where do I change it? — is answered by two rules.

### Rule 1: the app edits what is purely data; it does not edit what is also code

An internal field name such as `tbMDStatus` is not just a label. The same string is a column heading in the workbook, an index in the browser database, and a literal in the application source. The app cannot rewrite the source, so it will not let you rewrite the name.

That single idea decides every "can I edit this?" in the product:

| | **Where it changes** |
|---|---|
| The **values** in a picklist | in the app, or the spreadsheet |
| Which **picklist** a field opens | in the app, or the spreadsheet |
| A field's **label**, position, width | in the app, or the spreadsheet |
| Which **fields** sit on a form | in the app, or the spreadsheet |
| An **internal field name** | the spreadsheet, alongside a code change |
| A **primary key** | never |

### Rule 2: the grid finds the row, the form edits it

On all four Editable Reports the **grid is read-only**. You filter and sort to find the row you want, then open it on its **form** to change it.

There is one deliberate exception: four layout columns on Fields Values — **Label, Top, Left, Width** — stay editable in the grid, because positioning a field means comparing its numbers against its neighbours', and that is exactly what a grid is good at.

A companion rule follows from Rule 1: **names that reach code are picked from a list, never typed.** Every cross-table reference is a picklist sourced from the table that owns the name. The one place free typing is allowed is a **new picklist name** on the Picklist Values form — because a new picklist has to start somewhere.

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## 11. Where Configuration Lives

### The four Editable Reports, and the validator

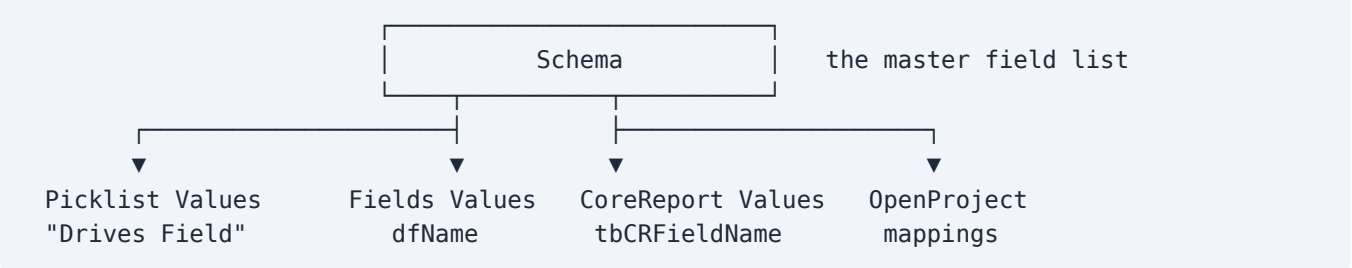
All five are on **Report Menu → Other**. The first four are the **Editable Reports** — the places you change how the product is configured. The fifth checks their work.

| Report | What a row is | You can |
|---|---|---|
| **Picklist Values** | one value inside one picklist | edit, add, delete |
| **Fields Values** | one field placed on one FOCD form | edit, add, delete |
| **Schema Values** | one field that exists in the system | edit only |
| **CoreReport Values** | one field placed on one Core Form section | edit only |
| **Config Integrity** | *(a validation report)* | run it |

Schema Values and CoreReport Values have **no Add and no Delete**. A Schema row corresponds to a database index and a spreadsheet column, neither of which the app can create; a CoreReport row places a field that must already exist.

### Schema is the spine

The four configuration tables are not independent lists. **Schema is the master field list, and everything else names a field in it.**




A name that does not resolve does not throw an error. A write addressed to a row that is not there is a silent no-op, and a picker whose picklist has gone simply opens with no rows in it. Nothing turns red. That is why the fifth report exists.

### Config Integrity — run it after every spreadsheet import

An import replaces whole tables. Rename a field on one sheet and not another, delete a row three tables still point at, empty a picklist — none of it announces itself. **Config Integrity** measures it: it checks that every field name resolves, that placements are unique, that `dfType` and `dfPicklist` agree, that no picklist is down to its last value or referenced by nothing.

It never blocks and never repairs. Bad data must not stop the tool opening, and a fix belongs where the value is owned — which is usually the spreadsheet.

**Make it a step in your import routine**, immediately after the import.

### Every write is stamped and trimmed

Two housekeeping behaviours worth knowing:

- Every change made in the app stamps that store's **Last Modified** column with the date, in `DD-MMM-YYYY`.
- Values are **trimmed on write**, and every comparison trims both sides. A trailing space typed into a name cannot create an invisible mismatch.

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## 12. Picklists and Tagging

### The two kinds of picklist

This is the single most important thing in this section, and the most common source of wasted effort.

**1. A tag-backed picklist.** The values are rows in the Tags table sharing one picklist name. You maintain them — add, edit, remove, reorder. Most picklists in the product are this kind.

**2. A live people-picker.** The field names a *person*, so its list is not stored anywhere — it is read live from the **Resource Pool** (`Human` rows in Resources) every time the picker opens. There are no tag values to maintain, and adding some would achieve nothing.

> **If a field names a person, maintain the Resource Pool, not the Tags table.**

The fifteen people-picker fields:

| Field | Shown as |
|---|---|
| `tbOwner` | Owner |
| `tbMDPM` | Project Manager |
| `tbMDExSponsor` | Executive Sponsor |
| `tbMDBusinessAdvisor` | Business Advisor |
| `tbMDDeliveryManager` | Delivery Manager |
| `tbMDResponsibility` | Responsible Person |

| Field | Shown as |
|---|---|
| `tbMDBusinessOwner` | Business Owner |
| `tbMDPrimaryContact` | Primary Contact |
| `tbMDContact` | CR Requestor |
| `tbMDOrgManager` | Org Manager |
| `tbMDStageApprover` | Stage Approver |
| `tbMDEscalationOwner` | Escalation Owner |
| `tbMDCharterApprovedBy` | Charter Approved By |
| `tbMDProductOwner` | Product Owner |
| `tbMDScrumMaster` | Scrum Master |

**This list is growing.** Fields move from tag-backed lists to the live pool over time, because a person's name kept in two places drifts. `tbMDResponsibleTeam` is deliberately *not* here — it names a team, and stays a tag-backed picklist.

### Changing what a picklist offers

**Report Menu → Other → Picklist Values.**

1. Filter the **Picklist** column to the list you want.
2. Click the **edit icon** on a row to open it on the form. Change the name, short name, sort order, purpose or owner. It saves as you go — there is no separate Save step.
3. **Add** puts a new value into whichever picklist is currently filtered — so filter first; the button asks you to if you have not. Then open the new row on the form to name it.
4. **Delete** removes the value from the list. Any record already holding that value keeps it; the value simply stops being offered from now on.

Remember Rule 2: the grid itself is read-only here. It is how you *find* the value; the form is where you change it.

The same values live on the **Tags** worksheet, and a spreadsheet import replaces them wholesale. Both routes are valid. Use the app for a handful of values, the workbook for a wholesale revision.

### Giving a field a picklist

A field opens a picklist because a Tags row points at it — not because of anything in the code.

> Set a value's **Drives Field** to the field you want, and that value's **Picklist** becomes that field's list.

Two constraints:

- **A picklist name must not contain a hyphen.** Forms encode the name as the last segment of a hyphen-separated key, so a hyphen splits it in the wrong place and the

picker opens empty. This has bitten before: `Part-time Full-time` had to become `Parttime Fulltime`.
- **A picklist cannot be empty.** See below.

### The never-empty rule

A picklist exists only as the set of rows carrying its name. Delete the last one and the picklist itself is gone — leaving a field whose picker opens with nothing in it and no way to put anything back.

So the app refuses. Deleting the **last** value in a picklist renames it to **Not Assessed** instead. The picklist survives with one neutral value in it, and the value you wanted rid of stops being offered. If you would rather remove it outright, add a replacement first.

### Locked values and the padlock

Some values are read by the application itself. A schedule status of `Late` is not just a word on a bar — it selects a colour. A budget band of `301K to 1000K` is what a portfolio score is calculated from. Rename one and nothing warns you: the comparison simply stops matching and the result quietly becomes wrong.

Those values carry a **padlock** in Picklist Values. On a locked row:

| | |
|---|---|
| **Locked** | the value's name, and its picklist name |
| **Still yours** | sort order, short name, purpose, owner |
| **Delete icon** | replaced by the padlock |

The picklist name is locked as well as the value, because renaming a picklist detaches every value in it from its field — that breaks a whole list, not one entry.

**You may still add your own values to any locked picklist.** Only the specific values the code names are fixed. Section 4 lists them, and they are marked in bold in the A–Z reference.

---

## 13. Dynamic Forms (FOCD)

FOCD — Forms on Cached Data — lets you add and remove fields on the product's built-in forms without writing code. The number of forms is fixed; what goes on them is yours.

### The seven forms

| Form name | The form it draws |
|---|---|
| `PF1` | L1 Portfolio flyout |
| `PJ1` | L2 Project flyout |
| `SPJ1` | L3 Sub-Project flyout |
| `TASK1` | L4 Task flyout |
| `ALLOC1` | L5 Allocation flyout |

| Form name | The form it draws |
|---|---|
| `dfRisk` | Risk form |
| `dfIssue` | Issue form |

### What a Fields row holds

**Report Menu → Other → Fields Values.** One row is one field on one form.

| Column | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Field** | the field this row places — **picked from Schema**, never typed |
| **Form** | which of the seven forms it appears on |
| **Type** | how it renders — see below |
| **Label** | the caption shown to the user on **this form**; free text |
| **Picklist** | which list the field opens, when Type is `WithPicklist` |
| **Tooltip** | the hover text on the field |
| **Top / Left / Width** | position and size, in pixels |
| **Show** | whether it is drawn at all |
| **Other 1** | which table the value is saved to — `tbTimebars` or `tbMetaData` |
| **Other 2** | `disabled` makes the field read-only on the form; blank leaves it editable |

> **Other 1 and Other 2 are load-bearing despite their names.** Other 1 decides where the field's value is stored and Other 2 whether the user can type into it. Other 3 and Other 5 are unused and are left blank on a new row.

The five field types:

| Type | Renders as |
|---|---|
| `NoPicklist` | a plain input |
| `WithPicklist` | an input that opens a picklist |
| `TextArea` | a multi-line box |
| `Editor` | a rich text editor |
| `Band` | a section heading bar, not a field |

### The label is deliberately per-form

A field's **official label** lives once, in Schema, and is what the field is called everywhere by default. The **Label on a Fields row overrides it for that one form** — and that is not an inconsistency to be tidied away, it is the point.

The person configuring a form decides what the field should be called *in that context*, in whatever language the team using the form actually speaks. The same underlying field can read differently on each form it appears on:

| Form | Field | Official label (Schema) | Label on this form |
|---|---|---|---|
| ALLOC1 | `tbName` | Name | **Allocation Name** |
| ALLOC1 | `tbPercentTimeOn` | Percent Time Allocated | **% Allocated** |
| ALLOC1 | `tbCalendar` | Calendar | **Availability/Calendar** |
| dfIssue | `tbStart` | Start | **Created On** |
| dfIssue | `tbMDHealth` | Schedule Status | **Timebar Health** |

Roughly forty of the shipped Fields rows carry a label that differs from the official one for exactly this reason. Leave it blank and the official label is used; fill it in whenever the form's context calls for different wording. It is a decision for the administrator and the users of that form to make together, and nothing else in the product is affected by it.

> **The Core Form works the other way.** Its captions are *derived* from the official Schema label and cannot be overridden per placement — see The Core Form. The per-form override is a FOCD feature only.

> `WithPicklist` **is one word.** The old guidance said "With Picklist" with a space; a field configured that way does not open a picklist. You no longer have to remember this — the type is picked from a list.

### Adding, changing and removing fields

- **Add** is scoped to the form you are filtered to, because "which form" cannot be guessed. The new row lands below everything already on that form and inherits its neighbours' left, width and target store. **Name is left empty** — an invented field name is exactly the broken reference these rules exist to prevent — and the form opens straight onto it for you to pick one.
- **Type and Picklist move together.** Choosing a picklist sets the type to `WithPicklist`; choosing any other type clears the picklist. They cannot disagree.
- **Delete** warns you in the two cases whose consequence is not visible in the row: deleting a **Band** row removes the form's heading, and deleting the **last** row leaves the form empty.

### Positioning fields

Two ways, and they suit different jobs.

**In the grid** — Label, Coord Top, Coord Left and Width are inline-editable, the only four columns on any configuration report that are. Use this when laying out a whole form, where the point is comparing one field's numbers against its neighbours'.

**On the form itself** — the blue icons at the top of a FOCD form move fields directly. The second icon moves one field at a time, the third moves several at once; dotted outlines show what is movable. Drag, then click the blue square to save. Use this for fine-tuning.

### Rich text

Rich text fields use **Tiptap**. (Earlier documentation referred to Quill, which was replaced.) Whether a field is a rich text editor is set by its type here, and for the Core Form by a list in the application — see The Core Form.

---

## 14. The Core Form

The Core Form is the large collapsible form that shows a bar's full metadata, grouped under business headings — Essential Facts, Progress & Health, Charter, Investment Alignment and so on. It is the form a PM spends most time in.

> **It is configured from a different table than the FOCD forms.** FOCD forms are built from the **Fields** table (section 5); the Core Form is built from the **CoreReport** table. They share nothing but the Schema field list underneath them, so a change to one never affects the other.

| | FOCD forms | The Core Form |
|---|---|---|
| Configured from | **tbFields** — *Fields Values* report | **tbCoreReport** — *CoreReport Values* report |
| A row is | one field on one of the seven FOCD forms | one field in one Core Form section |
| Add and delete rows in the app | **yes** | **no** — spreadsheet only |
| Field caption | free text, **per form** (section 5) | **derived** from the field's Schema label |
| Positioning | pixel coordinates you set | column widths inside a four-column section |
| Sections | one Band row per heading | a fixed set of named sections |

Everything below is about the Core Form and the CoreReport table.

There are two ways to change the Core Form: **in the application**, one row at a time, and **in the spreadsheet**, in bulk. They edit exactly the same data — the CoreReport table — so use whichever suits the job.

### In the application

**Report Menu > Other > CoreReport Values.** One row is one field placed on one section of the form. Filter to the section or field you want, then click the edit icon to open the row on its form.

| To change | Edit |
|---|---|
| Which section a field is in | **Section Name** — pick from the list of sections the form actually draws |
| Order within a section | **ID** — fields are drawn in ascending ID within their section |
| Field width | **Columns** — 1, 2 or 3 |

| To change | Edit |
|---|---|
| Shown at a level | the five level flags — Portfolio through Allocation |

Two things you will notice are read-only, and hovering them explains why:

- **Label** is **derived**. It always holds the field's own label from the Schema table, and changing it there updates every placement at once. Change a caption in **Schema Values**, not here.
- **Section Key** is written for you when you choose a Section Name. It has to match a section the form actually draws, so it is never typed.

Rows cannot be **added or deleted** in this report — a CoreReport row places a field that must already exist, and adding placements is a spreadsheet job.

> `tbCRForm` is now vestigial. Every row is `v2`; version 1 of the Core Form is dead at runtime.

### In the spreadsheet

Almost everything about how the Core Form looks is held in the **CoreReport sheet**, not in the code, and takes effect the next time you import the sheet and reopen the form. Each row is one field on the form. `tbCRSection` says which section it appears in, so moving a field from Essential Facts to Other Metadata is a matter of changing that one cell — nothing in the code names a field's section. `tbCRID` decides the running order: fields are drawn in ascending `tbCRID` within their section, so to move a field you give it a number that falls where you want it to sit. `tbCRNoOfColumns` is how many columns wide the field is (1 is a normal field, 2 is half a four-column row, 4 is the full row), and it applies to rich text editors exactly as it does to plain fields — an editor set to 2 sits beside its neighbour instead of taking a row of its own. A field behaves the same wherever you put it: width is the field's own, from the sheet, while how many columns a section is divided into belongs to the section, so moving a field into a different section does not drag a column count in with it. Every section is four columns wide, and a width larger than that is capped at the full row, so a stray value in the sheet costs you a wide field rather than a broken one. `tbCRLabel` is the caption shown above the field — but it is **derived from the field's label in Schema** and rewritten whenever that changes, so set the caption there rather than here. `tbCRSectionName` is the heading printed above the section. The five `tbCRPortfolio` … `tbCRAllocation` columns decide, per hierarchy level, whether the field appears at all: `show` means show, anything else means hide. Set `tbCRForm` to `v2` on every row, or the form will not see it. (Every row is `v2` now — v1 is dead at runtime — so this column is vestigial, but a blank still hides the row.)

A few things are not in the sheet, because it has no column for them. Whether a field is a **rich text editor** comes from `RICH_TEXT_FORM_FIELDS` in `scripts/focd/dfmain.js` — that one list also drives how the field renders in the tabular reports and the Gantt grid, so adding a field there changes it everywhere at once. Whether a field is a **date picker** comes from its Type being `Date` on the master field list, and whether it is **read-only** or forced onto a **new row** comes from `scripts/reports/coreFormV2Fields.js`. Which **picklist** a field opens is data of a different kind: add or point a `tbTags` row's `tbTagTbInternalName` at the field and its `tbTagGroup` becomes that field's list, with no code change — except for people-pickers such as Owner or Sponsor,

which always read the live resource pool and are listed in `PEOPLE_PICKER_FIELDS` in `scripts/reports/editableCells.js`. Finally, the Investment Alignment and Benefits & Financial Value sections are hidden outside Costbars regardless of what the sheet says; that rule is `HIDDEN_BY_PRODUCT` in `scripts/reports/coreFormV2.js`, and when it fires it says so in the browser console.

### Where each thing lives

| To change… | Edit | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Which section a field is in | `tbCRSection` | Must match a section id in `CFV2_SECTIONS` |
| Order within a section | `tbCRID` | Ascending; see the warning below |
| Field width | `tbCRNoOfColumns` | 1–5; editors included |
| Field caption | **`tbSchLabel` in Schema** | `tbCRLabel` follows it automatically; it is read-only in the app |
| Section heading | `tbCRSectionName` | Taken from the section's first row that has one |
| Shown at a level | `tbCRPortfolio` … `tbCRAllocation` | `show`, or anything else to hide |
| Which picklist a field opens | `tbTags` row | `tbTagTbInternalName` → `tbTagGroup` |
| Rich text editor on/off | `RICH_TEXT_FORM_FIELDS`, `dfmain.js` | Also changes the grids |
| Date picker | Type `Date` on the master field list | Uses the app's `DD-MMM-YYYY` format |
| Read-only, forced new row | `coreFormV2Fields.js` | Generated file; see its header |
| Columns a section is divided into | `columns` on the section in `CFV2_SECTIONS` | Every section is four across; set this only to break that |
| Sections and their order | `CFV2_SECTIONS`, `coreFormV2Fields.js` | |
| Costbars-only sections | `HIDDEN_BY_PRODUCT`, `coreFormV2.js` | Overrides the sheet |

### Two things that will bite you

**`tbCRID` is unique.** The store enforces it, and an import that leaves two rows sharing a number is rejected part-way through. The safe way to reorder a section is to reuse the numbers that section already has, dealt out in the new order — then nothing outside the section moves and no number can clash with another section.

**A field must be known in two other places or it will look broken rather than missing.** If it has no entry in `CFV2_FIELDS` the form skips it and logs a warning to the console. If it is absent from the join's field list in `scripts/tbdatabaseasync.js` it draws as an empty box that accepts what you type and then shows blank again when you reopen the form — the field saved correctly, but the form cannot read it back. If a field you added to the sheet behaves that way, that list is the first place to look.

## 15. What Is Configurable, by Product

A summary of what can be tailored. All three products share one build, so anything marked as common applies everywhere.

### Common to all three

#### Scheduling and calendar

- Report Date — the "as-of" date every progress calculation is measured against
- Timescale start and finish, weekly vs. monthly view, zoom level
- Working calendar exceptions and holidays (AdminPanel sheet, rows 6–100)

#### Canvas display

- Dark / light theme; bar row spacing; hierarchy level filter (L1–L5)
- Show or hide: completed bars, baseline bars, ghost bars, dependency lines, hierarchy connector lines
- Show or hide Risk, Issue and Change Request bars

#### Metadata and tagging

- The full metadata field set, and the picklist behind any dropdown (section 3)
- Rich-text business case sections
- Custom sort order per item

#### Forms

- Which fields appear on which FOCD form, their labels, tooltips, picklists, position, width and read-only state (section 5)
- The Core Form's sections, field order, widths and per-level visibility (section 6)

#### Status and health

- All automation thresholds, via `apMetadataRules` (section 7)

#### Data

- Full JSON backup and restore; per-store export; baseline snapshots

**Licence** *(display only, not user-editable after install)*

- Licensed organisation, expiry date, bar and project limits

### Agilebars

- Five-lane Kanban — Backlog, Will Do, Doing, Finalizing, Done — with automatic percent-complete mapping per lane
- Card content as text or as a bar chart
- Progress measured against the Report Date or against today ( `apMPO` )
- Fixed-sizing mode, where hours never change when a bar is dragged

- Sprint name per task; multiple boards; burndown chart
- Hierarchy is L2 and L4 only — L1, L3 and L5 are hidden by product

### Timebars

- Full five-level hierarchy, drag-to-schedule with working-day calculations
- Resource pool: role, skill, department, manager, location, team leader
- Work calendar and general availability percentage per resource
- Resources per line, and pixels-per-person display scaling
- Weekly and monthly demand views by name, role, skill, location and department
- Baseline snapshots and overlay

### Costbars

- PPM tabular, card and scorecard views; demand grids
- Prioritisation and scoring configuration
- Investment category, objective, strategy and initiative classification
- ROM estimate, estimation class, size and weighting
- Optional financial scoring: NPV, IRR, payback period, economic value added, benefit-cost ratio
- Risk vs. Size and Complexity assessment

---

## Appendix A — Picklist Reference A–Z

**97 picklists, 608 values.** Every picklist in the product, with the field it drives, its purpose, and its values in sort order.

**Values in bold are locked** - the code compares against that exact text (144 of them). See *Values the Code Depends On* in the *Data Model and Scheduling Engine Guide*.

> This reference is **generated from the live data** by `tools/buildPicklistReference.py`. Run that rather than editing entries here; hand-editing is how the previous version came to list twelve picklists that no longer existed.

Picklists named after a person are absent by design - those fields read the Resource Pool live and have no values to list. See *The two kinds of picklist* in section 12.

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### Approval State - `tbMDState`

*Workflow Life-cycle tag*

Values: **Spawned**, **Awaiting Input**, **Requested Approval**, **Awaiting Approval**, **Approved**, **Awaiting Review**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Benefit Cost Ratio - `tbMDBenefitCostRatio`

*Financial scoring value used at the project level.*

Values: **> 5:1**, **3:1 - 5:1**, **2:1 - 3:1**, **1.5:1 - 2:1**, **1:1 - 1.5:1**, **Not Assessed**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Benefit Owner - `tbMDBenefitOwner`

*Values for the tbMDBenefitOwner field*

Values: HR, Finance, Engineering, Shareholders

### Benefit Type - `tbMDBenefitType`

*Values for the tbMDBenefitType field*

Values: Financial, Cost Avoidance, Non-Financial

### Billing Type - `tbMDBillingType`

*Mainly Used in CR's and Tasks*

Values: Billable, Non Billable, Not Assessed

### Budget Estimate - `tbMDROMEstimate`

*Fixed ranges for sizing a project budget*

Values: **0 to 100K**, **101K to 300K**, **301K to 1000K**, **1001K to 5000K**, **5000K Plus**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Budget Fiscal Year - `tbMDBudgetFiscalYear`

*Values for the tbMDBudgetFiscalYear field*

Values: FY2026, FY2027, FY2028

### Calendar - `tbResResourceCalendar`

*Workday hours, used cor calculating wok on an Allocation*

Values: 4, 7.5, 8, 24

### Closure Reason - `tbMDClosureReason`

*Values for the tbMDClosureReason field*

Values: **Completed**, **Cancelled**, Deferred

### Cost Center - `tbMDCostCenter`

*Values for the tbMDCostCenter field*

Values: CC-1000 Operations, CC-2000 Technology, CC-3000 Corporate

### Cost Code - `tbResCostCode`

*Custom Cost Code Metadata for reporting costs, mainly used at Task or Allocation level*

Values: A26, B44, C99, D11, E11, E112

### Cost Type - `tbCostType`

*Cost Type Metadata to separate costs e.g. Software, Equipment . Mainly used at Task or Allocation level*

Values: Equipment, Hardware, Software

### CR Category - `tbMDCategoryCR`

*Metadata to categorize Change Requests. Used at Task level if Sub-Type is CR*

Values: Field, Engineerng, Equipment, Product, Defect

### Cross Team Collaboration - `tbPASCrossTeamCollaboration`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Single team, 2-3 teams, 4-6 teams, 7-10 teams, Many teams/departments

### Currency - `tbMDCurrencyCode`

*Values for the tbMDCurrencyCode field*

Values: CAD, USD, EUR

### Department - `tbMDDepartment`

*Task or Allocation Level tagging identifying what department is responsible*

Values: Sales and Marketing, Operations, Finance, Procurement, Business Development, Research and Development, Engineering

### Domain Experience - `tbPASDomainExperience`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Extensive experience, Good experience, Some experience, Limited experience, New domain

### Escalation Level - `tbMDEscalationLevel`

*Metadata to support the Excalation process, mainly for Projects but can be used at any level.*

Values: Executives, Directors, **Project Office**, **Not Assessed**

### Estimation Class - `tbMDEstimationClass`

*Project Tagging for the quality of the Estimate*

Values: **SWAG**, **Based on History**, **Resource Driven**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Executive Commitment - `tbMDSeniorLevelCommitment`

*Project Tagging for degree of management commitment.*

Values: **Full**, **Strong**, **Moderate**, **Limited**, **Not Clear**, **Not Assessed**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### External Integrations - `tbPASExternalIntegrations`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: None, 1-2 simple integrations, 3-5 moderate integrations, 5+ complex integrations, Many critical integrations

### ExtSystemResID - `tbResExtSystemResID`

*Use to tie into or integrate other systems in the organization*

Values: 456M23, 456M24

### Funding Source - `tbMDFundingSource`

*Values for the tbMDFundingSource field*

Values: Capex, Opex, Client Funded

### Gate - `tbMDGate`

*Project Level tagging identifying a project gating process*

Values: 1 Approved to Design, 2 Approved to Develop, 3 Approved to Implement, Not Applicable

### Health Cost - `tbMDHealthCost`

*Core Health Indicators mainly used at Portfolio and Project and Sub-Project/Work Pckage Level*

Values: Green, Yellow, **Not Assessed**, Red

### Health Hours - `tbMDHealthHours`

*Core Health Indicators mainly used at Portfolio and Project and Sub-Project/Work Pckage Level*

Values: Green, Yellow, **Not Assessed**, Red

### Health Issues - `tbMDHealthIssues`

*Core Health Indicators mainly used at Portfolio and Project and Sub-Project/Work Pckage Level*

Values: Green, Yellow, **Not Assessed**, Red

### Health Overall - `tbMDHealthOverall`

*Core Health Indicators mainly used at Portfolio and Project and Sub-Project/Work Pckage Level*

Values: Green, Yellow, **Not Assessed**, Red

### Health Risk - `tbMDHealthRisk`

*Core Health Indicators mainly used at Portfolio and Project and Sub-Project/Work Pckage Level*

Values: Green, Yellow, **Not Assessed**, Red

### Health Schedule - `tbMDHealthSchedule`

*Core Health Indicators mainly used at Portfolio and Project and Sub-Project/Work Pckage Level*

Values: Green, Yellow, **Not Assessed**, Red

### Health Scope - `tbMDHealthScope`

*Core Health Indicators mainly used at Portfolio and Project and Sub-Project/Work Pckage Level*

Values: Green, Yellow, **Not Assessed**, Red

### Internal Rate of Return - `tbMDInternalRateOfReturn`

*Tagging financial values at project level.*

Values: **> 50%**, **25% - 50%**, **15% - 25%**, **5% - 15%**, **< 5%**, **Not Assessed**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Investment Category - `tbMDInvestmentCategory`

*Project Portfolio Balancing â€“ Product/System Focus*

Values: **Not Assessed**, Business Systems, Our Core Products, Productivity Tools, **Innovation**, Digital Transformation, Infrastructure and Security, Data and Analytics

### Investment Initiative - `tbMDInvestmentInitiative`

*Project Portfolio Balancing â€“ Capability Building*

Values: **Not Assessed**, Strengthen Cybersecurity Infrastructure, Build AI/ML Capabilities, Faster response to new business opportunities, Improve employee skills, Improve product reliability, Improve productivity with Agile Teams, Source Cloud services for our Core products, Support modern digital workplace

### Investment Objective - `tbMDInvestmentObjective`

*Project Portfolio Balancing â€“ Business Impact*

Values: **Not Assessed**, **Grow the Business**, **Run the Business**, Modernize the Business, **Transform the Business**

### Investment Strategy - `tbMDInvestmentStrategy`

*Project Portfolio Balancing â€“ Specific Business Goals*

Values: **Not Assessed**, Attract and retain the best people, Improve our core products, Ensure compliance, Accelerate Time-to-Market, Improve customer service, Build Recurring Revenue Streams, Increase share of market, Reduce waste, Drive Contract Renewals, Server more customers

### Issue Category - `tbMDIssueCategory`

*Metadata to categorize Issues. Used at Task level if Sub-Type is Issue*

Values: Product, Procurement, Construction, **Technical**, Schedule

### Labour Type - `tbResLabourType`

*Type of Resource Generic, Human or other*

Values: **Generic**, **Human**, Other

### Location - `tbResLocation`

*Where is resource located*

Values: Edmonton, Halifax, Ottawa

### Manager - `tbResManager`

*The Resources Manager*

Values: George Bush, John Cougar, Sally Res, Rich Delment, Mitsy Meta, Manny Fact, Marg Ting, Ron Hay, Ron Scope, Al League, Sally Sail, Joe Purch

### Market Timing - `tbPASMarketTiming`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Perfect timing, Good timing, Acceptable timing, Challenging timing, Poor timing

### Mitigation Status - `tbMDMitigationStatus`

*Identify the status if onging mitigation for a Risk*

Values: Identified, Assessed, Mitigation Planned, **In Progress**, Mitigated, Under Review, Accepted, Transferred, **Escalated**, Closed, Deferred

### Net Present Value - `tbMDNetPresentValue`

*Tagging financial values at project level.*

Values: **> 5*M**, **1M - 5*M**, **250K - 1*M**, **50K - $250K**, **< $50K**, **Not Assessed**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Parttime Fulltime - `tbResPartTimeFullTime`

*Is the Resource Full time employee or part time*

Values: **Full Time**, **Part Time**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Payback Period - `tbMDPaybackPeriod`

*Set financial values at the Project Level*

Values: **< 1 year**, **1 - 2 years**, **2 - 3 years**, **3 - 5 years**, **> 5 years**, **Not Assessed**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Percent Available - `tbResPercentGeneralAvailability`

*Default Percent Available for the allocation.*

Values: 10, 25, 50, 75, 100

### PercentTimeAllocated - `tbPercentTimeOn`

*Can be used to override the percent allocated on the Allocation*

Values: 10, 25, 50, 75, 100

### Phase - `tbMDPhase`

*High-level Phase of Project or Program*

Values: **Closing**, Executing, **Initiating**, **Planning**

### Popular - `tbTagPopular`

*Groups tags so commonly used ones surface first*

Values: General, NewBars, NewBarsNo, OpenProject Integration, PPM, Project Management, Resource Management, Risks and Issues Management, StdTasks

### Portfolios - `tbMDPortfolio`

*Optional field to tag a project with another Portfolio Scheme*

Values: Building Services, Business Support Systems, Core Product Delivery, IT Platform, R&D New Technology

### Primary LOB - `tbMDPrimaryLineOfBusiness`

*Optional field to tag a project with a Business Owner*

Values: Business Development, Business Technology Solutions, Corporate Affairs, Engineering and Product Delivery, Human Resources, Research and Development

### Primary Role - `tbResPrimaryRole`

*Set role for resource demand calculations*

Values: **Executive Sponsor**, Director, Manager, Department Head, **Project Manager**, Vendor Manager, R&D, Innovation Manager, Engineer, Solution Architecture, Developer, Software

Engineer, DevOps Engineer, Database Administrator, UX/UI Designer, Graphic Designer, Technical Writer, Test Automation, Tester, Risk Manager, Network Administrator, Financial Analyst, HR SME, Finance SME, Marketing Manager, Sales Manager, RF Engineer, Field Service Technician, NOC Technician

### Primary Skill - `tbResPrimarySkill`

*Tag resources for resource for skill visibility*

Values: IT Architecture, Testing, Testing Software, Design, Design - Mechanical, Project Management, Procurement, Catch All Skill, na, Leadership, Management, Strategic Planning, Business Analysis, Stakeholder Management, Client Relationship Management, Vendor Management, Contract Management, Product Management, **Innovation**, Change Management, Solution Architecture, Siebel CRM Development, Cloud Computing, DevOps, Database Administration, Data Analytics, Artificial Intelligence, Robotics, UX/UI Design, Technical Writing, Document Management, Quality Assurance, Network Security, Risk Management, IT Operations, Incident Management, Network Administration, Network Operations (NOC), Customer Support, Training & Development, Human Resources, Financial Analysis, Facilities Management, Communication, Marketing, Sales, RF Engineering, Field Services, Site Acquisition, Design - UI, Testing Hardware, Java Development, JavaScript / Web Development, Python Development

### Product - `tbMDProduct`

*If this timebar is for creating a product, use this tag for reporting by Product*

Values: Access Point, Analyzers, Antenna, Billing System, CEP, Customer Solution, DM System, Hot spot, Hot Spot, HR System, NA, Network, SAP System, Secure Cloud System, Security System, Ticketing system, Tools, VNS System, WIFI System

### Program Activity Alignment (PAA) - `tbMDProgActivityAlignment`

*GOC Field for tracking programs.*

Values: 1 1 1 1 Sub-Sub-Program: Banks support of One-Benefit distribution, 1 1 1 2 Sub-Sub-Program: Tax System changes to suit new One-Benefit., 1 1 1 Sub-Program: One Canada wide monthly payment to each Canadian, 1 1 Program: Common One-Benefit service for all Canadians, Taxes, Food

### Programs - `tbMDProgram`

*Optional field to tag a project to a Program for Program Reporting*

Values: Building and Office Modernization, Business Continuity Management Program, Centralized Billing and Receivables, Continuous Improvement Transformation, Continuous Internal Delivery Enablement, Core Operations Program, Digital Workplace - Transformation

### Project Assessment Status - `tbPASStatus`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Draft, **Completed**, **Approved**, **Rejected**, **On Hold**

### Project Assessment Type - `tbPASProjectType`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Incremental Improvement, **Enhancement**, New Feature, New Product, Breakthrough Innovation

### Project Category - `tbMDCategory`

*Metadata to categorize bars at all leveles, Projects, Tasks etc.*

Values: SW Upgrade, Business System Configuration, HW Upgrade, Cloud Service New or Upgrade, HW, SW System Upgrade, New Ground to Cloud Service, Not Assessed, New HW, SW System, Upgrade Ground to Cloud Service, Not Applicable

### Project Similarity - `tbPASProjectSimilarity`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Very Similar, Somewhat Similar, Moderately Different, Quite Different, Completely New

### RandIStage - `tbMDStageRIC`

*Controlling Risk and Issue life-cycle workflow*

Values: 1 Proposed, 2 Triaged, 3 Prioritized, 4 Assigned, 5 Solving, 6 Mitigating, 7 Closed

### RandIState - `tbMDStateRIC`

*Workflow Life-cycle tag*

Values: Awaiting Input, Awaiting Approval, Approved, Awaiting Review

### RandIStatus - `tbMDStatusRIC`

*Timebar Task, Issue, Risk or CR Status.*

Values: Managing, **Concerned**, **Critical**, **Completed**

### Regulatory Approvals - `tbPASRegulatoryApprovals`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: None required, Internal approvals, Industry standards, Government approvals, Multiple regulatory bodies

### Resource Class - `tbResResourceClass`

*Resource Class External, Seasonal etc*

Values: External, Permanent, Seasonal

### Resource Department - `tbResDepartment`

*Resource belongs to what department*

Values: Finance, Field Operations, Information Technology, Legal Compliance, Engineering, Management

### Resource Type - `tbResResourceType`

*Resource type equipment, labour, material etc.*

Values: Equipment, Labour, Material

### Responsible Team - `tbMDResponsibleTeam`

*Project Tagging*

Values: Product Engineering, Business Analysis, Information Technology, IT Operations, Accounting, Corporate Communications, Finance, Procurement, Procurement & Vendor Mgmt, Design, Documentation, Executive Leadership, Facilities, Field Operations, Human Resources, Marketing, Product & Innovation, Product Management, Project Delivery, Quality Assurance, Sales, Security & Risk, Software Engineering, Solutions Engineering, Strategy & Innovation

### Risk Category - `tbMDRiskCategory`

*Metadata to categorize Issues. Used at Task level if Sub-Type is Risk*

Values: Schedule, Financial, **Operational**, **Technical**, Organizational

### Risk Impact - `tbMDImpact`

*Tagging risks for the risk score result*

Values: **Very Low**, Low, Medium, High, **Very High**, **Not Assessed**

### Risk Probability - `tbMDProbability`

*Tagging risks for the risk score result*

Values: **Very Unlikely**, **Unlikely**, **Likely**, **Very Likely**, **Certain**, **Not Assessed**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Risk Vs Size - `tbMDRiskVsSizeAndComplexity`

*Supports bubble charts*

Values: **Not Assessed**, **41-50 Complex but Manageable**, **0-10 Very Small and Simple**, **51-60 Significant Complexity**, **11-20 Small and Straightforward**, **61-70 Large and Complex**, **21-30 Medium with Some Complexity**, **71-80 Very Large and Complex**, **31-40 Large with Moderate Complexity**, **81-90 Highly Complex and Risky**, **91-100 Extremely Complex and Risky**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Schedule Status - `tbMDHealth`

*For Reporting Color indicators*

Values: **Completed**, **Early**, **Late**, **On schedule**, **Slipping**, **Not Assessed**, **Blocked**

> Every value in this picklist is locked. Add your own freely; do not rename these.

### Severity - `tbMDSeverity`

*Indicates how severe a priority item is, in terms of impact*

Values: **Critical**, Important, **Normal**

### Show In Reports - `tbMDShowIn`

*Manly used at Task, Issue, Risk, CR levels to ensure the bar shows in specific system report*

Values: Facility Schedule, **Key Deliverables**, Assembly Shop, **Key Milestones**, **Key Risks**, **Project Charter**

### Size - `tbMDSize`

*Project or Task Tagging*

Values: Small, Medium, Large, Huge

### Sponsoring Department - `tbMDSponsoringDepartment`

*Project Tagging*

Values: Finance, IT Department, Presidents Office, Communications Public Relations, Legal Compliance, Operations

### Stage - `tbMDStage`

*Controlling project life-cycle workflow*

Values: 1 Proposed, 2 Triaged, 3 Prioritized, 4 Selected, 5 Assigned, 6 Delivering, 7 Delivered, 8 Closed

### Stakeholder Count - `tbPASStakeholderCount`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: 1-5 stakeholders, 6-10 stakeholders, 11-20 stakeholders, 21-50 stakeholders, Over 50 stakeholders

### Strategic Priority - `tbMDPriorityStrategic`

*Project Tagging*

Values: High, Low, Medium

### SubType - `tbSubType`

*Task, Risk, Issue or Other. Determines Blue bar sub type*

Values: **Issue**, Other, **Risk**, Task, CR

### Supervisor - `tbResSupervisor`

*Resources supervisor, not Manager*

Values: John Hammond, Nora Antenna, Jim Key, Sam Backhaul, Helen Hunt, Lena Spectrum

### Task Category - `tbMDCategoryTask`

*Categorises a Task, kept separate from the Project-level Category*

Values: Engineering, Purchasing, Assembly, Construction, Operate

### Task Status - `tbMDStatusTask`

*Status of a Task, kept separate from the Timebar Status picklist*

Values: **Not Started**, Started, **Late**, **Not Assessed**

### tbType - `tbMDTypes`

*System Internal element that defines the bar type. E.g. Task, Project etc.*

Values: **Portfolio**, Project, **Sub-Project**, **Milestone**, Task, **Allocation**

### tbTypeInternal - `tbType`

*System Internal element that defines the bar type. E.g. Task, Project etc.*

Values: **Portfolio**, Project, **Sub-Project**, Task, **Milestone**, **Allocation**

### Team Leader - `tbResTeamLeader`

*Resource or person tagging*

Values: France Finney, Mack Engineer, Chris Java, Kai Pipeline, Mike Side, Jack Top, App Team, CRM Team, Desktop Team

### Team Size - `tbPASTeamSize`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: 1-3 people, 4-8 people, 9-15 people, 16-30 people, Over 30 people

### Team Tech Experience - `tbPASTeamTechExperience`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Expert level, Advanced, Intermediate, Basic, No experience

### Technology Novelty - `tbPASTechnologyNovelty`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: Proven/Mature, Established, Emerging, Cutting-edge, Experimental

### Test Status - `tbMDTestStatus`

*Values for the tbMDTestStatus field*

Values: **Not Started**, **In Progress**, Passed

### Timebar Priority - `tbMDPriority`

*Set timebar priority*

Values: High, **Immediate**, Low, **Normal**, **Not Assessed**

### Timebar Status - `tbMDStatus`

*Mandatory values for enabling reporting.*

Values: **In progress**, New, **Rejected**, Closed, **On Hold**, **Blocked**

### Type Of Initiative - `tbMDProjectType`

*Project Type Tagging for Portfolio Balancing*

Values: **Mandatory Compliance**, **Maintenance Operational**, **Growth Enhancement**, External Contract Delivery, Internal Delivery

### Value Stream - `tbMDValueStream`

*Values for the tbMDValueStream field*

Values: Customer Experience, Operations, Technology Platform

### Vendor Dependencies - `tbPASVendorDependencies`

*Helps determine the Project Asessment Score.*

Values: No vendors, 1 reliable vendor, 2-3 known vendors, Multiple/new vendors, Critical unknown vendors

### YesNo - `tbMDYesNo`

*for tagging a time bar for true or false on unknown*

Values: No, Yes, NA

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## Related Help Topics

- Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide - Import/export data for bulk editing
- Cloud Publishing Guide - Publish reports to the cloud
- User Interface Guide - Navigate the application
- Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide - Understand the data model

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# Part 6 — Risks, Issues and Change Requests

## Risks, Issues & Change Requests User Guide

This guide explains how to track and manage Risks, Issues, and Change Requests (RIC) in Agilebars, Timebars, and Costbars applications. The RIC system helps you identify potential problems, log current issues, and manage proposed changes—all directly on your project timeline.

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### Overview: What is the RIC System?

The **RIC (Risks, Issues, Change Requests) system** allows you to:

- **Track Risks**: Potential problems that might occur in the future
- **Manage Issues**: Problems that are happening right now
- **Handle Change Requests**: Proposed changes to project scope, schedule, or budget

**Key Concepts:**

- RIC items are created as regular tasks using the Bar Creator
- Each item is classified by changing the **SubType** field (Risk, Issue, or CR)
- Visual indicators appear automatically on the Canvas (R, I, or CR prefix)
- Dedicated views provide filtering, searching, and detailed tracking
- Customize forms to match your organization's methodology

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## Quick Start: Creating Your First RIC Item

### Step-by-Step Creation

1. **Create a Task Bar:**
    - Click **Main Menu > New Bar**
    - Drag the Task Creator Bar (blue) onto a Project Bar (green)
    - Drop to create the task
2. **Open the Form:**
    - Click on the **bar name** to open the Slide Out Right Form
3. **Change Name:**
    - Update the task name to describe your Risk, Issue, or CR
    - Examples:
        - "R-Database Migration Failure Risk"
        - "I-Server Outage on Production"
        - "CR-Add Mobile App Support"
4. **Set SubType:**
    - Find the **SubType** field in the form
    - Change from "Task" to **"Risk"**, **"Issue"**, or **"CR"**
5. **Visual Indicator Appears:**
    - **Risk**: Bold **R** prefix appears before bar name
    - **Issue**: Bold **I** prefix appears before bar name
    - **Change Request**: Bold **CR** prefix appears before bar name
6. **Save and Close:**
    - Data saves automatically
    - Close the form

**That's it!** You've created a RIC item. Now let's explore how to track and manage it.

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## Visual Indicators on the Canvas

RIC items display with automatic visual indicators to help you quickly identify them:

### Prefix Letters

- **R** = Risk
- **I** = Issue
- **CR** = Change Request

### Color Coding by Status

When you set the **Status** field to specific values, the visual indicator changes:

| Status | Visual Effect | When to Use |
|---|---|---|
| **Normal** | Black bold letter | Standard priority |
| **Concerned** | **Red letter** with thin red border | Needs attention |
| **Critical** | **RED letter** with thick red border | Urgent action required |

**Example:**

- Normal Risk: **R** Database Migration Failure (black)
- Concerned Issue: **I** Server Outage on Production (red letter, thin border)
- Critical Risk: **R** Security Vulnerability Discovered (red letter, thick border)

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## Accessing the RIC Management Page

To view and manage all your Risks, Issues, and Change Requests in one place:

1. Choose **Main Menu > RIC** (or **Main Menu > Risks/Issues**)
2. The RIC page opens with **Card View** as the default

**Two View Options:**

- **Card View**: Visual cards with expandable details (recommended for viewing)
- **Tabular View**: Sortable table with all fields (recommended for bulk analysis)

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## Card View: Visual Management

Card View displays your RIC items as color-coded, expandable cards in a two-column responsive grid.

### Card Colors by Type

- **Risk Cards**: Blue gradient background
- **Issue Cards**: Red gradient background
- **Change Request Cards**: Pink/Purple gradient background

### Card Structure

Each card shows:

**1. Header Section:**

- **Breadcrumb**: Project hierarchy (Portfolio > Program > Project)
- **SubType Chip**: Colored badge (Risk/Issue/CR)
- **ID and Name**: Item identifier and title
- **Action Buttons**:

    - **Edit** (pencil icon) - Opens full FOCD form
    - **Print** (printer icon) - Prints this card

**2. Metadata Section** (Always visible):

- **Parent Project**: Which project this belongs to
- **Dates**: Start/Finish (planned) and Actual dates (if started/completed)
- **Schedule Health**: Color-coded indicator (Green/Yellow/Red)
- **Risk-Specific**:
    - **Probability**: Likelihood rating
    - **Impact**: Severity rating
    - **Score**: Auto-calculated (Probability × Impact) with color coding
    - **Mitigation Status**: Current mitigation progress
- **Escalation Level**: Color-coded (e.g., red for Executives)
- **Owner**: Person responsible
- **Status**: Current status (New, In Progress, Closed, etc.)
- **State**: Workflow state (Awaiting Approval, Approved, etc.)
- **Category**: Classification type
- **Priority**: Color-coded (Immediate, High, Normal, Low)

**3. Details Section** (Expandable - Click "Show Details"):

**For Risks:**

- Description
- Executive Summary
- Notes
- Risk Response Strategy (rich text)
- Mitigation Plan (rich text)
- Contingency Plan (rich text)

**For Issues:**

- Description
- Executive Summary
- Notes

**For Change Requests:**

- **Tabbed Interface** with 4 tabs:
    - **Overview**: Description, Executive Summary, Problem/Opportunity
    - **Impact Assessment**: Schedule, Budget, Scope, Resource Commentary
    - **Benefits & Justification**: Expected Benefits, Cost-Benefit Analysis, Options Analysis
    - **Notes**: Implementation Approach, Next Steps, Dependencies

### Inline Editing in Cards

You can edit text fields directly in the cards:

1. Click "Show Details" to expand the card

2. Click on any text field
3. Edit the content
4. Click outside the field to save automatically
5. Rich text editors available for Risk strategy/plan fields

**Note:** Some fields require opening the full FOCD form to edit.

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## Tabular View: Data Analysis

Tabular View displays all RIC items in a sortable, scrollable table—ideal for analysis and reporting.

### Features

- **Sortable Columns**: Click any column header to sort ascending/descending
- **Fixed Actions Column**: Edit button always visible on the left
- **Horizontal Scrolling**: Scroll right to see all columns
- **Compact View**: See many items at once
- **Quick Access**: Click Edit button to open FOCD form

### Available Columns

The table includes columns for:

- Actions (Edit button)
- Hierarchy (L1, L2, L3)
- ID, Name, SubType
- Start Date, Finish Date, Actual Start, Actual Finish
- Owner, Status, State, Priority
- **Risk Fields**: Probability, Impact, Score, Category, Mitigation Status, Escalation Level
- **Health Indicators**: Schedule Health (color-coded)
- Description, Executive Summary, Notes

### Sorting Data

1. Click any column header (e.g., "Priority")
2. Data sorts ascending
3. Click again to sort descending
4. Default sort: Hierarchy Order (top to bottom as on Canvas)

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## Search and Filter

Both Card View and Tabular View include powerful search and filter tools at the top of the page.

### Free-Text Search

**Search Box** (top of page):

- Type any text to search across all fields
- Results filter in real-time as you type
- Searches: Names, Descriptions, Notes, all text content

**Example:**

- Type "database" to find all items mentioning database
- Type "migration" to find migration-related items

### Picklist Filters

**Filter Dropdowns**:

- Multiple dropdown filters available
- Filter by any picklist field:
  - **SubType**: Show only Risks, Issues, or CRs
  - **Status**: Active, Closed, On Hold, etc.
  - **Priority**: Immediate, High, Normal, Low
  - **Owner**: Filter by responsible person
  - **Category**: Filter by classification
  - **Escalation Level**: Show only escalated items
  - **State**: Filter by workflow state

**Combining Filters:**

- Select multiple filters to narrow results
- Example: Show only "High Priority Risks" with "Critical Status"

### Recalculate All Button

Click **"Recalculate All"** to:

- Refresh all calculated fields
- Recalculate every Risk Score from its current Probability and Impact (use this after any change to those picklists, and to clear scores left over from the old 0-100 scale)
- Ensure data consistency across views
- Rebuild system-generated data

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## Editing with FOCD Forms

FOCD (Field-Oriented Control Design) forms provide detailed editing of all RIC metadata.

### Opening a FOCD Form

**Three Ways to Open:**

1. Click **Edit button** (pencil icon) on any card
2. Click **Edit button** in Tabular View row
3. Click on a bar on the Canvas, then click **Edit** in the popup

**Two Form Types:**

- **Risk Edit Form (dfRisk)**: For Risks and Change Requests
- **Issue Edit Form (dfIssue)**: For Issues

### Form Features

**Auto-Save:**

- Changes save automatically to the database when you move off a field
- No "Save" button needed for most edits

**Rich Text Editors (Risks Only):** Three fields use rich text editors:

- **Risk Response Strategy**: Formatted text with bold, italic, lists
- **Mitigation Plan**: Detailed action plans with formatting
- **Contingency Plan**: Backup plans with formatting

**Risk Score Calculator:**

- When you change **Probability** or **Impact**, the **Score** field updates automatically
- Formula: Score = Probability (1-5) x Impact (1-5) = 1 to 25, higher is worse

**Field Types:**

- **Text Inputs**: Standard single-line text
- **Dropdowns**: Picklist selections
- **Text Areas**: Multi-line text with auto-resize
- **Rich Editors**: Formatted text (Risks only)
- **Date Pickers**: Calendar date selection
- **Section Headers**: Organize fields into groups

### Form Actions

**Save Button:**

- Click to explicitly save all changes
- Returns to Card or Tabular View

**Move/Resize Fields Button:**

- Click to enter customization mode
- Drag fields to reposition
- Resize using edge handles
- Click "Stop" to save layout

**Close Button (X):**

- Saves changes and closes form
- Reloads application with updated data

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## Managing Risks

Risks are potential problems that might occur in the future. Effective risk management helps you prevent issues before they happen.

### Core Risk Fields

When managing a Risk, you'll work with these key fields:

### 1. Probability (Likelihood)

How likely is this risk to occur? Each value carries a weight of 1 to 5, used to calculate the Score:

| Value | Weight |
|---|---|
| Very Unlikely | 1 |
| Unlikely | 2 |
| Likely | 3 |
| Very Likely | 4 |
| Certain | 5 |
| Not Assessed | *no weight — the risk scores 0* |

> **Do not rename these five values.** The weights are held in the application code and matched by exact text, so a renamed value stops scoring altogether and the risk silently reads Not Assessed. You may add values, but only these five produce a score. See *Customizing picklists* below.

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### 2. Impact (Severity)

How severe would the consequences be if this risk occurs? Consider schedule, budget, scope and quality. Each value carries a weight of 1 to 5:

| Value | Weight |
|---|---|
| Very Low | 1 |
| Low | 2 |
| Medium | 3 |
| High | 4 |
| Very High | 5 |
| Not Assessed | *no weight — the risk scores 0* |

> The same warning applies: these five values are matched by exact text and must not be

> renamed.

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### 3. Score (Auto-Calculated)

The Score follows the standard **5x5 probability-impact matrix** used by PMBOK, ISO 31000, PRINCE2 and M_o_R:

> **Score = Probability (1-5) x Impact (1-5) → 1 to 25, where higher is worse.**

It is calculated for you the moment you set both axes, on every surface — the risk form, the cards, the tabular view and the inline grid.

**Set only one axis and the score stays 0.** So does setting either to *Not Assessed*. A score of 0 means *not assessed*, and is deliberately outside the valid 1-25 range so it can never be mistaken for a real, low assessment.

**The four bands:**

| Band | Score | Reading |
|---|---|---|
| **Low** | 1-4 | green |
| **Moderate** | 5-9 | amber |
| **High** | 10-14 | orange |
| **Extreme** | 15-25 | red |
| *Not Assessed* | 0 | grey |

The score displays as the number and its band together — `12 - High` — so the reading never depends on remembering where the boundaries fall.

**Worked examples:**

| Probability | Impact | Score | Band |
|---|---|---|---|
| Certain | Very High | 25 | Extreme |
| Likely | High | 12 | High |
| Unlikely | Medium | 6 | Moderate |
| Very Unlikely | Very Low | 1 | Low |
| Likely | *(not set)* | 0 | Not Assessed |

### The risk matrix panel

The risk form carries a **5x5 heat map** showing all 25 combinations, with your assessed cell ringed. Probability runs down the rows worst-first and Impact across the columns, so it reads

like any published risk heat map. Hovering a cell tells you its combination, score and band, and a legend underneath shows the four band ranges.

**The panel is draggable** — move it aside if it covers a field you are working on.

> **A note if you have used earlier versions.** The score used to run the other way: it was normalised to 0-100 and inverted, so 100 meant *safest*. Most of the product read it as higher-is-worse, which meant the safest risk on a card rendered in the loudest red and the most dangerous one in plain small text. The scale, the colours and the matrix now all run the same direction. **Scores recorded under the old scale are meaningless on the new one** — reassess, or run **Recalculate All**, which recalculates every score from its Probability and Impact.

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### 4. Category

Classify the type of risk:

**Default Values for Risks:**

- Strategic: Alignment with business goals
- Financial: Budget and funding risks
- Operational: Day-to-day operations
- Technical: Technology and system risks
- Organizational: People and structure risks

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### 5. Risk Response Strategy

Your written approach to handling the risk.

**Common Strategies:**

- **Avoid**: Change plans to eliminate the risk
- **Mitigate**: Reduce likelihood or impact
- **Transfer**: Shift risk to third party (insurance, vendor)
- **Accept**: Acknowledge risk and prepare to deal with it

**Field Type:** Rich text editor (supports formatting)

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### 6. Mitigation Plan

Detailed actions to reduce the risk.

**What to Include:**

- Specific steps to take
- Who is responsible for each step

- Timeline for completion
- Resources needed
- Success metrics

**Field Type:** Rich text editor (supports formatting)

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### 7. Mitigation Status

Track progress of your mitigation efforts.

**Default Values:**

- Identified: Risk recognized but not yet assessed
- Assessed: Analysis complete
- Mitigation Planned: Plan created
- In Progress: Executing mitigation
- Mitigated: Risk reduced to acceptable level
- Under Review: Evaluating effectiveness
- Accepted: Acknowledged without mitigation
- Transferred: Shifted to third party
- Escalated: Raised to higher management
- Closed: Risk no longer relevant
- Deferred: Postponed to later

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### 8. Contingency Plan

Backup plan if the risk occurs despite mitigation.

**What to Include:**

- Fallback actions
- Resources reserved for response
- Decision triggers
- Communication plan

**Field Type:** Rich text editor (supports formatting)

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### 9. Escalation Level

Who needs to be informed if this risk materializes?

**Default Values:**

- Executives: C-level notification
- Directors: Department heads
- Project Office: PMO oversight
- Not Assessed

**Display:** Color-coded based on level

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### 10. Trigger Event

What event or condition signals this risk is occurring?

**Examples:**

- "Server CPU usage exceeds 80% for 24 hours"
- "Project spend reaches 90% of budget with 40% work remaining"
- "Key vendor misses two consecutive delivery dates"

**Field Type:** Plain text area

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### 11. Early Warning Indicators

Metrics or signals to detect the risk early.

**Examples:**

- Weekly defect trend increasing
- Resource availability dropping below threshold
- Velocity declining for two sprints
- Stakeholder engagement score decreasing

**Field Type:** Plain text area

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### Risk Management Workflow

#### Step 1: Identify

1. Create Risk item on Canvas (SubType = Risk)
2. Give it a clear, descriptive name
3. Set Category for classification

#### Step 2: Assess

1. Open RIC page (Main Menu > RIC)
2. Find your risk and click Edit
3. Set **Probability** and **Impact**
4. Review calculated **Score**
5. Set **Escalation Level** if needed

#### Step 3: Plan Response

1. Write **Risk Response Strategy** (Avoid/Mitigate/Transfer/Accept)
2. Detail **Mitigation Plan** with specific actions
3. Write **Contingency Plan** as backup

4. Set **Trigger Event** and **Early Warning Indicators**
5. Assign **Owner**
6. Set **Mitigation Status** to "Mitigation Planned"

**Step 4: Execute Mitigation**

1. Update **Mitigation Status** to "In Progress"
2. Add progress **Notes** regularly
3. Monitor early warning indicators
4. Update **Status** to "Concerned" or "Critical" if risk increases

**Step 5: Monitor and Close**

1. Review risk regularly (weekly/monthly)
2. Update Probability/Impact if conditions change
3. When risk is addressed:
    - Set **Mitigation Status** to "Mitigated" or "Closed"
    - Set **Status** to "Closed"
    - Document outcome in **Notes**

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## Managing Issues

Issues are problems that are happening right now and require immediate attention.

### Core Issue Fields

Issues use simpler fields than Risks since the problem has already occurred:

### Key Fields:

- **Description**: What is the problem?
- **Executive Summary**: High-level summary for management
- **Notes**: Updates on resolution progress
- **Status**: Current state (New, In Progress, Closed, etc.)
- **State**: Workflow tracking (Awaiting Input, Under Review, etc.)
- **Priority**: Urgency level (Immediate, High, Normal, Low)
- **Owner**: Person responsible for resolving
- **Escalation Level**: Who needs to know (Executives, Directors, Project Office)
- **Category**: Type of issue

### Category Values for Issues:

- Product: Product defects or problems
- Financial: Budget or cost issues
- Operational: Process or operational problems
- Technical: Technical failures or bugs
- Schedule: Timeline delays

### Issue Management Workflow

#### Step 1: Log the Issue

1. Create Issue item on Canvas (SubType = Issue)
2. Give it a clear name describing the problem
3. Set **Priority** based on urgency
4. Set **Category** for classification

#### Step 2: Assess

1. Open RIC page and click Edit
2. Write detailed **Description** of the problem
3. Write **Executive Summary** for stakeholders
4. Set **Escalation Level** if critical
5. Assign **Owner** to resolve

#### Step 3: Resolve

1. Update **Status** to "In Progress"
2. If urgent: Set Status to "Concerned" or "Critical" (triggers red visual indicator)
3. Add **Notes** with resolution activities
4. Update **State** as it moves through workflow (e.g., "Awaiting Approval")

#### Step 4: Close

1. When resolved:
    - Set **Status** to "Closed"
    - Document resolution in **Notes**
    - Set **Actual Finish** date
2. Review **Notes** to capture lessons learned

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## Managing Change Requests

Change Requests (CRs) track proposed changes to project scope, schedule, budget, or resources.

### Core CR Fields

CRs have extensive fields to justify and analyze the proposed change:

#### Overview Tab:

- **Description**: What is the change?
- **Executive Summary**: High-level summary
- **Problem/Opportunity**: What drives this change?

**Impact Assessment Tab:**

- **Schedule Commentary**: How does this affect timeline?
- **Budget Commentary**: Cost impact
- **Scope Commentary**: How does scope change?
- **Resource Commentary**: Resource needs

**Benefits & Justification Tab:**

- **Expected Benefits**: What do we gain? (Rich text editor)
- **Cost-Benefit Analysis**: Is it worth the investment?
- **Options Analysis**: What alternatives were considered?

**Notes Tab:**

- **Implementation Approach**: How will we execute?
- **Next Steps**: Immediate actions
- **Key Dependencies**: What's needed to proceed?

**Common Fields:**

- **Owner**: CR sponsor/requestor
- **Status**: Approval status
- **State**: Workflow state (Awaiting Approval, Approved, etc.)
- **Priority**: Importance level

### Change Request Workflow

#### Step 1: Submit CR

1. Create CR item (SubType = CR)
2. Name it clearly (e.g., "CR-Add Mobile App Support")
3. Open RIC page, find CR, click Edit

#### Step 2: Document Justification

1. **Overview Tab**:
    - Write detailed **Description**
    - Write **Executive Summary**
    - Explain **Problem/Opportunity**
2. **Benefits Tab**:
    - Document **Expected Benefits** (use rich text formatting)
    - Complete **Cost-Benefit Analysis**
    - Describe **Options Analysis** (alternatives considered)

#### Step 3: Assess Impact

1. **Impact Assessment Tab**:

- **Schedule Commentary**: Add X weeks? Delay milestone?
- **Budget Commentary**: Cost increase? Source of funds?
- **Scope Commentary**: What's added/removed?
- **Resource Commentary**: Need additional people/skills?

**Step 4: Plan Implementation**

1. **Notes Tab**:
   - **Implementation Approach**: How will we execute?
   - **Key Dependencies**: What must happen first?
   - **Next Steps**: Immediate actions
2. Set **Owner** (requestor)
3. Set **Priority**

**Step 5: Approval Process**

1. Set **State** to "Requested Approval"
2. Update **Status** and **State** as it moves through workflow:
   - Awaiting Approval
   - Approved / Rejected
   - Awaiting Implementation
3. Add **Notes** with decision rationale

**Step 6: Implementation or Closure**

- If Approved: Create tasks to implement, link to CR
- If Rejected: Set **Status** to "Rejected", document reason
- If Complete: Set **Status** to "Closed"

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## Customizing Forms and Picklists

The Risk and Issue forms, and every picklist behind them, are configured the same way as everything else in the product. The **Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide** is the full reference; this section covers only what is specific to Risks, Issues and CRs.

> Earlier versions of this guide routed you through *Reports > Data Management Grids*. **That screen no longer exists.** Configuration now lives on five reports under **Report Menu > Other**.

### Show, hide, move and add fields

**Report Menu > Other > Fields Values.** Filter the **Form** column to `dfRisk` or `dfIssue` and you have every field on that form, one per row.

| To do this | Do this |
|---|---|
| Hide a field | open it on the form and set **Show** to `No` |
| Show it again | set **Show** back to `Yes` |

| To do this | Do this |
|---|---|
| Reposition or resize | edit **Top**, **Left** and **Width** directly in the grid |
| Add a field | filter to the form first, click **Add**, then pick the field name |
| Remove a field | delete its row |

The layout columns are the only cells in that report you edit in the grid rather than on the form — because laying out a form means comparing one field's numbers against its neighbours'.

**Or move fields by hand.** Open a Risk or Issue form, click the **Move/Resize Fields** button, drag the fields where you want them, and click **Stop** to save. Easier than typing coordinates for small adjustments.

### Which picklists drive Risks, Issues and CRs

**Report Menu > Other > Picklist Values.** Filter to the picklist, open a value, edit it.

| Picklist | Field | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **Risk Probability** | `tbMDProbability` | **Do not rename the five scoring values** — see below |
| **Risk Impact** | `tbMDImpact` | **Do not rename the five scoring values** |
| **Risk Category** | `tbMDCategory` | free to customise; add your own |
| **Issue Category** | `tbMDCategory` | free to customise |
| **CR Category** | `tbMDCategory` | free to customise |
| **Mitigation Status** | `tbMDMitigationStatus` | free to customise, with one exception: **`Escalated`** is read by the health rules |
| **Escalation Level** | `tbMDEscalationLevel` | **`Executives`**, **`Directors`**, **`Project Office`** are read by the health rules |
| **Timebar Status** | `tbMDStatus` | **`Closed`** and **`Rejected`** are what make an item stop counting |
| **Approval State** | `tbMDState` | the workflow states |
| **Timebar Priority** | `tbMDPriority` | free to customise |
| **RandIStage**, **RandIState**, **RandIStatus** | R&I workflow | free to customise |

> **Values in bold are locked.** They carry a padlock in Picklist Values and cannot be renamed there, because the application compares against that exact text. You may always **add** your own values to any of these lists.

### Why the locked values matter here specifically

Risks, Issues and Change Requests do not just describe themselves — they drive their parent project's **Scope, Risk and Issue health indicators**. Those rules read your items by exact value:

- An item stops counting toward health once its Status is `Closed` or `Rejected`.
- An open item escalated to `Executives` or `Directors`, or a risk whose Mitigation Status is `Escalated`, turns the parent's indicator **Red**.
- An open item escalated to `Project Office`, or three or more open items, turns it **Yellow**.

Rename one of those values and the health rules stop seeing your escalations — without any error. The *Forms, Reports and Graphs Guide* covers the full rule set.

### People fields come from the Resource Pool

**Contact / Requestor**, and the other person-named fields on these forms, no longer read a picklist of typed names. They read the **live Resource Pool** — the `Human` rows in Resources. To change who can be picked, maintain the resource pool, not the Tags table.

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## Tips and Best Practices

### Risk Management

1. **Regular Reviews**: Review risks weekly or bi-weekly
2. **Update Probability/Impact**: Reassess as conditions change
3. **Monitor Early Warnings**: Track indicators proactively
4. **Document Triggers**: Define clear conditions that signal risk is occurring
5. **Keep Plans Current**: Update mitigation plans as you learn more
6. **Use Visual Indicators**: Set Status to "Concerned" or "Critical" for urgent risks

### Issue Management

1. **Log Immediately**: Create issues as soon as problems occur
2. **Escalate Appropriately**: Set Escalation Level for critical issues
3. **Update Progress**: Add Notes regularly with resolution activities
4. **Set Clear Ownership**: Always assign an Owner
5. **Close Properly**: Document resolution and lessons learned
6. **Use Red Indicators**: Set Status to "Critical" for urgent issues to trigger visual alerts

### Change Request Management

1. **Complete Justification**: Fill all Impact Assessment fields
2. **Quantify Benefits**: Use specific metrics in Expected Benefits
3. **Consider Alternatives**: Document Options Analysis thoroughly
4. **Track Through Workflow**: Update State as approval progresses
5. **Link to Implementation**: Create implementation tasks and link to CR

### General Best Practices

1. **Consistent Naming**: Use prefixes (R-, I-, CR-) in names
2. **Use Categories**: Classify items for better filtering
3. **Set Priorities**: Helps sort and filter critical items
4. **Leverage Search**: Use search box to find items quickly

5. **Print Cards**: Print individual cards for meetings or reviews
6. **Regular Recalculation**: Click "Recalculate All" periodically to ensure data accuracy
7. **Customize Forms**: Remove unused fields to simplify forms
8. **Standardize Picklists**: Ensure team uses consistent terminology

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## Troubleshooting

### Visual Indicator Not Appearing

**Problem:** R, I, or CR prefix doesn't show on Canvas

**Solution:**

1. Verify **SubType** field is set to "Risk", "Issue", or "CR" (exact spelling)
2. Refresh Canvas (click Refresh icon on top menu)
3. If still missing, Right-click Canvas > Recalculate All

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### Status Not Turning Red

**Problem:** Set Status to "Concerned" but letter doesn't turn red

**Solution:**

1. Ensure exact spelling: "Concerned" or "Critical"
2. Check tbTags store has these values defined
3. Refresh Canvas after changing Status

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### Risk Score Not Calculating

**Cause:** One axis is missing, or a value has been renamed.

**Solution:**

1. Set **both** Probability **and** Impact — one alone always scores 0.
2. Check neither is set to **Not Assessed**, which also scores 0.
3. If both are set and the score is still 0, the picklist value has been renamed. The five scoring values in each list are matched by exact text: `Very Unlikely`, `Unlikely`, `Likely`, `Very Likely`, `Certain` and `Very Low`, `Low`, `Medium`, `High`, `Very High`. Restore the original spelling in **Picklist Values**.
4. Run **Recalculate All** to recalculate every score in the database.

**Cause:** The score looks wrong rather than absent — a trivial risk showing red, or a severe one showing green.

**Solution:** The row is holding a score from the old 0-100 scale, where 100 meant safest. Run **Recalculate All**; every score is recalculated from its Probability and Impact on the current 1-25 scale.

### Fields Missing in Form

**Problem:** Expected fields don't appear in Risk or Issue form

**Solution:**

1. Go to **Report Menu > Other > Fields Values**
2. Filter **Form** to `dfRisk` or `dfIssue` and find the field
3. Open it on the form and check **Show** is `Yes`
4. If the field has no row on that form at all, **Add** one and pick the field name
5. Refresh the application after changes

---

### Cannot Edit in Card View

**Problem:** Click on field in card but can't edit

**Solution:**

1. Click **"Show Details"** to expand card first
2. Some fields require full FOCD form—click **Edit button**
3. Ensure you're not in read-only mode

---

### Filters Not Working

**Problem:** Select filter but no results appear

**Solution:**

1. Check that items exist with selected filter value
2. Clear other filters—they may be combining to exclude all results
3. Try Search box to verify items exist
4. Click "Recalculate All" to refresh data

---

## Data Storage

Understanding where RIC data is stored helps with backups, spreadsheet sync, and troubleshooting.

### IndexedDB Stores

**tbTimebars Store:**

- Contains all RIC items as task records
- Key field: **tbSubType** = "Risk", "Issue", or "CR"
- Includes: ID, Name, Type, Start/Finish dates, Hierarchy (L1-L5), Owner

**tbMetaData Store:**

- Contains all metadata fields (100+ fields)

- Links to tbTimebars via **tbMDID** = **tbID**
- Includes: Probability, Impact, Score, Status, Priority, Description, Plans, Commentary

**tbFields Store:**

- Defines FOCD form layouts
- Contains field positions (dfCoordLeft, dfCoordTop)
- Controls field visibility (dfShowYN)
- Filter by **dfFormName** = "dfRisk" or "dfIssue"

### Spreadsheet Sync

RIC items can be exported/imported via spreadsheet:

**Export:**

1. Click **Hamburger Icon > Export to CSV**
2. Files created: `Timebars.csv` and `MetaData.csv`
3. Open tbClientMaster.xlsm spreadsheet
4. Click "Import All" to load data

**Edit in Spreadsheet:**

- Timebars worksheet: ID, Name, SubType, Dates, Hierarchy
- MetaData worksheet: All 100+ metadata fields
- Edit, add rows, copy-paste as needed

**Import:**

- Save spreadsheet
- Drag and drop onto Canvas
- RIC items update from spreadsheet data

---

## Related Help Topics

- User Interface Guide - Creating and editing bars
- Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide - Data stores, backup, import and export
- Local Reports Guide - Risk and Issue reports
- Configurable Data Guide - Forms, picklists and the status/health rules

---

## Summary

**Key Takeaways:**

1. **Three Item Types**: Risks (potential problems), Issues (current problems), Change Requests (proposed changes)
2. **Create as Tasks**: Use Bar Creator, then change SubType field
3. **Visual Indicators**: R, I, CR prefixes appear automatically; turn red for Concerned/Critical status

4. **Two Views**: Card View (visual) and Tabular View (analytical)
5. **Powerful Search**: Free-text search plus multiple picklist filters
6. **FOCD Forms**: Detailed editing with auto-save, rich text editors and the risk matrix panel
7. **Risk Management**: Assess Probability and Impact; the Score is the 5x5 matrix product, 1-25, higher is worse
8. **Customizable**: Show/hide fields, move/resize layout, customise picklists - all from Report Menu > Other
9. **Track Workflows**: Use Status and State fields to track approval and resolution
10. **Regular Reviews**: Update items frequently; use visual indicators for urgency

**Effective RIC management helps you prevent problems, resolve issues quickly, and manage changes systematically.**

---

# Part 7 — How to Use Ask AI

## 🤖 How to Use Ask AI

### Table of Contents


1. What "Ask AI" Is
2. 🚀 Getting Started: the "Get Started" L1 bar
3. 🖱️ The two things you click
4. 🧭 What AI Creates at Each Level
5. 🧩 Two kinds of staffing: Resource Plan vs. Assigning People
6. 📋 While the AI Works
7. 💡 Tips for Great Results
8. 🆘 The Ask AI Help Assistant
9. 🐛 Troubleshooting


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### What "Ask AI" Is

**Ask AI** is the assistant built into your product. It does two things for you:

1. **Creates your project data for you.** Instead of building Projects, Work Packages, Tasks, Milestones and resource Allocations by hand, you describe what you want in plain English and the AI builds the bars on your timeline — at whatever level of the hierarchy you are working in.
2. **Answers your questions.** The **Ask AI** button on the main menu opens a help chat that answers "how do I…" questions about using the app, based on the official documentation.

You do not need to know any technical field names or rules. You write the way a project manager, portfolio manager or engineer would talk, and the AI fills in the rest.

> Ask AI is powered by Google Gemini. After the AI finishes creating data, **refresh the page (press F5)** to see the new bars appear on the canvas.

> **Log in first.** Ask AI only answers users who are logged in to the Timebars Cloud. If you see "Please log in to the Timebars Cloud to use AI", log in from the Publishing page (or the Login button) and try again.

---

### 🚀 Getting Started: the "Get Started" L1 bar

When you open a brand-new, empty canvas in **Timebars** or **Costbars**, the app automatically places one starter bar near the top for you:

> **L1 Get Started here using AI, click the L1 ID below**

This is your starting point — a top-level **Portfolio (L1)** that runs from today for about six months. You don't have to create anything first; just use it to launch the AI.

> **Agilebars note:** Agilebars uses a simpler two-level structure and does **not** create this starter bar. Agilebars users begin at the Project level (see the Agilebars guide).

---

## 🖱️ The two things you click

Everything in Ask AI starts from a bar on the canvas:

1. **Click the bar's ID** (the little ID label/circle on the bar). This opens that bar's **status pop-up form**.
2. On that form, click the ✨ **sparkle icon** (the "Ask AI" button). This opens the **AI Create** dialog for that bar.

The AI Create dialog always knows **which bar you launched it from** — it shows the ID, name and level at the top — so anything it creates is placed correctly underneath that bar.

Some levels also have **named buttons** on the status form (for example **Resource Plan** or **Create Allocations**) that run a specific action directly. These are described below.

---

## 🧭 What AI Creates at Each Level

Think of your plan as a set of nested levels:

**Portfolio (L1) → Project (L2) → Work Package / Sub-Project (L3) → Task (L4) → Allocation (L5 — a person assigned to a task)**

You move down this ladder one step at a time. At each step you click the bar's ID, click the ✨ sparkle icon, and tell the AI what you want.

---

### 1️⃣ From a Portfolio (L1): create a Project

This is where most people begin, using the **Get Started** bar.

1. Click the **ID** of the Portfolio bar, then click the ✨ **sparkle icon**.
2. In the big text box, describe the project. You can:
    - paste in a **Business Case** — formal (with headings) or rough — and the AI maps it into the Project Charter fields, or
    - simply type a **project name and a short description**, plus any background you have.
3. Optional tick-boxes:
    - **Fill in Project Charter fields with AI** — after the project is created, the AI also enriches its Project Charter fields (value proposition, benefits, success criteria, and so on).
    - **Create a Resource Plan** — the AI adds one **"Resource Plan"** task with **generic role placeholders** for the kinds of people the project will need (see *Resource Plan*

below).
4. Click **Create**.

**Result:** one new **Project (L2)** appears under your Portfolio as a **New** initiative, with its Project Charter fields filled from your Business Case. Anything the AI cannot map to a specific field is preserved under headings in **Management Notes** (`tbMDNotes`) so nothing is lost.

> 💡 The more you tell it — scope, goals, timeline, budget, who is involved — the more specific and useful the result.

---

### 2️⃣ From a Project (L2): create Work Packages, Tasks and Milestones

1. Click the **ID** of the Project bar, then the ✨ **sparkle icon**.
2. Describe how the project should be broken down (for example: *"Break this into a design phase, a build phase, and a testing phase"*). If you are not specific, the AI uses sensible project-management judgment.
3. Optional tick-box:
   - **Assign people to the Tasks (Human resources)** — after the Tasks are created, the AI also assigns the best-fit **real person** from your Resource Pool to each Task (see *Assigning people* below).
4. Click **Create**.

**Result:** new **Work Packages (Sub-Projects, L3)** are created under the Project, each containing the **Tasks (L4)** and **Milestones** needed.

**Also on the Project status form:** a **Resource Plan** button. Click it any time to generate the generic-role Resource Plan on demand (handy if you didn't tick the box when the project was first created).

---

### 3️⃣ From a Work Package / Sub-Project (L3): create Tasks and Milestones

1. Click the **ID** of the Work Package bar, then the ✨ **sparkle icon**.
2. Describe the work in that package.
3. Optional tick-box:
   - **Create Allocations for the Tasks (assign people)** — the AI assigns a real person to each new Task.
4. Click **Create**.

**Result: Tasks (L4)** and **Milestones** are created under the Work Package (up to six tasks per package), optionally staffed with people.

**Also on the Work Package status form:** a **Create Allocations** button. Click it to staff the Work Package's **existing** Tasks with people — useful when you created the tasks earlier without ticking the "assign people" box. (If the Work Package has no tasks yet, the assistant will tell you to create tasks first.)

---

### 4️⃣ From a Task (L4): assign people to it

1. Click the **ID** of the Task bar, then the ✨ **sparkle icon**.
2. Describe the roles you need in plain words, for example:
    - *"Add a developer and a tester"*
    - *"I need a business analyst and a project manager"*
3. Click **Create**.

**Result:** the AI finds the matching people in your Resource Pool and adds them as **Allocations (L5)** under the Task. If you ask for "a developer," it includes every matching role (for example *Senior Developer* and *Web Developer*), one allocation each. New allocations always appear neatly **below the task**, so they are easy to see.

---

## 🧩 Two kinds of staffing: Resource Plan vs. Assigning People

It helps to know the difference between the two ways AI adds resources:

| | Resource Plan | Assign People / Create Allocations |
|---|---|---|
| **What it adds** | Generic **role placeholders** (e.g. "Project Manager", "R&D") | **Real, named people** from your Resource Pool |
| **Answers** | *What kinds of people will this project need?* | *Who specifically will do this work?* |
| **Where** | Portfolio "Create a Resource Plan" tick-box, or the **Resource Plan** button on a Project | "Assign people" tick-box at Project/Work Package level, the **Create Allocations** button, or the ✨ button on a Task |
| **Used when** | Early planning, before you know exact names | Detailed planning, staffing the actual work |

**Resource Plan** is for early estimating — it judges which roles the project needs and, if it is unsure, always includes a Project Manager and an R&D role. It never assigns specific named people.

**Assigning People** picks the best **named person** for each task by matching the task to each person's **role and skill**, and it checks that the person is not already over-committed. It keeps people sensibly loaded and will not pile work onto someone who is already very busy. If no suitable person is free, it drops in a generic role placeholder instead, so the task is never left empty without telling you.

### 🎛️ You control which roles a Resource Plan can use

A Resource Plan does not see your whole Generic resource list. It only sees Generic resources whose **Quantity is greater than zero**.

That gives you a simple lever. Roles that exist for reporting or org structure rather than for doing the work — governance boards, steering committees, management overhead — should be set to **Quantity 0** in the Shared Resource Pool. They stay in the pool and stay reportable, but the AI will never propose them as allocations.

| Quantity | Effect |
|---|---|
| **Greater than 0** | The role is real capacity — the AI can plan with it, and it counts towards supply in the Supply and Demand grids |
| **0** | The role is invisible to planning — never proposed, never counted as capacity |

Two things follow from this, and they are the usual surprises:

- **The AI keeps proposing managers you did not want.** Do not rewrite the prompt — set those roles to Quantity 0 and generate again
- **A role you expected never appears.** It is almost certainly sitting at Quantity 0. Give it a quantity and it becomes available

Keeping the quantities honest is the resource pool manager's job, and it is the single highest-value thing you can do for the quality of AI resource plans.

---

## 📋 While the AI Works

When you click **Create**, the dialog shows a **running progress log** — gathering context, calling the AI, creating each row — and finishes with a short **summary** of what was created (and a note of anything it adjusted or skipped). If a step has a problem, it is clearly flagged, and any work that did succeed is kept.

When it is done, **refresh the page (F5)** to see the new bars on your timeline.

---

## 💡 Tips for Great Results

### ✅ Do:

- Give the AI real context — paste a Business Case, scope notes, or a solid description.
- Mention timelines, budgets, key phases, and who is involved when you know them.
- Work **top-down**: create the Project first, then break it into Work Packages and Tasks, then assign people.
- Keep a healthy **Resource Pool** (named people with roles, skills, rates and availability) so staffing has good people to choose from.

### ❌ Avoid:

- One-word requests like *"make a project"* — you'll get a generic result.
- Expecting people to be assigned if your Resource Pool is empty — add resources first.

---

## 🆘 The Ask AI Help Assistant

The **Ask AI** button on the main menu (and on the canvas toolbar) opens the **Help Assistant** — a chat window where you can ask questions about how to use the app, such as *"How do I create a baseline?"* or *"How do resource charts work?"*. It answers from the official product documentation for your edition (Agilebars, Timebars or Costbars).

- Type your question and press **Ask** (or press Enter).

- Use **Clear** to start a fresh conversation.
- Click the ✕ to close it.

The welcome message shows how many help files were loaded for your edition. The assistant reads the common guides (including the Administrators Guide) plus your product's User Guide. The *Complete Reference Guides* are left out on purpose: they repeat the same content.

---

## 🐛 Troubleshooting

**"I clicked Create but nothing appears on the canvas."** Refresh the page (F5). New bars show after a reload.

**"No people were assigned to my tasks."** Your Resource Pool may have no suitable **named (Human) resources**. Add people with roles and skills, then use the **Create Allocations** button on the Work Package, or the ✨ button on a Task.

**"The Help Assistant says some documentation files could not be loaded."** It names the files it could not fetch. The assistant still works, but it can't answer from those files. Refresh the page; if the warning stays, tell your administrator, as the help files are missing from the installed version.

**"The tasks don't quite match what I wanted."** Give more detail — name the phases, deliverables or roles you expect — and try again on the same bar.

**"I don't see the Get Started bar."** It only appears on an **empty** Timebars or Costbars canvas (when there are no Portfolios yet). Agilebars does not use it. If you already have bars, just use the ✨ button on any existing bar.

---

**Ready to build your plan? Click an ID, click the ✨ sparkle, and tell the AI what you need. 🚀**

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# Part 8 — Supply and Demand Grids

## Timebars/Costbars Supply and Demand Grids User Guide

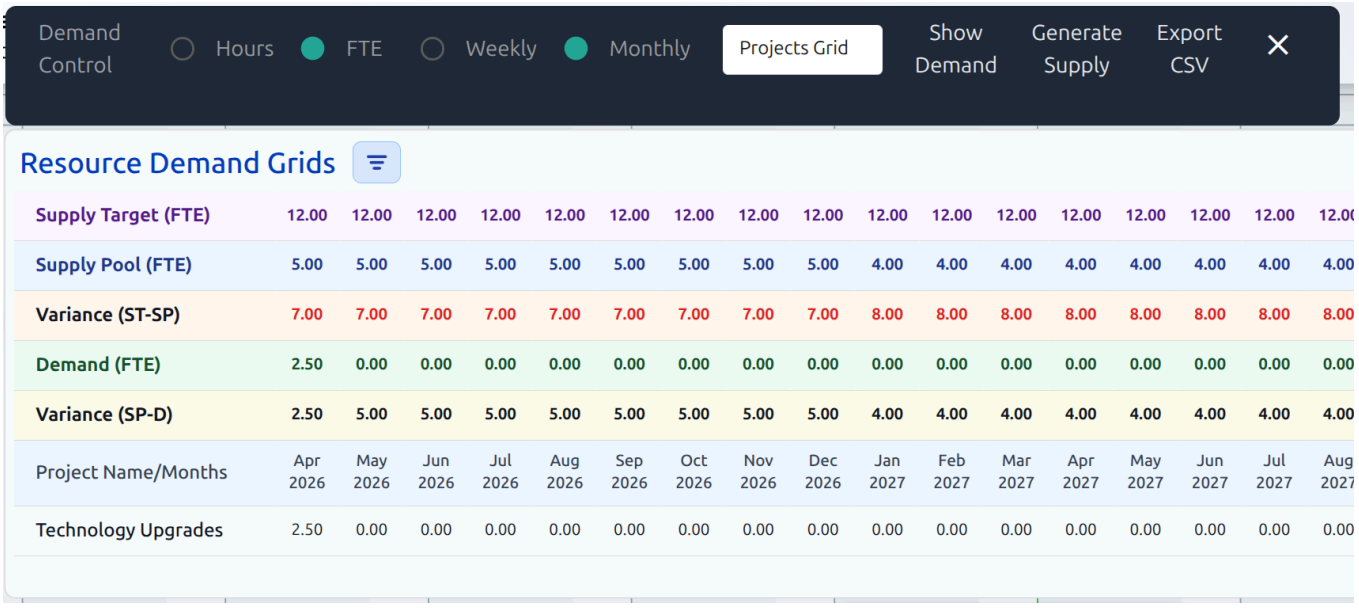
### Table of Contents


- Overview
- Purpose and Use Cases
- The Five Summary Rows
- View Modes and Configurations
- Primary Roles: Named and Generic Resources


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### Overview

The Supply vs Demand grid is a strategic resource management tool that provides visibility into resource capacity planning and allocation across projects. It enables resource managers and project managers to identify capacity gaps, prevent over-allocation, and make informed decisions about resource assignments and hiring needs.




| Supply Target (FTE) | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Supply Pool (FTE) | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 |
| Variance (ST-SP) | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 |
| Demand (FTE) | 2.50 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 |
| Variance (SP-D) | 2.50 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 |
| Project Name/Months | Apr 2026 | May 2026 | Jun 2026 | Jul 2026 | Aug 2026 | Sep 2026 | Oct 2026 | Nov 2026 | Dec 2026 | Jan 2027 | Feb 2027 | Mar 2027 | Apr 2027 | May 2027 | Jun 2027 | Jul 2027 | Aug 2027 |
| Technology Upgrades | 2.50 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 |

### Purpose and Use Cases

#### What Are Supply and Demand Grids?

**Supply** represents the available capacity of resources in your organization - the total FTE (Full-Time Equivalent) or hours that resources can work based on their employment contracts, calendars, and availability.

**Demand** represents the actual resource requirements from project allocations - how much capacity is being consumed by tasks and projects that resources are assigned to.

### Why Do We Need These Grids?

The gap between supply and demand reveals critical resource management issues:

- **Over-allocation**: When demand exceeds supply, resources are over-committed and projects are at risk
- **Under-utilization**: When supply exceeds demand, you have unused capacity that could be deployed
- **Future capacity planning**: Identifying when you'll need to hire, train, or contract additional resources
- **Portfolio decisions**: Understanding if you have capacity to take on new projects

### Who Uses These Grids?

**Resource Managers** use these grids to:

- Balance workloads across the organization
- Identify hiring needs 3-6 months in advance
- Resolve resource conflicts and over-allocations
- Optimize resource utilization rates

**Project Managers** use these grids to:

- Understand if sufficient resources are available for their projects
- Plan project schedules based on resource availability
- Request additional resources when gaps are identified
- Adjust project timelines when resources are over-committed

**Portfolio Managers** use these grids to:

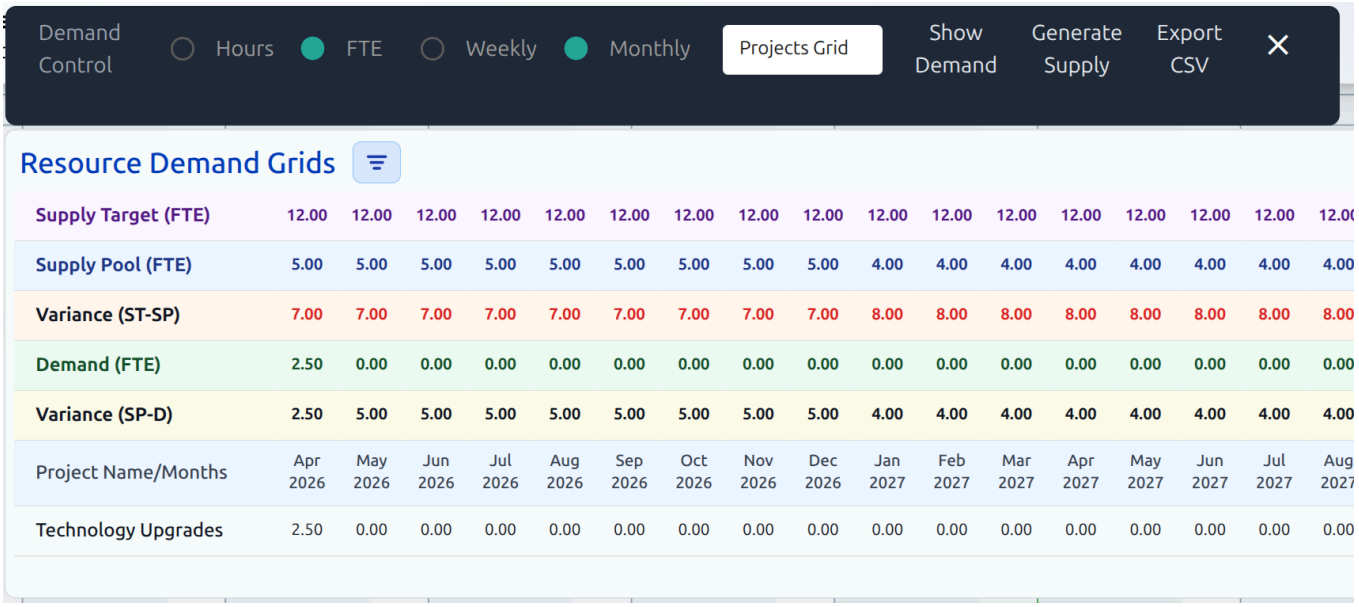
- Assess organizational capacity for new work
- Make go/no-go decisions on project proposals
- Prioritize projects based on resource constraints
- Plan strategic initiatives around resource availability

**Executive Leadership** uses these grids to:

- Make hiring and budgeting decisions
- Understand organizational capacity at a high level
- Evaluate departmental utilization and productivity
- Align business strategy with resource capacity

## The Five Summary Rows

At the top of the Resource Demand Grids, five critical rows provide aggregated metrics:




| | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Supply Target (FTE) | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 | 12.00 |
| Supply Pool (FTE) | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 |
| Variance (ST-SP) | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 7.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.00 |
| Demand (FTE) | 2.50 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 |
| Variance (SP-D) | 2.50 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 5.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 | 4.00 |
| Project Name/Months | Apr 2026 | May 2026 | Jun 2026 | Jul 2026 | Aug 2026 | Sep 2026 | Oct 2026 | Nov 2026 | Dec 2026 | Jan 2027 | Feb 2027 | Mar 2027 | Apr 2027 | May 2027 | Jun 2027 | Jul 2027 | Aug 2027 |
| Technology Upgrades | 2.50 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 |

### 1. Supply Target (FTE) (First Row)

**What it shows**: Total available resource capacity across all Generic Resources

**Data source**:

- Sourced from the `tbResources` store (resource pool)
- Fields:??
- Each Role has monthly FTE availability defined automatically calculated using tbResQuantity

**Example**: ??

**Timing considerations**:

- This allows forward planning for known hiring or departures

### 2. Supply Pool (FTE) (Second Row)

**What it shows**: Total available resource capacity across all resources in the pool

**Data source**:

- Sourced from the `tbResources` store (resource pool)
- Fields: `tbResMonth1` through `tbResMonth24`
- Each resource has monthly FTE availability defined (typically 1.0 for full-time)
- Sums ALL resources regardless of the groupBy selection

**Example**: If you have 6 full-time resources (1.0 FTE each), the supply shows 6.0 FTE per month

**Timing considerations**:

- Resource start dates ( `tbResStart` ) are factored in - new hires only contribute from their start month

- Resource finish dates (`tbResFinish`) are factored in - departing resources stop contributing
- This allows forward planning for known hiring or departures

### 3. Variance (ST - SP) (Third Row)

**What it shows**: ???

### 4. Demand (FTE) Row - Green Background

**What it shows**: Total resource requirements from all project allocations

**Data source**:

- Calculated from the `tbResCalcsUsage` store
- Generated by aggregating task allocations across all projects
- Fields: `tbResCalcMonth1` through `tbResCalcMonth32`
- Respects the groupBy filter - only sums demand for the filtered resources/projects/roles

**Calculation process**:

1. Task allocations are split into monthly buckets (via `splitAllocHoursMonthly`)
2. Each task's total work is distributed across its duration
3. Work hours per day are calculated: `totalWork / numberOfWorkDays`
4. Monthly hours are summed for each resource
5. Converted to FTE: `monthlyHours / (8 hours/day × 20 work days/month)`

### 5. Variance (S-D) Row - Yellow Background

**What it shows**: The difference between Supply and Demand (Supply minus Demand)

**Color coding**:

- **Green text** (positive variance): You have excess capacity - resources are under-utilized
- **Red text** (negative variance): You have a capacity deficit - resources are over-allocated

**Strategic interpretation**:

- Small negative variance (< 0.2 FTE): Minor over-allocation, manageable with overtime
- Large negative variance (> 0.5 FTE): Serious capacity problem, need to hire or delay projects
- Consistent positive variance: Opportunity to take on more work or reduce headcount

### 6. Month Header Row - Gray Background

**What it shows**: The calendar months for each column

**Format**: "MMM YYYY" (e.g., "Sep 2025", "Oct 2025")

**Start date**: Begins with the `apStatusDate` from the Admin Panel configuration

- This is typically set to the current month or the project baseline date

- Allows historical analysis by setting status date in the past
- Enables future planning by projecting 24+ months forward

### 7. Resource/Project/Role Header Row - White Background

**What it shows**: The first column header, which changes based on groupBy:

- "Resource ID/Owner" when grouping by ResourceName
- "Project Name" when grouping by Project
- "Role" when grouping by Role

## View Modes and Configurations

### FTE vs Hours Toggle

**FTE (Full-Time Equivalent)**:

- Standard view for strategic planning
- 1.0 FTE = one full-time resource for one month
- Easier to understand capacity at a glance
- Recommended for executive reporting and high-level planning

**Hours**:

- Detailed view for tactical planning
- Shows actual work hours (e.g., 160 hours/month for 1.0 FTE)
- Useful for detailed project scheduling
- Helps with billing and time-tracking analysis

**Conversion formula**:

```
FTE = Hours / (Calendar hours per day × Working days per period)

For monthly:
FTE = Hours / (8 hours/day × 20 days/month) = Hours / 160

For weekly:
FTE = Hours / (8 hours/day × 5 days/week) = Hours / 40
```

**Note**: Supply totals are always calculated in FTE from the resource pool, then converted to hours if needed. The conversion uses: `Hours = FTE × 8 × 21` (assuming 21 working days per month).

### Weekly vs Monthly Toggle

**Monthly View**:

- Displays resource capacity and demand by calendar month
- Better for long-term strategic planning (6-24 months out)
- Smooths out weekly variations
- Recommended for portfolio planning and hiring decisions

- Supply and demand totals are shown

**Weekly View**:

- Displays resource capacity and demand by work week (Monday-Friday)
- Better for short-term tactical planning (1-3 months out)
- Shows week-to-week fluctuations
- Useful for identifying specific bottleneck weeks
- Currently does NOT show supply/demand totals (demand data only)

**Why monthly is preferred for supply/demand analysis**:

- Resource supply data is typically managed monthly (hiring, contracts)
- Weekly granularity creates noise in capacity planning
- Monthly aligns with financial planning and reporting cycles

### Group By Options

The groupBy selection controls how demand rows are organized, but does NOT affect supply totals.

### Group By: Project

**Use case**: Understanding capacity allocated to each project

**What you see**:

- One row per project showing demand
- Supply row shows total capacity across ALL resources
- Variance shows if organization has capacity for all projects combined

**Strategic questions answered**:

- Which projects are consuming the most resources?
- Do we have enough capacity for all active projects?
- Can we take on a new project without hiring?

**Example scenario**: You have 3 projects (CRM Migration, ERP Upgrade, Website Redesign). The grid shows how much FTE each project demands per month, and whether your total resource pool can support all three simultaneously.

### Group By: Resource Name

**Use case**: Monitoring individual resource utilization

**What you see**:

- One row per named resource (e.g., "Joe Invent", "Ally HR")
- Each row shows that resource's project allocations
- Supply row still shows organizational total (all resources)

**Strategic questions answered**:

- Which individuals are over-allocated?
- Who has available capacity for new work?
- Are workloads balanced across the team?

**Example scenario**: Joe Invent shows 1.2 FTE demand in March (over-allocated by 20%), while Julia Finance shows 0.6 FTE (has 40% available capacity). You can rebalance by moving some of Joe's work to Julia.

### Group By: Role

**Use case**: Understanding capacity by job function or skillset

**What you see**:

- One row per role (e.g., "Developer", "Engineer", "Finance SME")
- Shows aggregated demand for all resources in that role
- Critical for skills-based capacity planning

**Strategic questions answered**:

- Do we have enough developers vs. testers?
- Which role is the bottleneck in our organization?
- Should we hire for a specific skillset?

**Example scenario**: Your "Developer" role shows 3.5 FTE demand but you only have 3.0 FTE supply of developers. You need to hire an additional 0.5 FTE developer (potentially a contractor) or delay some development work.

## Primary Roles: Named and Generic Resources

The system supports two types of resources that work together for flexible capacity planning:

### Named Resources (Humans)

**What they are**: Individual people with specific identities

**Characteristics**:

- `tbResLabourType: "Human"`
- Unique identifier: `tbResID` (e.g., "700", "701", "702")
- Named individuals: "Joe Invent", "Ally HR", "Julia Finance"
- Assigned a Primary Role: "R&D", "HR SME", "Finance SME"
- Quantity is typically 1

**Why we need them**:

- Track specific people's workloads and allocations
- Manage vacation, training, and individual availability
- Support performance management and utilization reporting

- Enable skills-based assignment to tasks

**Primary Role assignment**: Each named resource is assigned one Primary Role (e.g., Joe Invent has Primary Role = "R&D"). This:

- Categorizes the resource by function for reporting
- Enables role-based filtering and grouping
- Supports career development and succession planning
- Allows comparison of individuals within the same role

### Generic Resources

**What they are**: Placeholder resources representing a pool of similar workers

**Characteristics**:

- `tbResLabourType: "Generic"`
- Role-based identifier: `tbResID` (e.g., "800", "818", "830")
- Generic names matching the role: "R&D", "HR SME", "Finance SME"
- Assigned a Primary Role that matches the resource name
- Quantity can be > 1 (e.g., "2" means 2 FTE of this role)

**Why we need them**:

- Early project planning before specific people are assigned
- Representing contractor pools or offshore teams
- Capacity planning when you don't know who specifically will do the work
- Future hiring - you know you need "3 developers" but haven't hired them yet

**How quantity works**: If Generic Resource "Developer" has `tbResQuantity: "2"` and `tbResMonth1: "2.00"`, this means:

- You have 2.0 FTE of developer capacity available
- This could represent 2 full-time developers
- Or 4 half-time developers
- Or any combination totaling 2.0 FTE

### Why Have Both Named and Generic?

This dual approach supports the full project lifecycle:

**Early Planning Phase**:

- Use generic resources ("we need 2 developers and 1 tester")
- Estimate capacity needs without knowing specific people
- Justify hiring or budget requests

**Assignment Phase**:

- Replace generic allocations with named resources
- Assign Joe, Chris, and John to specific tasks
- Track actual people doing the work

**Capacity Planning**:

- Generic resources fill the gap between demand and available named resources
- If named resources show 4.5 FTE demand but only 4.0 FTE supply, the 0.5 FTE gap might be filled by generic "Developer" resource (representing a contractor)

**Reporting Flexibility**:

- Group by Resource Name: See named resources only
- Group by Role: See combined named + generic resources by function
- Supply totals: Includes both named and generic for total capacity

### Primary Role in Generic Resources

Generic resources have their Primary Role set to match their name:

- Resource Name: "Developer" → Primary Role: "Developer"
- Resource Name: "R&D" → Primary Role: "R&D"

This ensures that when grouping by Role, both named resources with that role AND the generic resource pool for that role are aggregated together, giving a complete picture of capacity for that function.

---

# Part 9 — Text Notifications

## Text Notifications User Guide

Timebars Ltd. products — Agilebars, Timebars, and Costbars — include an automated notification system that alerts portfolio and project managers when projects require attention. Notifications are delivered to your phone via the **Pushover** app. An optional SMS escalation channel (Costbars only) is available via Twilio for executive-level alerts.

The system evaluates your in-progress projects automatically every four hours and sends a push notification when your configured thresholds are met. You can also trigger a notification at any time from the admin panel — for example, immediately after publishing a new dataset.

> **Which products support notifications?** All three products — Agilebars (AB), Timebars (TB), and Costbars (CB) — support push notifications. The number of conditions evaluated and the available threshold settings differ by product. Costbars includes the full five-scenario evaluation and optional SMS escalation. See How the System Evaluates Projects for details.

> **This document has two parts. Part 1** is the user guide — setting up Pushover, creating a notification configuration, choosing thresholds and testing them. **Part 2 — Technical Reference** covers the server side: environment variables, authentication, API security, cron scheduling and Strapi integration. Part 2 is for system administrators and developers; a portfolio manager never needs it.

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# Part 1 — Using Notifications

## Overview

The notification system works in three stages:

1. **Evaluate** — The system reads your in-progress projects and checks them against the thresholds you have configured.
2. **Gate** — Before sending, the system checks timing rules: business hours, quiet hours, cooldown period, and daily send limits.
3. **Send** — If at least one project triggers an alert and all timing gates pass, a push notification is sent to the manager's phone via Pushover.

You manage all of this from the **Notifications** page in the admin panel at `/admin/notifications`.

---

## Preparing Your Projects for Notifications

Before notifications can fire, two things must be true about each project record, and the relevant metadata fields must be populated. The notification engine silently skips projects that do not meet the prerequisites.

### Prerequisites — every product

| Requirement | Field | Value |
|---|---|---|
| Must be a project-type bar | `tbType` | `Project` |
| Must be actively in progress | `tbMDStatus` | `In progress` (exact match, case-sensitive) |

Tasks, milestones, allocations, and projects with any other status (e.g., Complete, On Hold) are not evaluated.

### Fields the engine reads — by product

The engine reads these metadata fields from your project records. Empty fields are not neutral — each has a default behaviour that may trigger an alert.

**Agilebars — 2 fields:**

| Field | Form label | Pick-list values | Empty treated as |
|---|---|---|---|
| `tbMDHealthOverall` | Health Overall | Red, Yellow, Green | **Red** (triggers) |
| `tbMDSeniorLevelCommitment` | Senior Level Commitment | Full, Strong, Moderate, Limited, Not Clear, Not Assessed | **Moderate** (triggers) |

**Timebars — 3 fields (includes the 2 above, plus):**

| Field | Form label | Pick-list values | Empty treated as |
|---|---|---|---|
| `tbMDRiskVsSizeAndComplexity` | Risk Vs Size And Complexity | 0–10 Very Small and Simple … 91–100 Extremely Complex and Risky | **Score 51+** (triggers) |

**Costbars — 5 scenarios (includes the 3 above, plus):**

| Field | Form label | Notes | Used in scenario |
|---|---|---|---|
| `tbMDPriorityStrategic` | Strategic Priority | Numeric score — higher = more critical | 1, 2, 4, 5 |
| `tbCost` | Actual Cost | Current actual cost spend | 4 (Budget Overrun) |
| `tbBudgetCost` | Budget Cost | Approved budget | 4 (Budget Overrun) |
| `tbWork` | Actual Work (hours) | Current actual hours | 5 (Work Overrun) |
| `blWork` | Baseline Work (hours) | Baseline hours snapshot | 5 (Work Overrun) |
| `tbMDEscalationLevel` | Escalation Level | Set to `Executives` to trigger SMS escalation | SMS only |

> **Tip — force a test result:** Set Health Overall = Green, Senior Level Commitment = Not Assessed, and (for TB/CB) Risk = 0–10 Very Small and Simple on a test project. These are the most permissive values and will match against almost any notification threshold, making it easy to verify the system end-to-end.

---

## Setting Up Pushover on Your Phone

Pushover is a third-party push notification service used to deliver alerts to your phone. It has a one-time cost of approximately $5 USD and includes a free 30-day trial.

### Step 1 — Install and create an account

1. Install **Pushover** from the App Store (iOS) or Google Play (Android).
2. Create an account at pushover.net or directly within the app.

### Step 2 — Get your User Key

After logging in to pushover.net, your **User Key** is displayed on the home dashboard in the top section. Copy it — this is your `PUSHOVER_USER_KEY`.

### Step 3 — Create an App Token

1. In pushover.net, go to **Your Applications → Create an Application / API Token**.
2. Give it a name such as `Timebars PPM`.
3. Copy the **API Token** — this is your `PUSHOVER_APP_TOKEN`.

### Step 4 — Confirm the keys are in your environment

Your system administrator will have added these two values to the server's environment configuration file:

```
PUSHOVER_APP_TOKEN=    ← From pushover.net → Your Applications → API Token
PUSHOVER_USER_KEY=     ← From pushover.net → Home dashboard, top section
```

Once these are in place, notifications can be sent. You can verify the connection is working from the Testing section before creating your first configuration.

---

## Creating a Notification Configuration

Navigate to `/admin/notifications` and click **Add Notification** (or the **+** button). The form has four tabs.

### Tab 1 — Basic

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| Manager Name | The name of the person who will receive this notification |
| Phone | Manager's phone number (used for SMS escalation if enabled) |
| Email | Manager's email address |
| Timezone | The manager's local timezone — used for business hours and quiet hours calculations |
| Order | Select the product licence order this config belongs to |
| Active | Toggle to **ON** to enable this notification config |

### Tab 2 — Preferences

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| Primary Channel | Set to **push** to use Pushover. (SMS is the escalation channel, not the primary channel.) |
| Business Hours Only | If enabled, notifications are only sent between 09:00 and 17:00 in the manager's timezone |
| Send on Weekends | If disabled, notifications are skipped on Saturday and Sunday |
| Quiet Hours Start / End | Times during which notifications are suppressed (e.g., 22:00–07:00) |
| Cooldown (hours) | Minimum hours between notifications for this manager. Set to a low value (e.g., 1 hour) during initial testing. |
| Daily Limit | Maximum number of notifications per day for this manager |

### Tab 3 — Thresholds

The fields shown on this tab depend on your product licence. See How the System Evaluates Projects for a full explanation of each threshold.

#### Agilebars (AB) — 2 fields:

| Field | Options | Default |
|---|---|---|
| Overall Health Threshold | Green, Yellow, Red | Red |
| Senior Level Commitment Threshold | Full, Strong, Moderate, Limited, Not Clear, Not Assessed | Moderate |

#### Timebars (TB) — 3 fields:

| Field | Options | Default |
|---|---|---|
| Overall Health Threshold | Green, Yellow, Red | Red |
| Senior Level Commitment Threshold | Full, Strong, Moderate, Limited, Not Clear, Not Assessed | Moderate |
| Risk / Size / Complexity Threshold | 0–10 Very Small and Simple … 91–100 Extremely Complex and Risky | 51–60 Significant Complexity |

#### Costbars (CB) — 5 fields:

| Field | Options | Default |
|---|---|---|
| Overall Health Threshold | Green, Yellow, Red | Red |
| Senior Level Commitment Threshold | Full, Strong, Moderate, Limited, Not Clear, Not Assessed | Moderate |
| Risk / Size / Complexity Threshold | 0–10 Very Small and Simple … 91–100 Extremely Complex and Risky | 51–60 Significant Complexity |
| Strategic Value Threshold | Numeric (e.g., 50) | 50 |
| Budget Overrun % Threshold | Numeric percentage (e.g., 10) | 10 |
| Work Hours Overrun % Threshold | Numeric percentage (e.g., 20) | 20 |

### Choosing your threshold values

Each threshold answers "how bad does this have to get before I want to hear about it?" The defaults are a reasonable starting point; these are the questions each one is really asking:

| Threshold | What it watches | A worked example |
|---|---|---|
| **Overall Health** | the project's rolled-up health indicator | set to **Red** to hear only about projects already in trouble; **Yellow** to catch them earlier |
| **Senior Level Commitment** | the recorded level of executive support | set to **Moderate** to be told when sponsorship is drifting below solid backing |
| **Risk / Size / Complexity** | the project's risk and complexity score | set to **51–60** to ignore small, simple projects and hear only about substantial ones |
| **Strategic Value** | the strategic score from portfolio analysis | set to **50** so a high-value project in difficulty reaches you ahead of a low-value one |
| **Budget Overrun %** | forecast cost against budget | set to **10** to be told when a project passes 10% over |
| **Work Hours Overrun %** | forecast hours against budgeted hours | set to **20** to allow more tolerance on effort than on money |

Remember the chain-of-values rule: a threshold is not an exact match. Setting Overall Health to **Yellow** catches Yellow **and** Red, because the check climbs toward the most critical end of the scale.

**Start loose, then tighten.** Set generous thresholds first, watch what actually arrives over a reporting cycle or two, and tighten from there. Thresholds that are too tight produce silence, which reads exactly like a system that is not working; thresholds that are too loose produce noise, and a manager who stops reading the alerts. Both failures are quiet, which is why the dry run below matters.

### Tab 4 — Escalation

Escalation is a Costbars-only feature that sends an SMS via Twilio in addition to the Pushover notification. See Escalation — SMS for Costbars. For Agilebars and Timebars, leave escalation off.

---

## How the System Evaluates Projects

The system reads all projects in your published dataset where `Status = In progress` and evaluates each one against your notification configuration. The logic applied depends on your product licence.

### The Chain-of-Values Rule

All categorical threshold comparisons use a **chain-of-values** model. Rather than checking for an exact match, the system checks whether a project's value is **at or beyond the threshold you set**, climbing toward the most critical end of the scale.

**Overall Health** — climbs toward Red (worst):

| Threshold you set | Fires for these project health values |
|---|---|
| Green | Green, Yellow, Red |
| Yellow | Yellow, Red |
| Red | Red only |

An empty health field on a project is treated as **Red**.

**Senior Level Commitment** — climbs toward Full (strongest):

| Threshold you set | Fires for these project commitment values |
|---|---|
| Not Assessed | Not Assessed, Not Clear, Limited, Moderate, Strong, Full |
| Not Clear | Not Clear, Limited, Moderate, Strong, Full |
| Limited | Limited, Moderate, Strong, Full |
| Moderate | Moderate, Strong, Full |
| Strong | Strong, Full |
| Full | Full only |

An empty commitment field on a project is treated as **Moderate**.

**Risk / Size / Complexity** — climbs toward higher complexity:

Each label maps to a numeric score. The system fires when a project's score is **greater than or equal to** the score of your configured threshold.

| Label | Score |
|---|---|
| Not Assessed | 0 |
| 0–10 Very Small and Simple | 10 |
| 11–20 Small and Straightforward | 20 |
| 21–30 Medium with Some Complexity | 30 |
| 31–40 Large with Moderate Complexity | 40 |
| 41–50 Complex but Manageable | 50 |
| 51–60 Significant Complexity | 60 |
| 61–70 Large and Complex | 70 |
| 71–80 Very Large and Complex | 80 |
| 81–90 Highly Complex and Risky | 90 |
| 91–100 Extremely Complex and Risky | 100 |

An empty risk field on a project is treated as triggering (score 51+).

---

### Agilebars — 2-Condition Check

A notification fires when **both** conditions are true for the same in-progress project:

1. The project's **Overall Health** is at or beyond your configured health threshold (climbing toward Red).
2. The project's **Senior Level Commitment** is at or above your configured commitment threshold (climbing toward Full).

> **Example:** You configure Health = Yellow and Commitment = Moderate. The system will send a notification for any in-progress project where health is Yellow **or** Red, **and** commitment is Moderate, Strong, **or** Full — both must be true simultaneously.

---

### Timebars — 3-Condition Check

A notification fires when **all three** conditions are true for the same in-progress project:

1. The project's **Overall Health** is at or beyond your configured health threshold.
2. The project's **Senior Level Commitment** is at or above your configured commitment threshold.
3. The project's **Risk / Size / Complexity** score is greater than or equal to the score of your configured risk threshold.

> **Example:** You configure Health = Yellow, Commitment = Moderate, Risk = 51–60 Significant Complexity (score 60). A notification fires for any in-progress project where health is Yellow or Red, **and** commitment is Moderate or higher, **and** risk score is ≥ 60.

---

### Costbars — 5-Scenario Check

Costbars evaluates five independent scenarios against every in-progress project. A notification fires if **any one** scenario triggers.

| # | Scenario | Fires when |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Critical High-Value Project** | Health is at or beyond your health threshold **AND** strategic value exceeds your strategic value threshold |
| 2 | **Missing Strategic Data** | Health is at or beyond threshold **AND** strategic value field is blank **AND** risk score ≥ your risk threshold |
| 3 | **Missing Health Status** | Health field is blank **AND** commitment is at or above your commitment threshold **AND** risk score ≥ your risk threshold |
| 4 | **Budget Overrun** | Actual cost exceeds budget by more than your budget overrun % **AND** the project is high-value (strategic value ≥ threshold) |
| 5 | **Work Hours Overrun** | Actual hours exceed baseline hours by more than your work overrun % **AND** the project is high-value |

The notification message you receive identifies which scenario(s) triggered and which project(s) were flagged.

> **SMS escalation note:** If escalation is enabled on your configuration and a flagged project has its `Escalation Level` field set to `Executives`, an SMS is sent in addition to the Pushover notification. See Escalation — SMS for Costbars.

---

## When Notifications Are Sent

### Automated Schedule

The system runs an automated check every **four hours**, around the clock. Each run evaluates all active notification configurations against your published dataset. If a configuration's timing gates pass and projects are flagged, a notification is sent.

### On-Publish Notifications

When you publish a dataset from any of the three client apps, the system can trigger an **immediate** notification check — bypassing the four-hour schedule. This is useful for ensuring managers are alerted as soon as new data is available.

On-publish notifications bypass business hours and quiet hours checks. Cooldown and daily limit rules still apply to prevent duplicate sends on rapid re-publishes.

> **Note:** On-publish notifications require no additional configuration. They are triggered automatically when you publish, provided you have an active notification configuration set up.

### Timing Gates

Before any notification is sent during an automated run, the system checks each manager's configuration against the following gates in order:

| Gate | What it checks |
|---|---|
| **Active** | The notification config must have Active set to ON |
| **Business hours** | If enabled, the current time must be between 09:00 and 17:00 in the manager's timezone |
| **Weekend block** | If weekends are disabled, the current day must be Monday–Friday |
| **Quiet hours** | The current time must be outside the configured quiet hours window |
| **Cooldown** | Sufficient hours must have passed since the last notification was sent to this manager |
| **Daily limit** | The manager must not have reached their configured maximum notifications for the current day |

If any gate fails, the notification is skipped for that run. Manual sends from the admin panel bypass all timing gates and send immediately.

---

## Escalation — SMS for Costbars

Costbars configurations include an optional SMS escalation channel. When enabled, any flagged project that has its `Escalation Level` metadata field set to `Executives` will trigger an SMS message in addition to the standard Pushover notification.

To configure escalation:

1. Open the notification configuration form and go to **Tab 4 — Escalation**.
2. Enable the escalation toggle.
3. Enter the **escalation phone number** to receive the SMS.

> **Important:** SMS escalation only fires when the flagged project's `tbMDEscalationLevel` field is set to `Executives`. Projects with other escalation level values receive the Pushover notification only. Agilebars and Timebars projects always receive Pushover only — the escalation level field is not used in those products.

---

## Testing Your Configuration

### Manual Dry Run

On the `/admin/notifications` page, scroll to the **Notification Testing & Message Generation** section and click **Run Manual Test**. This runs the full evaluation logic in your browser using your current project data and notification configurations. It shows:

- How many in-progress projects were found
- Which projects were flagged and which scenario or condition triggered
- The full notification message that would be sent
- Debug logs for each condition checked (click **Show Debug Logs**)

No notification is sent during a dry run. Data is not written to the server.

### Sending a Test Notification

If projects are flagged during the dry run, an **AdminNotificationSender** section appears below the results. Click **Send to [Manager Name]** to fire the actual Pushover notification immediately. This bypasses all timing gates and is intended for verifying that your Pushover keys and phone setup are working correctly.

> **Tip:** If you want to force a flagged result during testing, temporarily set permissive threshold values — for example, Health = Green (fires for all health values), Commitment = Not Assessed (fires for all), and a low risk or strategic value threshold. Remember to restore your intended thresholds after testing.

### Low-Level API Test

To confirm that Pushover itself is reachable (before configuring anything in the admin UI), your system administrator can run a direct test from the server:

```
curl -s \
  --form-string "token=YOUR_PUSHOVER_APP_TOKEN" \
  --form-string "user=YOUR_PUSHOVER_USER_KEY" \
  --form-string "message=Test from Timebars!" \
  --form-string "title=PPM Test" \
  https://api.pushover.net/1/messages.json
```

A successful response looks like: `{"status":1,"request":"..."}` and a push notification arrives on the phone within seconds.

---

### Best Practice

- **Run a dry run every time you change a threshold.** It costs nothing and tells you immediately whether the change did what you expected.
- **Start with looser thresholds** and tighten once you have seen real behaviour over a reporting cycle.
- **Keep a short cooldown while testing** (an hour), then raise it for live use so a manager is not alerted repeatedly about the same project.
- **Reserve executive escalation for genuinely high-impact projects.** An escalation channel that fires often stops being treated as an escalation.
- **Write down the thresholds you chose and why.** The numbers are easy to change and easy to forget, and the next person to look at them will want the reasoning, not just the values.

---

## Managing Notifications

All notification configurations for your licences are listed on `/admin/notifications`. From this page you can:

- **Add** a new notification configuration with the **+** button
- **Edit** an existing configuration by clicking on it
- **Toggle Active** on or off directly from the list to temporarily pause a configuration without deleting it
- **View the threshold summary** for each configuration at a glance — the list shows the key configured values by product

Multiple configurations can exist for the same order (for example, one per portfolio manager). Each fires independently based on its own thresholds and timing settings.

---

## Troubleshooting

| Symptom | What to check |
|---|---|
| No push notification received | Run the curl test in Low-Level API Test to verify your Pushover token and user key are valid |
| Pushover returns `status:0` | Your `PUSHOVER_APP_TOKEN` or `PUSHOVER_USER_KEY` is incorrect — check for typos or placeholder values |
| Dry run shows "No flagged projects" | Lower your thresholds temporarily (e.g., Health = Green) to verify the evaluator runs at all. Also confirm your projects have `Status = In progress`. |
| Notification was expected but not sent during automated run | Check Active = ON, verify the manager's timezone is correct, and review business hours / quiet hours / cooldown / daily limit settings |
| SMS not received (Costbars) | Confirm escalation is enabled on the config **and** that the flagged project's `Escalation Level` field is set to `Executives` |
| On-publish notification not received | Confirm cooldown has elapsed since the last send — on-publish sends still respect the cooldown setting |
| Admin panel shows a 500 error on the notifications page | Contact your system administrator — this typically indicates a missing server-side environment variable |

## Quick Reference — Fields by Product

| Field | Agilebars (AB) | Timebars (TB) | Costbars (CB) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Overall Health Threshold | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Senior Level Commitment Threshold | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Risk / Size / Complexity Threshold | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Strategic Value Threshold | — | — | ✓ |
| Budget Overrun % Threshold | — | — | ✓ |
| Work Hours Overrun % Threshold | — | — | ✓ |
| SMS Escalation | — | — | ✓ |
| Conditions evaluated | 2 | 3 | 5 scenarios |
| Automated check frequency | Every 4 hours | Every 4 hours | Every 4 hours |
| On-publish notification | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |

# Part 2 — Technical Reference

This part covers server-side configuration, authentication, API security, cron scheduling and Strapi integration. It is intended for **system administrators and developers**. Nothing in Part 1 requires it.

## Environment Variables

The following env vars must be set on the server:

```
PUSHOVER_APP_TOKEN=     # From pushover.net → Your Applications → API Token
PUSHOVER_USER_KEY=      # From pushover.net → Home dashboard, top section
NOTIFICATION_STRAPI_KEY # Used by the automated endpoint to fetch configs and project data
from Strapi (no user session needed — designed for cron use)
SYSTEM_ADMIN_EMAIL=     # The email whose active pubset is used to fetch project data for
automated runs
```

> **Note:** `PUSHOVER_API_URL` and `ORTHISURL` env vars are not used. The code hardcodes `https://api.pushover.net/1/messages.json` directly in `pushover.js` and `pushover/route.js`.

---

## Data Sources — How Projects Are Fetched

The automated notification route always fetches from the **`timebars` Strapi collection** (the pubset), filtering to the `SYSTEM_ADMIN_EMAIL`'s active pubset. It reads `tbmdjoined` rows and filters down to:

- `tbType === "Project"`
- `tbMDStatus === "In progress"`

Only those rows enter the evaluation engine. Projects that are not of type Project, or whose status is not exactly `"In progress"`, are silently skipped.

The notification configurations are fetched from the **`notifications`** Strapi collection, each linked to an **order** in the **`orders`** collection. The order carries the product licence (e.g., Agilebars Tier 2, Costbars Tier 1), and the system reads the `product_code` from that order to decide which evaluation logic to apply.

### Product code prefix convention

| Prefix | Product | Scenarios evaluated |
|---|---|---|
| `CB*` | Costbars | 5 scenarios |
| `TB*` | Timebars | 3-condition check |
| `AB*` | Agilebars | 2-condition check |

---

## Authentication Flow

When a user signs in, NextAuth runs a JWT callback (`app/auth/auth.js`) that performs two things beyond standard login:

1. Stores the Strapi JWT in the session (`session.jwt`) — used for all subsequent Strapi API calls.
2. Makes an extra call to Strapi to fetch two RBAC fields from the user record:
    - `primary_role` — determines admin access

- `customer_id` — organisation identifier for data scoping

These are then available on `session.user` throughout the app.

---

## Route Protection

| Route | Guard |
|---|---|
| `/admin` | Must be authenticated **AND** `primary_role === 'admin'` or email is the designated admin email |
| `/admin/notifications` | Must be authenticated only — **no role check** |

`/admin/notifications` is reachable by any logged-in user. The main `/admin` page is the harder gate.

---

## API Route Security

| Route | Protection |
|---|---|
| `POST /api/notifications/automated` | System-only — uses `NOTIFICATION_STRAPI_KEY` env var. No user session required. Designed for cron. |
| `GET/POST /api/notifications/pushover` | Requires `Authorization: Bearer <token>` header |
| `GET/POST /api/notifications/twilio` | **No auth check** — open if reachable |
| `POST /api/notifications/on-publish` | Validated via Strapi JWT token |

> **Note:** The Twilio route validates input but does not verify the caller's identity. As long as it is only called server-side from `AdminNotificationSender` this is acceptable in practice, but it could be called directly by anyone who knows the URL. Consider adding a bearer token check if the route becomes externally reachable.

---

## Strapi Collections

**`orders`** — stores purchases, each linked to a product and a user. Filtered by the `owner` field (email address) to scope to each user's licences.

When `/admin/notifications` loads, it calls `getMyOrders(email, jwt)` which hits:

```
GET /api/orders?populate[0]=product&populate[1]=user
    &filters[owner][$eq]={your-email}
```

Fields displayed from each order:

| UI label | Strapi field |
|---|---|
| Order name | `order.name` |

| UI label | Strapi field |
|---|---|
| Product name / code | `order.product.name` / `order.product.product_code` |
| Cost | `order.total` |
| Expiration | `order.expires_on` |
| Active status | `order.active_status` |

**`notifications`** — stores per-manager notification configurations, each linked back to an order by `order.id`. Multiple notification configs can exist per order (one per manager). Fields cover all thresholds, channels, quiet hours, cooldown, and daily limit settings.

---

## Strapi User Fields Required

Each user record in the Strapi `users` collection needs two custom fields:

| Field | Type | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| `primary_role` | String | Set to `'admin'` to grant `/admin` access |
| `customer_id` | String / Number | Organisation identifier for data scoping |

If `primary_role` is null or missing, the user passes the `/admin/notifications` check (authenticated only) but is redirected away from `/admin` itself.

---

## Automated Cron Job

The automated notification chain runs as a bash cron job on the production server.

### Chain of execution

```
cron job (server)
  └─ runs automate_pushover_twillio.sh
       └─ internal guard: exits if weekend or outside 09:00–18:00 server time
       └─ POST https://www.timebars.com/api/notifications/automated
            └─ fetches all active notification configs (via NOTIFICATION_STRAPI_KEY)
            └─ fetches all in-progress projects (via fetchProjectDataFromPubset)
            └─ calls evaluateInProgressProjects() ← scenarios run here
            └─ for each flagged manager:
                 checks timezone / quiet hours / cooldown / daily limit
                 sends Pushover (+ SMS if escalation conditions met)
                 updates last_notification_sent + notification_count_today in Strapi
```

### Script location and schedule

The script lives at `~/docker/tbwwwp/automate_pushover_twillio.sh` and is registered in root's crontab via `sudo crontab -e`.

**Recommended schedule — every 4 hours, any day:**

```
0 */4 * * * /home/jcox/docker/tbwwwp/automate_pushover_twillio.sh >> /var/log/ppm-notifications.log 2>&1
```

### Previous schedule — hourly, weekdays only:

```
0 6-23 * * 1-5 /home/jcox/docker/tbwwwp/automate_pushover_twillio.sh
```

> **Absolute path required:** `sudo crontab -e` registers in root's crontab, so `~/` expands to `/root/` not `/home/jcox/`. Always use the full path.

### Setup checklist

```
# Verify script exists and is executable
ls -la /home/jcox/docker/tbwwwp/automate_pushover_twillio.sh
chmod +x /home/jcox/docker/tbwwwp/automate_pushover_twillio.sh

# Create log file writable by root
sudo touch /var/log/ppm-notifications.log
sudo chmod 644 /var/log/ppm-notifications.log

# Verify cron registration
sudo crontab -l
```

---

## On-Publish Endpoint

`POST /api/notifications/on-publish` triggers an immediate notification check when users publish a dataset from any of the three client apps.

### Behaviour differences from automated runs

| Behaviour | Automated cron | On-publish |
|---|---|---|
| Business hours check | Applied | **Bypassed** |
| Quiet hours check | Applied | **Bypassed** |
| Cooldown | Applied | Applied (prevents duplicate sends on rapid re-publish) |
| Daily limit | Applied | Applied |
| Authentication | `NOTIFICATION_STRAPI_KEY` | Strapi JWT token |

### Deduplication

Two-layer deduplication prevents duplicate sends:

1. **In-memory cache** (per user per day) — fast, survives normal runtime restarts
2. **Strapi `last_notification_sent` field** — persistent, survives full server restarts

### Client integration

A reference integration snippet is at `app/admin/notifications/tbrunp-integration-snippet.js`. The design is fire-and-forget: notification failures never block or break the publish operation. Missing notification configs or no in-progress projects result in silent skips.

---

## Manual Test Button — What It Actually Does

The **Run Manual Test** button on `/admin/notifications` calls `evaluateInProgressProjects()` **directly in the browser** using project data and notification configs that were loaded server-side when the page rendered. It does not make any HTTP request and does not write to the server.

- Results and debug logs appear in the UI (Show Debug Logs button) and in the browser console (F12 → Console).
- The server log at `/var/log/ppm-notifications.log` is only written when the cron job fires the real API call.
- The **Send to [Manager]** buttons in `AdminNotificationSender` call the Pushover/Twilio routes directly and bypass the cron, timing gates, and cooldown/daily-limit counters entirely. They are intended for verifying that keys and phone setup work.

---

## Low-Level Connectivity Test

Before configuring anything in the admin UI, confirm Pushover is reachable from the server:

```
curl -s \
  --form-string "token=YOUR_PUSHOVER_APP_TOKEN" \
  --form-string "user=YOUR_PUSHOVER_USER_KEY" \
  --form-string "message=Test from Timebars!" \
  --form-string "title=PPM Test" \
  https://api.pushover.net/1/messages.json
```

A successful response: `{"status":1,"request":"..."}` — push arrives on the phone within seconds.

You can also test the app's own API route once the dev server is running:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3001/api/notifications/pushover \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"message":"Hello from Timebars","title":"PPM Test","priority":1}'
```

---

*Document version: 1.0 — 2026-05-07*

---

# Part 10 — Cloud Publishing

## Cloud Publishing and Bulk Operations Guide

**Applies to**: Agilebars, Timebars, Costbars **Version**: 2.3 **Last Updated**: 2026-09-26

---

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---

### 1. Overview

Cloud Publishing is an **optional feature** that allows you to securely upload your project data from the client applications (Agilebars, Timebars, or Costbars) to the Timebars Cloud. The Cloud Publishing page is the central hub for managing data between your local browser (IndexedDB) and the Timebars Cloud. From here you can:

- **Publish** your local project data to the cloud for sharing and dashboards
- **Download** a published dataset back into your local browser
- **Clear** published data from the cloud
- **Bulk Update** specific fields across multiple published datasets at once
- **Re-Publish** datasets with recalculated scheduling engine data
- **Sync** with OpenProject (external PM system)

Published datasets are called **Pubsets**. Each pubset is a complete snapshot of your project data stored in the cloud. The active pubset feeds your Personal Cloud Dashboard.

**Key Benefits:**

- **Cloud Dashboard Access**: View interactive reports and charts from any device
- **Cross-Device Sync**: Work on one device, continue on another
- **Data Backup**: Secure cloud storage for your project data

- **Team Collaboration**: Share data with stakeholders (requires individual licenses)
- **Real-Time Updates**: Publish changes instantly to the cloud

**Important Notes:**

- Publishing is entirely optional—client apps work fully offline
- Your local data remains in the browser unless you choose to publish
- Cloud Publishing requires an active subscription
- Data is encrypted during transmission (HTTPS/TLS)
- You must log in each session — credentials are not saved or persisted

---

## 2. Account Registration & Subscription

### Create an Account

1. **Register**: Visit www.timebars.com/register, provide your email address and create a secure password, then click "Register"
2. **Verify Email**: Check your email for the verification link and click it to confirm your account

### Choose a Subscription Plan

1. Navigate to www.timebars.com/pricing and review available subscription tiers
2. Select a plan based on your needs — you can purchase up to 10 PubSets depending on tier
3. Complete the credit card transaction; your license activates automatically
4. Log in at www.timebars.com/login to view subscription details and manage PubSets

**Subscription Includes:**

- Client application license (Agilebars, Timebars, or Costbars)
- Cloud Publishing capabilities
- Cloud Dashboard access
- Number of PubSets based on tier
- Technical support

---

## 3. Logging In to Timebars Cloud

### Steps

1. Navigate to the publishing page from the main menu (**Main Menu > Publish**)
2. You will land on the **Login** tab
3. Enter your **Email** and **Password**
4. Click **Cloud Login!**

### What Happens

- Your credentials are validated against the Timebars Cloud authentication service

- On success, a green message appears: *"Login successful! Your pubsets are loaded."*
- After 1 second the page switches to the **Pubsets** tab showing your datasets
- The Pubsets (Cards) and Pubsets (Table) tabs become visible

**Note:** The cloud login is a **secondary login** separate from your local app login, providing an additional security layer. Your data requires both local app login AND cloud login to access.

### Important Notes

- You must log in each session — credentials are not saved or persisted
- No cookies or tokens are stored between sessions
- If you try to access other tabs before logging in, you will be redirected back to the Login tab

---

## 4. Publishing Page Interface

### Tab Navigation

The publishing page has six tabs:

| Tab | Visible | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| **Login** | Always | Cloud authentication |
| **Pubsets (Cards)** | After login | Card-style view of your pubsets |
| **Pubsets** | After login | Table view with sorting and filtering |
| **OpenProject** | Tier-3 licenses only | Sync projects, bars and people with OpenProject (see section 11) |
| **Bulk Update** | Always | Bulk data operations across pubsets (an Administrator works across the whole customer — see section 12) |
| **Re-Publish** | Always | Download, recalculate, and republish (Administrator: whole customer — see section 13) |

**Tier-1 licenses** include no pubsets, so the Publish icons (main menu, canvas toolbar and the dashboard **Publish!** button) are hidden and the Publishing page is not available.

Click any tab button to switch. The active tab is highlighted with a blue underline.

### Top Navigation Bar

The blue navigation bar at the top of the publishing page provides quick actions:

| Button | Action |
|---|---|
| **Show License** | Displays your current license tier, product code, and expiration date |
| **Recalculate All** | Runs all system calculations (hierarchy names, rollups) to ensure data accuracy before publishing |
| **Dashboard** | Opens your Personal Cloud Dashboard in a new browser tab |

| Button | Action |
|---|---|
| **Purchase** | Opens the Timebars pricing page to buy or upgrade a license |
| **Sync Users** | Admin-only: syncs resource pool data to portal user accounts |
| **Close** (X icon) | Closes the publishing page and returns to the main application |

---

## 5. Viewing Pubsets

After logging in, your pubsets are displayed in two views:

### Card View

- Shows each pubset as a card with its name and action buttons
- The **active pubset** (the one feeding your Cloud Dashboard) has a **blue background**
- Use this view for a quick visual overview

### Table View

- Shows all pubsets in a sortable, searchable table
- Columns: Active status, Pubset Name, ID, Published Date, Published By, Customer ID, Actions
- Click column headers to sort; use the search box to filter by name, owner, or customer ID
- The active pubset is highlighted in blue
- Action buttons for each pubset: **Download**, **Publish**, **Clear**

---

## 6. Publishing to the Cloud

Publishing takes all your local project data and uploads it to a pubset in the cloud.

### Prerequisites

- Active Timebars Ltd. subscription
- Client application installed and running
- Project data created in the client application
- Internet connection
- Logged into the client app locally (gold icon, top right) AND the cloud (see Section 3)

### Steps

1. Go to the **Pubsets** tab after logging in
2. Click the **Publish** button next to the target pubset
3. Enter a name for the pubset when prompted (or keep the existing name)
4. Wait 3–5 seconds for publishing to complete

### What Gets Published

All six data stores are uploaded:

| Store | Content |
|---|---|
| **tbTimebars** | Tasks, projects, milestones, allocations (scheduling data) |
| **tbMetaData** | Extended metadata: descriptions, status, priority, assessments |
| **tbResources** | Resource definitions (people, roles, teams) |
| **tbTags** | Picklist tag definitions with colours and groupings |
| **tbFields** | Dynamic form field configurations |
| **tbCoreReport** | Report configurations and settings |

After the stores are published, the system also updates RBAC fields (role-based access control) and enterprise metadata (customer ID, access grants).

### Dashboard PubSet vs Storage PubSets

- **Blue Background PubSet** — your **Dashboard PubSet**: directly connected to the Cloud Dashboard. Publishing here updates all dashboard reports and charts immediately.
- **White Background PubSets** — **Storage PubSets**: used for backup and cross-device synchronization. Publishing here does **not** update the dashboard.

**Best Practice:** Use the blue Dashboard PubSet for day-to-day work. Use white PubSets for backups and snapshots.

### After Publishing

- A green toast notification confirms: *"Publishing complete, go to dashboard to see results!"*
- Your data is immediately available in the Personal Cloud Dashboard

---

## 7. Downloading from Cloud to Local (Re-Hydrate)

Downloading restores a published dataset from the cloud into your local browser.

### Steps

1. Go to the **Pubsets** tab
2. Click the **Download** button next to the pubset you want to restore
3. Confirm by entering **y** when prompted: *"Over-write local data?"*
4. Wait for the download to complete

### Important

- **This overwrites all your local data** with the cloud pubset's data
- If you cancel (enter **n**), your local data is not affected
- All six stores are replaced with the downloaded data
- The tbMdJoined table is automatically rebuilt after download
- No page reload is required — views update automatically
- Ensure you have published any unsaved local work before re-hydrating

---

## 8. Clearing a Published Dataset

Clearing removes all data content from a pubset in the cloud while keeping the pubset container.

### Steps

1. Go to the **Pubsets** tab
2. Click the **Clear/Delete** button next to the pubset
3. Confirm the action when prompted

### What Happens

- All six store fields are set to empty arrays
- The pubset container (name, owner, dates) is preserved
- You can publish new data to the same pubset later
- Your local IndexedDB data is **not affected**
- If the cleared pubset was the active pubset, the Cloud Dashboard will show empty data

---

## 9. License and Activation

### License Tiers

| Tier | Products | Pubsets | Features |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Tier-1** | ABT01, TBT01, CBT01 | 0 | Local only — no cloud publishing; Publish icons are hidden |
| **Tier-2** | ABT02, TBT02, CBT02 | per product | Cloud publishing |
| **Tier-3** | ABT03, TBT03, CBT03 | per product | Cloud publishing plus OpenProject sync |

The exact numbers for each product are on the pricing page. They come from your purchased product and are downloaded each time you log in (gold icon, top right):

| License limit | What it counts |
|---|---|
| **Bars** | Every row below the Project level — Sub-Projects, Tasks, Allocations, Milestones, Gates, Risks, Issues and Notes |
| **Projects** (Backlogs in Agilebars) | L2 Project bars |
| **Cloud Pubsets** | How many pubsets you own — missing ones are created each time you log in to the cloud |
| **Spreadsheets** / **Training** | Shown in **Show License**; not enforced by the app |

A blank limit means unlimited. When a limit is exceeded, the New Bar menu is hidden and publishing is disabled until you remove rows or upgrade. Log in again after an upgrade so the new limits are downloaded.

### Activation (One-Time Setup)

Pubsets are created automatically when you log in to the cloud on the Publishing page. Each cloud login re-reads your license and tops your pubsets up to the number it includes:

1. On your first login the system creates all your pubset containers
2. The first pubset is marked as active (feeds the Cloud Dashboard)
3. Remaining pubsets are inactive (for backup or testing)
4. After an upgrade, the next cloud login adds the extra pubsets (inactive)

Pubsets are never deleted automatically — after a downgrade you keep the ones you have. Only the person who purchased the license gets pubsets created; team members see the pubsets shared with them. After activation, your PubSets are permanent until you manually clear them.

### Viewing Your License

Click **Show License** to see your product code, expiration date and license limits:

```
TBT02,expires on: 31-Dec-2026, Bars 500, Projects 10, Pubsets 2, Spreadsheets 2, Training:
Not included
```

---

## 10. Cross-Device Synchronization

The Timebars Cloud enables seamless work across multiple devices.

### Scenario: Work on PC, Continue on iPad

#### On Your PC (Primary Device):

1. Work on your project data normally
2. Choose **Main Menu > Publish** and log in to cloud service
3. Click **Publish** on your Dashboard PubSet (blue background)

#### On Your iPad (Secondary Device):

1. Open the same client app and log in locally (gold icon, top right)
2. Choose **Main Menu > Publish** and log in to cloud service
3. Click **Download** on the Dashboard PubSet — your project data loads
4. Continue working where you left off

#### Syncing Changes Back:

- After making changes on the iPad, click **Publish** to sync back to the cloud
- Back on the PC, click **Download** to get the latest changes

#### Key Rules:

- Always publish after making changes
- Always download before starting work on a different device

- Downloading will overwrite local data — save any local work first

### Real-Time Dashboard Access

After publishing, click the **Dashboard** button in the top nav bar, or visit www.timebars.com/dashboard from any browser. The dashboard is touch-optimized and works on tablets and phones.

---

## 11. OpenProject Sync

The **OpenProject** tab on the Publishing page connects Timebars to an OpenProject instance and moves data in either direction, one project at a time. It is available on **Tier-3 licenses only** (ABT03, TBT03, CBT03); on other licenses the tab is hidden.

Before anything syncs, three things have to be true: Timebars knows which instance to talk to, the two systems agree on what each field is called, and the project has a declared owner. The tab is laid out in that order — the scenario checkboxes at the top for day-to-day running, the **OpenProject Integration** buttons below them for the set-up and repair work you do less often.

---

### A note on wording: projects, and everything under them

OpenProject calls **every** scheduled row beneath a project a *work package*. Timebars does not — it has levels, and the level is what decides where a row goes:

| Timebars | Becomes, in OpenProject |
|---|---|
| **L2 Project** (green bar) | an OpenProject **project** |
| **L3 Sub-Project** (orange bar) | a row of type **L3 SP/WP** |
| **L4 Task** | **L4 Task** |
| **L4 Task** with subtype Risk / Issue / CR | **L4 Risk** / **L4 Issue** / **L4 CR** |
| **L4 Milestone** | **L4 Milestone** |
| **L5 Allocation** (gold bar) | **L5 Allocation**, carrying the assignee |

An OpenProject user who says "work package" almost always means what Timebars calls a **Sub-Project** — the L3 row, which is why its OpenProject type is named `L3 SP/WP`. The rest of this section says *Sub-Project*, *Task* and *Allocation* rather than *work package*, because those are the words on your bars.

**L1 Portfolio does not travel.** OpenProject has no type for it. A sync run always starts at a Project and covers everything under it.

---

### 11.1 Point Timebars at your instance

| Control | What it does |
|---|---|
| **OpenProject URL** | The instance every sync talks to. Type `op.yourcompany.com` — the scheme and any trailing slash are tidied for you. Saved to your settings as the admin panel row **`apOpUrl`**, so it survives a reload and a change of instance no longer needs a rebuild. Leave it empty and the build-time default is used. |
| **Test Connection** | Reads your identity and the instance's type list. It confirms the API key works and prints the work package type ids this instance actually has. Run it first, every time; almost every "nothing happened" report starts here. |

Types are matched **by name at run time, never by id** — a customer's `L5 Allocation` is not necessarily id 13 — so a type renamed in OpenProject admin stops resolving until the name matches again.

---

### 11.2 The four scenarios

Each project has a **sync master**: the side that owns it, held in `tbMDSyncMaster`. The create steps set it; the update steps refuse to run against a project the other way round, and name the button to press instead. Changing master is a deliberate edit on the project, not something a run does behind you.

| | Timebars is master | OpenProject is master |
|---|---|---|
| **Create** | **A1** — create the project and every row under it in OpenProject | **B1** — create the project and every bar under it in Timebars |
| **Update** | **A2** — update OpenProject, creating anything missing | **B2** — update Timebars, creating anything missing |

Tick the box and you are asked for the project id — a Timebars `tbID` for A1 and A2, an OpenProject project id for B1 and B2. Each run previews what it will do and asks once before writing.

There is **no separate bulk-create step**. A2 and B2 create what is missing as part of the update, so a project that has grown since the last run does not need a different button. A row that has been deleted on the master side is **reported, never deleted** on the other — removals stay a human decision.

**A2 recalculates the hierarchy and rollups before it sends**, so the numbers that reach OpenProject are the ones the app would show you.

Every run writes its progress into the feedback list under its own checkbox, and every row it could not carry is named with the reason. Read those lines before assuming the run worked.

---

### 11.3 The Integration buttons

| Button | Reads | Writes | When to use it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Test Connection** | OpenProject | nothing | first, and whenever a run behaves oddly |
| **Discover OP Configuration** | OpenProject | nothing — four CSVs to your Downloads folder | after any field or picklist change in OpenProject admin |
| **Reconcile with OpenProject** | OpenProject | tbSchema, tbTags and tbResources in Timebars, plus five CSVs | straight after Discover, and after every OpenProject configuration change |
| **Create OP Users & Groups** | tbResources | OpenProject users and groups | when setting up people, once the resource pool has emails |
| **Create "All Users" Group** | OpenProject | an *All Users* group holding everybody | when a permission has to be granted to everyone at once |

**Discover** walks the Project, Work Package and User schemas and writes nothing at all — it is safe to run any time.

**Reconcile** is the one that closes the loop. It matches every Timebars field and every picklist value against OpenProject **by name**, and records the ids it finds. Those ids are per-instance — your `customField107` is not another customer's — so they are never typed by hand, and reconciling them from the live instance is the entire point of the button. It previews, then asks before writing, and it changes IndexedDB only. Take a backup first if you want a way back.

Two things Reconcile deliberately does **not** do:

- **It never writes to OpenProject.** OpenProject's API cannot create a custom field or a picklist value, so those are added in its admin screens — Reconcile tells you which ones are missing and downloads the list.
- **It never sets Sync Yes/No.** Whether a field travels is your decision, held in the workbook; an id is a fact about the instance, and Reconcile now records one for every field that declares a mapping whether or not that field is switched on.

---

### 11.4 Where the field mapping lives

The mapping is **data, not code**. Two workbook sheets own it, and two reports in the app show it.

**The Schema sheet** ( `tbSchema` ) is the master field list — one row per field in the system. Alongside each field's label, type and purpose it carries the OpenProject columns:

| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `tbSchOpSyncYN` | **Sync Yes/No** — whether this field travels at all. Yours to set; nothing else writes it |
| `tbSchOpTableName` | which level it maps at — Project, WP, or Users |
| `tbSchOpFormat` | OpenProject's own type for the field, which decides the payload shape. `Formattable` is what routes a rich text field onto the markdown path |

| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `tbSchOpFieldName` | the field's **label** in OpenProject — the name its admin UI shows |
| `tbSchOpInternalName` / `tbSchOpInternalNameWP` | the `customFieldNN` ids, at project and work package level. **Written by Reconcile, never by hand** |

**The Tags sheet** (`tbTags`) does the same for every picklist value: `tbTagOpFieldName` and `tbTagOpInternalName` say which OpenProject field the value belongs to, and `tbTagOpTagName` / `tbTagOpCustomOptionID` hold the value's own name and id in OpenProject — again filled in by Reconcile.

In the app, both are visible and partly editable:

| Report | Where | What you can do |
|---|---|---|
| **Schema Values** | Report Menu → Other | Search and filter the whole field list; **OP Field** and **OP Internal** are shown and locked, because the picklist values join to them and a rename here would orphan them. Label, purpose, width, alignment, Validate and Mandatory are editable |
| **Picklist Values** | Report Menu → Other | Filter to one picklist and open a value. Its **OpenProject Mapping** section lets you pick **OP Field** and **OP Internal** from the names the Schema table owns; **OP Value** and **OP Custom Option ID** are read-only, because OpenProject owns those |
| **Config Integrity** | Report Menu → Other | The standing check across Schema, Tags, Fields and CoreReport. Run it after every spreadsheet import — the drift it finds never throws an error on its own |

`Sync Yes/No`, the level and the format are **workbook columns and are not editable in the app**, on purpose: turning a field on or off is a configuration decision that has to survive the next spreadsheet import, and the workbook is what both stores are rebuilt from.

> **The loop to remember.** Discover and Reconcile write to the browser's database and to your Downloads folder. The workbook is what Timebars is rebuilt from on the next import. Until the reconciled ids are pasted back into the Schema and Tags sheets, the next import throws the reconciliation away. That is what `tbSchemaForWorkbook.csv` and `tbTagsForWorkbook.csv` are for.

---

### 11.5 Two things that travel outside the mapping

Almost everything the sync sends is a **custom field** in OpenProject, and the Schema sheet says where each one goes. Two project attributes are not custom fields, and so cannot be described in the Schema sheet at all:

| In OpenProject | What it is |
|---|---|
| **Description** | the block of text at the top of the project overview page |
| **Status** | the coloured chip beside the project name — On track, At risk, Off track and three more |

These are OpenProject **built-ins**. The Schema sheet's internal-name columns hold `customFieldNN` ids, Reconcile regenerates them from what OpenProject reports about its *custom*

fields, and a built-in appears nowhere in that walk — so a built-in name typed into the workbook by hand would be wiped by the next Reconcile run. Both are therefore written by the sync itself, and **the workbook needs no change for either**.

**This is in addition to the mapping, not instead of it.** `tbMDDescription` still travels to the *TB Description* custom field and `tbMDHealth` still travels to *Schedule Status*, exactly as before. What changed is that the same two values now also fill the OpenProject built-ins, so a project reads correctly to somebody looking at the stock OpenProject page who has never heard of Timebars.

**Description.** The project's `tbMDDescription` is converted to markdown and written to the OpenProject description. A blank description is **not** sent — an update will not wipe text somebody typed in OpenProject just because the Timebars field has not been filled in yet.

**Status** comes from the project's **Health** (`tbMDHealth`, the *Schedule Status* picklist), not from Timebar Status. OpenProject's project status answers *"is this project in trouble"* rather than *"what stage is it at"*, which is the question Health answers too:

| Timebars Health | OpenProject project status |
|---|---|
| On schedule | On track |
| Early | On track |
| Slipping | At risk |
| Late | Off track |
| Blocked | Off track |
| Completed | Finished |
| Not Assessed | Not started |

The seven values above are the whole table, and it is **fixed in code**. OpenProject's six project statuses are a closed set it does not let an administrator add to, so unlike a work package status there is no id to reconcile and nothing that can drift.

A Health value outside that list — one added to the Tags sheet but not to the table above — is reported in the run's feedback list and in its anomaly CSV. What happens then depends on the scenario: **A1** creates the project as *On track*, and **A2** leaves the project's status in OpenProject exactly as it is rather than resetting it. The same applies to a project whose Health is blank.

**Work packages are not affected.** Their own description and status fields are untouched by this and continue to travel only as the custom fields the Schema sheet names. A work package status in OpenProject is an administrator-defined, per-instance list with numeric ids — a different problem from the fixed six above, and not one this table speaks for.

---

### 11.6 The CSV files, and what each one is for

Every button and every run downloads its findings, so you are never reading a mapping problem off a screen. All of them land in the browser's Downloads folder.

**From Discover — what OpenProject actually holds:**

| File | What it answers |
|---|---|
| `opFields.csv` | every custom field on this instance, at every level |
| `opCustomOptions.csv` | every picklist value on this instance |
| `opFieldComparison.csv` | only the fields where OpenProject and `tbSchema` **disagree** |
| `opTagComparison.csv` | only the picklist values where OpenProject and `tbTags` **disagree** |

The two comparison files are the ones to open first: they are short by design, and a field that is not in them is a field that is already fine.

**From Reconcile — what to do next:**

| File | What it answers |
|---|---|
| `tbSchemaForWorkbook.csv` | the **whole** Schema sheet in sheet column order, ids filled in. Paste it over the sheet, below the header rows |
| `tbTagsForWorkbook.csv` | the same for the Tags sheet |
| `opFieldsToCreate.csv` | the fields a Timebars row names that this instance does not have. **Admin-UI work** — the API cannot create them |
| `opRemainingWork.csv` | the picklist values still to add in OpenProject. Same — admin UI |
| `opUnmatchedPeople.csv` | resources with no matching OpenProject user, so an assignee cannot be set |
| `currentOPFormFieldConfigStatus.csv` | **every field each work package type must have on its OpenProject form** - where the requirement comes from, whether `tbSchema` maps it, and whether the form exposes it today. The list to configure a type's form from |

The two workbook files are written **whether or not** you confirm the write into Timebars, because they describe what would change either way.

**From a run — what did not carry:**

`opSyncAnomalies_A1.csv`, `_A2.csv`, `_B1.csv`, `_B2.csv` — one row per thing worth knowing about that run, at three severities:

| Severity | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **blocked** | did not sync. Something has to change before it will |
| **guessed** | synced, but on a fallback rather than an exact match. Worth a look |
| **note** | nothing was lost; worth knowing |

A run whose anomalies are all notes is a clean run. The same lines are printed on screen as the run goes, so the CSV is the copy you can sort, filter and send to whoever owns the fix.

---

### 11.7 When a field will not sync

Almost every "the field is empty in OpenProject" report is one of five things, and the files above name which:

1. `Sync Yes/No` **is not** `Yes` on that `tbSchema` row. Nothing else is wrong; the workbook has decided the field does not travel.
2. **The field does not exist in OpenProject yet** — it is in `opFieldsToCreate.csv`. Add it in OpenProject admin, then Reconcile.
3. **The labels disagree.** Matching is by label, so `Cost Centre` against `Cost Center` resolves at neither level. `opFieldComparison.csv` lists exactly these.
4. **The field exists but is not on that type's form.** OpenProject refuses a value for a field the type does not expose, so the run drops it and says so. Fixing it is **Administration → Work packages → Types → *type* → Form configuration**, by hand — OpenProject has no API for form configuration. A run names each such field **once**, at the top, and only for fields that belong on that type; `currentOPFormFieldConfigStatus.csv` from Reconcile is the full list, type by type.
5. **A picklist value has no option id** — it is in `opRemainingWork.csv`. Add the value in OpenProject admin, then Reconcile.

Order of operations, whenever anything changes on either side: **change it → Discover → Reconcile → paste the two workbook CSVs back into the sheets → run A2 or B2.**

---

### 11.8 Formatted text fields

43 metadata fields hold formatted text — descriptions, executive summaries, options analyses and the rest of the Charter and Assessment content. They are stored in Timebars in the editor's own format and **converted at the sync boundary**: Timebars sends markdown, and markdown coming back is converted for display. Nothing reaches OpenProject as raw markup, and no formatting has to be re-typed.

Two things follow from that:

- **Set those fields to *Long text* in OpenProject.** A field left as single-line *Text* has its formatting flattened on purpose, because markdown syntax in a one-line box is noise. Change the field's type in OpenProject admin and re-run Reconcile — it upgrades itself, with no code change.
- **A round trip loses underline and colour.** Headings, lists, bold, italic, links, quotes and code survive in both directions; markdown cannot carry the other two. Everything else comes back as it went.

---

## 12. Bulk Update

The Bulk Update tab lets you modify data across multiple pubsets simultaneously without downloading and re-publishing each one individually.

### Who You Are Working As

The top of the Bulk Update and Re-Publish tabs states who is logged in and their role, taken from the resource pool (the person's **Primary Role** and **Customer ID** in tbResources, matched by the login email).

| Role | What Load Pubsets loads |
|---|---|
| **Administrator** (shown in red) | **Every** pubset for the administrator's Customer ID, whoever owns it, plus the administrator's own — so one person can bulk update and re-publish for the whole customer |
| Anyone else | Only the pubsets you own |

The **Published Since** date narrows either list. Each loaded pubset shows its owner. An Administrator's changes are written to each pubset in place — the owner does not change.

### Getting Started

1. Go to the **Bulk Update** tab
2. Choose an **Update Mode** (see modes below)
3. Select the **Target Store** you want to update
4. Optionally set a **Published Since** date to filter which pubsets are shown
5. Click **Load Pubsets** to fetch your available pubsets from the cloud
6. Check the boxes next to the pubsets you want to update (or use Select All)
7. Configure the mode-specific options (see below)
8. Click **Apply Bulk Update**
9. Confirm the operation in the dialog

---

### Mode 1: Complete Replacement (JSON File)

**Use case**: Replace the entire contents of a store with data from a prepared JSON file.

**Steps**:

1. Select **Complete Replacement (JSON file)** mode
2. Choose the target store from the dropdown
3. Click **Load Pubsets** and select which pubsets to update
4. Upload a JSON file containing the replacement data
5. The preview shows: file name, size, and record count
6. Click **Apply Bulk Update** and confirm

**JSON file format**:

```
[
  { "tbID": "A001", "tbName": "Task One", "tbWork": 40 },
  { "tbID": "A002", "tbName": "Task Two", "tbWork": 80 }
]
```

The file must contain a JSON array of objects. The entire store content on each selected pubset is replaced with this array.

---

### Mode 2: Filter and Set

**Use case**: Find records matching a specific value in a field and change that field to a new value. Ideal for bulk metadata updates like changing status, priority, or category across many

pubsets at once.

**Available stores**: tbMetaData and tbResources only.

**Steps**:

1. Select **Filter & Set (no file needed)** mode
2. The **Target Store** defaults to tbMetaData
3. The **Published Since** date defaults to one month ago
4. Click **Load Pubsets** and select which pubsets to update
5. If tbMetaData is selected, a **Set Values by Type** filter appears — choose All Types or a specific type (Portfolio, Project, Sub-Project, Task, Milestone, or Allocation)
6. Select a **Field Name** from the dropdown (populated from your Tags definitions in the local database)
7. Select the current value in **Where Value Equals**
8. Select the replacement value in **Set To New Value**
9. Click **Apply Bulk Update** and confirm

**Example**: Change the priority of all Tasks from "Low" to "Medium" across 5 pubsets:

- Store: tbMetaData | Type filter: Task | Field Name: tbMDPriority | Where Value Equals: Low | Set To New Value: Medium

**How the dropdowns are populated**:

| Dropdown | Data Source |
|---|---|
| **Field Name** | Local tbTags store, filtered by prefix (tbMD for tbMetaData, tbRes for tbResources) |
| **Where Value Equals** | Unique values found in the actual pubset data for the selected field. Includes **(Blank)** for empty/null values. Respects the type filter. |
| **Set To New Value** | Tag values from the local tbTags store where tbTagTbInternalName matches the selected field |

---

### Mode 3: Row-Level Patch (CSV File)

**Use case**: Update specific rows identified by their unique ID, changing one or more fields per row.

**Steps**:

1. Select **Row-Level Patch (CSV file)** mode
2. Choose the target store from the dropdown
3. Click **Load Pubsets** and select which pubsets to update
4. Upload a CSV file with your updates
5. The preview shows: file name, size, row count, column names, and a sample row
6. Click **Apply Bulk Update** and confirm

**CSV file format**:

```
tbMDID,tbMDStatus,tbMDPriority
A001,Complete,High
```

```
A002,In Progress,Medium
A003,Not Started,Low
```

**Rules**:

- The first column must be the store's unique key (tbID for tbTimebars, tbMDID for tbMetaData, tbResID for tbResources, etc.)
- Only the fields listed in the CSV are changed; all other fields on the record are preserved
- Rows in the pubset that don't match any CSV key are left unchanged

---

### Bulk Update Results

After execution, a results table appears:

| Column | Content |
|---|---|
| **Pubset Name** | Name of the pubset |
| **ID** | Strapi record ID |
| **Status** | success or failed |
| **Detail** | "Replaced" (Mode 1), "X rows matched" (Mode 2), "X rows patched" (Mode 3), or error message |

- Green background: all pubsets succeeded
- Red background: one or more pubsets failed (check Detail column for error)

---

## 13. Re-Publish with Scheduling Engine

The Re-Publish feature downloads pubsets from the cloud, runs the PM scheduling engine to recalculate all derived data (dates, hours, costs, percent complete, rollups, resource demand), then publishes the refreshed data back to the cloud.

### When to Use

- After a bulk update that changed fields affecting calculations (e.g. status, work hours, dates)
- To refresh derived data across many pubsets without manually opening each one
- When the scheduling engine or rollup logic has been updated and you want all pubsets recalculated

### Steps

1. Go to the **Re-Publish** tab
2. Optionally set a **Published Since** date filter
3. Click **Load Pubsets** — an Administrator gets every pubset for their Customer ID (see *Who You Are Working As* in section 12)
4. Select the pubsets you want to re-publish (checkboxes or Select All)
5. Choose which calculation steps to run (all checked by default):

    - **Scheduling Engine** — recalculates dates, hours, costs, and percent complete for allocations
    - **Rollups & Hierarchy** — rolls up costs and hours from children to parents, rebuilds L1–L5 hierarchy names, regenerates the tbMdJoined table
    - **Resource Calculations** — regenerates weekly and monthly resource demand data (tbResCalcs2, tbResCalcsUsage)
6. Click **Execute Re-Publish**
7. Confirm the operation in the dialog
8. Watch the progress log as each pubset is processed

### The 5-Step Pipeline (per pubset)

| Step | Operation | Description |
|---|---|---|
| **1** | Download to IDB | Fetches the pubset from cloud and loads all stores into local IndexedDB |
| **2** | Scheduling Engine | Runs `calcCostWorkTBCB()` on allocations to recalculate dates, hours, costs, and percent complete |
| **3** | Rollups & Hierarchy | Runs `performFullSystemUpdate()` to roll up values through the hierarchy and rebuild joined tables |
| **4** | Resource Calculations | Runs `createUnifiedWeeklyUsageData()` to regenerate weekly/monthly resource demand splits |
| **5** | Publish Back | Runs `publishToTimebarsCloud()` to upload all stores, then updates RBAC and enterprise metadata |

Steps 2, 3, and 4 can be individually enabled or disabled via the checkboxes.

### Progress Log

A dark terminal-style log panel shows timestamped entries as each step executes:

```
[14:23:45] --- Starting pubset: Project Q4 (ID: 123) ---
[14:23:46] Step 1: Downloading pubset data to IndexedDB...
[14:23:48] Step 1 complete: Data loaded into IDB
[14:23:50] Step 2: Running scheduling engine on allocations...
[14:23:53] Step 2 complete: Scheduling engine finished
[14:23:54] Step 3: Running rollups, hierarchy, and joined table rebuild...
[14:23:56] Step 3 complete: Rollups and hierarchy rebuilt
[14:23:57] Step 4: Regenerating resource calculations...
[14:23:59] Step 4 complete: Resource calculations regenerated
[14:24:00] Step 5: Publishing all stores back to cloud...
[14:24:04] Step 5b: Updating RBAC and enterprise metadata...
[14:24:05] Pubset "Project Q4" re-published successfully!
```

- **Blue text**: Start/end markers | **Green text**: Successful step | **Orange text**: Warnings | **Gray text**: Skipped steps | **Red text**: Fatal errors

### Processing Notes

- Pubsets are processed **one at a time** (sequential) to avoid database conflicts
- Typical time per pubset: 20–25 seconds with all calculation options enabled

- Your local IndexedDB will contain the data from the last processed pubset when complete
- Toast notifications confirm each pubset as it completes

---

## 14. Support Resources

### Knowledge Base

- Browse articles at www.timebars.com/knowledgebase
- Search for specific topics or error messages
- View step-by-step tutorials and videos

### Customer Support

- **Email**: jcox@tbcox.com
- **Support Tickets**: www.timebars.com/support
- **Response Time**: 24–48 hours (varies by subscription level)
- **Phone**: (613) 255-5374

### Feature Requests

- Email: jcox@tbcox.com with a detailed description and use case
- All requests are reviewed for the product roadmap

---

## 15. Quick Reference

### Publishing Workflow

```
1. Log in to client app (gold icon, top right)
2. Main Menu > Publish
3. Cloud Login (email + password)
4. PubSets are created (or topped up) for you on each cloud login
5. Click Publish next to blue PubSet (Dashboard PubSet)
6. View Dashboard button or www.timebars.com/dashboard
```

### Cross-Device Workflow

```
Device A:
1. Make changes
2. Main Menu > Publish → Publish (to save to cloud)

Device B:
1. Main Menu > Publish → Download (to get latest from cloud)
2. Make changes
3. Main Menu > Publish → Publish (to save changes back)

Device A:
1. Main Menu > Publish → Download (to get Device B's changes)
```

## Troubleshooting Quick Reference

| Problem | Solution |
|---|---|
| Cannot log in to cloud | Check email/password; verify subscription at www.timebars.com/login |
| Publishing hangs | Wait 10+ seconds; check browser console for errors |
| Data not in dashboard | Ensure you published to the **active** pubset (blue highlight) |
| Re-Hydrate fails | Check "Last Published" date on pubset — if empty, pubset has no data |
| "No pubsets found" (Bulk Update) | Adjust or clear the Published Since date filter |
| Field Name dropdown empty (Bulk Update) | Ensure local tbTags store has definitions with matching tbTagTbInternalName prefix |
| Pubset is empty (Re-Publish) | Pubset has been cleared — publish data to it first |
| OpenProject run does nothing | Run **Test Connection** first; check the OpenProject URL field ( `apOpUrl` ) |
| A field is empty in OpenProject | Check `Sync Yes/No` on its Schema row, then `opFieldComparison.csv` for a label mismatch |
| A picklist value will not sync | It has no option id — see `opRemainingWork.csv` , add it in OpenProject admin, then Reconcile |
| A2 or B2 refuses to run | The project's sync master is the other side. Use the other button, or change the master on the project |
| Reconciled ids disappear after an import | The two workbook CSVs were not pasted back into the Schema and Tags sheets |
| Project status in OpenProject looks wrong | It comes from the project's Health, not Timebar Status — see the table in section 11.5 |

---

*Cloud Publishing and Bulk Operations Guide v2.2 — Timebars Ltd.*

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# Part 11 — The Personal Dashboard

## Personal Dashboard Guide

The Timebars Personal Dashboard delivers a focused suite of interactive reports, visualizations, and data management tools for individual project managers and team leads. It connects directly and automatically to your **single active pubset** — the pubset you have marked as Active (or "connected") in your Timebars, Agilebars, or Costbars client application. No additional configuration is needed; publish your data and the Personal Dashboard reflects it immediately.

> **Personal Dashboard vs. Enterprise Dashboard** The Personal Dashboard (`/personaldashboard`) is designed for a single-pubset workflow: one user, one active data source, instant access. If your organisation needs to combine data from multiple pubsets across projects or teams into a shared portfolio view, see the Enterprise Dashboard Guide (`/dashboard`).

---

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---

## What is the Personal Dashboard?

The Personal Dashboard is a web-based platform that transforms data from your Agilebars, Timebars, or Costbars application into dynamic visualizations — graphs, line charts, pie charts, bar charts, and tabular reports. It is powered by the **one pubset you have set as Active** in your client application. Unlike the client apps, which work offline, the Personal Dashboard requires an internet connection and an active subscription.

**Key Benefits:**

- **Zero Configuration**: No dashboard sources to create or manage — your Active pubset is the data source
- **Real-Time Updates**: Changes sync automatically when you re-publish from your client app
- **Anywhere Access**: View reports from any device with a modern web browser
- **Interactive Intelligence**: Filter, sort, search, and drill down through hierarchical data
- **Seven-Dimension Health Tracking**: Monitor project health across Overall, Scope, Schedule, Cost, Hours, Risk, and Issues

---

## How to Access

**Prerequisites:**

- Active Timebars Ltd. Cloud subscription
- Published data from Agilebars, Timebars, or Costbars client application
- An **Active pubset** set in the client app (the one flagged as connected)
- Internet connection

**Two Ways to Access:**

1. **From Client Applications**:
   - After publishing your data, click the **Dashboard** button in the client app
   - You will be automatically logged in and directed to the Personal Dashboard
2. **Direct Web Access**:
   - Visit `www.timebars.com/personaldashboard`
   - Log in with your credentials

## How Publishing Connects to Your Dashboard

The Personal Dashboard is powered exclusively by your **Active pubset** — the pubset you have designated as active (connected) in the Publish panel of your client application. This is the key difference from the Enterprise Dashboard, which lets you combine multiple pubsets.

**Workflow:**

1. Open your Timebars, Agilebars, or Costbars client
2. Navigate to **Main Menu → Publish**
3. Log in to the cloud service
4. Identify the pubset with a blue background (your Dashboard/Active pubset)
5. Click **Re-Publish!** to send updated data to the cloud
6. Your Personal Dashboard reflects the new data automatically

For full details on the publishing process, see the Cloud Publishing Guide - Publish reports to the cloud

---

## Dashboard Navigation

The Personal Dashboard uses a **left sidebar navigation** to browse available reports.

### Report Categories

1. **Executive Portfolio Reports**: Portfolio-wide visibility and variance tracking
2. **Card-Based Drilldown**: Interactive hierarchical navigation with health indicators
3. **Charts and Visualizations**: Burndown charts, pie charts, and bar charts
4. **Resource Reports**: Resource allocation, utilization, and cost analysis

**To View a Report:**

- Click any report name in the sidebar
- The report displays in the main viewing area
- Use filters and search to focus on specific data

---

## Project Status Report (Dashboard Home)

Your command center for portfolio-wide visibility. This comprehensive tabular report displays all portfolios, projects, work packages, tasks, and resource allocations from your active pubset in a unified view.

**Key Features:**

- **Multi-Level Search**: Search by project name or unique ID with instant filtering
- **Advanced Filtering**: Filter by Project (L2), Type, Owner, and Status simultaneously
- **Smart Sorting**: Click any column header to sort ascending/descending
- **Color-Coded Rows**: Visual distinction between:
    - Portfolios (light green background)

    - Projects (light orange background)
    - Tasks (default background)
- **Hierarchical Indentation**: Clear visual hierarchy showing Portfolio → Project → Work Package → Task relationships
- **One-Click Details**: Click any row to open a detailed item dialog with full editing capabilities
- **License-Aware Columns**: Display adapts to show Agilebars, Timebars, or Costbars-specific fields based on your license
- **Real-Time Updates**: Data refreshes automatically using SWR caching

**When to Use:**

- Daily portfolio status reviews
- Executive briefings
- Identifying project bottlenecks
- Tracking ownership and accountability
- Quick access to any project detail

**Export Options:**

- Export to Excel with all filtered/sorted data
- Export to CSV for external analysis
- Maintains column order and formatting

---

## Project Variance Report

Track deviations from baseline plans with variance-specific metrics showing the delta between planned and actual performance across cost, schedule, and scope dimensions.

**Key Features:**

- **Variance-Focused Columns**: Baseline vs. actual comparisons for:
    - Start Date Variance (days early/late)
    - Finish Date Variance (days early/late)
    - Duration Variance (work days)
    - Work Variance (hours)
    - Cost Variance (budget units)
- **Deviation Highlighting**: Quickly identify projects off-track from original plans
- **Same Powerful Filtering**: All search, filter, and sort capabilities from the main report
- **Historical Tracking**: Compare current state against original baseline commitments
- **Performance Indicators**: Visual cues for schedule variance, cost variance, and scope creep

**When to Use:**

- Earned Value Management (EVM) analysis
- Monthly project performance reviews
- Identifying projects requiring corrective action
- Forecasting final project outcomes

> **Note:** Baselines must be set in the client application before publishing for this report to show variance data. The Enterprise Dashboard offers an equivalent Variance Report across combined pubset sources.

---

## Interactive Card-Based Drilldown

### Project Status Cards — Hierarchical Navigation

Navigate project data in a visually engaging, click-to-drill format with collapsible cards representing each level of your portfolio hierarchy. Navigate from portfolio to project to work package to individual tasks with interactive health indicators on every card.

### Four-Level Hierarchy

**Level 1 — Portfolio Cards** (Light Brown Background)

- High-level portfolio overview cards
- Aggregated health indicators for all projects within
- Click any portfolio card to reveal its projects

**Level 2 — Project Cards** (Light Green Background)

- All projects within the selected portfolio
- Displays project-level health, dates, owner, status
- Click any project card to reveal work packages and associated Tasks/Risks/Issues

**Level 3 — Work Package Cards** (Light Orange Background)

- Work packages within the selected project
- Click any work package to reveal its Level 4 items

**Level 4 — Tasks, Risks, Issues** (Tabbed Interface)

- Detailed tabular data for individual work items
- Separate tabs for:
  - **Tasks Tab**: All tasks with status, dates, owner, progress
  - **Risks Tab**: Risk probability, impact, mitigation status
  - **Issues Tab**: Issue priority, severity, resolution tracking
- Full editing capabilities on each tab

### Interactive Features

**Breadcrumb Navigation Path:**

- Shows current location: L1 > L2 > L3
- Click breadcrumb levels to navigate back up the hierarchy

**Hide/Show Controls:**

- Toggle visibility of card levels as needed
- Collapse levels to focus on specific areas

**Health Indicator Lights:** Every card displays 7 color-coded health indicators:

- 🟢 **Green**: On track
- 🟡 **Yellow**: Needs attention
- 🔴 **Red**: Critical issue
- 🟠 **Orange**: Not yet assessed

**Seven Health Dimensions:**

1. Overall Health
2. Cost Health
3. Hours Health
4. Risk Health
5. Schedule Health
6. Scope Health
7. Issues Health

**Planned vs. Current Comparison:**

- See baseline dates and current dates side-by-side
- Variance indicators on each card

**When to Use:**

- Executive presentations requiring visual engagement
- Project health assessment at-a-glance
- Understanding risk/issue context within project structure
- Mobile access (card interface is touch-friendly)

---

## Agilebars Burndown Chart

Track sprint velocity and work completion rates with the classic agile burndown chart showing ideal vs. actual progress over time.

**Chart Components:**

- **Ideal Line** (Blue): Planned work burn rate based on sprint timeline
- **Actual Line** (Red/Green): Actual work completion to date
- **X-Axis**: Sprint timeline (days or iterations)
- **Y-Axis**: Remaining work (hours or story points)

**Key Features:**

- Visual comparison of planned burn rate against actual progress
- Sprint performance evaluation and team velocity assessment
- Forecast completion dates

**Prerequisites:**

- Must publish the Active Pubset from the Agilebars client application
- Must run the Burndown calculation in the client before publishing
- Data must include sprint-based work items

**When to Use:**

- Sprint retrospectives and planning
- Daily standup reference
- Velocity trend analysis across sprints

---

## Resource Cost & Usage — Pie Charts

Visualize cost distribution across your active pubset with interactive pie charts breaking down resource costs and hours by multiple dimensions.

**Four Pie Charts Displayed** (2×2 grid):

1. **By Project (L2)**: Which projects consume the most resources
2. **By Resource Role**: Cost distribution across Developer, Manager, QA, Architect, etc.
3. **By Resource Location**: Geographic cost analysis (Office locations, Remote, Offshore)
4. **By Department**: Departmental resource allocation and spend

**Indicator Cards** (Top of Page):

- **Total Cost Cards**: Prominent cards showing total costs for each dimension
- **Currency Formatting**: Professional $USD formatting with thousands separators

**Interactive Features:**

- **Hover Details**: Hover over pie slices for exact values and percentages
- **Legend**: Color-coded legend with labels
- **Percentage Labels**: Show percentage on larger slices

**When to Use:**

- Monthly financial reviews
- Budget allocation decisions
- Chargeback reporting to business units
- Resource planning and forecasting

---

## Resource Usage — Bar Charts

Detailed bar chart analysis of resource utilization across six critical dimensions showing both hours and cost consumption patterns.

**Six Resource Dimensions:**

1. **By Resource Name**: Individual resource utilization and costs
2. **By Project (L2)**: Project-level resource consumption
3. **By Resource Role**: Role-based allocation analysis (PM, Dev, QA, Architect, BA, etc.)
4. **By Primary Skill**: Skill-based resource distribution (Java, Python, Cloud, Database, etc.)

5. **By Resource Location**: Geographic resource allocation
6. **By Department**: Departmental resource usage

**Chart Features:**

- **Stacked Bar Charts**: Show both hours (blue) and cost (green) in single view
- **Dual Y-Axis**: Left axis for hours, right axis for costs
- **Legend Toggle**: Show/hide hours or cost bars independently
- **Configurable Metadata**: Works with your custom metadata fields from the Timebars client

**When to Use:**

- Resource capacity planning meetings
- Skill gap identification for hiring
- Utilization rate analysis
- Workforce planning decisions

---

## Common Features Across All Reports

### Search & Filter

**Text Search:**

- Search by project name or description, or by unique ID
- Instant filtering as you type (case-insensitive)

**Multi-Select Filters:**

- **By Project**: Filter to specific project (L2 level)
- **By Type**: Portfolio, Project, Sub-Project, Task, Milestone, Allocation
- **By Owner**: Filter by assigned resource
- **By Status**: Active, On Hold, Cancelled, Complete
- **"All" Option**: Clear a specific filter dimension instantly

**Filter Combinations:**

- Combine multiple filters for precise data views
- Filters persist during navigation
- Clear all filters with one click

### Sorting

- Click any column header to sort ascending/descending
- Arrow indicators show current sort direction
- Maintains filter state during sort operations

### Inline Editing

- Click the row action button (pencil icon) to open the edit dialog

- Full CRUD operations directly from reports
- Built-in field validation prevents data errors
- Changes sync immediately to the backend

### Health Indicators

**Seven-Dimensional Health Tracking** — all cards and detail views display:

| Dimension | Green | Red |
|---|---|---|
| Overall Health | On track | Critical |
| Cost Health | Under budget | Over budget |
| Hours Health | On track | Over hours |
| Risk Health | Low risk | High risk |
| Schedule Health | On schedule | Late |
| Scope Health | Stable | Scope creep |
| Issues Health | No critical issues | Critical issues |

**Color Coding:**

- 🟢 Green: On track / healthy
- 🟡 Yellow: Needs attention / at risk
- 🔴 Red: Critical issue / off track
- 🟠 Orange: Not yet assessed / no baseline

### Responsive Design

- Touch-optimized controls for tablets and phones
- Adaptive column display on smaller screens
- Fixed headers during scroll on desktop

### Performance

- **SWR Caching**: Client-side data caching for instant navigation
- **Automatic Revalidation**: Data stays fresh with background updates
- **Loading States**: Professional loading indicators during data fetch
- **Error Handling**: Graceful error messages with retry options

---

## Data Export & Integration

### Export Options

Available on all tabular reports:

- **Excel Export**: Full data export with formatting
- **CSV Export**: Raw data for external analysis tools
- **Maintains Filters**: Export only filtered/sorted data

- **One-Click Download**: Simple download button

### Cloud Integration

### Seamless Data Flow:

1. **Publish from Client**: One-click publish from the Timebars/Agilebars/Costbars desktop client selects the Active pubset and sends data to the cloud
2. **Real-Time Sync**: Changes reflect in the dashboard within seconds of publishing
3. **Secure Authentication**: Enterprise-grade JWT security, encrypted data transmission (HTTPS/TLS)
4. **Multi-User Viewing**: Multiple users can view the dashboard simultaneously

See the Cloud Publishing Guide - Publish reports to the cloud for full publishing instructions.

---

## License Tiers & Report Availability

| Report | Basic (T01) | Standard (T02) | Professional (T03) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Project Status Report | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Export to Excel/CSV | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Project Variance Report | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Resource Pie Charts | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Resource Bar Charts | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Card-Based Drilldown | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Burndown Charts (Agilebars) | — | — | ✓ |
| Advanced analytics | — | — | ✓ |

### Check Your License:

- View license details in the client app: **Main Menu → Publish → Show License**
- Upgrade at `www.timebars.com/pricing`

---

## Getting Started with the Personal Dashboard

### Step-by-Step:

1. **Publish Your Data**:
    - Open your Timebars, Agilebars, or Costbars client
    - Navigate to **Main Menu → Publish**
    - Log in to the cloud service
    - Click **Activate** if this is your first time (one-time setup)
    - Identify the pubset with a blue background (your Active/Dashboard pubset)
    - Click **Re-Publish!** to send data to the cloud
2. **Access the Personal Dashboard**:

- Visit `www.timebars.com/personaldashboard`
- Sign in with your credentials

3. **Explore Reports**:
   - Use the sidebar navigation to browse reports
   - Start with the Dashboard Home for a portfolio overview
   - Try Card-Based Drilldown for visual navigation
4. **Filter & Search**:
   - Use search boxes to find specific projects
   - Apply filters to focus on project types, owners, or status
   - Combine filters for precise views
5. **Analyze with Charts**:
   - View Resource charts for capacity planning
   - Use Pie charts for cost distribution analysis
   - Track sprint progress with Burndown charts (Agilebars)

---

## Tips for Effective Use

1. **Regular Publishing**: Publish data daily or weekly to keep the dashboard current
2. **Consistent Metadata**: Use consistent tagging and naming for better filtering
3. **Baseline First**: Set baselines in the client before using the Variance Report
4. **Health Tracking**: Update health indicators regularly for accurate status
5. **Use Cards for Presentations**: Card view is excellent for executive briefings
6. **Export for Offline**: Create Excel exports for offline analysis or board meetings
7. **Check License**: Ensure your license is current for uninterrupted access
8. **Need Multi-Pubset Views?**: If you need to combine multiple pubsets (e.g., across teams or products), use the Enterprise Dashboard instead

---

## Troubleshooting

### Dashboard Not Loading

**Possible Causes:** Internet connection issue, subscription expired, or no data published yet.

**Solutions:**

- Check your internet connection
- Verify subscription status at `www.timebars.com/login`
- Publish data from the client application

---

### Reports Show No Data

**Possible Causes:** Data not published from client, filters excluding all data, or wrong pubset published.

**Solutions:**

- Publish from the client using the Active pubset (blue background)
- Click **All** to clear all filters
- Verify data exists in the client before publishing

---

### Visualization Not Updating

**Possible Causes:** Browser cache, old SWR cache, or publishing to the wrong pubset.

**Solutions:**

- Refresh the browser page (F5 or Ctrl+R)
- Clear the browser cache
- Re-publish from the client to the Active pubset

---

### Cannot Edit Data

**Possible Causes:** Network connectivity issue or session expired.

**Solutions:**

- Check your internet connection
- Log out and log back in
- Verify your subscription is active

---

## Related Help Topics

- Enterprise Dashboard Guide — Combine multiple pubsets into shared portfolio views with RBAC
- Cloud Publishing Guide — How to publish data to the cloud and manage pubsets
- Local Reports Guide — Reports available within client applications
- Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide — Understanding the data model
- User Interface Guide — Navigate the client apps

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## Support

### Need Help?

- Knowledge Base: `www.timebars.com/knowledgebase`
- Email Support: jcox@tbcox.com
- Feature Requests: jcox@tbcox.com
- Phone: (613) 255-5374

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**The Personal Dashboard transforms your active project data into strategic intelligence — accessible anytime, anywhere, on any device.**

# Part 12 — The Enterprise Dashboard

## Enterprise Dashboard Guide

The Timebars Enterprise Dashboard provides a consolidated, organisation-wide view of your project portfolio. It draws data from one or more published datasets (pubsets) — from Agilebars, Timebars, or Costbars — that are combined into a **Dashboard Source**: a single, unified snapshot that powers all reports, charts, and visualizations in the enterprise view.

> **Enterprise Dashboard vs. Personal Dashboard** The Enterprise Dashboard ( `/dashboard` ) is designed for teams and organisations that need to combine data across multiple pubsets — for example, rolling up projects from different teams, products, or time periods into one portfolio view. Role-based access control (RBAC) governs who can see which pubsets and sources.
>
> If you work with a single active pubset and want an instant, zero-configuration view of your own data, see the Personal Dashboard Guide ( `/personaldashboard` ).

---

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1. Getting Started
2. Understanding Dashboard Sources
3. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
4. Creating and Managing Dashboard Sources
5. Managing Pubsets
6. The Executive Dashboard Home
7. Reports
8. Visualizations
9. Drilldown
10. Analytics
11. Shop Schedule (Gantt)
12. Preprocessing Resource Data
13. Quick Reference


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### Getting Started

To access the Enterprise Dashboard, sign in and navigate to **Dashboard** in the main navigation menu. You will land on the Executive Dashboard home page at `/dashboard`.

If you see a message saying you have no access, contact your **Administrator** to have your role assigned or a pubset shared with you (see RBAC below).

#### What you need before using the Enterprise Dashboard

1. A user account with a role of **Administrator**, **Project Manager**, or **Team Member**

2. At least one **pubset** published from Timebars, Agilebars, or Costbars (see the Cloud Publishing Guide - Publish reports to the cloud)
3. At least one **Dashboard Source** created from your pubsets (see Creating and Managing Dashboard Sources)

> **Coming from the Personal Dashboard?** The Enterprise Dashboard requires an extra step — you must create a Dashboard Source before reports will display data. This is because the Enterprise Dashboard lets you combine multiple pubsets, and you choose which combination to activate. The Personal Dashboard skips this step by automatically connecting to your single active pubset.

---

## Understanding Dashboard Sources

A **Dashboard Source** is the data backbone of the Enterprise Dashboard. It is a consolidated snapshot built from one or more pubsets and stored in the system. All reports, charts, and visualizations draw from the currently active source.

### Key facts

- Each source has a **name**, creation date, and an `isActive` flag
- Only **one source can be active at a time** for your organisation
- Sources are created by selecting pubsets at `/dashboard/pubsets`
- You can switch the active source at `/dashboard/sources`
- Sources are **snapshots** — they do not update automatically; create a new source each time your data changes

### How this differs from the Personal Dashboard

| | Personal Dashboard | Enterprise Dashboard |
|---|---|---|
| **Data source** | Your single Active pubset (auto-connected) | One or more pubsets combined into a Dashboard Source |
| **Source creation** | None required | Must create a Dashboard Source |
| **Pubset selection** | Automatic (flagged as Active in client) | Manual — choose which pubsets to combine |
| **Multi-pubset support** | No | Yes |
| **Access control** | Per-user | RBAC (Admin, PM, Team Member) |

### Source naming convention

When a source is generated, the system proposes a name in this format:

```
{Product} — {PubsetNames} [{IDs}] — MMM DD, YYYY HH:MM
```

Example:

```
Timebars — Q1 Portfolio, Infrastructure Refresh [12-14] — Apr 06, 2026 09:30
```

Edit this name before saving to choose something meaningful that lets you identify snapshots later.

---

## Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

The Enterprise Dashboard uses RBAC to control which pubsets and dashboard sources each user can see.

### Roles

| Role | What they can see |
|---|---|
| **Administrator** | All pubsets and sources in the organisation |
| **Project Manager** | Their own pubsets + any pubsets where they have been granted PM access |
| **Team Member** | Their own pubsets + any pubsets where they have been granted TM access |
| *(No role)* | No access to the Enterprise Dashboard |

### How access is granted

- **Ownership**: If you created (own) a pubset, you always have access to it
- **Admin grant**: An Administrator can see all org pubsets by default
- **Explicit grant**: In Timebars/Agilebars/Costbars, the pubset owner can add a user's email to the `grant_pm_access_to` or `grant_tm_access_to` fields when publishing

### Changing a user's role

Roles are managed in **Strapi** (the backend CMS) by an Administrator:

1. Log in to the Strapi admin panel
2. Navigate to **Content Manager → Users**
3. Find the user and edit their `primary_role` field
4. Set to `Administrator`, `Project Manager`, or `Team Member`
5. Save — the change takes effect on the user's next page load

---

## Creating and Managing Dashboard Sources

### Step 1 — Publish your data

Before creating a dashboard source, project data must be **published as a pubset** from within Timebars, Agilebars, or Costbars. See the Cloud Publishing Guide for full publishing instructions. Each publish creates a new pubset record.

### Step 2 — Browse and select pubsets

Navigate to **Dashboard → Manage Pubsets** (`/dashboard/pubsets`). You will see all pubsets your RBAC role grants you access to. Use the checkboxes to select one or more pubsets to consolidate.

### Step 3 — Generate a dashboard source

With pubsets selected, click **Generate Dashboard Source**. You will be taken to the consolidation page (`/dashboard/pubsets/consolidated`) where you can:

- Review which pubsets are included
- Edit the auto-generated source name
- Click **Save Dashboard Source** to create the source

### Step 4 — Set the active source

Navigate to **Dashboard → Manage Sources** (`/dashboard/sources`). You will see a list of all sources accessible to you. Click **Set Active** on the source you want to use. All reports will now draw from this source.

### Managing existing sources

From the Sources page you can:

- **View** source details (which pubsets are included, creation date)
- **Set active** to switch which source powers the dashboard
- **Delete** sources you no longer need

---

## Managing Pubsets

Navigate to **Dashboard → Manage Pubsets** (`/dashboard/pubsets`) to manage your enterprise pubsets.

### What you can do here

- Browse all pubsets you have access to (RBAC-filtered)
- See pubset status, product, owner, and creation date
- Select multiple pubsets and generate a consolidated dashboard source
- View an individual pubset report

### Pubset report

Click **View Report** on any pubset to open a read-only report for that single dataset at `/dashboard/pubsets/report/{id}`.

---

## The Executive Dashboard Home

**Route:** `/dashboard`

The home page provides an executive-level summary of your active dashboard source. It shows:

- Key portfolio metrics and health indicators
- Summary cards with quick-access links to reports
- Status of the currently active dashboard source

If no source is active, you will be guided to create one via the Manage Pubsets page.

---

## Reports

Navigate to **Dashboard → Reports** (`/dashboard/reports`) to access the full report catalogue.

### Project Status Report

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/projects`

Detailed project and portfolio status drawn from the active dashboard source. Shows timelines, budgets, and health indicators for every project in the portfolio — spanning all pubsets included in the active source. Use this report for regular project review meetings.

---

### Portfolio Status Report

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/portfolio`

Portfolio-level insights and strategic analysis across all projects in the active source. Provides cross-project comparisons and helps identify which projects are on track, at risk, or in trouble. Ideal for portfolio review sessions.

---

### Variance Report

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/variance`

Compares current project data against baseline plans to identify schedule and cost deviations across all pubsets in the active source. Quickly highlights where projects are running ahead or behind plan, and by how much.

> This report is unique to the Enterprise Dashboard in that it covers all pubsets in your Dashboard Source.

---

### Risk Register

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/risks`

A consolidated view of all identified risks across the entire portfolio (all pubsets in the active source). Each risk is scored for probability and impact. Includes mitigation plans and escalation tracking so risk owners can take action before issues materialise.

---

### Issues Log

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/issues`

Tracked issues across the entire portfolio, including impact assessment, mitigation status, and escalation levels. Use this log to ensure open issues are being actively managed and resolved.

---

### Change Requests

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/change-requests`

Formal change requests affecting project scope, schedule, or budget. Tracks approval status and the financial or schedule impact of each change. Useful for governance and audit purposes.

---

### Resource Pool Report

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/resources`

Comprehensive resource capacity and allocation data drawn from all pubsets in the active source. Shows availability by role, location, and department alongside current assignments. Use this report to understand where your resource capacity sits across the organisation.

---

### Capacity vs Demand

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/capacity-demand`

Side-by-side view of resource supply and demand by week and role, consolidated across all included pubsets. Highlights overloaded or underutilised resource pools so you can rebalance allocations or plan hiring decisions proactively.

---

### Executive Portfolio Summary

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/executive-summary`

An at-a-glance summary built for executive audiences. Presents portfolio health across seven key dimensions and includes a financial summary. Designed to be shared in board-level or steering committee meetings with minimal preparation.

---

### Project Prioritization Matrix

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/prioritization`

Composite scoring of every project based on health, cost performance, schedule performance, and risk level. Helps leadership decide which projects to continue as-is, restructure, or terminate. Output is a ranked list with a recommended action for each project.

---

### Project Selection Bubble Chart

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/bubble-chart`

A strategic scatter plot of **Strategic Value** vs **Ability to Execute** with bubble size representing project cost. Includes a selection algorithm and quadrant analysis to guide portfolio optimisation decisions. Adjust weights and thresholds interactively to simulate different selection scenarios.

---

### Balanced Scorecard

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/balanced-scorecard`

Assesses portfolio balance across eight KPI dimensions including investment strategy alignment, objectives coverage, risk distribution, resource mix, and project duration spread. Surfaces imbalances that may not be visible from individual project views.

---

### Portfolio Financial Summary

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/financial-summary`

Aggregates financial data across the entire portfolio including NPV, IRR, Payback Period, and ROM Estimates. Provides a single source of truth for portfolio cost analysis and investment return tracking across all included pubsets.

---

### Strategic Alignment Heatmap

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/strategic-alignment`

A heatmap of **Investment Objective vs Category** showing where portfolio spend is concentrated. Quickly reveals whether the portfolio is aligned to your organisation's strategic priorities or skewed towards certain objectives.

---

### What-If Scenario Dashboard

**Route:** `/dashboard/reports/what-if`

An interactive simulation tool. Adjust Strategic Value and Ability to Execute weights and scoring thresholds to model different portfolio decisions and see the financial and health impact of each scenario. Useful for pre-planning workshops and scenario analysis.

---

## Visualizations

Navigate to **Dashboard → Visualizations** (`/dashboard/visualizations`) to access interactive chart views. All visualization data is drawn from the active Dashboard Source.

### Resource Cost Charts

**Route:** `/dashboard/visualizations/cost-charts`

Interactive pie charts showing resource cost distribution across four dimensions: by project, by role, by location, and by department. Drill into any segment to see the contributing detail. Covers all pubsets in the active source.

> **Prerequisite:** Resource data must be preprocessed before these charts will display. See Preprocessing Resource Data.

---

### Resource Usage Charts

**Route:** `/dashboard/visualizations/usage-charts`

Bar charts showing resource utilization across six dimensions with weekly breakdowns. Use these alongside the Resource Pool Report and Capacity vs Demand report to understand allocation patterns across the organisation.

> **Prerequisite:** Resource data must be preprocessed. See Preprocessing Resource Data.

---

### Burndown Charts

**Route:** `/dashboard/visualizations/burndown`

Sprint burndown charts comparing planned vs forecast progress over time. Includes both computed project burndown from Timebars data and sprint-level charts from Agilebars. Covers all included pubsets in the active source.

---

## Drilldown

Navigate to **Dashboard → Drilldown** (`/dashboard/drilldown`) to explore the portfolio hierarchy interactively.

### Project Cards Drilldown

**Route:** `/dashboard/drilldown/cards`

Navigate through your combined portfolio in four levels: **Portfolio → Project → Work Package → Task**. Each card displays health indicators, status, and key metrics. At the task level, tabbed sections show related risks and issues. This view covers all pubsets consolidated in the active Dashboard Source.

> The Personal Dashboard offers an equivalent drilldown scoped to your single active pubset.

---

## Analytics

**Route:** `/dashboard/analytics`

The Analytics section is planned for a future phase. It will provide performance and cost analytics for data-driven project decisions. Check this section for updates as new capabilities are released.

---

## Shop Schedule (Gantt)

**Route:** `/dashboard/facilities`

The Shop Schedule presents facility and shop tasks as a Gantt chart. Filter by schedule type and task status to focus on specific workstreams. Use this view for operational planning when projects involve physical facilities, workshops, or lab schedules.

---

## Preprocessing Resource Data

**Route:** `/dashboard/settings/preprocess`

Before the Resource Cost Charts and Resource Usage Charts can display data, the allocation rows in your active dashboard source must be extracted and reshaped into the resource calculations format (`tbrescalcs2`).

### When to preprocess

- After setting a new active dashboard source
- If resource charts show no data or stale data

### How to preprocess

1. Navigate to **Dashboard → Settings → Preprocess Resource Data**
2. Confirm the active dashboard source shown is the correct one
3. Click **Run Preprocess**
4. Wait for the operation to complete (a confirmation message will appear)
5. Return to the visualization pages — charts should now display updated data

> **Note:** Preprocessing overwrites the previous resource calculations data for your organisation. If you switch the active source, run preprocess again before viewing resource charts.

## Quick Reference

| Task | Where to go |
|---|---|
| View executive summary | `/dashboard` |
| Browse all reports | `/dashboard/reports` |
| Create a dashboard source | `/dashboard/pubsets` |
| Switch active source | `/dashboard/sources` |
| View resource cost charts | `/dashboard/visualizations/cost-charts` |
| View resource usage charts | `/dashboard/visualizations/usage-charts` |
| View burndown charts | `/dashboard/visualizations/burndown` |
| Explore project hierarchy | `/dashboard/drilldown/cards` |
| View shop/Gantt schedule | `/dashboard/facilities` |
| Refresh resource chart data | `/dashboard/settings/preprocess` |
| Manage user roles | Strapi Admin → Content Manager → Users |

### Roles at a glance

| Role | Create Sources | See All Pubsets | See Own Pubsets | See Granted Pubsets |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Administrator | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Project Manager | ✓ | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Team Member | — | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| No role | — | — | — | — |

## Related Help Topics

- Personal Dashboard Guide — Single-pubset dashboard with zero configuration
- Cloud Publishing Guide — How to publish data to the cloud and manage pubsets
- Local Reports Guide — Reports available within client applications
- Data Synchronization, Backup, Recovery and Retention Guide — Understanding the data model
- User Interface Guide — Navigate the client apps

## Support

### Need Help?

- Knowledge Base: `www.timebars.com/knowledgebase`
- Email Support: jcox@tbcox.com
- Phone: (613) 255-5374

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*For technical issues, contact your system administrator or the Timebars support team.*